Before you begin

In July 2026, a candidate for the presidency of Brazil filed an 86-page document in Washington with commitments on Pix, the country's free instant payment system, on Mercosur, the South American trade bloc, and on Brazil's trade[1]. Almost none of it appears in the government platform he registered for Brazilian voters[2]. This report starts from that gap and follows the thread as far as the documents allow. Along the way, questions arise that any voter should be asking:

- Why did a candidate offer the US government, in writing, a law to stop Pix from connecting to "non-Western" systems, without saying a word about it to voters?
- Who left behind, on page 84 of the filed document, the instruction to check the product codes "before filing"? Who wrote the text the senator signed?
- How did money from a Chinese billionaire convicted of fraud in New York reach the conferences Eduardo Bolsonaro organised in Brazil's interior?
- Why do the same businessmen tied to Abu Dhabi appear in the attempted purchase of Banco Master and next to the technology supplier of Flávio's campaign?
- What did the Pentagon buy when it committed $750 million to the vehicle that buys a Goiás rare earths mine's output, and what is left for the town where it sits[3]?
- Why does the sector that sells almost 80% of Brazil's soybeans to China finance a candidate who promises Washington a continent closed to Chinese systems?
- Why did the US government use as evidence against Brazil precisely the law defended by Mato Grosso's soybean growers, the source of most farm money for Flávio?

1 Senator Flávio Bolsonaro, 'Written Comment on the Proposed Action', docket USTR-2026-0331, 1 July 2026, copy published by *Poder360*, https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/07/Flavio-pede-aos-EUA-adiamento-de-tarifaco-2jul2026.pdf.

2 *Diretrizes_Plano_de_Governo_Flavio_Bolsonaro_2027-2030_versaofinal*, *static.poder360.com.br*, 13 August 2026, https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/08/FLAVIO-BOLSONARO-PARA-O-BRASIL-VENCER-O-ATRASO-1-1.pdf.

3 Dionys Duroc, 'War Department Bets $750M on Brazil's Rare Earths Mine', *Sociedad Media*, 25 August 2026, https://www.sociedadmedia.com/serra-verde-rare-earths-war-department-2026/.

- Who paid for the foreign posts that presented betting odds as if they were polls, and who will receive the $1 million the State Department released four days before the first-round vote[4]?
- And, in the end, who pays the bill: the small shopkeeper, the family trapped in revolving credit card debt, the factory worker whose output goes to Argentina, the sugarcane cutter in the Northeast?

Some of these questions the report answers with documents. Others remain open, and the text shows exactly how far the investigation could go and what is still unknown.

Flávio Bolsonaro, a senator and the eldest son of former president Jair Bolsonaro, reached the runoff surrounded by an international network that began to be woven long before the campaign. Between 2018 and 2025, the Bolsonaro family, and above all Eduardo, another of Jair's sons, gathered allies in the United States, Israel, Europe, the United Arab Emirates and the Latin American right. In 2026 this network surfaced in the Trump administration's pressure on the Brazilian judiciary, in campaign playbooks inspired by Trump, Javier Milei and Nayib Bukele, in campaign suppliers with business partners in Abu Dhabi and, above all, in a set of commitments Flávio took to Washington and left out of the platform presented to voters.

This report starts from that last point. What was offered to the United States involves the country's payment system, its customs union with its neighbours and its subsoil. The report asks who gains from that offer, who finances it and who pays the bill, and it shows the network of people, companies and organisations that sustains it. The first round ended with Flávio at 47.03% and President Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva, known as Lula, at 45.16%, and the runoff is on October 25[5].

Everything stated here comes from open sources: official Brazilian and US documents, court records, company registries, reporting in Brazil and the United States, and academic studies. The numbered notes gathered at the end of the text give the source of each fact. When the text offers an interpretation, it says so. Accusations made in court filings by one of the parties are treated as accusations, and the denials of those named are recorded.

How to read this report

The text has nine chapters. Each covers one part of the argument:

1. The concealed programme. What Flávio offered Washington and what he told voters on the same subjects, with the documents side by side.

4 Andrew Roth; Joseph Gedeon, 'Trump administration diverts human rights funds to push far-right agenda abroad', *the Guardian*, 30 September 2026, https://www.theguardian.com/us-news/2026/sep/30/trump-state-department-human-rights-fund.

5 'Flávio Bolsonaro (PL) e Lula (PT) vão disputar o 2º turno para a Presidência da República', *Tribunal Superior Eleitoral*, 5 October 2026, https://www.tse.jus.br/comunicacao/noticias/2026/Outubro/flavio-bolsonaro-e-lula-vao-disputar-o-2o-turno-para-a-presidencia-da-republica.

2. From covert channels to franchise. How the form of US intervention changed from 1962 onwards, until it became a network of conferences, donors and platforms that works like a franchise.

3. The money circuit. Where the money that moved through the network came from: public party funds, a platform financed with fraud proceeds, a liquidated bank and Gulf capital.

4. What is at stake. The three rents in dispute: the card fees Pix took from the card networks, rare earths and state-level concessions.

5. The China contradiction. Agribusiness finances Bolsonarism and sells most of its soybeans to China; how the sector's fractions position themselves and who loses.

6. Coercion. Tariffs, sanctions and visas used against the Brazilian judiciary, and where Washington retreated[6].

7. Israel, the Gulf and the Iberosphere. The network's secondary poles and what each offers and charges.

8. The information machine. How claims produced in Brazil leave the country and return as if they were foreign analysis, from voting machines in 2022 to betting odds in 2026.

9. What the network is. The overall reading, who pays the bill and the questions that remain open.

Three threads run through several chapters. The first is Eduardo's institute, which organises CPAC Brasil and the Brasil Profundo conferences and was paid for by parties, by Gettr and by Aprosoja, the soybean growers' association (chapters 2, 3 and 5)[7]. The second is pressure from Washington, with the same people reappearing from 2018 to 2026 (chapters 1, 2, 6 and 8). The third runs from Abu Dhabi to Texas and links Flávio's technology supplier, the attempted purchase of Banco Master and a US fund linked to Eduardo (chapters 3 and 7). The shaded boxes explain the organisations at the centre of the story.

6 'Fact Sheet: President Donald J. Trump Addresses Threats to the United States from the Government of Brazil', *The White House*, 30 July 2025, https://www.whitehouse.gov/fact-sheets/2025/07/fact-sheet-president-donald-j-trump-addresses-threats-to-the-united-states-from-the-government-of-brazil/.

7 João Pedroso de Campos, 'Instituto do PL pagou R$ 250 mil em patrocínio a evento de Eduardo Bolsonaro em SC', *PlatôBR*, 26 June 2025, https://platobr.com.br/instituto-do-pl-pagou-r-250-mil-em-patrocinio-a-evento-de-eduardo-bolsonaro-em-sc.

Chapter 01: The concealed programme: dependent integration as the class content of 2026

On July 1, 2026, the last day of the comment period, Senator Flávio Bolsonaro's campaign delivered an eighty-six page submission to the Office of the United States Trade Representative, the USTR[89]. Eight days earlier, on June 23, Secretary of State Marco Rubio had replied to a letter from the same senator[10]. Between those two documents sits the political content of the 2026 Brazilian election: what the Bolsonaro campaign undertook to do to the Brazilian state if it won, addressed to a foreign government, set beside what it told Brazilian voters about the same subjects.

The divergence between the two is this chapter's subject, and it is not an accident of campaign communication. The chapter calls dependent integration the programme in which a subordinate state binds its payment infrastructure, its customs union and its subsoil to the strategic requirements of a dominant power. Such a programme cannot be campaigned on in a country where it would demolish the material base of part of the coalition that finances that same campaign. Concealing the programme is the condition under which the coalition holds together.

What the USTR is

The USTR, the Office of the United States Trade Representative, is the agency of the US presidency that negotiates trade agreements and investigates practices of other countries considered harmful to US companies[11]. Those investigations, provided for in Section 301 of the US Trade Act of 1974, can end in tariffs[12]. On July 15, 2025, the USTR opened an investigation of this kind against Brazil, covering digital trade and electronic payment services (Pix), preferential tariffs, anti-corruption enforcement, intellectual property, ethanol

8 Amaury Junior, 'Carta de Flávio aos EUA inclui proposta para restringir integração do Pix', *Folha do Estado da Bahia*, 3 July 2026, https://www.jornalfolhadoestado.com/politica/carta-de-flavio-aos-eua-inclui-proposta-para-restringir-integracao-do-pix/.

9 *PROCESSO: 0602222-72.2026.6.00.0000*, *static.congressoemfoco.com.br*, 23 September 2026, https://static.congressoemfoco.com.br/2026/09/24/attachment/2026/09/24/ff691f_lula_aciona_tse_contra_possivel_financiamento_dos_eua_por_flavio_13_set__2026.pdf.

10 'Rubio responde a carta de Flávio Bolsonaro e reforça defesa de tarifas contra o Brasil', *G1*, 26 June 2026, https://g1.globo.com/politica/noticia/2026/06/26/rubio-responde-a-carta-de-flavio-bolsonaro-e-reforca-defesa-de-tarifas-contra-o-brasil.ghtml.

11 'About USTR', *United States Trade Representative*, https://ustr.gov/about-us/about-ustr.

12 'Notice of Determination and Request for Comments Concerning Action Pursuant to Section 301: Brazil's Acts, Policies, and Practices Related to Digital Trade and Electronic Payment Services; Unfair, Preferential Tariffs; Anti-Corruption Enforcement; Intellectual Property Protection; Ethanol Market Access; and Illegal Deforestation', *Federal Register*, 4 June 2026, https://www.federalregister.gov/documents/2026/06/04/2026-11158/notice-of-determination-and-request-for-comments-concerning-action-pursuant-to-section-301-brazils.

and illegal deforestation[13]. Any interested party may submit written comments and speak at a public hearing, and it was in this process that Flávio filed his submission and addressed the Americans[1415].

Four documents, four audiences

A comparison of four documents shows what each audience heard: Flávio's letter to Rubio of June 2[16]; the eighty-six page submission filed with the USTR on July 1[17]; the transcript of the USTR hearing of July 7[18]; and the government programme registered with the Superior

13 Senator Flávio Bolsonaro, 'Written Comment on the Proposed Action', docket USTR-2026-0331, 1 July 2026, copy published by *Poder360*, https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/07/Flavio-pede-aos-EUA-adiamento-de-tarifaco-2jul2026.pdf.

14 'Initiation of Section 301 Investigation: Brazil's Acts, Policies, and Practices Related to Digital Trade and Electronic Payment Services; Unfair, Preferential Tariffs; Anti-Corruption Enforcement; Intellectual Property Protection; Ethanol Market Access; and Illegal Deforestation; Hearing; and Request for Public Comments', *Federal Register*, 18 July 2025, https://www.federalregister.gov/documents/2025/07/18/2025-13498/initiation-of-section-301-investigation-brazils-acts-policies-and-practices-related-to-digital-trade.

15 'Cinco minutos para argumentação, perguntas e registro oficial: como funcionará a audiência nos EUA que ouvirá Flávio Bolsonaro', *O Globo*, 6 July 2026, https://oglobo.globo.com/politica/noticia/2026/07/06/cinco-minutos-para-argumentacao-perguntas-e-registro-oficial-como-funcionara-a-audiencia-nos-eua-que-ouvira-flavio-bolsonaro.ghtml.

16 Luciana Amaral, 'Em carta, Flávio pede a Rubio que poupe Brasil de nova proposta de tarifaço', *CNN Brasil*, 2 June 2026, https://www.cnnbrasil.com.br/politica/em-carta-flavio-pede-a-rubio-que-poupe-brasil-de-nova-proposta-de-tarifaco/.

17 Senator Flávio Bolsonaro, 'Written Comment on the Proposed Action', docket USTR-2026-0331, 1 July 2026, copy published by *Poder360*, https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/07/Flavio-pede-aos-EUA-adiamento-de-tarifaco-2jul2026.pdf.

18 · · · · · · *EXECUTIVE OFFICE OF THE PRESIDENT*, *ustr.gov*, https://ustr.gov/sites/default/files/files/Issue_Areas/Enforcement/Section%20301/0707%20USTR%20Brazil%20301%20Day%202_full.pdf.

Electoral Court (TSE, which runs and adjudicates Brazilian elections), seventy-six pages long[19][20][21].

The USTR submission has been published in full. Poder360 hosts an eighty-six page copy of the comment filed in docket USTR-2026-0331, with a submission date of July 1, 2026[22]. The page numbers cited below are those of that copy.

The letter to Rubio carried no sectoral commitment[23]. Flávio thanked Washington for its decision to designate the Comando Vermelho (CV) and the Primeiro Comando da Capital (PCC), Brazil's largest criminal organisations, as terrorist organisations, and declared himself ready to "immediately place my transition team at the disposal of your government" in order to conclude "a broad trade and investment agreement"[24]. Rubio replied on June 23[25]. The reply does not thank him for the offer: it records the offer[26]. The Secretary noted the senator's optimism about the October elections and his "generous offer to place a transition team at our disposal", that is, at the disposal of the United States, "should you be elected"[27].

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19 static.poder360.com.br, 'Diretrizes_Plano_de_Governo_Flavio_Bolsonaro_2027-2030_versaofinal', https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/08/FLAVIO-BOLSONARO-PARA-O-BRASIL-VENCER-O-ATRASO-1-1.pdf.

20 static.poder360.com.br, 'Diretrizes_Plano_de_Governo_Flavio_Bolsonaro_2027-2030_versaofinal', https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/08/FLAVIO-BOLSONARO-PARA-O-BRASIL-VENCER-O-ATRASO-1-1.pdf.

21 O Globo, 'Cinco minutos para argumentação, perguntas e', https://oglobo.globo.com/politica/noticia/2026/07/06/cinco-minutos-para-argumentacao-perguntas-e-registro-oficial-como-funcionara-a-audiencia-nos-eua-que-ouvira-flavio-bolsonaro.ghtml.

22 Senator Flávio Bolsonaro, 'Written Comment on the Proposed Action', docket USTR-2026-0331, 1 July 2026, copy published by *Poder360*, https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/07/Flavio-pede-aos-EUA-adiamento-de-tarifaco-2jul2026.pdf.

23 Amaral, 'Em carta, Flávio pede a Rubio', https://www.cnnbrasil.com.br/politica/em-carta-flavio-pede-a-rubio-que-poupe-brasil-de-nova-proposta-de-tarifaco/.

24 Amaral, 'Em carta, Flávio pede a Rubio', https://www.cnnbrasil.com.br/politica/em-carta-flavio-pede-a-rubio-que-poupe-brasil-de-nova-proposta-de-tarifaco/.

25 Amanda Souza, 'Em carta, Rubio agradece a Flávio Bolsonaro por oferta de "equipe de transição" aos EUA caso seja eleito', *Times Brasil | CNBC*, 27 June 2026, https://timesbrasil.com.br/brasil/em-carta-rubio-agradece-a-flavio-bolsonaro-por-oferta-de-equipe-de-transicao-aos-eua-caso-seja-eleito/.

26 G1, 'Rubio responde a carta de Flávio', https://g1.globo.com/politica/noticia/2026/06/26/rubio-responde-a-carta-de-flavio-bolsonaro-e-reforca-defesa-de-tarifas-contra-o-brasil.ghtml.

What Washington was offered

Rubio's letter is not a courtesy. According to Times Brasil, what it thanks him for is his support for designating the PCC and the CV as terrorist organisations[28]. In the same text Rubio defends the USTR investigation into, among other matters, "electronic payment services", which underpins the proposed tariffs on Brazilian products[29].

Twenty-nine days after Flávio's letter, the submission to the USTR, filed as a comment on the six subjects of the investigation, carried a detailed list[3031]. It proposed "a legislative commitment that Pix will not be interconnected to non-Western cross-border settlement arrangements" (page 11), that is, a law to prevent Pix, the Central Bank's free instant payment system, from connecting to the systems of other blocs[3233]. On the same page and the next, it asked for relief from the "regulatory and tax burden" borne by credit and debit cards and

27 Souza, 'Em carta, Rubio agradece a Flávio', https://timesbrasil.com.br/brasil/em-carta-rubio-agradece-a-flavio-bolsonaro-por-oferta-de-equipe-de-transicao-aos-eua-caso-seja-eleito/.

28 Souza, 'Em carta, Rubio agradece a Flávio', https://timesbrasil.com.br/brasil/em-carta-rubio-agradece-a-flavio-bolsonaro-por-oferta-de-equipe-de-transicao-aos-eua-caso-seja-eleito/.

29 Congresso em Foco, 'Carta de Marco Rubio a Flávio reafirma defesa do tarifaço e ataca Pix', *Congresso em Foco*, 26 June 2026, https://www.congressoemfoco.com.br/noticia/120024/carta-de-marco-rubio-a-flavio-reafirma-defesa-do-tarifaco-e-ataca-pix.

30 Office of the United States Trade Representative, 'Section 301 Investigation of Brazil: Public Hearing, Day 2', transcript, 7 July 2026, https://ustr.gov/sites/default/files/files/Issue_Areas/Enforcement/Section%20301/0707%20USTR%20Brazil%20301%20Day%202_full.pdf.

31 'Flávio pediu suspensão de tarifaço e propôs negociar se vencer', *Poder360*, 14 July 2026, https://www.poder360.com.br/poder-eleicoes/flavio-pediu-suspensao-de-tarifaco-e-propos-negociar-se-vencer/.

32 'Flávio Bolsonaro propõe aos Estados Unidos barrar conexão do Pix com sistemas "não ocidentais', *Jornal O Sul*, https://www.osul.com.br/flavio-bolsonaro-propoe-aos-estados-unidos-barrar-conexao-do-pix-com-sistemas-nao-ocidentais/.

33 Senator Flávio Bolsonaro, 'Written Comment on the Proposed Action', docket USTR-2026-0331, 1 July 2026, copy published by *Poder360*, https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/07/Flavio-pede-aos-EUA-adiamento-de-tarifaco-2jul2026.pdf.

acquirers[3435]. The document does not name the companies. At the hearing they acquired a name: Flávio recalled that the volume of transactions on "payment cards issued by U.S. brands continued to grow" alongside Pix (transcript, page 14)[3637]. The document also asked Washington to defer for 180 days the application of the new tariffs[38].

The text went on to Mercosur[39]. On page 12 it proposed to "aggressively pursue ways to establish bilateral agreements" with the United States, said that Brazil "seeks ways to free itself from Mercosur bindings", and cited "the path taken by Javier Milei's Argentina" as a precedent "that the commenter is committed to examining and pursuing"[40]. It also spoke of a "reciprocal zero-for-zero deal on ethanol and sugar" (page 15), of accession to the copyright treaties of the World Intellectual Property Organization and a patent-term-adjustment mechanism (page 14), and promised that the president-elect would "immediately appoint a negotiator" after victory (page 18)[41].

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34 Senator Flávio Bolsonaro, 'Written Comment on the Proposed Action', docket USTR-2026-0331, 1 July 2026, copy published by *Poder360*, https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/07/Flavio-pede-aos-EUA-adiamento-de-tarifaco-2jul2026.pdf.

35 Marcos Hermanson, 'Flávio diz aos EUA querer 'se libertar' do Mercosul e propõe alívio a empresas de cartão de crédito', *Folha de S.Paulo*, 2 July 2026, https://www1.folha.uol.com.br/mercado/2026/07/flavio-diz-a-eua-querer-se-libertar-do-mercosul-e-propoe-alivio-a-empresas-de-cartao-de-credito.shtml.

36 Mariza Sabino, 'Aos EUA, Flávio defende o Pix, mas propõe veto a bloco oriental', *Portal iG*, 3 July 2026, https://ultimosegundo.ig.com.br/2026-07-03/aos-eua–flavio-defende-o-pix–mas-propoe-veto-a-bloco-oriental.html.

37 ustr.gov, '· · · · · ·', https://ustr.gov/sites/default/files/files/Issue_Areas/Enforcement/Section%20301/0707%20USTR%20Brazil%20301%20Day%202_full.pdf.

38 Jornal O Sul, 'Flávio Bolsonaro propõe aos Estados Unidos', https://www.osul.com.br/flavio-bolsonaro-propoe-aos-estados-unidos-barrar-conexao-do-pix-com-sistemas-nao-ocidentais/.

39 Senator Flávio Bolsonaro, 'Written Comment on the Proposed Action', docket USTR-2026-0331, 1 July 2026, copy published by *Poder360*, https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/07/Flavio-pede-aos-EUA-adiamento-de-tarifaco-2jul2026.pdf.

40 Senator Flávio Bolsonaro, 'Written Comment on the Proposed Action', docket USTR-2026-0331, 1 July 2026, copy published by *Poder360*, https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/07/Flavio-pede-aos-EUA-adiamento-de-tarifaco-2jul2026.pdf.

41 Senator Flávio Bolsonaro, 'Written Comment on the Proposed Action', docket USTR-2026-0331, 1 July 2026, copy published by *Poder360*, https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/07/Flavio-pede-aos-EUA-adiamento-de-tarifaco-2jul2026.pdf.

At the hearing on July 7, Flávio put the position in a different register: “Pix is not a problem to be fixed, it’s a solution”[42]. Answering the panel, he said there was “a big chance to have a president that is not anti-American as we have today”, and closed with “You could wait or you could suspend this decision” (transcript, page 34)[43]. Read together, filing and testimony are not an argument about trade. They are a scheduling arrangement: defer the tariff until the electorate has been asked, because the next government will not be anti-American.

The document says otherwise on one page and argues the opposite on the rest. On page 16 it states that the request “rests on the statute, not on any election”[44]. Around that sentence the election is the argument: the text says the incumbent’s “electoral position has strengthened” whenever US tariff pressure was most salient (page 4) and charts that gain (page 5), notes that “Brazil holds general elections in October 2026” and asks for the tariff to wait until after the vote (page 17), offers a deferral that “removes the volatility of the electoral factor” (page 18), warns that the tariff would hand the government “precisely the political victory it has been engineering” (page 19), and devotes an annex, Annex E, to “Electoral Instrumentalization” (page 71)[45]. Six days later, at the hearing, the argument was the same[46]. The filed text also keeps a drafting mark. On page 84, introducing a list of products that should be kept out of the tariff, it says the codes “should be confirmed against the current HTSUS and cross-checked against the exclusions already in the Notice’s Annex before filing”, that is, checked against the current US tariff schedule and against the exclusions already in the notice’s annex

42 ustr.gov, ‘· · · · · ·’, https://ustr.gov/sites/default/files/files/Issue_Areas/Enforcement/Section%20301/0707%20USTR%20Brazil%20301%20Day%202_full.pdf.

43 Office of the United States Trade Representative, ‘Section 301 Investigation of Brazil: Public Hearing, Day 2’, transcript, 7 July 2026, https://ustr.gov/sites/default/files/files/Issue_Areas/Enforcement/Section%20301/0707%20USTR%20Brazil%20301%20Day%202_full.pdf.

44 Senator Flávio Bolsonaro, ‘Written Comment on the Proposed Action’, docket USTR-2026-0331, 1 July 2026, copy published by *Poder360*, https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/07/Flavio-pede-aos-EUA-adiamento-de-tarifaco-2jul2026.pdf.

45 Senator Flávio Bolsonaro, ‘Written Comment on the Proposed Action’, docket USTR-2026-0331, 1 July 2026, pages 4, 5, 17, 18, 19 and 71, copy published by *Poder360*, https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/07/Flavio-pede-aos-EUA-adiamento-de-tarifaco-2jul2026.pdf.

46 Office of the United States Trade Representative, ‘Section 301 Investigation of Brazil: Public Hearing, Day 2’, transcript, 7 July 2026, https://ustr.gov/sites/default/files/files/Issue_Areas/Enforcement/Section%20301/0707%20USTR%20Brazil%20301%20Day%202_full.pdf.

before submission[47]. The instruction, which nobody removed, shows that someone prepared the text for the senator to file. Who did so, the documents do not say.

That this was an organised campaign rather than a senator's private initiative is on the record from the moment the pressure began. In August 2025 Responsible Statecraft reported Eduardo Bolsonaro, then a federal deputy, saying that he had convinced Trump to impose the tariffs; the report ran under the headline "Bolsonaro's son: I convinced Trump to slap tariffs on Brazil"[4849]. On July 30, 2025, the White House issued an executive order imposing an additional 40 per cent tariff on Brazil[50]. The same day the US Treasury designated Justice Alexandre de Moraes under the Global Magnitsky Act, which allows the freezing of assets and the blocking of transactions of foreigners accused of human rights violations[51].

The rare earths memorandum

A fifth document completes the picture. In September 2026 Amado Mundo revealed a twenty-two page "strategic memorandum", in English and in slide format, titled "Prosperity Partnership"[52]. The cover reads "Flávio Bolsonaro | 2026 Campaign", and the other pages carry a logo with the candidate's name[53]. The author is André Marinho, the Novo party's candidate for governor of Rio de Janeiro and the son of Flávio's alternate in the Senate[54]. The authorship appears in the file's metadata and was confirmed by Marinho himself to Amado

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47 Senator Flávio Bolsonaro, 'Written Comment on the Proposed Action', docket USTR-2026-0331, 1 July 2026, copy published by *Poder360*, https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/07/Flavio-pede-aos-EUA-adiamento-de-tarifaco-2jul2026.pdf.

48 Nick Cleveland-Stout, 'Bolsonaro's son: I convinced Trump to slap tariffs on Brazil', *Responsible Statecraft*, 8 August 2025, https://responsiblestatecraft.org/bolsonaro-trump-tarriffs/.

49 Leandro Prazeres; Nomia Iqbal, 'Eduardo Bolsonaro diz que brasileiros entendem que tarifaço de Trump é 'sacrifício a ser feito': 'Nossa liberdade vale mais do que a economia', *BBC News Brasil*, 13 August 2025, https://www.bbc.com/portuguese/articles/c987e8znyg9o.

50 The White House, 'Fact Sheet', https://www.whitehouse.gov/fact-sheets/2025/07/fact-sheet-president-donald-j-trump-addresses-threats-to-the-united-states-from-the-government-of-brazil/.

51 'Treasury Sanctions Alexandre de Moraes', *U.S. Department of the Treasury*, 30 July 2025, https://home.treasury.gov/news/press-releases/sb0211.

52 Guilherme Amado; João Pedroso de Campos, 'Documento traz plano de Flávio Bolsonaro para ceder terras raras a EUA', *Amado Mundo*, 12 September 2026, https://amadomundo.com/documento-eua-terras-raras-governo-flavio-bolsonaro/.

53 Campos, 'Documento traz plano de Flávio Bolsonaro', https://amadomundo.com/documento-eua-terras-raras-governo-flavio-bolsonaro/.

54 Campos, 'Documento traz plano de Flávio Bolsonaro', https://amadomundo.com/documento-eua-terras-raras-governo-flavio-bolsonaro/.

Mundo; he denies that the text is connected to the campaign and says he did not present it to any US official; the campaign did not answer the column's questions[55].

The memorandum, dated March 19, says that a Flávio government "will align with the United States in building a parallel supply system" for critical minerals, proposes a "critical minerals club" aligned with the United States and closes with the line "The West does not have a minerals problem[56]. It has an execution problem. Brazil is the solution"[57]. Nine days later, on March 28, Flávio repeated the thesis on the CPAC stage in Dallas: "Brazil is the United States' solution to break its dependence on China for critical minerals, especially rare earth elements"[58]. None of this is in the programme registered with the TSE, which speaks of mineral partnerships "with all countries", with no preference for any bloc[59].

What voters were told

The Diretrizes 2027-2030 registered with the TSE present Pix as an achievement of the Bolsonaro government: "It was also there that PIX was born, which lifted the weight of bank fees from the poorest Brazilians"[60]. Household indebtedness appears in the same document through the figure of the "revolving card credit", the credit a family falls back on when it cannot pay the full bill[61].

Foreign economic policy appears there as openness to all. The programme promises to negotiate "with all those of interest to Brazil, from China to the European Union, from the

55 Campos, 'Documento traz plano de Flávio Bolsonaro', https://amadomundo.com/documento-eua-terras-raras-governo-flavio-bolsonaro/.

56 Campos, 'Documento traz plano de Flávio Bolsonaro', https://amadomundo.com/documento-eua-terras-raras-governo-flavio-bolsonaro/.

57 Campos, 'Documento traz plano de Flávio Bolsonaro', https://amadomundo.com/documento-eua-terras-raras-governo-flavio-bolsonaro/.

58 Campos, 'Documento traz plano de Flávio Bolsonaro', https://amadomundo.com/documento-eua-terras-raras-governo-flavio-bolsonaro/.

59 static.poder360.com.br, 'Diretrizes_Plano_de_Governo_Flavio_Bolsonaro_2027-2030_versaofinal', https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/08/FLAVIO-BOLSONARO-PARA-O-BRASIL-VENCER-O-ATRASO-1-1.pdf.

60 static.poder360.com.br, 'Diretrizes_Plano_de_Governo_Flavio_Bolsonaro_2027-2030_versaofinal', https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/08/FLAVIO-BOLSONARO-PARA-O-BRASIL-VENCER-O-ATRASO-1-1.pdf.

61 static.poder360.com.br, 'Diretrizes_Plano_de_Governo_Flavio_Bolsonaro_2027-2030_versaofinal', https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/08/FLAVIO-BOLSONARO-PARA-O-BRASIL-VENCER-O-ATRASO-1-1.pdf.

United States to the Asian markets”[62]. It never names Mercosur, and it never names BRICS[63]. It does contain a section on critical minerals[64]. What the programme does not do is present the payment system, the customs union or the mineral reserves as the objects of a negotiation already under way with a foreign government, which is how all three appear in the documents addressed to Washington[6566]. The passages on payments address wages and bank fees as domestic social questions; the minerals section sets out an industrial ambition; the trade passage is a list of partners.

Three crossed signals

On three subjects, voters and Washington heard opposite things. On cards, to the USTR the problem was the regulatory and tax burden on the companies; in the programme, it was the indebted voter whose “salary comes in and goes almost entirely to cover the revolving credit-card balance” (page 32)[6768]. On China, to the USTR Flávio defended “a hemisphere closed to non-Western strategic penetration” and “the integrity of the Western financial architecture” (page 19 of the submission)[69]; in the programme, he promised to negotiate “with all […] from

62 static.poder360.com.br, ‘Diretrizes_Plano_de_Governo_Flavio_Bolsonaro_2027-2030_versaofinal’, https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/08/FLAVIO-BOLSONARO-PARA-O-BRASIL-VENCER-O-ATRASO-1-1.pdf.

63 static.poder360.com.br, ‘Diretrizes_Plano_de_Governo_Flavio_Bolsonaro_2027-2030_versaofinal’, https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/08/FLAVIO-BOLSONARO-PARA-O-BRASIL-VENCER-O-ATRASO-1-1.pdf.

64 static.poder360.com.br, ‘Diretrizes_Plano_de_Governo_Flavio_Bolsonaro_2027-2030_versaofinal’, https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/08/FLAVIO-BOLSONARO-PARA-O-BRASIL-VENCER-O-ATRASO-1-1.pdf.

65 Senator Flávio Bolsonaro, ‘Written Comment on the Proposed Action’, docket USTR-2026-0331, 1 July 2026, copy published by *Poder360*, https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/07/Flavio-pede-aos-EUA-adiamento-de-tarifaco-2jul2026.pdf.

66 Senator Flávio Bolsonaro, ‘Written Comment on the Proposed Action’, docket USTR-2026-0331, 1 July 2026, copy published by *Poder360*, https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/07/Flavio-pede-aos-EUA-adiamento-de-tarifaco-2jul2026.pdf.

67 static.poder360.com.br, ‘Diretrizes_Plano_de_Governo_Flavio_Bolsonaro_2027-2030_versaofinal’, https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/08/FLAVIO-BOLSONARO-PARA-O-BRASIL-VENCER-O-ATRASO-1-1.pdf.

68 Hermanson, ‘Flávio diz aos EUA querer ’se’, https://www1.folha.uol.com.br/mercado/2026/07/flavio-diz-a-eua-querer-se-libertar-do-mercosul-e-propoe-alivio-a-empresas-de-cartao-de-credito.shtml.

69 Senator Flávio Bolsonaro, ‘Written Comment on the Proposed Action’, docket USTR-2026-0331, 1 July 2026, copy published by *Poder360*,

China to the European Union" (page 62)[70]. On sanctions, to the USTR he "does not contest that Brazil has longstanding practices that warrant correction" (page 9 of the submission)[71]; in the programme, "sanctions from the United States" appear side by side with those of China and Europe, as a threat to be met with "effective diplomatic solutions" (page 54)[72].

The pattern is visible in the whole. The programme keeps the commitments that win votes in Brazil, such as fighting criminal money laundering and revoking the measures against digital platforms[73]. The programme does not mention the commitments that have an identifiable foreign beneficiary: the American card brands, US ethanol, American holders of patents and copyrights, and "Western" financial alignment[747576].

The Mercosur nuance

On Mercosur the record is narrower than the campaign's opponents claim and wider than the programme admits. Gazeta do Povo reports a proposal to "relax Mercosur rules to negotiate new bilateral agreements"[77]. The formulation that the document seeks the end of Mercosur is the Lula government's reading of it ("Defending the end of Mercosur […] is one more attack

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https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/07/Flavio-pede-aos-EUA-adiamento-de-tarifaco-2jul2026.pdf.

70 static.poder360.com.br, 'Diretrizes_Plano_de_Governo_Flavio_Bolsonaro_2027-2030_versaofinal', https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/08/FLAVIO-BOLSONARO-PARA-O-BRASIL-VENCER-O-ATRASO-1-1.pdf.

71 Senator Flávio Bolsonaro, 'Written Comment on the Proposed Action', docket USTR-2026-0331, 1 July 2026, copy published by *Poder360*, https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/07/Flavio-pede-aos-EUA-adiamento-de-tarifaco-2jul2026.pdf.

72 static.poder360.com.br, 'Diretrizes_Plano_de_Governo_Flavio_Bolsonaro_2027-2030_versaofinal', https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/08/FLAVIO-BOLSONARO-PARA-O-BRASIL-VENCER-O-ATRASO-1-1.pdf.

73 Senator Flávio Bolsonaro, 'Written Comment on the Proposed Action', docket USTR-2026-0331, 1 July 2026, copy published by *Poder360*, https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/07/Flavio-pede-aos-EUA-adiamento-de-tarifaco-2jul2026.pdf.

74 Senator Flávio Bolsonaro, 'Written Comment on the Proposed Action', docket USTR-2026-0331, 1 July 2026, copy published by *Poder360*, https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/07/Flavio-pede-aos-EUA-adiamento-de-tarifaco-2jul2026.pdf.

75 ustr.gov, '· · · · · ·', https://ustr.gov/sites/default/files/files/Issue_Areas/Enforcement/Section%20301/0707%20USTR%20Brazil%20301%20Day%202_full.pdf.

76 static.poder360.com.br, 'Diretrizes_Plano_de_Governo_Flavio_Bolsonaro_2027-2030_versaofinal', https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/08/FLAVIO-BOLSONARO-PARA-O-BRASIL-VENCER-O-ATRASO-1-1.pdf.

on the interests of the Brazilian people"), and belongs to an adversary's statement about the text, not to the text[78]. What the document says, on page 12, is that Brazil seeks to "free itself from Mercosur bindings" in order to negotiate with the United States and that Milei's path is a precedent to examine[79].

The chosen example weakens the argument. "The path taken by Javier Milei's Argentina" was not to leave Mercosur[8081]. Argentina remains in the bloc and ratified, as did Brazil, Uruguay and Paraguay, the Mercosur agreement with the European Union, which has been provisionally in force since May 1, 2026[8283]. An agreement negotiated bloc to bloc presupposes remaining in the bloc.

The mineral counterpart

The extractive half of the programme has a measurable counterpart in the United States. Serra Verde, a rare earths miner in the state of Goiás, has entered into a fifteen-year offtake agreement with the US government for 100 per cent of its Phase I production, with guaranteed price floors for its magnetic rare earths[84]. The Department of War committed $750

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77 Gazeta do Povo Lab; John Lucas, 'O impacto de Flávio Bolsonaro na política externa com China e EUA', *Gazeta do Povo*, 11 October 2026, https://www.gazetadopovo.com.br/mundo/flavio-bolsonaro-planeja-guinada-na-politica-externa-com-foco-nos-eua/.

78 Sabino, 'Aos EUA, Flávio defende o Pix,', https://ultimosegundo.ig.com.br/2026-07-03/aos-eua–flavio-defende-o-pix–mas-propoe-veto-a-bloco-oriental.html.

79 Senator Flávio Bolsonaro, 'Written Comment on the Proposed Action', docket USTR-2026-0331, 1 July 2026, copy published by *Poder360*, https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/07/Flavio-pede-aos-EUA-adiamento-de-tarifaco-2jul2026.pdf.

80 Hermanson, 'Flávio diz aos EUA querer 'se', https://www1.folha.uol.com.br/mercado/2026/07/flavio-diz-a-eua-querer-se-libertar-do-mercosul-e-propoe-alivio-a-empresas-de-cartao-de-credito.shtml.

81 'Agora é oficial: acordo comercial UE-Mercosul entra em vigor a partir de 1º de maio', *O Globo*, 23 March 2026, https://oglobo.globo.com/economia/noticia/2026/03/23/agora-e-oficial-ue-mercosul-entra-em-vigor-a-partir-de-1o-de-maio.ghtml.

82 Evelyn Ann-Marie Dom, 'Acordo comercial UE-Mercosul entra em vigor provisoriamente', *euronews*, 1 May 2026, https://pt.euronews.com/2026/05/01/uniao-europeia-acordo-comercial-com-o-mercosul-entra-em-vigor-provisorio.

83 Nayara Batschke, 'Paraguay ratifica acuerdo UE-Mercosur, el último en hacerlo por el bloque sudamericano', *AP*, 17 March 2026, https://apnews.com/article/paraguay-ue-mercosur-acuerdo-libre-comercio-votacion-7eafff0a6da191c754b0bffb48de5ff3.

84 *sec.gov*, 24 August 2026, https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1970622/000121390026092810/ea030292401ex99-

million to the special purpose vehicle holding that offtake, $250 million more than the $500 million originally contemplated[85]. The resale prospectus accompanying the transaction lists the US International Development Finance Corporation (DFC) as a selling stockholder with 15,221,917 shares[86]. The department announced the package as part of a $1.55 billion initiative.[87]

Brazilian law moved the other way. On September 16, 2026, President Lula signed into law a national policy for critical and strategic minerals, with R$5 billion in tax credits and a council empowered to decide on foreign participation in the sector[88].

The contradiction that forces concealment

The programme is concealed because one fraction of the campaign's own base cannot survive its disclosure. China bought 87.1 million of the 108.6 million tonnes of soybeans Brazil exported in 2025, "around 80%" of the total[89]. On its own count, Valor puts the Chinese share at 78.7 per cent[90]. On September 10, 2026, during a panel at the Bradesco BBI Agro Summit, Blairo Maggi, former governor of Mato Grosso, former agriculture minister and owner of the Amaggi group, said that Bolsonaro "got it wrong" and that the foreign ministry also got it wrong "in staging that confrontation with China to please the United States"[9192]. Senator

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2.htm.

85 *sec.gov*, 28 August 2026, https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1970622/000121390026092810/ea030292401ex99-1.htm.

86 *sec.gov*, 18 November 2025, https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1970622/000121390026100977/ea0305798-424b3_usarare.htm.

87 'Department of War Announces a $750 Million Investment as Part of a $1.55 Billion Initiativ', *U.S. Department of War*, 24 August 2026, https://www.war.gov/News/Releases/Release/Article/4581110/department-of-war-announces-a-750-million-investment-as-part-of-a-155-billion-i/.

88 Fernanda Brigatti; Caio Spechoto, 'Lula sanciona lei dos minerais críticos com R$ 5 bi em subsídios e poder de decidir sobre estrangeiros', *C-Level*, 16 September 2026, https://c-level.folha.uol.com.br/infraestrutura/2026/09/lula-sanciona-lei-dos-minerais-criticos-com-r-5-bi-em-subsidios-e-poder-de-decidir-sobre-estrangeiros.shtml.

89 Gustavo Lustosa, 'Brasil fecha 2025 com recorde na exportação de soja, diz Anec', *AgFeed*, 8 January 2026, https://agfeed.com.br/economia/brasil-fecha-2025-com-recorde-na-exportacao-de-soja-mas-anec-ja-projeta-desafios-para-2026/.

90 'Graças às tarifas de Trump, o Brasil deve continuar como grande fornecedor de soja para a China', *Valor Econômico*, 30 April 2026, https://valor.globo.com/publicacoes/especiais/revista-brasil-china/noticia/2026/04/30/gracas-as-tarifas-de-trump-o-brasil-deve-continuar-como-grande-fornecedor-de-soja-para-a-china.ghtml.

Tereza Cristina said that in the event of a Flávio Bolsonaro government there would have to be balance in agribusiness negotiations with China and the United States.[93]

Four weeks later the same bloc backed the candidate. On October 8, 2026, the president of the Frente Parlamentar da Agropecuária, the congressional farm caucus, said: “I see no other way than for everyone to throw themselves headlong into this campaign”[9495].

An export fraction whose profits run through Beijing, financing a candidate who has offered Washington a payment architecture built against Chinese systems, is not being incoherent. It is buying time, and what it is trying to postpone is the disclosure of the programme. This is a contradiction inside a class fraction rather than between classes: the same fraction that needs the Chinese market needs American political cover, and concealing the programme is the arrangement that permits both to be pursued in one electoral cycle.

The limits of the instrument

The sequence of pressure that produced the USTR submission also shows the limits of those who carried it. The 40 per cent tariff imposed in July 2025 was removed from Brazilian food products, including beef, coffee, cocoa and fruits, on November 20, 2025[96]. The final Section 301 action, in July 2026, imposed a 25 per cent tariff[97], but not on everything: according to the Minister of Development, Márcio Elias Rosa, it reaches about 18 per cent of Brazilian

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91 Pasquale Augusto, ‘Rei da Soja’ diz que Bolsonaro errou ao enfrentar a China, alerta para grande perigo no agronegócio e chama Trump de ‘doidão’, *Money Times*, 10 September 2026, https://www.moneytimes.com.br/para-o-rei-da-soja-bolsonaro-errou-ao-enfrentar-china-cita-grande-perigo-para-o-agronegocio-brasileiro-e-chama-trump-de-doidao-pads/.

92 Augusto, ‘Rei da Soja’ diz que Bolsonaro’, https://www.moneytimes.com.br/para-o-rei-da-soja-bolsonaro-errou-ao-enfrentar-china-cita-grande-perigo-para-o-agronegocio-brasileiro-e-chama-trump-de-doidao-pads/.

93 ‘Flávio Bolsonaro precisará de equilíbrio em negociações do agro com EUA e China se for eleito, diz senadora’, *Valor Econômico*, 12 October 2026, https://valor.globo.com/agronegocios/noticia/2026/10/12/flavio-bolsonaro-precisara-de-equilibrio-em-negociacoes-do-agro-com-eua-e-china-se-for-eleito-diz-senadora.ghtml.

94 Isadora Duarte, ‘Presidente da FPA diz que não há outro caminho senão agro entrar na campanha de Flávio Bolsonaro’, *Estadão*, 8 October 2026, https://www.estadao.com.br/politica/eleicoes/presidente-da-fpa-diz-que-nao-ha-outro-caminho-senao-agro-entrar-na-campanha-de-flavio-bolsonaro/.

95 Cesar Augusto de Lara Fraga, ‘Dossiê identifica 142 empresários do agronegócio ligados a atos golpistas’, *Extra Classe*, 28 July 2025, https://www.extraclasse.org.br/politica/2025/07/dossie-identifica-142-empresarios-do-agronegocio-ligados-a-atos-golpistas/.

96 Ismail Shakil; Marcelo Teixeira, ‘Trump signs order to remove tariffs from Brazilian beef, coffee’, *Reuters*, 20 November 2025, https://www.reuters.com/world/us/trump-signs-order-remove-tariffs-some-brazilian-agricultural-imports-2025-11-20/.

exports to the United States, about $7.4 billion[98]. Beef, coffee and orange juice were left out; sugar, ethanol, agricultural machinery, footwear and paper were hit[99]. The request for deferral produced nothing. Moraes, designated in July 2025[100], was removed from the list on December 12, 2025[101].

Washington's leverage over Brazil is real and expensive to use, and the pressure accordingly migrated into the grant machinery. In the last hours of the US fiscal year, the State Department obligated a $1 million award titled "Countering Lawfare and Censorship in Brazil", after the Secretary of State signed a memo to disregard a senator's ten holds on $22 million of awards[102]. Nor did the network prevent Brazilian institutions from acting: the Supreme Federal Court (STF) convicted Eduardo Bolsonaro of coercion in June 2026[103].

The allegation and the record

The Lula coalition's petition to the TSE argues that the conduct "is not exhausted by the contest for competitive advantage among rivals" and does not reduce to ordinary offences of propaganda or campaign finance; it characterises the parallel diplomacy as direct external interference and abuse of political power[104]. The same petition records the appointment of

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97 Lisandra Paraguassu; David Lawder; Devika Madhusudhanan Nair; Devika Nair, 'US imposes new 25% tariffs on Brazil, expands exemptions list', *Reuters*, 16 July 2026, https://www.reuters.com/world/americas/us-imposes-25-tariff-some-goods-brazil-2026-07-16/.

98 Estadão Conteúdo, 'Nova tarifa dos EUA afetará até 18% das exportações do Brasil, diz ministro', *InfoMoney*, 16 July 2026, https://www.infomoney.com.br/economia/nova-tarifa-dos-eua-afetara-ate-18-das-exportacoes-do-brasil-diz-ministro/.

99 'Notice of Action: Brazil's Acts, Policies, and Practices Related to Digital Trade and Electronic Payment Services; Unfair, Preferential Tariffs; Anti-Corruption Enforcement; Intellectual Property Protection; Ethanol Market Access; and Illegal Deforestation', *Federal Register*, 20 July 2026, https://www.federalregister.gov/documents/2026/07/20/2026-14542/notice-of-action-brazils-acts-policies-and-practices-related-to-digital-trade-and-electronic-payment.

100 U.S. Department of the Treasury, 'Treasury Sanctions Alexandre de Moraes', https://home.treasury.gov/news/press-releases/sb0211.

101 'Global Magnitsky Designations Removals', *Office of Foreign Assets Control | U.S. Department of the Treasury*, 12 December 2025, https://ofac.treasury.gov/recent-actions/20251212.

102 Andrew Roth; Joseph Gedeon, 'Trump administration diverts human rights funds to push far-right agenda abroad', *the Guardian*, 30 September 2026, https://www.theguardian.com/us-news/2026/sep/30/trump-state-department-human-rights-fund.

103 'Eduardo Bolsonaro é condenado pelo STF por coação em trama golpista', *G1*, 16 June 2026, https://g1.globo.com/politica/noticia/2026/06/16/moraes-vota-para-condenar-eduardo-bolsonaro-por-coacao-em-processo-sobre-trama-golpista.ghtml.

Darren Beattie as senior adviser for Brazil policy[105]. The petition is a party's pleading, and its characterisations are treated here as allegations.

Independent reporting records that Flávio Bolsonaro was received by President Trump in the Oval Office on May 26, 2026[106].

Conclusion

The concealed programme is the election's central political fact because it defines what the contest is about. A vote for the Bolsonaro ticket is a vote for a government that has already told Washington what it intends to do with the payment system, the customs union and the subsoil, while telling voters something else. The chapters that follow address the material base of that offer: which fractions gain from dependent integration, which lose, and how a coalition assembled from both can be held together long enough to win.

Chapter 02: From covert channel to franchise: the forms of US intervention, 1962 to 2026

Three organisational forms, one function. The covert corporate apparatus that financed candidates against João Goulart was exposed when a parliamentary commission of inquiry made its money visible, and was suspended by presidential decree in August 1963 and dissolved by court order that December[107]. The military option that replaced it was a state's option and carried a state's costs: a dictatorship of twenty-one years whose bill was paid inside Brazil[108]. The police and judicial channel of 2013 to 2018 ended in the largest foreign bribery settlement in the history of the US Department of Justice, and left the Brazilian

104 static.congressoemfoco.com.br, 'PROCESSO', https://static.congressoemfoco.com.br/2026/09/24/attachment/2026/09/24/ff691f_lula_aciona_tse_contra_possivel_financiamento_dos_eua_por_flavio_13_set__2026.pdf.

105 static.congressoemfoco.com.br, 'PROCESSO', https://static.congressoemfoco.com.br/2026/09/24/attachment/2026/09/24/ff691f_lula_aciona_tse_contra_possivel_financiamento_dos_eua_por_flavio_13_set__2026.pdf.

106 Rodrigo Chagas, 'Em meio a denúncias de interferência de Trump, Flávio foi seis vezes aos EUA neste ano eleitoral', *Brasil de Fato*, 2 October 2026, https://www.brasildefato.com.br/2026/10/02/em-meio-a-denuncias-de-interferencia-de-trump-flavio-foi-seis-vezes-aos-eua-neste-ano-eleitoral/.

107 Sérgio Lamarão, 'Instituto Brasileiro de Ação Democrática (IBAD)', *CPDOC, Fundação Getulio Vargas*, 20 September 2024, https://www18.fgv.br/cpdoc/acervo/dicionarios/verbete-tematico/instituto-brasileiro-de-acao-democratica-ibad.

108 Thomas E. Skidmore, *The Politics of Military Rule in Brazil, 1964-85*, *Oxford University Press*, 1988.

operators who had run it exposed in turn[109]. The form that takes shape from 2019 onwards is a brand owned by the American organisation and licensed to a Brazilian deputy's institute: five editions of an American conference between 2019 and 2024 and, in 2026, the governing channel of a presidential campaign[110]. The campaign's principal advertising contractor, F.A.R.O, is commanded by Duda Lima and received R$13.1 million of the R$49.98 million in contracted expenses declared by early September 2026; the same accounts carry R$3 million for 'TV Celular', a live YouTube programme running twenty-four hours a day.[111] The PL's Direita Já platform runs on a system associated with another Brazilian digital operator.[112]

Chapter 1 showed what was offered in 2026 and to whom. This chapter shows where the offer came from. What changes across the forms is the design of liability, not the purpose. The object, that is, the terms on which foreign capital controls Brazilian assets, is constant; what moves is who carries the legal risk: first a Brazilian front, then a foreign state, finally a Brazilian licensee.

One caveat applies to the whole chapter. The new form adds to the old ones; it does not replace them. The records of US government agencies on the recent period remain classified, and those agencies' history in Brazil does not allow their involvement to be ruled out. What is new is that much of the pressure came to be exerted in the open, with a name and an address.

The covert form and the problem of exposure

In the 1962 legislative elections the vehicle was the Instituto Brasileiro de Ação Democrática (IBAD) and its electoral arm, Ação Democrática Popular, financed by foreign corporations with operations in Brazil and by transfers sent to a Royal Bank of Canada account held in the name of an advertising agency[113]. That year the money reached candidates through IBAD and

109 'Odebrecht and Braskem Plead Guilty and Agree to Pay at Least $3.5 Billion in Global Penalties to Resolve Largest Foreign Bribery Case in History', *Office of Public Affairs | Odebrecht and Braskem Plead Guilty and Agree to Pay at Least $3.5 Billion in Global Penalties to Resolve Largest Foreign Bribery Case in History*, 21 December 2016, https://www.justice.gov/archives/opa/pr/odebrecht-and-braskem-plead-guilty-and-agree-pay-least-35-billion-global-penalties-resolve.

110 Redação SGBR, 'Brasil é destaque em evento da extrema direita global', *Sleeping Giants Brasil: descubra como combatemos fake news*, 30 March 2026, https://sleepinggiantsbrasil.com/saiba-como-foi-a-participacao-brasileira-no-maior-evento-da-extrema-direita-global/.

111 Aliz Lambiazzi, 'Flávio Bolsonaro já gastou quase R$ 50 milhões em campanha; veja principais despesas', *Folha de Alphaville*, 8 September 2026, https://folhadealphaville.com.br/politica/2026/09/08/flavio-bolsonaro-ja-gastou-quase-r-50-milhoes-em-campanha-veja-principais-despesas.html.

112 Diego Feijó de Abreu, 'Site do PL, que propaga ataques de Flávio Bolsonaro a Lula, usa sistema de Pablo Marçal', *Revista Fórum*, 7 August 2026, https://revistaforum.com.br/politica/direita-ja-pablo-marcal-pl-lula/.

113 CPDOC - Centro de Pesquisa e Documentação História Contemporânea do Brasil, 'INSTITUTO BRASILEIRO DE ACAO DEMOCRATICA (IBAD) | CPDOC - Centro de

its electoral arm, which poured funds into the campaigns of 250 candidates for federal deputy, 600 for state deputy and eight for governor;[114] the institute drew on contributions from Brazilian and foreign businessmen, as the Fundação Getulio Vargas's historical research centre records.[115] A parliamentary commission of inquiry uncovered the transfers in 1963, and on August 31, 1963 a decree of President João Goulart suspended both organisations for three months, and on December 20, 1963 the courts ordered their dissolution[116]. The episode is usually told as a story about Washington's reach. Its more important lesson is about exposure: once the funding became visible, the liability settled on the Brazilian institution and its head, and the instrument had to be dropped in the middle of an electoral cycle.

What came next was not a front but a state, and the channel of contact ran through the armed forces rather than through an electoral committee. The main American contact with the conspiring officers was the military attaché, Vernon Walters[117]. In 1964 officials in Washington evaluated a proposal, transmitted by the ambassador Lincoln Gordon the previous day, calling for the covert delivery of armaments and gasoline and for the positioning of a naval task force off the Brazilian coast.[118][119] On March 31, 1964, President Johnson authorised the American military to supply arms, ammunition and fuel, covertly and overtly, and, if needed, combat troops, should the effort to overthrow Goulart meet strong resistance; the declassified Joint Chiefs of Staff records of that authorisation are known as Operation Brother Sam[120][121]. The Joint Chiefs assigned the operation its code name that same

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Pesquisa e Documentação de História Contemporânea do Brasil', *CPDOC - Centro de Pesquisa e Documentação de História Contemporânea do Brasil*, 20 September 2024, https://www18.fgv.br/cpdoc/acervo/dicionarios/verbete-tematico/instituto-brasileiro-de-acao-democratica-ibad.

114 Memorial da Democracia, 'Memorial da Democracia', http://memorialdademocracia.com.br/card/ibad-custeia-eleicao-da-direita-no-brasil.

115 Brasil, 'INSTITUTO BRASILEIRO DE ACAO DEMOCRATICA (IBAD)', https://www18.fgv.br/cpdoc/acervo/dicionarios/verbete-tematico/instituto-brasileiro-de-acao-democratica-ibad.

116 Sérgio Lamarão, 'Instituto Brasileiro de Ação Democrática (IBAD)', *CPDOC, Fundação Getulio Vargas*, 20 September 2024, https://www18.fgv.br/cpdoc/acervo/dicionarios/verbete-tematico/instituto-brasileiro-de-acao-democratica-ibad.

117 William Blum, *Killing Hope: U.S. Military and CIA Interventions Since World War II*, *Zed Books*, 2003.

118 'Brazil Marks 50th Anniversary of Military Coup', *National Security Archive, George Washington University*, 31 March 2004, https://nsarchive2.gwu.edu/NSAEBB/NSAEBB465/.

119 Blum, 'Killing Hope'.

120 National Security Archive, George Washington University, 'Brazil Marks 50th Anniversary of Military', https://nsarchive2.gwu.edu/NSAEBB/NSAEBB465/.

121 National Security Archive, George Washington University, 'Brazil Marks 50th Anniversary of Military', https://nsarchive2.gwu.edu/NSAEBB/NSAEBB465/.

day, the day the troops moved, and the published diplomatic record of the period cites their telegram of that date[122][123]. This form worked, and it worked by giving up any possibility of denying involvement. Because the instrument was a state, the liability was a state's liability, and it fell on the Brazilian population rather than on the sponsors[124].

That gives the periodisation its first hinge. The covert form collapsed when it became visible; the military form collapsed when it lost legitimacy. Both were expensive, and neither could be repeated at the pace the 2026 conjuncture requires.

The judicial and security form

Half a century later the object had changed. The discovery of large offshore oil reserves reopened the question of who would operate them and on what terms[125]. In September 2013 the Guardian reported, from the documents leaked by Edward Snowden, that the US National Security Agency (NSA) had intercepted Petrobras's private networks, and that President Dilma Rousseff had put her planned state visit to Washington in doubt and asked for explanations[126]. Her own account of the motive was explicit: if the reports were confirmed, it would be evident that the purpose was not security or the fight against terrorism but strategic economic interests[127].

The instrument that followed was judicial. The archive of Telegram messages published by The Intercept in June 2019 shows a judge and the prosecutors in the case against Lula discussing timing, evidence and messaging in a collaboration the reporting describes as prohibited, and records their own doubts about the evidence they were using[128]. Less visible is

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122 'Foreign Relations of the United States, 1964-1968, Volume XXXI, South and Central America; Mexico', *US Department of State*, https://history.state.gov/historicaldocuments/frus1964-68v31/ch5.

123 US Department of State, 'Foreign Relations of the United States,', https://history.state.gov/historicaldocuments/frus1964-68v31/ch5.

124 Perry Anderson, *Brazil Apart 1964-2019*, *Verso*, 2019.

125 Anthony Boadle, 'NSA spying on Petrobras, if proven, is industrial espionage: Rousseff', *Reuters*, 9 September 2013, https://www.reuters.com/article/business/nsa-spying-on-petrobras-if-proven-is-industrial-espionage-rousseff-idUSBRE98817O/.

126 Jonathan Watts, 'NSA accused of spying on Brazilian oil company Petrobras', *the Guardian*, 9 September 2013, https://www.theguardian.com/world/2013/sep/09/nsa-spying-brazil-oil-petrobras.

127 Boadle, 'NSA spying on Petrobras, if proven,', https://www.reuters.com/article/business/nsa-spying-on-petrobras-if-proven-is-industrial-espionage-rousseff-idUSBRE98817O/.

128 Andrew Fishman; Rafael Moro Martins; Leandro Demori; Alexandre de Santi; Glenn Greenwald, 'Exclusive: Leaked Chats Between Brazilian Judge and Prosecutor Who Imprisoned Lula Reveal Prohibited Collaboration and Doubts Over Evidence', *The Intercept*, 9 June 2019, https://theintercept.com/2019/06/09/brazil-lula-operation-car-wash-sergio-

the parallel channel: Agência Pública's investigation examined the FBI's role in the Curitiba task force[129], and Brazilian legislators later signed a letter asking their American counterparts to demand from the United States government an explanation of the cooperation between the FBI and Lava Jato[130][131].

The material result was a settlement. In December 2016 Odebrecht and Braskem pleaded guilty in the Eastern District of New York and agreed to pay at least $3.5 billion in global penalties, the largest foreign bribery case in the department's history[132]. The construction groups that carried Brazilian engineering into Latin America and Africa were taken out of the market. The point is not that the prosecutions were fabricated. It is that benefit and liability fell in different places: the benefit to the American state and to the foreign oil companies that, once a 2016 law ended Petrobras's role as mandatory operator of the pre-salt fields, bid in the auctions held from late 2017[133]; the liability to a Brazilian judge and a Brazilian prosecutor, the visible operators. The Intercept published their private messages from June 2019[134]; in March 2021 the Supreme Court's Second Panel declared the judge, Sergio Moro, biased in Lula's case[135]; and in May 2023 the Superior Electoral Court annulled the election of the prosecutor, Deltan Dallagnol, as a federal deputy, ruling him ineligible[136].

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moro/.

129 Natalia Viana; Alice Maciel; Amanda Audi; Sofia Amaral, 'Confidencial: as digitais do FBI na Lava Jato', *Agência Pública*, 1 July 2026, https://apublica.org/especial/confidencial-as-digitais-do-fbi-na-lava-jato/.

130 Brasilwire, 'Folha: Brazilian lawmakers demand US probe into secret FBI-Lava Jato cooperation', *BRASILWIRE*, 17 July 2020, https://www.brasilwire.com/folha-brazilian-lawmakers-fbi-and-lava-jato-cooperation/.

131 Brasilwire, 'Folha', https://www.brasilwire.com/folha-brazilian-lawmakers-fbi-and-lava-jato-cooperation/.

132 Office of Public Affairs | Odebrecht and Braskem Plead Guilty and Agree to Pay at Least $3.5 Billion in Global Penalties to Resolve Largest Foreign Bribery Case in History, 'Odebrecht and Braskem Plead Guilty and', https://www.justice.gov/archives/opa/pr/odebrecht-and-braskem-plead-guilty-and-agree-pay-least-35-billion-global-penalties-resolve.

133 Nick Cleveland-Stout, 'Como petroleiras gringas usaram um think tank para apoiar a Lava Jato e tomar o pré-sal', *Intercept Brasil*, 30 August 2024, https://www.intercept.com.br/2024/08/30/petroleiras-gringas-apoio-lava-jato/.

134 Greenwald, 'Exclusive', https://theintercept.com/2019/06/09/brazil-lula-operation-car-wash-sergio-moro/.

135 Ana Pompeu; Hyndara Freitas; Luiz Orlando Carneiro, '2ª Turma do STF declara suspeição de Moro em processo de Lula', *JOTA*, 23 March 2021, https://www.jota.info/stf/do-supremo/2a-turma-do-stf-declara-suspeicao-de-moro-em-processo-de-lula.

The franchise

The third form answers precisely that weakness. The term franchise is used here for an arrangement in which a foreign private organisation owns a political brand and licenses it to a local operator, who handles the money, the address and the risk. The first thread was pulled during the transition. In November 2018, before his father took office, Eduardo Bolsonaro went to Washington to talk with Jared Kushner, Trump's son-in-law and adviser, about moving the Brazilian embassy in Israel to Jerusalem, and posed in a "Trump 2020" cap[137]. The same year, the fighter Royce Gracie introduced him to Donald Trump Jr., the president's eldest son, at a gun show in Las Vegas; Eduardo himself thanked him for the introduction on social media[138][139].

In February 2019 Eduardo announced in a statement that he was "very proud" to join Steve Bannon, the former strategist of Trump's campaign, as South American leader of The Movement, the network Bannon was trying to build with the far right of several countries[140][141][142]. By August 2021 Bannon's ambition to turn Brazil into the next MAGA

136 'Por unanimidade, TSE cassa registro do deputado federal Deltan Dallagnol', *Tribunal Superior Eleitoral*, 16 May 2023, https://www.tse.jus.br/comunicacao/noticias/2023/Maio/por-unanimidade-tse-cassa-registro-do-deputado-federal-deltan-dallagnol-pode.

137 Estadão Conteúdo, 'Com boné "Trump 2020", Eduardo Bolsonaro diz que embaixada brasileira em Israel será em Jerusalém', *GZH*, 28 November 2018, https://gauchazh.clicrbs.com.br/mundo/noticia/2018/11/com-bone-trump-2020-eduardo-bolsonaro-diz-que-embaixada-brasileira-em-israel-sera-em-jerusalem-cjp0hdw730h5j01pib0ewog89.html.

138 Robert Mackey, 'Eduardo Bolsonaro, Pro-Trump Son of Brazil's President, on Track to Be Ambassador to U.S.', *The Intercept*, 13 August 2019, https://theintercept.com/2019/08/13/eduardo-bolsonaro-pro-trump-son-brazils-president-track-ambassador-u-s/.

139 *Volume 11, Número 2, Novembro de 2022*, *cech.ufscar.br*, 25 November 2022, https://www.cech.ufscar.br/pt-br/news/imagens/artigo-casaroes-americanizacao-journal-of-democracy-1.pdf.

140 The Movement, 'Steve Bannon Welcomes Eduardo Bolsonaro as Head of The Movement in South America', *Cision PR Newswire*, 2 February 2019, https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/steve-bannon-welcomes-eduardo-bolsonaro-as-head-of-the-movement-in-south-america-300788579.html.

141 Thais Bilenky, 'Bannon anuncia Eduardo Bolsonaro como líder sul-americano de movimento de direita populista', *Folha de S.Paulo*, 1 February 2019, https://www1.folha.uol.com.br/mundo/2019/02/bannon-anuncia-eduardo-bolsonaro-como-lider-sul-americano-de-movimento-de-ultradireita.shtml.

142 Mackey, 'Eduardo Bolsonaro, Pro-Trump Son of Brazil's', https://theintercept.com/2019/08/13/eduardo-bolsonaro-pro-trump-son-brazils-president-track-ambassador-u-s/.

battleground was the subject of a long profile in an American magazine,[143] which does not prove the relationship worked but does establish that it was public, deliberate and advertised. The role matters because of what it licensed: not a state but a private organisation conferred a transnational political role on a deputy, and a private organisation can be renamed, wound up or sold without any government having to answer for it. Agência Pública's survey of the years that followed counts 125 meetings between Eduardo and figures of the continent's far right[144][145].

Personal access came with it. In March 2019, on Jair Bolsonaro's first visit to the United States as president, Trump called Eduardo into the private meeting in the Oval Office, according to his father's own account[146][147]. On the eve of that visit, on March 16, Eduardo joined Steve Bannon and Olavo de Carvalho at the Trump International Hotel in Washington for the screening of a documentary in Olavo's honour, and was photographed in a "Make Brazil Great Again" cap.[148] In July, Jair announced that he wanted to nominate his son as ambassador in Washington[149]. Trump praised the choice, and in August the US government

143 Andre Pagliarini, 'Steve Bannon Wants to Turn Brazil Into the Next MAGA Battleground', *The New Republic*, 17 August 2021, https://newrepublic.com/article/163301/steve-bannon-brazil-maga-battleground-bolsonaro.

144 Alice Maciel; Juliana Dal Piva; Ken Silverstein; Bianca Muniz; Natalia Viana, 'Eduardo Bolsonaro teve 125 reuniões com membros da extrema direita do continente', *Agência Pública*, 7 August 2023, https://apublica.org/2023/08/eduardo-bolsonaro-teve-125-reunioes-com-membros-da-extrema-direita-do-continente/.

145 Agência Pública, 'Como Eduardo Bolsonaro e comitiva articulam com parlamentares dos EUA punições ao Brasil', *CartaCapital*, 11 April 2024, https://www.cartacapital.com.br/politica/como-eduardo-bolsonaro-e-comitiva-articulam-com-parlamentares-dos-eua-punicoes-ao-brasil/.

146 'US President Endorses Bolsonaro's Son as Ambassador to The United States', *Folha de S.Paulo*, 31 July 2019, https://www1.folha.uol.com.br/internacional/en/world/2019/07/us-president-endorses-bolsonaros-son-as-ambassador-to-the-united-states.shtml.

147 Mackey, 'Eduardo Bolsonaro, Pro-Trump Son of Brazil's', https://theintercept.com/2019/08/13/eduardo-bolsonaro-pro-trump-son-brazils-president-track-ambassador-u-s/.

148 Julia Braun, 'Eduardo Bolsonaro se reúne com Steve Bannon em Washington', *VEJA*, 17 March 2019, https://veja.abril.com.br/politica/eduardo-bolsonaro-se-reune-com-steve-bannon-em-washington/.

149 Reuters, 'Brazil's Bolsonaro offers his son US ambassador post', *Al Jazeera*, 12 July 2019, https://www.aljazeera.com/news/2019/7/12/brazils-bolsonaro-offers-his-son-us-ambassador-post.

gave its formal approval, the agrément[150]. The nomination went no further, but the personal channel was open.

The brand and who paid for it

The brand followed the person. In 2019 Eduardo brought the American Conservative Union's conference to Brazil[151], and by October the event was being reported as an American import in which he reproduced Trump's gestures on stage before a Brazilian audience[152]. The first edition, in São Paulo, was paid for by the Fundação Indigo, the foundation of the PSL, then Bolsonaro's party, with money from the Fundo Partidário, the public fund distributed to political parties[153]. Its organisers expected about 1,200 participants,[154] and its speakers included Senator Mike Lee, Walid Phares and two leaders of the American Conservative Union, Charles Gerow and Mercedes Schlapp.[155] At the closing session, Eduardo and Matt Schlapp, chairman of the American organisation, went on stage to sign publicly a letter of commitment guaranteeing the following editions in Brazil[156][157].

What CPAC is

150 'Bolsonaro says Trump approved his son as ambassador to Washington', *The Times of Israel*, 9 August 2019, https://www.timesofisrael.com/bolsonaro-says-trump-approved-his-son-as-ambassador-to-us/.

151 Fábio Zanini, 'Evento em SC consolida aliança de bolsonarismo com direita global', *Folha de S.Paulo*, 5 July 2024, https://www1.folha.uol.com.br/poder/2024/07/evento-em-sc-consolida-alianca-de-bolsonarismo-com-direita-global.shtml.

152 Ligia Guimarães, 'Sob gritos de 'mitinho', Eduardo Bolsonaro repete gesto de Trump e convoca direita em evento 'importado' dos EUA', *BBC News Brasil*, 12 October 2019, https://www.bbc.com/portuguese/brasil-50024632.

153 Guimarães, 'Sob gritos de 'mitinho', Eduardo Bolsonaro', https://www.bbc.com/portuguese/brasil-50024632.

154 Ricardo Galhardo, 'Veja quem são os participantes da conferência de direita em São Paulo', *Estadão*, 11 October 2019, https://www.estadao.com.br/politica/veja-quem-sao-os-participantes-a-da-conferencia-de-direita-em-sao-paulo/.

155 Viana, 'Eduardo Bolsonaro teve 125 reuniões com', https://apublica.org/2023/08/eduardo-bolsonaro-teve-125-reunioes-com-membros-da-extrema-direita-do-continente/.

156 'CPAC e a integração conservadora Brasil-EUA', *opeu.org.br*, 20 October 2019, https://www.opeu.org.br/2019/10/20/cpac-e-a-integracao-conservadora-brasil-eua/.

157 FĂ˘bio Zanini, 'Conservative Event Solidifies Eduardo Bolsonaro as Successor to Father', *Folha de S.Paulo*, 14 October 2019, https://www1.folha.uol.com.br/internacional/en/brazil/2019/10/conservative-event-solidifies-eduardo-bolsonaro-as-successor-to-father.shtml.

CPAC, the Conservative Political Action Conference, is the most important annual gathering of the American right[158]. It belongs to the American Conservative Union, an organisation created in 1964, shortly after the defeat of the Republican Barry Goldwater, to give the party's right wing a permanent voice; the conference has existed since 1974, and Matt Schlapp has chaired the board since 2014[159][160]. His wife, Mercedes Schlapp, was director of strategic communications in Trump's White House during his first term and has played an outsize role at CPAC events;[161] in March 2026 she appeared at the conference as a CPAC senior fellow.[162] It operates through two entities with nearly identical leadership: the American Conservative Union itself, which has a greater array of political actions it can take legally, and the tax-exempt foundation that produces the conference[163][164].

Its finances grew with the turn to Trump[165]. According to its annual returns to the US tax authority, the American Conservative Union's revenue was $16.7 million in the fiscal year ending March 2019 and $21.2 million in the fiscal year ending March 2025; the donors are not identified[166][167]. Critics have accused the organisation of selling space to whoever pays.

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158 'American Conservative Union', *Ballotpedia*, 28 July 2025, https://ballotpedia.org/American_Conservative_Union.

159 Ballotpedia, 'American Conservative Union', https://ballotpedia.org/American_Conservative_Union.

160 Johan Norberg, 'Matt Schlapp', *Young America's Foundation*, 19 July 2023, https://yaf.org/people/matt-schlapp/.

161 Neil Vigdor, 'New Allegation of Sexual Misconduct Swirls Around CPAC Chair Matt Schlapp (Published 2025)', *The New York Times*, 20 February 2025, https://www.nytimes.com/2025/02/20/us/cpac-matt-schlapp.html.

162 Nathan Layne, 'At CPAC, Republicans close ranks behind Trump on Iran war', *Reuters*, 26 March 2026, https://www.reuters.com/world/us/cpac-republicans-close-ranks-behind-trump-iran-war-2026-03-26/.

163 S V Date, 'CPAC, Not Registered As A Foreign Agent, Is Taking Money From Foreign Interests Anyway', *HuffPost*, 25 February 2022, https://www.huffpost.com/entry/cpac-fara-foreign-interests_n_62193e3de4b0f800ce212893.

164 Grant Silverman, 'Rallying the Troops: CPAC and the International Far Right', *illiberalism.org*, 23 December 2025, https://www.illiberalism.org/rallying-the-troops-cpac-and-the-international-far-right/.

165 Peter Stone, 'Critics accuse CPAC of becoming pay-to-play as Trump loyalists gain power', *the Guardian*, 14 March 2022, https://www.theguardian.com/us-news/2022/mar/14/cpac-pay-to-play-trump-loyalists-gain-power.

166 Andrea Suozzo; Alec Glassford; Ash Ngu; Brandon Roberts, 'American Conservative Union', *ProPublica*, 9 May 2013, https://projects.propublica.org/nonprofits/organizations/520810813.

In 2023 the Republican operative Carlton Huffman sued Schlapp for sexual assault; the case ended in March 2024 with a $480,000 settlement paid by an insurer, and Schlapp denies the accusation[168]. The same year the treasurer, Bob Beauprez, resigned saying he could not vouch for the accounts[169], and the board's vice chair, Charlie Gerow, left in August calling for an investigation[170].

Since 2017 CPAC has held editions outside the United States, in Japan, Australia, South Korea, Hungary, Israel, Mexico, Argentina, Poland and Brazil[171]. The American organisation owns the brand and licenses it to a local partner in each country, which stages the conference[172]. The partners also pay to appear at the American event: in 2022 those from Korea and Japan gave $75,000 each, without the organisation registering as a foreign agent[173]. In Australia, the government warned the local partner that its relationship with CPAC might require it to register under the foreign influence transparency law, and the country's High Court upheld the law in 2021[174].

At the opening of the 2019 edition, Eduardo said the event "does not serve as a way for us to map out a strategy to reach power"[175]. In the same opening, according to Agência Pública, he

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167 'American Conservative Union (ACU)', *Influence Watch*, 31 March 2023, https://www.influencewatch.org/non-profit/american-conservative-union-acu/.

168 Jamie Gangel; Gregory Krieg, 'CNN Exclusive: Conservative bigwig Matt Schlapp agreed to hefty settlement to end sexual assault lawsuit', *CNN*, 27 March 2024, https://www.cnn.com/2024/03/27/politics/matt-schlapp-settlement-sexual-assault-lawsuit.

169 Ben Jacobs, 'CPAC Is Rocked by a Resignation', *Intelligencer*, 25 May 2023, https://nymag.com/intelligencer/2023/05/bob-beauprez-resigns-from-cpac-blasting-matt-schlapp.html.

170 Natalie Allison, 'CPAC vice chair resigns amid turmoil', *POLITICO*, 25 August 2023, https://www.politico.com/news/2023/08/25/cpac-vice-chair-resigns-amid-turmoil-00113078.

171 The Associated Press, 'Noem urges Poles to elect Trump ally as CPAC holds its first meeting in Poland', *NPR*, 28 May 2025, https://www.npr.org/2025/05/28/g-s1-69278/noem-cpac-poland.

172 Silverman, 'Rallying the Troops', https://www.illiberalism.org/rallying-the-troops-cpac-and-the-international-far-right/.

173 Date, 'CPAC, Not Registered As A Foreign', https://www.huffpost.com/entry/cpac-fara-foreign-interests_n_62193e3de4b0f800ce212893.

174 Elizabeth Byrne, 'Think tank behind conservative conference loses High Court bid against Australia's foreign influence laws', *Abcnews*, 16 June 2021, https://www.abc.net.au/news/2021-06-16/conservative-think-tank-libertyworks-loses-high-court-bid/100219092.

175 opeu.org.br, 'CPAC e a integração conservadora Brasil-EUA', https://www.opeu.org.br/2019/10/20/cpac-e-a-integracao-conservadora-brasil-eua/.

called the conference “the very embryo” of the creation of a world movement of the right.[176] What came later went in another direction. At the Campinas edition, in June 2022, there were explicit calls to vote for Jair Bolsonaro, before the official campaign period[177]. In 2024 the sponsorship contract with the Liberal Party (PL, Bolsonaro’s party) reserved ten minutes of stage time for the party[178].

A local vehicle followed: an institute registered in December 2019 and publicly launched in December 2020, set up to raise money and modelled explicitly on the Heritage Foundation and the American Conservative Union[179][180].

What the Instituto Conservador-Liberal is

It is the association that organises CPAC Brasil and the Brasil Profundo congress[181]. It was registered on December 23, 2019, two months after the first CPAC Brasil, and is listed as active with the Federal Revenue Service[182]. It was founded by Eduardo Bolsonaro and has the lawyer Sérgio Sant’Ana as a founder; its declared activities include organising congresses,

176 Viana, ‘Eduardo Bolsonaro teve 125 reuniões com’, https://apublica.org/2023/08/eduardo-bolsonaro-teve-125-reunioes-com-membros-da-extrema-direita-do-continente/.

177 Alice Maciel, ‘How The Trump Universe Is Backing Bolsonaro’s Reelection Bid In Brazil’, *Agência Pública*, 24 June 2022, https://apublica.org/2022/06/how-the-trump-universe-is-backing-bolsonaros-reelection-bid-in-brazil/.

178 João Pedroso de Campos, ‘Instituto do PL pagou R$ 250 mil em patrocínio a evento de Eduardo Bolsonaro em SC’, *PlatôBR*, 26 June 2025, https://platobr.com.br/instituto-do-pl-pagou-r-250-mil-em-patrocinio-a-evento-de-eduardo-bolsonaro-em-sc.

179 Fábio Zanini, ‘Novo instituto de Eduardo Bolsonaro busca financiadores e se espelha na direita pró-Trump’, *Folha de S.Paulo*, 4 July 2021, https://www1.folha.uol.com.br/poder/2021/07/novo-instituto-de-eduardo-bolsonaro-busca-financiadores-e-se-espelha-na-direita-pro-trump.shtml.

180 CNPJá, ‘INSTITUTO CONSERVADOR - LIBERAL, CNPJ 36.376.724/0001-81 (Receita Federal registration data)’, *CNPJá*, 19 October 2026, https://cnpja.com/office/36376724000181.

181 Da Redação, ‘Congresso de direita em Várzea Grande terá presença de Eurodeputado espanhol | Rdnews - Principais notícias de Cuiabá, Várzea Grande e Mato grosso’, *Rdnews - Principais notícias de Cuiabá, Várzea Grande e Mato grosso*, 3 December 2021, https://www.rdnews.com.br/legislativo/congresso-de-direita-em-varzea-grande-tera-presenca-de-eurodeputado-espanhol/152771.

182 CNPJá, ‘INSTITUTO CONSERVADOR - LIBERAL, CNPJ 36.376.724/0001-81 (Receita Federal registration data)’, *CNPJá*, 19 October 2026, https://cnpja.com/office/36376724000181.

publishing books and conducting opinion polls[183][184]. In 2022 Eduardo rented a house in Brasília to host the institute, which, according to Veja, had fewer than a hundred members, paying monthly fees of up to R$5,000[185]. In the company registry, the institute's declared seat was, in October 2021, a commercial office room in the Setor Comercial Sul, in central Brasília; it is now a residential plot in the Setor de Habitações Individuais Sul, in Lago Sul.[186] CPAC Brasil is organised by the institute[187]. It should not be confused with ICL Notícias, a news outlet with no connection to it.

The revenue model is documented in the brand owner's own numbers. Conference revenue rose from $735,000 in the period April 2020 to January 2021 to $3.4 million in the period April 2021 to January 2022[188]. An investigation into the same events found organisers charging foreign groups between $15,000 and $75,000 for packages that included exhibition space, main-stage video airtime and dedicated social media amplification, without registering as foreign agents: CPAC Hungary paid $15,000 for a ten-by-ten booth at the American gathering, and the Japanese Conservative Union and CPAC Korea each paid $75,000 for twenty-by-ten booths[189][190].

On the Brazilian side the money came from three places, and who paid changed with each phase. In 2019 it was the PSL, through the Fundação Indigo[191]. In July 2024 the Liberal Party's foundation, the Instituto Álvaro Valle, paid R$250,000 to sponsor that year's conference, CPAC Brasil 2024 in Balneário Camboriú, and the transfer reached Eduardo's

183 'INSTITUTO CONSERVADOR', *cnpja.com*, 23 December 2019, https://cnpja.com/office/36376724000181.

184 Ethel Rudnitzki, 'Sócio de Eduardo Bolsonaro presta serviço para campanhas eleitorais', *Agência Pública*, 1 October 2026, https://apublica.org/2026/10/socio-de-eduardo-bolsonaro-presta-servico-para-campanhas-eleitorais/.

185 Hugo Marques, 'Instituto Conservador-Liberal de Eduardo Bolsonaro não decolou', *VEJA*, 15 July 2023, https://veja.abril.com.br/politica/instituto-conservador-liberal-de-eduardo-bolsonaro-nao-decolou/.

186 'Instituto Conservador - Liberal em Brasília, DF - 36.376.724/0001-81', *Econodata*, 23 December 2019, https://www.econodata.com.br/consulta-empresa/36376724000181-instituto-conservador-liberal.

187 Gabriel de Sousa, 'Saiba quem vai na cúpula da direita que reunirá Jair Bolsonaro e Javier Milei em Santa Catarina', *Estadão*, 3 July 2024, https://www.estadao.com.br/politica/saiba-quem-vai-na-cupula-da-direita-cpac-balneario-camboriu-que-vai-reunir-jair-bolsonaro-javier-milei-em-santa-catarina-nprp/.

188 Stone, 'Critics accuse CPAC of becoming pay-to-play', https://www.theguardian.com/us-news/2022/mar/14/cpac-pay-to-play-trump-loyalists-gain-power.

189 Date, 'CPAC, Not Registered As A Foreign', https://www.huffpost.com/entry/cpac-fara-foreign-interests_n_62193e3de4b0f800ce212893.

190 Date, 'CPAC, Not Registered As A Foreign', https://www.huffpost.com/entry/cpac-fara-foreign-interests_n_62193e3de4b0f800ce212893.

Instituto Conservador-Liberal on July 1, 2024; the party's president, Valdemar Costa Neto, represented the sponsor and spoke at the conference[192][193]. Gettr, the platform run by a former Trump adviser, sponsored political events supporting Jair Bolsonaro's re-election[194]. And when that adviser flew out of Brasília after the September 2021 edition, the Federal Police (PF) detained and questioned him for three hours at the airport[195]. In the United States a bankruptcy trustee for the estate of Miles Guo sued Gettr USA to recover $35,659,193.40 in transfers made through Guo's companies, Hamilton Opportunity Fund, GFNY and ACA Capital Group, and moved for a default judgment in that amount;[196] in May 2026 the Connecticut bankruptcy court granted the trustee's motion for a default judgment.[197]

The guest list and the circuit abroad

The list of foreign guests shows how the project evolved. In 2019 they were all Americans: the Schlapps, Senator Mike Lee and other figures linked to the Republican Party. In 2021 came Jason Miller, Trump's former spokesman, and Donald Trump Jr., by video[198][199]. In

191 opeu.org.br, 'CPAC e a integração conservadora Brasil-EUA', https://www.opeu.org.br/2019/10/20/cpac-e-a-integracao-conservadora-brasil-eua/.

192 Campos, 'Instituto do PL pagou R$ 250', https://platobr.com.br/instituto-do-pl-pagou-r-250-mil-em-patrocinio-a-evento-de-eduardo-bolsonaro-em-sc.

193 Campos, 'Instituto do PL pagou R$ 250', https://platobr.com.br/instituto-do-pl-pagou-r-250-mil-em-patrocinio-a-evento-de-eduardo-bolsonaro-em-sc.

194 Alice Maciel, 'Rede social trumpista patrocina eventos que fazem pré-campanha para Bolsonaro', *Agência Pública*, 24 June 2022, https://apublica.org/2022/06/rede-social-trumpista-patrocina-eventos-que-fazem-pre-campanha-para-bolsonaro/.

195 Bryan Metzger, 'Trump ally Jason Miller was 'questioned for 3 hours' at Brasilia airport after CPAC Brasil conference that promoted Jair Bolsonaro', *Business Insider*, 7 September 2021, https://www.businessinsider.com/jason-miller-questioned-brazil-airport-bolsonaro-cpac-2021-9.

196 Patrick Linsey, *24-05252 (Gettr USA) - MOL iso MTN Default Judgment - ETR 5.11.26 4930-4653-6102 v.1*, *storage.courtlistener.com*, 11 May 2026, https://storage.courtlistener.com/recap/gov.uscourts.ctb.312847/gov.uscourts.ctb.312847.34.1.pdf.

197 'Despins, Luc A., Chapter 11 Trustee v. Gettr USA, Inc. (5:24-ap-05252), Connecticut Bankruptcy Court', *pacermonitor.com*, https://www.pacermonitor.com/public/case/52362539/Despins,_Luc_A,_Chapter_11_Trustee_v_Gettr_USA,_Inc.

198 Maciel, 'How The Trump Universe Is Backing', https://apublica.org/2022/06/how-the-trump-universe-is-backing-bolsonaros-reelection-bid-in-brazil/.

199 João Batista Jr; De Washington, 'Pai (e eu) acima de tudo', *revista piauí*, 1 September 2025, https://piaui.uol.com.br/revista/228/como-eduardo-bolsonaro-vive-e-opera-nos-estados-unidos/.

2022, the Chilean José Antonio Kast and the Argentine Javier Milei[200]. In 2024, in Balneário Camboriú, Milei, by then president, Kast, Gustavo Villatoro, Nayib Bukele's justice minister in El Salvador, and the Mexican actor Eduardo Verástegui[201]. What began as an American stage in Brazil became a continental axis centred on Brazil.

Eduardo also took Brazil to the CPACs abroad. He sent a video message to the first CPAC Hungary, in May 2022[202][203]. He was one of the stars of the first CPAC Mexico, on November 19, 2022, three weeks after his father's defeat, where he repeated the claim of fraud in Brazil's voting machines and introduced Verástegui as the "future president of Mexico"[204]. He attended CPAC Argentina, in Buenos Aires, in December 2024, with Milei and the Spaniard Santiago Abascal, according to the Argentine government itself[205][206].

In the United States, the meetings recurred in places that signal access. Days after the 2022 election, Eduardo met Trump at Mar-a-Lago[207].

What Mar-a-Lago is

200 Catherine Osborn, 'A Far-Right Huddle in São Paulo', *Foreign Policy*, 17 June 2022, https://foreignpolicy.com/2022/06/17/cpac-brazil-far-right-south-america-bolsonaro-kast-milei-trump/.

201 Gabriel de Sousa, 'Saiba quem vai na cúpula da direita que reunirá Jair Bolsonaro e Javier Milei em Santa Catarina', *Estadão*, 3 July 2024, https://www.estadao.com.br/politica/saiba-quem-vai-na-cupula-da-direita-cpac-balneario-camboriu-que-vai-reunir-jair-bolsonaro-javier-milei-em-santa-catarina-nprp/.

202 MTI-Hungary Today, 'CPAC Hungary: Santorum, Farage, Bolsonaro Address Conference', *Hungary Today*, 20 May 2022, https://hungarytoday.hu/cpac-hungary-santorum-farage-bolsonaro-address-conference/.

203 Silverman, 'Rallying the Troops', https://www.illiberalism.org/rallying-the-troops-cpac-and-the-international-far-right/.

204 Viana, 'Eduardo Bolsonaro teve 125 reuniões com', https://apublica.org/2023/08/eduardo-bolsonaro-teve-125-reunioes-com-membros-da-extrema-direita-do-continente/.

205 'Cumbre de la CPAC en Buenos Aires', *Secretaría General*, 5 December 2024, https://www.argentina.gob.ar/noticias/cumbre-de-la-cpac-en-buenos-aires.

206 Facundo Chaves, 'CPAC Argentina confirmó oradores y horarios: de Lara Trump y Ben Shapiro, a Bolsonaro y el cierre de Milei', *infobae*, 3 December 2024, https://www.infobae.com/politica/2024/12/03/cpac-argentina-confirmo-oradores-y-horarios-de-lara-trump-y-ben-shapiro-a-bolsonaro-y-el-cierre-de-milei/.

207 Antoine Vessaud, 'Trump's politically motivated sanctions against Brazil strain relations among old allies', *The Associated Press*, 5 August 2025, https://www.ap.org/news-highlights/spotlights/2025/trumps-politically-motivated-sanctions-against-brazil-strain-relations-among-old-allies/.

Mar-a-Lago is Donald Trump's private club in Palm Beach, Florida[208]. The mansion was built by the heiress Marjorie Merriweather Post, who on her death in 1973 left it to the federal government as a retreat for presidents; the government judged it too costly to maintain, and Trump bought it in December 1985 and in 1995 turned it into a paying club[209]. After he left office in 2021, the club became the headquarters of Trump's political life, and it was there that the FBI seized classified documents in August 2022[210]. Being received at Mar-a-Lago is a sign of direct access to Trump.

In this story the club appears three times: Eduardo was there days after his father's defeat in 2022; in February 2026, at a gala at the club, he handed Latino Wall Street's consultant-of-the-year award to the Argentine consultant Fernando Cerimedo on stage and predicted victory in the October elections "with my brother Flávio"[211]; and CPAC's annual gala for its major supporters was scheduled there in November 2025 and November 2026[212][213].

The operators and the model

The operational arm of the structure was the lawyer Sérgio Sant'Ana, a director of the institute[214][215]. In 2020 he and Eduardo visited the headquarters of the Heritage Foundation, the institute's declared model[216][217][218].

What the Heritage Foundation is

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208 Majlie de Puy Kamp; Curt Devine; Casey Tolan, 'Trump Jr.'s 1789 fund invests in companies that have scored billions in federal funding', *CNN*, 20 July 2026, https://www.cnn.com/2026/07/20/politics/trump-jr-investments-federal-funding-invs.

209 Erika Ryan, 'This is the wild and opulent history of Mar-a-Lago, long before Trump and the FBI', *NPR*, 8 September 2022, https://www.npr.org/2022/09/08/1121578102/mar-a-lago-trump-fbi-investigation-history-merriweather-post.

210 Erika Ryan, 'This is the wild and opulent history of Mar-a-Lago, long before Trump and the FBI', *NPR*, 8 September 2022, https://www.npr.org/2022/09/08/1121578102/mar-a-lago-trump-fbi-investigation-history-merriweather-post.

211 Plinio Teodoro; Plínio Teodoro, 'Eduardo Bolsonaro confirmou que Cerimedo ajudou tentativa de golpe de Jair e sinalizou ação com Flávio; veja vídeo', *Revista Fórum*, 24 August 2026, https://revistaforum.com.br/politica/eduardo-bolsonaro-cerimedo-ajudou-golpe-video/.

212 'CPAC Events', *cpac.org*, 7 January 2023, https://www.cpac.org/us/events.

213 Natalia Viana, 'Eduardo Bolsonaro é um projeto de Steve Bannon', *Agência Pública*, 25 August 2025, https://apublica.org/2025/08/eduardo-bolsonaro-e-um-projeto-de-steve-bannon/.

214 Paulo Motoryn, 'PL usou fundo para pagar sócio de Eduardo Bolsonaro', *Intercept Brasil*, 23 May 2024, https://www.intercept.com.br/2024/05/23/pl-usa-fundo-partidario-para-pagar-socio-de-eduardo-bolsonaro-e-organizador-do-cpac-no-brasil/.

215 Paulo Motoryn, 'PL usou fundo para pagar sócio de Eduardo Bolsonaro', *Intercept Brasil*, 23 May 2024, https://www.intercept.com.br/2024/05/23/pl-usa-fundo-partidario-para-pagar-socio-de-eduardo-bolsonaro-e-organizador-do-cpac-no-brasil/.

The Heritage Foundation is the most influential conservative think tank in the United States[219]. It was founded in 1973 in Washington, and in 1980 it handed Ronald Reagan and his transition team the "Mandate for Leadership", a manual with more than 2,000 recommendations for federal agencies[220]. It was born with the support of major businessmen, among them the brewer Joseph Coors[221]. Headed by Kevin Roberts, it coordinated Project 2025, a plan of more than 900 pages for a second Trump administration, with proposals to expand presidential powers and replace career civil servants with allies[222][223][224].

In this story Heritage is the declared model of Eduardo's institute[225]. Eduardo and Sant'Ana visited its headquarters in 2020, and in March 2024, on a visit to Washington that included the Heritage Foundation, Brazilian deputies brought by Eduardo argued for sanctions against Brazilian officials[226].

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216 Paulo Motoryn, 'Quanto dinheiro está financiando a conspiração transnacional?', *Intercept Brasil*, 16 July 2025, https://www.intercept.com.br/2025/07/16/pl-usou-dinheiro-publico-socio-de-eduardo-bolsonaro/.

217 Valter Xeu, 'Quem está bancando o golpismo internacional do bolsonarismo?', *Patria Latina*, 15 July 2025, https://patrialatina.com.br/quem-esta-bancando-o-golpismo-internacional-do-bolsonarismo/.

218 Redação, 'Congresso de direita em Várzea Grande', https://www.rdnews.com.br/legislativo/congresso-de-direita-em-varzea-grande-tera-presenca-de-eurodeputado-espanhol/152771.

219 'Feulner Timeline', *The Heritage Foundation*, 17 October 2017, https://www.heritage.org/feulner-timeline.

220 The Heritage Foundation, 'Feulner Timeline', https://www.heritage.org/feulner-timeline.

221 Julia Taliesin, 'Profile on the Right: The Heritage Foundation', *Political Research Associates*, 22 June 2018, https://politicalresearch.org/2018/06/22/profile-right-heritage-foundation.

222 Rachel Treisman, 'Project 2025 keeps coming up this election. What is it?', *NPR*, 5 November 2024, https://www.npr.org/2024/11/05/g-s1-32720/what-is-project-2025-trump-election.

223 Franco Ordoñez, 'The conservative think tank behind the controversial Project 2025 faces Trump's ire', *NPR*, 20 July 2024, https://www.npr.org/2024/07/20/nx-s1-5044495/the-conservative-think-tank-behind-the-controversial-project-2025-faces-trumps-ire.

224 Rachel Leingang, 'Project 2025: rightwing manifesto's key proposals and how they could affect you', *the Guardian*, 1 August 2024, https://www.theguardian.com/us-news/article/2024/aug/01/project-2025-key-proposals.

225 Zanini, 'Novo instituto de Eduardo Bolsonaro busca', https://www1.folha.uol.com.br/poder/2021/07/novo-instituto-de-eduardo-bolsonaro-busca-financiadores-e-se-espelha-na-direita-pro-trump.shtml.

Sant'Ana's contacts with Washington also run through Sergio Gor. On September 8, 2021, Sant'Ana and Gor, then a consultant linked to Senator Rand Paul, organised a dinner at the Copacabana Palace in Rio de Janeiro for sixteen American conservatives, among them Senator Mike Lee; Eduardo thanked both men publicly[227]. Sant'Ana described the dinner as "a private event" of the senator's, unrelated to the institute[228]. Gor later ran the presidential personnel office in Trump's second administration and was confirmed as US ambassador to India in October 2025[229].

The liability logic is now inverted relative to 1964. The brand owner is an American non-profit with a public balance sheet, the constitutional defence of free speech and no foreign-agent registration; the sponsorship is a commercial contract; the political content is produced by the licensee. The Brazilian side holds the local brand, the address, the bank account and the exposure. By 2026 the franchise was no longer a parallel channel but a governing one: at the American conference in March 2026 Flávio Bolsonaro spoke from the main stage as a presidential candidate, with seventeen sitting Brazilian parliamentarians in the audience[230]. A further layer was being laid at the same time: the donor network co-founded by the US vice-president was reported to have begun setting up a Brazilian operation, although a Brazilian who had been introduced to the group said in September 2026 that the initiative had been suspended since May[231].

What complicates the picture

None of this is a story of impunity, and the Brazilian courts are the strongest complication to any account that treats the franchise as unstoppable. The Supreme Federal Court (STF) sentenced Jair Bolsonaro to twenty-seven years and three months for the coup attempt[232]. It convicted Eduardo Bolsonaro of coercion in the course of the proceedings, with a sentence of

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226 Pública, 'Como Eduardo Bolsonaro e comitiva articulam', https://www.cartacapital.com.br/politica/como-eduardo-bolsonaro-e-comitiva-articulam-com-parlamentares-dos-eua-punicoes-ao-brasil/.

227 Alice Maciel; Natalia Viana; Laura Scofield; Ken Silverstein, 'How the US far-Right is acting to get Bolsonaro re-elected in Brazil', *Agência Pública*, 29 September 2022, https://apublica.org/2022/09/how-the-us-far-right-is-acting-to-get-bolsonaro-re-elected-in-brazil/.

228 Silverstein, 'How the US far-Right is acting', https://apublica.org/2022/09/how-the-us-far-right-is-acting-to-get-bolsonaro-re-elected-in-brazil/.

229 'Sergio Gor confirmed as US Ambassador to India', *The Tribune*, 8 October 2025, https://www.tribuneindia.com/news/india/sergio-gor-confirmed-as-us-ambassador-to-india/.

230 SGBR, 'Brasil é destaque em evento da', https://sleepinggiantsbrasil.com/saiba-como-foi-a-participacao-brasileira-no-maior-evento-da-extrema-direita-global/.

231 Alexa Salomão, 'Rockbridge, Conservative Group Founded by U.S. Vice President, Began Setting Up in Brazil', *Folha de S.Paulo*, 28 September 2026, https://www1.folha.uol.com.br/internacional/en/world/2026/09/rockbridge-conservative-group-founded-by-us-vice-president-began-setting-up-in-brazil.shtml.

four years and two months[233], after the Chamber of Deputies had already stripped him of his seat for successive absences[234]. Paulo Figueiredo, the Brazilian commentator, was denounced by the Prosecutor-General's Office for coercion in the proceedings over the attempted coup.[235] Operations against the operational core of the plot led to the arrest of agents who had put themselves at the disposal of the plotters[236].

The limit is due process, and it is not decorative. Michelle Bolsonaro was in the network's most serious files, the cheque deposits made by a former aide and the plea-bargain testimony placing her in the radical core, and was indicted in neither. The deposits case was archived by the full Supreme Court, ten votes to one[237]. The coup inquiry was closed without her name because, as the Federal Police's director-general said publicly, the investigators had not seen sufficient elements to indict her[238].

That is the asymmetry the franchise has to price, and it prices it with insurance. Beyond brand and money, the brand owner offers political retaliation against the jurisdiction enforcing the law. In February 2025 a Republican congressman publicly called for US action against the justice conducting the prosecutions[239][240]. The majority of the House Judiciary Committee published a report on what it called the attack on free speech abroad[241]. A Florida

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232 Ione Wells, *Jair Bolsonaro sentenced to 27 years in prison for plotting Brazil coup*, *BBC*, 11 September 2025, https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/c8xrqxk9p4xo.

233 'STF condena Eduardo Bolsonaro a inelegibilidade e a 4 anos de prisão', *Agência Brasil*, 16 June 2026, https://agenciabrasil.ebc.com.br/justica/noticia/2026-06/stf-condena-eduardo-bolsonaro-inelegibilidade-e-4-anos-de-prisao.

234 Redação DW, 'STF decreta prisão de Eduardo Bolsonaro após condenação por coação', *Deutsche Welle*, 8 October 2026, https://www.dw.com/pt-br/stf-decreta-pris%C3%A3o-de-eduardo-bolsonaro-ap%C3%B3s-condena%C3%A7%C3%A3o-por-coa%C3%A7%C3%A3o/a-79605868.

235 'PGR denuncia Eduardo Bolsonaro e Paulo Figueiredo por coação', *Agência Brasil*, 22 September 2025, https://agenciabrasil.ebc.com.br/justica/noticia/2025-09/pgr-denuncia-eduardo-bolsonaro-e-paulo-figueiredo-por-coacao.

236 'Policial federal preso na Operação Contragolpe repassou informações sobre segurança de Lula, diz PF', *G1*, 19 November 2024, https://g1.globo.com/politica/noticia/2024/11/19/policial-federal-preso-na-operacao-contragolpe-repassou-informacoes-sobre-seguranca-de-lula-diz-pf.ghtml.

237 João Pedroso de Campos, 'Por 10 a 1, STF arquiva pedido para apurar cheques de Queiroz a Michelle', *VEJA*, 3 August 2021, https://veja.abril.com.br/coluna/maquiavel/por-10-a-1-stf-arquiva-pedido-para-apurar-cheques-de-queiroz-a-michelle/.

238 'PF não viu 'elementos suficientes' para o indiciamento de Michelle Bolsonaro em plano de golpe, diz diretor-geral', *O Globo*, 28 January 2025, https://oglobo.globo.com/politica/noticia/2025/01/28/pf-nao-viu-elementos-suficientes-para-o-indiciamento-de-michelle-bolsonaro-em-plano-de-golpe-diz-diretor-geral.ghtml.

congresswoman urged the State Department to revoke the visas of Brazilian judges[242]. Chapter 1 recorded the executive expression of that insurance and its partial withdrawal in December 2025; the legislative layer did not withdraw.

What remains constant

Three forms, one object. In Goulart's time the question was a law limiting how much profit multinationals could send out of the country[243]. In 2013 it was the offshore oil and who would operate it. In 2026 it is the payment system, the customs union and the subsoil, the three items the campaign put to Washington and not to the voters.

The literature has begun to describe the arrangement in these terms. Casarões and Belém-Lopes have made the transnational partisan dimension of Brazilian foreign policy a subject in its own right[244]. Rennó and his co-authors document the consolidation of a far-right electoral alignment and its endurance beyond the 2022 defeat[245]. On the American side, the researcher Grant Silverman, in the Journal of Illiberalism Studies, shows that the international CPACs are a source of revenue and organisation-building for the American Conservative Union, which depends on local partners to stage the conferences; in the fiscal year ending March 2020, 84 per cent of revenue of $19.8 million came from "program services"[246]. These works treat the international channel as structure rather than ornament.

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239 'Congressman McCormick Calls for U.S. Action Against Brazilian Supreme Court Justice Alexandre de Moraes', *Representative Mccormick*, 24 February 2025, http://mccormick.house.gov/media/letters/congressman-mccormick-calls-us-action-against-brazilian-supreme-court-justice.

240 Richard McCormick, 'Richard McCormick', *Richard McCormick | Congress.gov*, https://www.congress.gov/member/richard-mccormick/M001218.

241 *THE ATTACK ON FREE SPEECH ABROAD: THE CASE OF BRAZIL*, *judiciary.house.gov*, 31 March 2026, https://judiciary.house.gov/sites/evo-subsites/republicans-judiciary.house.gov/files/evo-media-document/brazil-part-iii-report-final.pdf.

242 'Salazar Urges State Department to Cancel Visas of Brazilian Judges Unfairly Targeting U.S. Companies', *Representative Maria Salazar*, 18 September 2024, http://salazar.house.gov/media/press-releases/salazar-urges-state-department-cancel-visas-brazilian-judges-unfairly.

243 Blum, 'Killing Hope'.

244 Guilherme Casarões, Dawisson Belém-Lopes, *Foreign policy and transnational partisanship in Brazil*, *revistas.ucm.es*, 17 June 2025, https://revistas.ucm.es/index.php/POSO/article/download/99351/4564456573289/4564456753168.

245 Lucio Rennó; Thiago Moreira; Eduardo Ryo Tamaki, *Beyond Electoral Fortunes: The Consolidation of a Far-Right Alignment in Brazil - Lucio Rennó, Thiago Moreira, Eduardo Ryo Tamaki, 2026*, *SAGE Publications*, 23 April 2025, https://journals.sagepub.com/doi/10.1177/1866802X261424885.

The franchise is best understood as an answer to a problem the earlier forms did not solve. Covert funding failed when it became visible; military intervention failed when it lost legitimacy; judicial and security cooperation failed when its operators became prosecutable. The franchise survives all three failures because it separates the political product from the entity that sells it. What it cannot do, and what no organisational form can do, is answer the question Chapter 1 left open. The franchise explains who bears the risk of the 2026 programme. It does not explain who captures the gain, or which Brazilian class fractions are being asked to pay for it. That question belongs to the chapters that follow.

Chapter 03: The money circuit: fraud proceeds, public party funds and opaque offshore vehicles

Chapter 2 traced the organisational form through which the 2026 programme is sold. This chapter follows the money that moves through it, and finds a circuit layered by what can be said about where each tranche came from. Public party money and a farm-lobby sponsorship can be declared. A convicted fraudster's shell companies, a liquidated bank's payment processor and a Gulf sovereign fund cannot. The structure is opaque in proportion to how impossible it is to declare the payer, and that opacity has a function: it converts political loyalty into a transferable asset, such as a sponsorship, a film contract, a loan or a consultancy, while leaving the address, the bank account and the criminal exposure with the Brazilian operator. Where the payer is instead a foundation with a reputation to protect, the same network discloses everything. That contrast is the chapter's argument.

The two legal persons at the top

The franchise runs across an American non-profit whose books are public. The American Conservative Union files annual returns with the Internal Revenue Service as a US tax-exempt organisation, listing its officers, its revenue and its expenses, and the organisation appears in ProPublica's non-profit database, which indexes those filings[247][248]. Foreign partners buy presence at its conference, $15,000 for a small booth and $75,000 for a large one with main-stage airtime and social-media promotion, and neither the chairman nor the organisation has registered under the US Foreign Agents Registration Act (FARA)[249]. As that foreign-partner model grew, revenues from CPAC events more than quadrupled, as Chapter 2 showed, from $735,000 in the period from April 2020 to January 2021 to $3.4 million in the period from April 2021 to January 2022, according to an American Conservative Union board

246 Silverman, 'Rallying the Troops', https://www.illiberalism.org/rallying-the-troops-cpac-and-the-international-far-right/.

247 Roberts, 'American Conservative Union', https://projects.propublica.org/nonprofits/organizations/520810813.

248 Roberts, 'American Conservative Union', https://projects.propublica.org/nonprofits/organizations/520810813.

249 Date, 'CPAC, Not Registered As A Foreign', https://www.huffpost.com/entry/cpac-fara-foreign-interests_n_62193e3de4b0f800ce212893.

statement that a current board member shared with the Guardian[250][251]. What matters here is the asymmetry beneath it: the brand owner's books are public because it is an American entity with a named board; the licensee's are not, because it is a Brazilian association that shared an address with its operator's law firm[252].

Sérgio Sant'Ana is that operator. He and Eduardo Bolsonaro founded the Instituto Conservador-Liberal together[253]. A lawyer, he was a special adviser to Minister Abraham Weintraub at the Ministry of Education and opened his own law firm in 2022[254]. According to Intercept Brasil, that firm received R$600,000 from the PL's share of the Fundo Partidário, the public party fund, in 2024, in five instalments of R$80,000, one of R$160,000, and a final one of R$40,000, for legal advice to the party's members on the CPMI of January 8 (the joint congressional inquiry into the January 8, 2023 attack on the seats of the three branches of government), in the same period in which Sant'Ana was organising that year's CPAC Brasil with Eduardo; neither Sant'Ana nor the PL, Bolsonaro's Liberal Party, answered the reporters[255][256]. The first edition was paid for, with money from the Fundo Partidário, by the Fundação Instituto de Inovação e Governança (Indigo), the foundation of the PSL, Bolsonaro's party at the time.[257][258] In 2026 a further R$340,000 of campaign money reached

250 Stone, 'Critics accuse CPAC of becoming pay-to-play', https://www.theguardian.com/us-news/2022/mar/14/cpac-pay-to-play-trump-loyalists-gain-power.

251 Stone, 'Critics accuse CPAC of becoming pay-to-play', https://www.theguardian.com/us-news/2022/mar/14/cpac-pay-to-play-trump-loyalists-gain-power.

252 Rudnitzki, 'Sócio de Eduardo Bolsonaro presta serviço', https://apublica.org/2026/10/socio-de-eduardo-bolsonaro-presta-servico-para-campanhas-eleitorais/.

253 Rudnitzki, 'Sócio de Eduardo Bolsonaro presta serviço', https://apublica.org/2026/10/socio-de-eduardo-bolsonaro-presta-servico-para-campanhas-eleitorais/.

254 Motoryn, 'PL usou fundo para pagar sócio', https://www.intercept.com.br/2024/05/23/pl-usa-fundo-partidario-para-pagar-socio-de-eduardo-bolsonaro-e-organizador-do-cpac-no-brasil/.

255 Motoryn, 'Quanto dinheiro está financiando a conspiração', https://www.intercept.com.br/2025/07/16/pl-usou-dinheiro-publico-socio-de-eduardo-bolsonaro/.

256 Motoryn, 'PL usou fundo para pagar sócio', https://www.intercept.com.br/2024/05/23/pl-usa-fundo-partidario-para-pagar-socio-de-eduardo-bolsonaro-e-organizador-do-cpac-no-brasil/.

257 Guimarães, 'Sob gritos de 'mitinho', Eduardo Bolsonaro', https://www.bbc.com/portuguese/brasil-50024632.

258 opeu.org.br, 'CPAC e a integração conservadora Brasil-EUA', https://www.opeu.org.br/2019/10/20/cpac-e-a-integracao-conservadora-brasil-eua/.

him through two companies[259]. One is new: NHR Estratégia e Comunicação, registered in March 2026 with capital of R$100,000, which received R$160,000 from the campaigns of two candidates for federal deputy; the other is the law firm, which received R$180,000 from a third candidate[260]. Sant'Ana says, as he told Agência Pública, that the institute is active only on paper, at the Receita Federal, and that he has distanced himself from Eduardo since Eduardo moved to the United States[261][262].

The immunity is institutional rather than personal, and the record shows both sides of it. Matt Schlapp agreed a settlement in 2024 to end a sexual assault lawsuit[263], and a former officer of the organisation resigned while attacking his conduct[264]. The American side holds a corporate form, the constitutional defence of free speech and a filed balance sheet. The Brazilian side holds a criminal conviction: the Supreme Federal Court (STF) sentenced Eduardo Bolsonaro to four years and two months and to ineligibility for coercion in the coup proceedings[265].

The fraud layer

The first tranche whose origin cannot be declared is that of Guo Wengui, who also goes by the names Miles Guo and Ho Wan Kwok[266]. He made a fortune in Chinese real estate from the 1990s; his best-known project is Pangu Plaza, a hotel and office complex opened in Beijing in

259 Rudnitzki, 'Sócio de Eduardo Bolsonaro presta serviço', https://apublica.org/2026/10/socio-de-eduardo-bolsonaro-presta-servico-para-campanhas-eleitorais/.

260 Rudnitzki, 'Sócio de Eduardo Bolsonaro presta serviço', https://apublica.org/2026/10/socio-de-eduardo-bolsonaro-presta-servico-para-campanhas-eleitorais/.

261 Rudnitzki, 'Sócio de Eduardo Bolsonaro presta serviço', https://apublica.org/2026/10/socio-de-eduardo-bolsonaro-presta-servico-para-campanhas-eleitorais/.

262 Rudnitzki, 'Sócio de Eduardo Bolsonaro presta serviço', https://apublica.org/2026/10/socio-de-eduardo-bolsonaro-presta-servico-para-campanhas-eleitorais/.

263 Krieg, 'CNN Exclusive', https://www.cnn.com/2024/03/27/politics/matt-schlapp-settlement-sexual-assault-lawsuit.

264 Jacobs, 'CPAC Is Rocked by a Resignation', https://nymag.com/intelligencer/2023/05/bob-beauprez-resigns-from-cpac-blasting-matt-schlapp.html.

265 Agência Brasil, 'STF condena Eduardo Bolsonaro a inelegibilidade', https://agenciabrasil.ebc.com.br/justica/noticia/2026-06/stf-condena-eduardo-bolsonaro-inelegibilidade-e-4-anos-de-prisao.

266 'Miles Guo Sentenced To 30 Years In Prison For Leading Billion-Dollar Fraud', *U.S. Department of Justice*, 29 June 2026, https://www.justice.gov/usao-sdny/pr/miles-guo-sentenced-30-years-prison-leading-billion-dollar-fraud.

2008[267][268]. According to The New York Times, he built that fortune in alliance with a corrupt official of the Chinese intelligence service[269]. In 2014 he left China and settled in the United States, where he applied for political asylum in 2017; Chinese authorities accuse him of corruption, which he denies[270]. He always presented his departure as a political escape; at trial, US prosecutors gave another explanation: mounting debts and the arrest of a partner for corruption[271]. In 2018 Guo and Bannon helped found the Rule of Law Foundation and its sister organisation, the Rule of Law Society, which prosecutors describe as a Guo-led NGO; two of Guo's companies transferred $850,000 to Bannon's consulting concern not long before the bankruptcy filing.[272]

In New York, Guo reinvented himself as a dissident, a critic of the Chinese Communist Party, in interviews given from a $67.5 million penthouse facing Central Park[273]. He grew close to Steve Bannon, whom he paid at least $1 million in consulting fees[274]. On June 4, 2020, the two announced, from a boat on the Hudson River, the "New Federal State of China", a government in exile with Guo as president in waiting[275][276]. Around this, Guo built a media and finance conglomerate: GTV Media Group, which raised $452 million; the G|Clubs

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267 Laura Italiano; Natalie Musumeci, 'Worst personal bankruptcy ever - the yearslong hell that happens when a billionaire says he's worth $3,850', *Business Insider*, 16 February 2026, https://www.businessinsider.com/billionaire-miles-guo-hijacked-bankruptcy-court-system-yachts-mansions-2026-1.

268 Michael Forsythe; Benjamin Weiser, 'The Undoing of Guo Wengui, Billionaire Accused of Fraud on 2 Continents (Published 2023)', *The New York Times*, 30 March 2023, https://www.nytimes.com/2023/03/30/us/guo-wengui-china.html.

269 Michael Forsythe, 'Former Chinese Billionaire and Bannon Associate Is Sentenced for Fraud', *The New York Times*, 30 June 2026, https://www.nytimes.com/2026/06/29/us/guo-wengui-sentencing.html.

270 Miranda Jeyaretnam, 'Chinese Billionaire Guo Wengui Sentenced to 30 Years for Billion-Dollar Fraud', *TIME*, 30 June 2026, https://time.com/article/2026/06/30/miles-guo-wengui-fraud-china-billionaire-ccp-ho-wan-kwok/.

271 Musumeci, 'Worst personal bankruptcy ever', https://www.businessinsider.com/billionaire-miles-guo-hijacked-bankruptcy-court-system-yachts-mansions-2026-1.

272 William Bredderman, 'Chinese Mogul Funneled Millions to Bannon, Fox, Gettr, Docs Show', *Yahoo News*, 15 March 2024, https://www.thedailybeast.com/chinese-mogul-guo-wengui-funneled-millions-to-bannon-fox-gettr-docs-show.

273 Musumeci, 'Worst personal bankruptcy ever', https://www.businessinsider.com/billionaire-miles-guo-hijacked-bankruptcy-court-system-yachts-mansions-2026-1.

274 Alice Maciel; Laura Scofield; Maria Martha Bruno; Isabela Dias, 'Brazil's key MAGA ally linked to massive fraud scheme involving jailed Chinese billionaire', *Mother Jones*, 5 August 2025, https://www.motherjones.com/politics/2025/08/paulo-figueiredo-fraud-brazil-tariffs-trump-maga-bolsonaro-sanctions-guo/.

membership clubs, run through G Club Operations, which raised at least $255 million; and the Himalaya Exchange cryptocurrency platform, with its own coin, H-Coin, and the companion H-Dollar, for which investors contributed at least $500 million[277][278]. According to the Department of Justice, it was through them that he sold his followers shares, memberships and cryptocurrency with the promise of making them rich and bringing down the Chinese regime[279].

The money sustained a life of luxury. According to prosecutors, Guo spent it on a Manhattan penthouse, a mansion of about 4,600 square metres in New Jersey, a $1 million Lamborghini and a $37 million yacht[280]. The US Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC) described four unregistered offerings that raised more than $850 million from small investors[281][282]. In his personal bankruptcy, opened in 2022, he swore he was worth $3,850[283], and his followers went after the trustee appointed to locate his assets, with protests at his door[284]. Guo was

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275 *Ants in a Web*, *public-assets.graphika.com*, 14 May 2021, https://public-assets.graphika.com/reports/graphika_report_ants_in_a_web.pdf.

276 Musumeci, 'Worst personal bankruptcy ever', https://www.businessinsider.com/billionaire-miles-guo-hijacked-bankruptcy-court-system-yachts-mansions-2026-1.

277 'Miles Guo Sentenced To 30 Years In Prison For Leading Billion-Dollar Fraud', *justice.gov*, 29 June 2026, https://www.justice.gov/usao-sdny/pr/miles-guo-sentenced-30-years-prison-leading-billion-dollar-fraud.

278 U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission, *Ho Wan Kwok (a/k/a Miles Guo, Miles Kwok, Wengui Guo and Brother Seven), Kin Ming Je (a/k/a William Je), Mountains of Spices LLC (d/b/a New York Farm), and G Club Operations LLC, Defendants, and Mei Guo, Qiang Guo (a/k/a Mileson Guo), Hing Chi Ngok, and Sin Ting Rong, Relief Defendants*, *sec.gov*, 15 March 2023, https://www.sec.gov/files/litigation/complaints/2023/comp25668.pdf.

279 justice.gov, 'Miles Guo Sentenced To 30 Years', https://www.justice.gov/usao-sdny/pr/miles-guo-sentenced-30-years-prison-leading-billion-dollar-fraud.

280 Jeyaretnam, 'Chinese Billionaire Guo Wengui Sentenced to', https://time.com/article/2026/06/30/miles-guo-wengui-fraud-china-billionaire-ccp-ho-wan-kwok/.

281 U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission, 'Ho Wan Kwok (a/k/a Miles Guo,', https://www.sec.gov/files/litigation/complaints/2023/comp25668.pdf.

282 Blum, 'Killing Hope'.

283 Musumeci, 'Worst personal bankruptcy ever', https://www.businessinsider.com/billionaire-miles-guo-hijacked-bankruptcy-court-system-yachts-mansions-2026-1.

284 Musumeci, 'Worst personal bankruptcy ever', https://www.businessinsider.com/billionaire-miles-guo-hijacked-bankruptcy-court-system-

arrested by the FBI in March 2023 and convicted the following year on nine of twelve counts, among them fraud and money laundering[285]. According to prosecutors, Guo used more than $1 billion raised from retail investors to fund a life that included a 150-foot superyacht called the *Lady May*, three private planes and a fleet of luxury cars including a Bugatti Chiron worth more than $4 million.[286] On June 29, 2026, he was sentenced to thirty years in prison and the forfeiture of $889 million[287][288]. Judge Analisa Torres said he had "preyed on those seeking to bring democracy to China"[289].

The Guo and Bannon media machine has been studied in its own right[290]. In 2021 the research firm Graphika described a network of entities and thousands of accounts centred on Guo, which spread false claims of electoral fraud in the United States, Covid-19 disinformation and the QAnon conspiracy theory, with content translated into several languages, Portuguese among them[291]. In July 2024 the government of Singapore ordered platforms to block 95 accounts linked to Guo and the New Federal State of China, over a coordinated campaign about the country's government succession[292]. Bannon, for his part, was arrested in August

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yachts-mansions-2026-1.

285 Jeyaretnam, 'Chinese Billionaire Guo Wengui Sentenced to', https://time.com/article/2026/06/30/miles-guo-wengui-fraud-china-billionaire-ccp-ho-wan-kwok/.

286 Musumeci, 'Worst personal bankruptcy ever', https://www.businessinsider.com/billionaire-miles-guo-hijacked-bankruptcy-court-system-yachts-mansions-2026-1.

287 justice.gov, 'Miles Guo Sentenced To 30 Years', https://www.justice.gov/usao-sdny/pr/miles-guo-sentenced-30-years-prison-leading-billion-dollar-fraud.

288 Jeyaretnam, 'Chinese Billionaire Guo Wengui Sentenced to', https://time.com/article/2026/06/30/miles-guo-wengui-fraud-china-billionaire-ccp-ho-wan-kwok/.

289 Osmond Chia, 'Guo Wengui: Chinese tycoon sentenced to 30 years in US jail', *BBC News*, 30 June 2026, https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/cjeg15vw3z9o.

290 'Issuance of Account Restriction Directions Under the Foreign Interference (Countermeasures) Act 2021 Against 95 Social Media Accounts Linked to a Foreign Network', *Ministry of Home Affairs*, 30 July 2026, https://www.mha.gov.sg/media-room/newsroom/issuance-of-account-restriction-directions-under-the-foreign-interference-countermeasures-act-2021-against-95-social-media-accounts-linked-to-a-foreign-network/.

291 public-assets.graphika.com, 'Ants in a Web', https://public-assets.graphika.com/reports/graphika_report_ants_in_a_web.pdf.

292 Ministry of Home Affairs, 'Issuance of Account Restriction Directions Under', https://www.mha.gov.sg/media-room/newsroom/issuance-of-account-restriction-directions-under-the-foreign-interference-countermeasures-act-2021-against-95-social-media-accounts-

2020 aboard Guo's yacht, in a fraud case unrelated to Guo, that of the fundraising campaign for the wall on the Mexican border[293], and was pardoned by Trump in January 2021, before trial[294][295]. In September 2021 the lawyer Sérgio Sant'Ana, of Eduardo Bolsonaro's Instituto Conservador-Liberal, organised, with Sergio Gor, a dinner for Senator Mike Lee at the Copacabana Palace hotel in Rio, which Sant'Ana describes as a private event of the senator's; the guest list included Connor Hickey, identified in reporting as a former aide to Senator Rand Paul.[296] On Guo's activity in Brazil there is no published study, only reporting and court records.

From Guo's estate, the bankruptcy trustee moved against at least $21 million received by Gettr, and against payments to Jason Miller, Warroom Broadcasting and Bannon Strategic Advisors[297].

What Gettr is

Gettr is a social network launched in July 2021 in the United States as an alternative to Twitter for the American right, after Trump was banned from the major platforms[298]. It was run by Jason Miller, Trump's former spokesman[299]. Less than a week after its launch, Brazilians were already the second-largest nationality on the network, behind Americans[300]; in

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linked-to-a-foreign-network/.

293 Chia, 'Guo Wengui', https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/cjeg15vw3z9o.

294 'Pardons Granted by President Donald J. Trump (2017-2021)', *Pardons Granted by President Donald J. Trump (2017-2021)*, 28 August 2017, https://www.justice.gov/pardon/pardons-granted-president-donald-j-trump-2017-2021.

295 Jeyaretnam, 'Chinese Billionaire Guo Wengui Sentenced to', https://time.com/article/2026/06/30/miles-guo-wengui-fraud-china-billionaire-ccp-ho-wan-kwok/.

296 Agência Pública, 'Quem são os aliados do clã Bolsonaro na extrema-direita dos EUA', *CartaCapital*, 29 September 2022, https://www.cartacapital.com.br/politica/quem-sao-os-aliados-do-cla-bolsonaro-na-extrema-direita-dos-eua/.

297 Dan Friedman, 'Scoop: MAGA App Gettr Hit With Mass Layoffs', *Mother Jones*, 21 February 2024, https://www.motherjones.com/politics/2024/02/gettr-guo-layoffs/.

298 Steve Holland; Elizabeth Culliford, 'Former Trump aide Miller launches social media site GETTR', *Reuters*, 1 July 2021, https://www.reuters.com/world/us/former-trump-aide-miller-launches-social-media-site-gettr-2021-07-01/.

299 Gustaf Kilander, 'Jason Miller: Former Trump spokesman questioned for three hours by police in Brazil', *The Independent*, 7 September 2021, https://www.independent.co.uk/news/world/americas/us-politics/jason-miller-trump-questioned-brazil-b1915819.html.

300 Ethel Rudnitzki; Laura Scofield, 'Bolsonaro já tem perfil verificado e quase 100 mil seguidores na rede social de Trump', *Agência Pública*, 7 July 2021, https://apublica.org/2021/07/bolsonaro-ja-tem-perfil-verificado-e-quase-100-mil-seguidores-

September, Miller said that 15 per cent of its users were Brazilian[301]. The political scientist Camila Rocha told Agência Pública that CPAC placed Brazil at the centre of the international far-right ecosystem.[302] Its Brazilian presence ran through Eduardo's institute; the Brasília CPAC in September 2021 carried its brand, and after the event Miller met President Jair Bolsonaro at the Palácio da Alvorada.[303]

Behind it was Guo Wengui, who financed it through shell companies. When Guo was arrested in March 2023, US authorities seized $634 million in 21 accounts treated as fraud proceeds, of which more than $2.7 million was in Gettr's account[304]. In 2026 Guo's bankruptcy trustee asked the Connecticut bankruptcy court for a judgment of $35.66 million against Gettr; the docket records the order granting the motion and a signed judgment of $59,453.40[305306]. The Lula coalition's petition to the electoral court alleges that Rockbridge Brazil was registered in Wyoming in May 2026, and that Pedro Sang, Rockbridge's articulator in Brazil, works at the campaign committee installed in a two-storey house on Avenida República do Líbano in São Paulo; the allegation is the petition's, and the Wyoming incorporation and the São Paulo operation are reported separately.[307]

Gettr's Brazilian operation ran through Paulo Figueiredo's Florida consultancy, International Treasure Group, which received $140,000, not from Gettr's own accounts but from HCHK

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na-rede-social-de-trump/.

301 Kilander, 'Jason Miller', https://www.independent.co.uk/news/world/americas/us-politics/jason-miller-trump-questioned-brazil-b1915819.html.

302 Andrea DiP; Clarissa Levy; Ricardo Terto; Stela Diogo, 'CPAC: os bastidores do fórum da extrema direita no Brasil', *Agência Pública*, 13 July 2024, https://apublica.org/2024/07/cpac-poe-brasil-no-centro-da-extrema-direita-internacional-diz-cientista-politica/.

303 Maciel, 'Rede social trumpista patrocina eventos que', https://apublica.org/2022/06/rede-social-trumpista-patrocina-eventos-que-fazem-pre-campanha-para-bolsonaro/.

304 Matt Binder, 'Chinese billionaire funding conservative social network GETTR arrested for crypto fraud', *Mashable*, 15 March 2023, https://mashable.com/article/guo-wengui-arrested-fraud-gettr-crypto.

305 Linsey, '24-05252 (Gettr USA)', https://storage.courtlistener.com/recap/gov.uscourts.ctb.312847/gov.uscourts.ctb.312847.34.1.pdf.

306 pacermonitor.com, 'Despins, Luc A., Chapter 11 Trustee', https://www.pacermonitor.com/public/case/52362539/Despins,_Luc_A,_Chapter_11_Trustee_v_Gettr_USA,_Inc.

307 static.congressoemfoco.com.br, 'PROCESSO', https://static.congressoemfoco.com.br/2026/09/24/attachment/2026/09/24/ff691f_lula_aciona_tse_contra_possivel_financiamento_dos_eua_por_flavio_13_set__2026.pdf.

Technologies, one of Guo's shells[308]. Figueiredo, a commentator and grandson of the last president of the dictatorship, was served with the trustee's complaint and did not answer it; default was entered against the company[309]. His motion to vacate, of December 2025, is where the circuit is documented: he attached nine documents, including the contract and a weekly report, and, in attaching them, conceded both that the money had come from HCHK and that the work had been done.[310]

What those reports reveal is the content of the Brazilian product: a proposal to commission a national presidential poll, rejected by Jason Miller on the ground that Gettr should publish nothing unfavourable to Bolsonaro at that time; and a sponsorship schedule, with Brasil Profundo, the congresses of Eduardo's institute; Carlos Jordy's Congresso Politicamente Incorreto; and a congress for a thousand doctors from around the world, negotiated at a sponsorship of R$20,000, in the period when Gettr was circulating disinformation about early treatment for Covid-19[311]. At the Várzea Grande edition, besides Eduardo, the former environment minister Ricardo Salles, Magno Malta and Nikolas Ferreira, the stage carried two foreigners: Santiago Abascal, the leader of Spain's Vox, and Hermann Tertsch, a Vox member of the European Parliament.[312][313] The Londrina edition was held on 12 March 2022, and served as a showcase for right-wing pre-candidates in the state; Agência Pública records the deputy Filipe Barros speaking there about Lula.[314]

Figueiredo also has an open front in Brazil. According to data from the Office of the Attorney General of the National Treasury published in July 2026, he is listed in the federal government's register of tax debtors for about R$5 million in federal taxes; he contests the assessment, which he attributes to Operation Armadeira 2, of 2020, and says he is no longer a

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308 Chico Alves, 'Paulo Figueiredo informa à Justiça dos EUA que trabalhou para rede pró-Bolsonaro Gettr', *ICL Notícias*, 6 January 2026, https://iclnoticias.com.br/paulo-figueiredo-eua-trabalhou-bolsonaro-gettr/.

309 Alice Maciel; Laura Scofield; Maria Martha Bruno; Isabela Dias; Mother Jones, 'Brazil's Key MAGA Ally Linked to Massive Fraud Scheme Involving Jailed Chinese Billionaire', *Agência Pública*, 5 August 2025, https://apublica.org/2025/08/records-reveal-paulo-figueiredos-alleged-connection-to-fraud/.

310 Alves, 'Paulo Figueiredo informa à Justiça dos', https://iclnoticias.com.br/paulo-figueiredo-eua-trabalhou-bolsonaro-gettr/.

311 Alves, 'Paulo Figueiredo informa à Justiça dos', https://iclnoticias.com.br/paulo-figueiredo-eua-trabalhou-bolsonaro-gettr/.

312 Redação, 'Congresso de direita em Várzea Grande', https://www.rdnews.com.br/legislativo/congresso-de-direita-em-varzea-grande-tera-presenca-de-eurodeputado-espanhol/152771.

313 EFE, 'Ultraderechista español Abascal impulsa en Brasil su alianza de «patriotas»', *Swissinfo*, 10 December 2021, https://www.swissinfo.ch/spa/ultraderechista-espa%C3%B1ol-abascal-impulsa-en-brasil-su-alianza-de-patriotas/47183588.

314 Maciel, 'Rede social trumpista patrocina eventos que', https://apublica.org/2022/06/rede-social-trumpista-patrocina-eventos-que-fazem-pre-campanha-para-bolsonaro/.

tax resident of Brazil[315]. In Florida, besides the consultancy, state records show a real estate company in which he is the authorised person, Olive-Fig Tree Real Properties LLC, registered in December 2015 and active[316], and a non-profit of which he was treasurer and director, the Pan-American Prosperity Institute, registered in January 2020 at his home in Weston and administratively dissolved in September 2022 for failing to file an annual report[317][318].

Then the judgment against Gettr. On May 11, 2026, the trustee moved for a default judgment against Gettr in the amount of $35,659,193.40[319]. The docket records an order of May 19, 2026, granting that motion and, 21 minutes later, a signed default judgment in the amount of $59,453.40[320]. The two figures sum exactly to the amount sought: $35,599,740.00 on the third

315 Mylenna Scheidegger, ‘Paulo Figueiredo está na Dívida Ativa da União por débito de R$ 5 milhões’, *Jornal Opção*, 10 July 2026, https://www.jornalopcao.com.br/ultimas-noticias/paulo-figueiredo-divida-5-milhoes-uniao-pgfn-845548/.

316 ‘Detail by Officer/Registered Agent Name’, *search.sunbiz.org*, 14 December 2015, https://search.sunbiz.org/Inquiry/CorporationSearch/SearchResultDetail?inquirytype=OfficerRegisteredAgentName&directionType=Initial&searchNameOrder=FIGUEIREDOPAULO%20L150002075692&aggregateId=flal-l15000207569-72d9bbd9-25ac-478e-83e3-8a21924281f4&searchTerm=FIGUEIREDO%20PAULO&listNameOrder=FIGUEIREDOPAULO%20L150002075692.

317 ‘Detail by Officer/Registered Agent Name’, *search.sunbiz.org*, 1 August 2020, https://search.sunbiz.org/Inquiry/CorporationSearch/SearchResultDetail?inquirytype=OfficerRegisteredAgentName&directionType=Initial&searchNameOrder=FIGUEIREDOPAULO%20N200000005582&aggregateId=domnp-n20000000558-d2f90919-b120-4a86-bf95-7187410df072&searchTerm=FIGUEIREDO%20PAULO&listNameOrder=FIGUEIREDOPAULO%20L150002075692.

318 Alice Maciel; Natalia Viana, ‘Mansões, carros de luxo, viagens: a vida de Eduardo Bolsonaro e Figueiredo nos EUA’, *Agência Pública*, 31 August 2026, https://apublica.org/2026/08/mansoes-carros-de-luxo-viagens-a-vida-de-eduardo-bolsonaro-e-figueiredo-nos-eua/.

319 Linsey, ‘24-05252 (Gettr USA)’, https://storage.courtlistener.com/recap/gov.uscourts.ctb.312847/gov.uscourts.ctb.312847.34.1.pdf.

320 pacermonitor.com, ‘Despins, Luc A., Chapter 11 Trustee’, https://www.pacermonitor.com/public/case/52362539/Despins,_Luc_A,_Chapter_11_Trustee_v_Gettr_USA,_Inc.

claim of the amended complaint plus $59,453.40 on the pre-petition claim[321]. The signed judgment's docket text mentions only the smaller of the two.

The exile layer

The second tranche that cannot be declared comes from a bank in crisis. Daniel Vorcaro, owner of Banco Master, pledged $24 million, R$134 million at the time, to the *Dark Horse* biopic about Jair Bolsonaro, and $10.6 million, about R$61 million, was paid in six operations between February and May 2025[322][323]. By September a report by COAF, Brazil's financial intelligence unit, put the total at $12.3 million, more than R$65 million, with a single transfer of $1,666,667[324]. The owner of the payment conglomerate that made the remittances, Entre Investimentos, confirmed to the Prosecutor General's Office, in a plea agreement signed on August 8, 2026 and approved by Supreme Court Justice André Mendonça on September 9, 2026, seven transfers totalling $12.3 million[325][326][327][328]. The Federal

321 Robert Flynn, *24-05252 (Gettr USA) - MTN Default Judgment - ETR 5.11.26 4920-8072-7462 v.1*, *storage.courtlistener.com*, 11 May 2026, https://storage.courtlistener.com/recap/gov.uscourts.ctb.312847/gov.uscourts.ctb.312847.34.0.pdf.

322 Laís Martins; Eduardo Goulart; Leandro Becker; Paulo Motoryn, 'EXCLUSIVO: Eduardo Bolsonaro tinha poder sobre dinheiro do "Dark Horse", revela contrato', *Intercept Brasil*, 15 May 2026, https://www.intercept.com.br/2026/05/15/eduardo-bolsonaro-poder-dinheiro-dark-horse-contrato/.

323 'Filme "Dark Horse" recebeu R$ 65 milhões de Daniel Vorcaro', *Poder360*, 1 September 2026, https://www.poder360.com.br/poder-justica/filme-dark-horse-recebeu-r-65-milhoes-de-daniel-vorcaro/.

324 Breno Pires; De Brasília, 'Liberei mais uma hoje', *revista piauí*, 1 September 2026, https://piaui.uol.com.br/web/flavio-bolsonaro-dinheiro-dark-horse-vorcaro/.

325 'Delator confirma 7 transferências a fundo norte-americano de "Dark Horse', *Poder360*, 9 September 2026, https://www.poder360.com.br/poder-justica/delator-confirma-7-transferencias-a-fundo-norte-americano-de-dark-horse/.

326 Thais Carrança, 'Havengate: o fundo na mira da PF que conecta Vorcaro, Flávio e Eduardo Bolsonaro', *BBC News Brasil*, 16 May 2026, https://www.bbc.com/portuguese/articles/cp8pwzl3y45o.

327 Poder360, 'Delator confirma 7 transferências a fundo', https://www.poder360.com.br/poder-justica/delator-confirma-7-transferencias-a-fundo-norte-americano-de-dark-horse/.

328 Flávia Maia, 'Mendonça homologa delação de operador financeiro do filme "Dark Horse"', *JOTA*, 9 September 2026, https://www.jota.info/stf/do-supremo/mendonca-homologa-delacao-de-operador-financeiro-do-filme-dark-horse.

Police's (PF) reading is that the fund stood to receive $24 million and that the first remittance, of $2,000,000, left for the film on February 13, 2025[329].

Where it landed is the point. Havengate Development Fund LP is a Dallas limited partnership whose general partner is managed by Paulo Calixto, the immigration lawyer who handled Eduardo Bolsonaro's US visa, and by the broker Altieris Santana[330]. Foreign funds of this kind can conceal who their quotaholders are, and because the United States never joined the international standard for the automatic exchange of bank account information, no automatic mechanism carries their identity back to Brazil; the Federal Police must ask by treaty request[331].

Beneath it sits a smaller vehicle with the same logic. Braz Global Holding was registered in Arlington, Texas, on March 18, 2023, with Eduardo Bolsonaro, Paulo Generoso and André Porciúncula as members; four months later, with no employees and no business history, it lent $140,000 to a Fort Worth builder against three plots of land[332]. In May 2025 Jair Bolsonaro sent Eduardo R$2 million by Pix, the Central Bank's free instant payment system[333][334].

The distinction to hold is between the transfers and their purpose. The transfers are documented in financial intelligence reports, a plea agreement and the inquiry record. That the film vehicle served to sustain Eduardo Bolsonaro in the United States is the Federal Police's hypothesis, and it is treated here as a hypothesis[335].

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329 'PF diz que Eduardo Bolsonaro orientou como dinheiro de 'Dark Horse' seria gerido nos EUA', *Valor Econômico*, 11 September 2026, https://valor.globo.com/politica/noticia/2026/09/11/pf-aponta-que-eduardo-bolsonaro-orientou-como-dinheiro-de-dark-horse-seria-gerido-nos-eua.ghtml.

330 Carrança, 'Havengate', https://www.bbc.com/portuguese/articles/cp8pwzl3y45o.

331 Carrança, 'Havengate', https://www.bbc.com/portuguese/articles/cp8pwzl3y45o.

332 Miguel do Rosário; Miguel do Rosario, 'O elo perdido: a empresa no Texas que liga Eduardo Bolsonaro ao dinheiro do Master', *Revista Fórum*, 2 July 2026, https://revistaforum.com.br/blogs/o-cafezinho/o-elo-perdido-a-empresa-no-texas-que-liga-eduardo-bolsonaro-ao-dinheiro-do-master/.

333 Viana, 'Mansões, carros de luxo, viagens', https://apublica.org/2026/08/mansoes-carros-de-luxo-viagens-a-vida-de-eduardo-bolsonaro-e-figueiredo-nos-eua/.

334 Marcela Ayres, 'Brazil and US clash over future of payments as popular Pix system stirs global interest', *Reuters*, 21 July 2026, https://www.reuters.com/business/finance/brazil-us-clash-over-future-payments-popular-pix-system-stirs-global-interest-2026-07-21/.

335 José Marques, 'PF suspeita que dinheiro de Vorcaro tenha custeado despesas de Eduardo Bolsonaro nos EUA', *Folha de S.Paulo*, 14 May 2026, https://www1.folha.uol.com.br/poder/2026/05/pf-suspeita-que-dinheiro-de-vorcaro-tenha-custeado-despesas-de-eduardo-bolsonaro-nos-eua.shtml.

The Gulf layer

The third tranche that cannot be declared is sovereign. Lerco Consulting, registered in Abu Dhabi, is owned in equal shares by Renzo Gracie, the cybersecurity entrepreneur Eric Leandri and Ludgero de Sousa; because a Brazilian contract must be signed with a CPF, the Brazilian individual taxpayer number, Leandri signed the Fictor and Royal Capital bid for Banco Master with Gracie's[336][337]. Gracie's later account is that he told the Abu Dhabi investors to walk away; it was given after the bank's liquidation, and it places him inside a transaction from which he was trying to distance himself[338]. Gracie is also the person who took Eduardo Bolsonaro to the Gulf in 2022[339].

The same business group appears on the campaign's own books. According to DivulgaCand, the electoral court's system in which campaigns declare income and spending, Flávio Bolsonaro's campaign declared R$600,000 paid to Elytron Cybersecurity, booked as information technology consultancy, and the PL a further R$131,900 in July; the invoices describe technology consulting, and the campaign says it hired cybersecurity services[340][341]. Elytron is a Brazilian cybersecurity firm founded in 2018 by João Brasio and Felipe Garofalo; Brasio is its chief executive in Brazil, and its European branch is a small office in the Algarve with two employees[342][343][344]. What Intercept Brasil reported is that Elytron offered people close to the Trump campaign an influence system driven by artificial intelligence; the account

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336 Jenne Andrade; Luiz Vassallo, 'Lutador Renzo Gracie diz ter orientado árabes a não comprarem Banco Master', *Estadão*, 20 May 2026, https://www.estadao.com.br/economia/lutador-renzo-gracie-diz-ter-orientado-arabes-a-nao-comprarem-banco-master/.

337 Laís Martins; Leandro Becker; Eduardo Goulart, 'EXCLUSIVO: Flávio Bolsonaro pagou R$ 600 mil a empresa que vende nos EUA sistema de IA para manipular eleições', *Intercept Brasil*, 16 October 2026, https://www.intercept.com.br/2026/10/16/flavio-pagou-empresa-eua-sistema-manipular-eleicoes/.

338 Vassallo, 'Lutador Renzo Gracie diz ter orientado', https://www.estadao.com.br/economia/lutador-renzo-gracie-diz-ter-orientado-arabes-a-nao-comprarem-banco-master/.

339 Vinícius Valfré; Felipe Frazão, 'Renzo Gracie leva Eduardo Bolsonaro a encontros com acusados de tortura no Oriente Médio', *Estadão*, 3 June 2022, https://www.estadao.com.br/politica/renzo-gracie-abre-portas-para-eduardo-bolsonaro-no-oriente-medio/.

340 Laís Martins; Leandro Becker; Eduardo Goulart, 'EXCLUSIVO: Flávio Bolsonaro pagou R$ 600 mil a empresa que vende nos EUA sistema de IA para manipular eleições', *Intercept Brasil*, 16 October 2026, https://www.intercept.com.br/2026/10/16/flavio-pagou-empresa-eua-sistema-manipular-eleicoes/.

341 Goulart, 'EXCLUSIVO', https://www.intercept.com.br/2026/10/16/flavio-pagou-empresa-eua-sistema-manipular-eleicoes/.

342 Goulart, 'EXCLUSIVO', https://www.intercept.com.br/2026/10/16/flavio-pagou-empresa-eua-sistema-manipular-eleicoes/.

comes from an American consultant, Vincent Reed, who took it to the FBI, and it is denied by the company and by the campaign[345][346][347].

The declared circuit

The European and Ibero-American network qualifies the pattern, and the qualification matters. Fundación Disenso, chaired by Santiago Abascal, leader of the Spanish party Vox, hired the former Bolsonaro foreign minister Ernesto Araújo as international adviser in October 2023 and announced the hiring, placing a Brazilian cadre on a Spanish party foundation's payroll rather than the reverse[348][349]. The vehicle of the Isaac Accords, American Friends of the Isaac Accords, is a new non-profit launched with $1 million from the Genesis Prize Foundation[350]. In June 2026, legislators from fourteen Latin American countries were

343 Goulart, 'EXCLUSIVO', https://www.intercept.com.br/2026/10/16/flavio-pagou-empresa-eua-sistema-manipular-eleicoes/.

344 Goulart, 'EXCLUSIVO', https://www.intercept.com.br/2026/10/16/flavio-pagou-empresa-eua-sistema-manipular-eleicoes/.

345 Goulart, 'EXCLUSIVO', https://www.intercept.com.br/2026/10/16/flavio-pagou-empresa-eua-sistema-manipular-eleicoes/.

346 Redação Jornal de Brasília, 'Intercept afirma que campanha de Flávio Bolsonaro pagou R$ 600 mil a empresa de manipulação', *Jornal de Brasília*, 16 October 2026, https://jornaldebrasilia.com.br/noticias/politica-e-poder/intercept-afirma-que-campanha-de-flavio-bolsonaro-pagou-r-600-mil-a-empresa-de-manipulacao/.

347 Goulart, 'EXCLUSIVO', https://www.intercept.com.br/2026/10/16/flavio-pagou-empresa-eua-sistema-manipular-eleicoes/.

348 Juan Jesús Morales Martín; Francisco Luciano Álvarez Sepúlveda, '(PDF) El Think Tank Fundación Disenso y la Iberosfera: ideas, discursos y narrativas de las nuevas derechas sobre Iberoamérica', *ResearchGate*, 14 April 2025, https://www.researchgate.net/publication/393475238_El_Think_Tank_Fundacion_Disenso_y_la_Iberosfera_ideas_discursos_y_narrativas_de_las_nuevas_derechas_sobre_Iberoamerica.

349 Fundación Disenso, 'Ernesto Araújo, ex ministro de Relaciones Exteriores de Brasil, se incorpora a la Fundación Disenso como asesor internacional', *Fundación Disenso*, 18 October 2023, https://fundaciondisenso.org/ernesto-araujo-ex-ministro-de-relaciones-exteriores-de-brasil-se-incorpora-a-la-fundacion-disenso-como-asesor-internacional/.

350 'President Milei's Initiative to Advance Latin America-Israel Ties Receives Financial Boost from the Genesis Prize', *genesisprize.org*, 11 August 2025, https://www.genesisprize.org/press-center/2025-08-11-president-milei-initiative-to-advance-latin-america-israel-ties-receives-financial-boost-from-the-genesis-prize.

signing its principles in Buenos Aires[351][352]. Here the payers are a party foundation and a prize foundation. The reputational cost of secrecy exceeds the cost of disclosure, and so everything is disclosed, including the name of the Brazilian the foundation announces as its adviser[353]. Latino Wall Street, the outfit run by Gabriela Berrospi and Tony Delgado, sells seats at galas in Mar-a-Lago and Washington at between $10,000 and more than $100,000, and this February gave its consultant-of-the-year award to Fernando Cerimedo, now detained.[354]

Conclusion

The circuit is not a partnership of equals. It is a hierarchy organised around who can be named. Party money and a farm-lobby entity can be named; a fraudster's shells, a liquidated bank and a sovereign fund cannot, and the structure is built to that constraint. What the circuit buys is transferability: loyalty converted into a sponsorship contract, a film contract, a loan or a consultancy, assets that outlive the office-holder who generated them. What it does not buy is consent. Nothing in this circuit explains why an export bloc whose profits run through Beijing backs a programme built against Chinese systems. That is the next chapter's problem.

Chapter 04: The Material Stakes: Payment Rails, Rare Earths and the State-Level Enclave

Three rent streams run through the 2026 campaign, and none of them is a programme in the ordinary sense. Rent, here, is income that comes from controlling a resource or a position (a payment network, a mineral deposit, a public service without a competitor), not from producing more or better. The first is the toll levied on retail payments, which a public Central Bank settlement system made unnecessary and which the filing examined in the previous chapter offered to restore. The second is the ground rent on Brazil's heavy rare earths, whose first-phase output is contracted forward for fifteen years to a special purpose vehicle capitalised by United States government agencies and private investors[355]. The third is the monopoly rent on a water and sanitation utility privatised at the state level, a sale that no

351 'Legislators from 14 Latin American countries commit to pro-Israel agenda at the Buenos Aires summit', *genesisprize.org*, 30 June 2026, https://www.genesisprize.org/press-center/2026-06-30-legislators-from-14-latin-american-countries-commit-to-pro-israel-agenda-at-the-buenos-aires-summit.

352 Walter Guevara, 'Isaac Accords and Latin America's Ideology Premium', *Juncture Policy*, 18 September 2026, https://juncturepolicy.org/isaac-accords-latin-america-ideology-premium/.

353 Disenso, 'Ernesto Araújo, ex ministro de Relaciones', https://fundaciondisenso.org/ernesto-araujo-ex-ministro-de-relaciones-exteriores-de-brasil-se-incorpora-a-la-fundacion-disenso-como-asesor-internacional/.

354 Mauricio Caminos, 'Gaby WallStreet y Tony Delgado: la pareja trumpista con vida de ricos que premió a Cerimedo y lleva a Milei otra vez a EE.UU.', *eldiarioar.com*, 4 October 2026, https://www.eldiarioar.com/politica/gaby-wallstreet-tony-delgado-pareja-trumpista-vida-ricos-premio-cerimedo-lleva-milei-vez-ee-uu_1_13557463.html.

federal screening reaches. The first two are federal questions. The third is not, and that is the argument of this chapter: the material base of the 2026 realignment is being assembled at the state level, by a governor who is not on the national ballot and a Senate campaign that is.

The toll on payments

Pix (the Central Bank's free instant payment system) is a settlement rail operated by the Central Bank, and its significance in this contest is not technological. Settlement is the moment money actually leaves one account and enters another. With a card, each sale pays a fee along the chain: the merchant pays a fee to the card-machine company (the acquirer), part of which, the interchange fee, goes to the bank that issued the card, while the card network (Visa, Mastercard, Elo) charges for the use of its rails. Where a public rail settles the payment at no charge to the payer, that toll has no product to sell. The proposal reported in July 2026, that a future government would pass a law so that Pix would not be interconnected with "non-Western" international payment systems, is a proposal about which settlement systems may talk to each other[356]. The request is on page 11 of the 86-page document Flávio Bolsonaro filed in docket USTR-2026-0331, published in full by Poder360[357]. Its addressee is not the Brazilian regulator[358]. The offer went to a foreign trade authority because the object being protected is not market share inside Brazil; it is the architecture that determines whether a public rail can grow beyond the country that built it.

The weight of Pix in daily life explains the interest. In the second half of 2025 it accounted for 54.7% of payment transactions in the country, and cards (credit, debit and prepaid combined) for 30.4%[359]. Debit lost the most: its share of the number of transactions fell from about 26% before Pix to about 10%; credit fell from about 20% to about 15%[360]. The cost

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355 sec.gov, https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1970622/000121390026092810/ea030292401ex99-1.htm.

356 'Flávio propõe aos EUA blindar Pix de sistemas "não ocidentais', *Poder360*, 3 July 2026, https://www.poder360.com.br/poder-eleicoes/flavio-propoe-aos-eua-blindar-pix-de-sistemas-nao-ocidentais/.

357 Senator Flávio Bolsonaro, 'Written Comment on the Proposed Action', docket USTR-2026-0331, 1 July 2026, copy published by *Poder360*, https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/07/Flavio-pede-aos-EUA-adiamento-de-tarifaco-2jul2026.pdf.

358 Senator Flávio Bolsonaro, 'Written Comment on the Proposed Action', docket USTR-2026-0331, 1 July 2026, copy published by *Poder360*, https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/07/Flavio-pede-aos-EUA-adiamento-de-tarifaco-2jul2026.pdf.

359 Danylo Martins, 'Pix domina pagamentos no 2º semestre de 2025; TED e cartões também avançam', *Finsiders Brasil*, 7 April 2026, https://finsidersbrasil.com.br/pagamentos/pix-domina-pagamentos-no-2o-semestre-de-2025-ted-e-cartoes-tambem-avancam/.

360 Ayres, 'Brazil and US clash over future', https://www.reuters.com/business/finance/brazil-us-clash-over-future-payments-popular-pix-

difference for merchants is large. The Bank for International Settlements (BIS, the central banks' bank) estimated the average cost of Pix to the merchant at 0.22% of the sale value[361]. On cards, the average fee charged to merchants in the first half of 2025 was 1.08% on debit and 2.16% on credit[362].

The USTR public consultation shows who in the United States had an interest in Pix. The critics were the US Chamber of Commerce and the ITI (Information Technology Industry Council), which asked, among other things, for the Central Bank's roles as regulator and as operator of the system to be separated[363]. The ITI is the Washington association that brings together Visa, Mastercard and Meta and that has for several years asked the USTR for a level playing field for its members in Brazil; Visa and Mastercard have already warned their investors that systems such as Pix may threaten their business[364]. Even among the critics, the tone was not a call to end Pix: in 2026 the business association USCIB wrote that "industry is not opposed to the Pix system"[365], and the NFTC, in its own submission, that industry "supports real-time payment systems", Pix included[366]. And some on the American side defended it: at the hearing of July 7, 2026, the US National Retail Federation (NRF) said Pix had shown how alternative systems can "lower transaction costs" in markets where merchants face "high fees from dominant card networks"[367].

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system-stirs-global-interest-2026-07-21/.

361 Angelo Duarte; Jon Frost; Leonardo Gambacorta; Priscilla Koo Wilkens; Hyun Song Shin, 'Central banks, the monetary system and public payment infrastructures: lessons from Brazil's Pix', *Bank for International Settlements*, 23 March 2022, https://www.bis.org/publications/bulletin-52-central-banks-monetary-system-and-public-payment-infrastructures-lessons-brazils-pix.

362 Amanda Lucio, 'Primeiro semestre registra mais de 72 bilhões de transações financeiras, revela BC', *E-Commerce Brasil - Artigos e Dicas sobre comércio eletrônico*, 10 November 2025, https://www.ecommercebrasil.com.br/noticias/primeiro-semestre-registra-mais-de-72-bilhoes-de-transacoes-financeiras-revela-bc.

363 Simon Lester, 'Is Brazil's Pix Payment System an Unfair Trade Practice?', *International Economic Law and Policy Blog*, 31 August 2026, https://ielp.worldtradelaw.net/2026/08/is-brazils-pix-payment-system-an-unfair-trade-practice/.

364 Ayres, 'Brazil and US clash over future', https://www.reuters.com/business/finance/brazil-us-clash-over-future-payments-popular-pix-system-stirs-global-interest-2026-07-21/.

365 *July 1, 2026*, *uscib.org*, 1 July 2026, https://uscib.org/uscib-content/uploads/2026/07/USCIB-Comments-on-Brazil-Section-301-Remedies-1.pdf.

366 *WRITTEN SUBMISSION OF THE NATIONAL FOREIGN TRADE COUNCIL*, *nftc.org*, 1 July 2026, https://www.nftc.org/wp-content/uploads/2026/07/FINAL-NFTC-Comments-for-Brazil-301-PUBLIC.pdf.

367 ustr.gov, '· · · · · ·', https://ustr.gov/sites/default/files/files/Issue_Areas/Enforcement/Section%20301/0707%20USTR%20Brazil%20301%20Day%202_full.pdf.

None of the business comments located asks for what Flávio asked for: a law preventing Pix from connecting to “non-Western” systems[368]. That request is his, and it went beyond what American industry itself asked for. At the date of the document, moreover, no such connection existed: the Pix infrastructure allows only domestic transactions, and use abroad runs through private partnerships that send the money through traditional channels[369]. The only connection of that kind to appear afterwards was a pilot programme by China’s UnionPay, announced in August 2026, which lets Chinese apps pay Pix QR codes in Brazilian shops[370].

This is the contradiction between finance capital and the productive requirements of the economy in its classic form: a claim on the social product defensible only while the alternative is technically unavailable. A rail that settles domestic payments at close to zero cost is a different object from one that must route through a correspondent bank, and the difference between them is not only one of price; it is a question of who controls the passage.

The symmetry is worth naming. At the trade hearing in July the candidate argued against the new 25% tariff on Brazilian goods[371]. The final decision imposed 25% on a set of products that, according to minister Márcio Elias Rosa, accounted for about 18% of Brazilian exports to the United States, about $7.4 billion[372][373]. The trade on offer becomes legible: relief on the export price in exchange for a payment architecture. What is purchased with one hand is a rent stream with the other.

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368 ustr.gov, ‘· · · · · ·’, https://ustr.gov/sites/default/files/files/Issue_Areas/Enforcement/Section%20301/0707%20USTR%20Brazil%20301%20Day%202_full.pdf.

369 Banco Central do Brasil - Departamento de Competição e de Estrutura do Mercado Financeiro - Decem, *Relatório de Gestão do Pix 2023-2025*, *Banco Central do Brasil*, 18 August 2026, https://www.bcb.gov.br/content/estabilidadefinanceira/pix/relatorio_de_gestao_pix/relatorio_gestao_pix_2026.pdf.

370 **责任编辑**：Margarida, ‘UnionPay International anuncia lançamento do programa de interoperabilidade transfronteiriça do QR Code entre China e Brasil’, *br-cn.com*, 4 August 2026, https://www.br-cn.com/static/content/news/pyxw/2026-08-04/1534272237069275567.html.

371 Luciana Novaes Magalhaes, ‘Brazil’s Senator Bolsonaro argues against 25% US tariff on its exports’, *Reuters*, 7 July 2026, https://www.reuters.com/world/americas/brazils-senator-bolsonaro-argues-against-25-us-tariff-its-exports-2026-07-07/.

372 Estadão Conteúdo, ‘Nova tarifa dos EUA afetará até 18% das exportações do Brasil, diz ministro’, *InfoMoney*, 16 July 2026, https://www.infomoney.com.br/economia/nova-tarifa-dos-eua-afetara-ate-18-das-exportacoes-do-brasil-diz-ministro/.

373 Nair, ‘US imposes new 25% tariffs on’, https://www.reuters.com/world/americas/us-imposes-25-tariff-some-goods-brazil-2026-07-16/.

Card-network fees are not bank interest

To understand who gains and who pays, two things the debate tends to conflate must be separated. Card networks and acquirers earn from fees charged on each sale[374]. Card interest goes to the banks that issue the cards, mostly Brazilian[375]. Flávio's document asks for relief from the "regulatory and tax burden" on card networks and acquirers (p. 11); it says nothing about interest[376].

And it is interest that weighs on households. In February 2026, revolving card credit charged 435.9% a year, and card instalment credit 200.2%[377]. Law 14,690 of 2023 established that interest and charges on revolving and instalment card credit may not exceed the original amount of the debt; it capped the total charged, not the rate[378]. In July 2026, 82% of households were in debt, the highest level ever recorded, and the credit card appeared in 85.3% of those cases[379]. The burden is unequal: in August, 38.8% of households earning up to three minimum wages had overdue bills, against 14.9% of those earning more than ten[380].

This report's reading is that the request to Washington serves the card networks and the card-machine companies, which lost part of the fees they charged to Pix. If Pix loses ground, those who pay more are merchants, small ones above all, who swap an average cost of about 0.2%

374 Banco Central do Brasil, *Relatório de Economia Bancária 2023*, *Banco Central do Brasil*, 7 June 2024, https://www.bcb.gov.br/content/publicacoes/boxe_relatorio_de_economia_bancaria/reb2023b3p.pdf.

375 Banco Central do Brasil, *Relatório de Economia Bancária 2023*, *Banco Central do Brasil*, 2024, https://www.bcb.gov.br/content/publicacoes/relatorioeconomiabancaria/reb2023p.pdf.

376 Senator Flávio Bolsonaro, 'Written Comment on the Proposed Action', docket USTR-2026-0331, 1 July 2026, copy published by *Poder360*, https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/07/Flavio-pede-aos-EUA-adiamento-de-tarifaco-2jul2026.pdf.

377 'Juros do cartão de crédito pesam mais para famílias em fevereiro', *Agência Brasil*, 30 March 2026, https://agenciabrasil.ebc.com.br/economia/noticia/2026-03/juros-do-cartao-de-credito-pesam-mais-para-familias-em-fevereiro.

378 Presidência da República, 'Lei nº 14.690, de 3 de outubro de 2023', *Planalto*, 3 October 2023, https://www.planalto.gov.br/ccivil_03/_ato2023-2026/2023/lei/l14690.htm.

379 'CNC: endividamento das famílias sobe para 82%, mas inadimplência cai', *Agência Brasil*, 6 August 2026, https://agenciabrasil.ebc.com.br/economia/noticia/2026-08/cnc-endividamento-das-familias-sobe-para-82-mas-inadimplencia-cai.

380 CNC, 'CNC: mais endividadas do que a média, famílias de menor renda lideram avanço na inadimplência em agosto', *Portal do Comércio*, 10 September 2026, https://portaldocomercio.org.br/acoes-institucionais/cnc-mais-endividadas-do-que-a-media-familias-de-menor-renda-lideram-avanco-na-inadimplencia-em-agosto/.

of the sale on Pix for an average fee of about 1.1% on debit and 2.2% on credit[381][382], and consumers, to whom that cost returns built into the price. The comment asks Washington to ease the “regulatory and tax burden” on cards and acquirers and says nothing about the interest those cards charge: revolving-credit interest stays where it is.[383]

The concession

USA Rare Earth agreed in April 2026 to buy the Serra Verde rare earth mine in Minaçu, in the state of Goiás, for $2.8 billion[384]. Rare earths are a group of minerals used in the magnets of electric motors, turbines, mobile phones and weapons, and China today dominates their production[385]. The US government put in a further R$1.2 billion to close the purchase[386]. The buyer already held a separate $1.6 billion deal with the US Department of Commerce, announced in January 2026, under which the federal government was to take a 10 per cent stake in USA Rare Earth; in July 2026 three US senators and a representative opened a probe into that deal, citing conflict-of-interest concerns over the role of Cantor Fitzgerald, led by Commerce Secretary Howard Lutnick’s sons, as its placement agent[387].

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381 Angelo Duarte; Jon Frost; Leonardo Gambacorta; Priscilla Koo Wilkens; Hyun Song Shin, ‘Central banks, the monetary system and public payment infrastructures: lessons from Brazil’s Pix’, *Bank for International Settlements*, 23 March 2022, https://www.bis.org/publications/bulletin-52-central-banks-monetary-system-and-public-payment-infrastructures-lessons-brazils-pix.

382 Amanda Lucio, ‘Primeiro semestre registra mais de 72 bilhões de transações financeiras, revela BC’, *E-Commerce Brasil*, 10 November 2025, https://www.ecommercebrasil.com.br/noticias/primeiro-semestre-registra-mais-de-72-bilhoes-de-transacoes-financeiras-revela-bc.

383 Senator Flávio Bolsonaro, ‘Written Comment on the Proposed Action’, docket USTR-2026-0331, 1 July 2026, copy published by *Poder360*, https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/07/Flavio-pede-aos-EUA-adiamento-de-tarifaco-2jul2026.pdf.

384 ‘Terras raras: cidade goiana saiu do amianto para disputa de minérios’, *G1*, 26 August 2026, https://g1.globo.com/go/goias/noticia/2026/08/26/saiba-como-cidade-goiana-saiu-da-exploracao-de-amianto-para-o-centro-da-disputa-por-terras-raras.ghtml.

385 IEA, International Energy Agency, ‘Executive summary’, *IEA*, https://www.iea.org/reports/rare-earth-elements/executive-summary.

386 Thiago Bethônico, ‘Governo dos EUA põe mais R$ 1,2 bi, e compra de mineradora brasileira de terras raras deve sair nesta semana’, *Folha de S.Paulo*, 24 August 2026, https://www1.folha.uol.com.br/mercado/2026/08/governo-dos-eua-poe-mais-r-12-bi-para-concluir-compra-de-mineradora-brasileira-de-terras-raras-nesta-semana.shtml.

387 ‘Warren, Wyden, Van Hollen, Lofgren Lead New Probe Into Cantor Fitzgerald, USAR After $1.6 Billion Trump Administration Deal’, *Senator Elizabeth Warren*, 7 July 2026, https://www.warren.senate.gov/newsroom/press-releases/warren-wyden-van-hollen-lofgren-lead-new-probe-into-cantor-fitzgerald-usar-after-1-6-billion-trump-administration-deal/.

American dependence explains the effort. The United States imports 67% of the rare earth compounds and metals it consumes, and 71% of those imports come from China[388]. For niobium, a metal used in specialty steels, the United States imports everything it consumes, and 67% comes from Brazil[389]. Brazil has the world's second-largest rare earth reserves, 11 million tonnes according to the same survey, although it mined only 2,000 tonnes in 2025[390].

The structure around the mine converts a commercial acquisition into a state instrument. The company's filings record a fifteen-year offtake agreement (a contract for the forward purchase of output) to supply a special purpose vehicle capitalised by United States government agencies and private capital[391], covering 100% of first-phase production, with guaranteed price floors for the magnetic rare earths[392]. A second exhibit records the Department of War's (the Pentagon's new name) commitment of $750 million to that vehicle, $250 million more than the $500 million originally contemplated[393]. The DFC, the US International Development Finance Corporation, appears in the resale prospectus both as a selling stockholder with 15,221,917 shares and as a lender holding the right to appoint a director to the acquired company's board[394]; in February 2026 it had already signed a $565 million loan to expand the mine[395].

A quieter chain links the same capital to the southern coast of Bahia. Energy Fuels, a separate US company, moved into the Bahia heavy-mineral sands precisely for their monazite, which carries the light and heavy rare earths its White Mesa mill in Utah plans to separate.[396] It holds nineteen active mining processes at the National Mining Agency in Alcobaça, Caravelas and

388 U.S. Geological Survey, *Mineral Commodity Summaries 2026*, *pubs.usgs.gov*, 2021, https://pubs.usgs.gov/periodicals/mcs2026/mcs2026-rare-earths.pdf.

389 U.S. Geological Survey, *Mineral Commodity Summaries 2026*, *pubs.usgs.gov*, May 2026, https://pubs.usgs.gov/periodicals/mcs2026/mcs2026.pdf.

390 Survey, 'Mineral Commodity Summaries 2026', https://pubs.usgs.gov/periodicals/mcs2026/mcs2026-rare-earths.pdf.

391 sec.gov, https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1970622/000121390026092810/ea030292401ex99-1.htm.

392 sec.gov, https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1970622/000121390026092810/ea030292401ex99-2.htm.

393 sec.gov, https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1970622/000121390026092810/ea030292401ex99-1.htm.

394 sec.gov, https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1970622/000121390026100977/ea0305798-424b3_usarare.htm.

395 'DFC Highlights Landmark Critical Minerals Investments to Strengthen U.S. National Security During State Department Ministerial', *DFC Highlights Landmark Critical Minerals Investments to Strengthen U.S. National Security During State Department Ministerial*, 4 February 2026, https://www.dfc.gov/media/press-releases/dfc-highlights-landmark-critical-minerals-investments-strengthen-us-national.

Prado[397]. In August 2025 it agreed with Vulcan Elements to supply separated rare earth oxides to a magnet manufacturer[398]. Vulcan had announced a $65 million funding round[399]. The venture fund whose partners include Donald Trump Jr. invested in Vulcan, and Vulcan's $620 million Pentagon loan was pushed by a senior White House aide: among dozens of start-ups under review, it was the only one whose request was raised to that level[400]. Democratic senators wrote to the Department of Defense about it, which is the ordinary way such an arrangement becomes a public fact.

American interest also reached the negotiating table in writing[401]. Among the 21 demands the Trump administration put to Brazil to negotiate the tariff, in an October 2025 draft revealed in September 2026, were items on critical minerals, such as opening space for investment by American companies in the sector; a second proposal, presented in January 2026, added the "review" of the sale of Anglo American's nickel operations[402]. The buyer of those operations is MMG, a Chinese state-owned company, which agreed to pay up to $500 million for the ferronickel mines of Barro Alto and Niquelândia, in Goiás[403]; the sale has also come under

396 'News Releases', *Energy Fuels*, 19 May 2022, https://investors.energyfuels.com/2022-05-19-Energy-Fuels-Secures-Major-Rare-Earth-Land-Position-in-Brazil.

397 Brenda Neri, 'Grupo ligado à campanha de Flávio explora terras raras na Bahia', *Consultor Jurídico*, 22 September 2026, https://conjur.com.br/2026-set-22/grupo-dos-eua-ligado-a-campanha-de-flavio-bolsonaro-explora-terras-raras-na-bahia/.

398 'Energy Fuels and Vulcan Elements Join Forces to Advance U.S. Rare Earth Magnet Security', *Vulcan Elements*, 26 August 2025, https://vulcanelements.com/company/updates/energy-fuels-and-vulcan-elements-join-forces-to-advance-u-s-rare-earth-magnet-security.

399 'Vulcan Elements Announces $65 Million Series A, and Produces High-Performance Rare Earth Magnets in the United States', *Vulcan Elements*, 11 August 2025, https://vulcanelements.com/company/updates/vulcan-elements-announces-65-million-series-a-and-produces-high-performance-rare-earth-magnets-in-the-united-states.

400 Robert Faturechi, 'The White House Intervened to Get a $620 Million Deal for a Company Tied to Donald Trump Jr.', *ProPublica*, 28 May 2026, https://www.propublica.org/article/donald-trump-jr-vulcan-deal-white-house.

401 Carlos Augusto; Diretor Do Jornal Grande Bahia, 'Governo Trump incluiu eleição de 2026, 'dissidentes políticos' e minerais em 21 exigências ao Brasil sobre tarifaço', *Jornal Grande Bahia (JGB)*, 17 September 2026, https://jornalgrandebahia.com.br/2026/09/governo-trump-incluiu-eleicao-de-2026-dissidentes-politicos-e-minerais-em-21-exigencias-ao-brasil-sobre-tarifaco/.

402 Bahia, 'Governo Trump incluiu eleição de 2026,', https://jornalgrandebahia.com.br/2026/09/governo-trump-incluiu-eleicao-de-2026-dissidentes-politicos-e-minerais-em-21-exigencias-ao-brasil-sobre-tarifaco/.

403 Circulação M3, 'Anglo American Vende Operações de Níquel no Brasil para a MMG', *Revista Minérios | Notícias sobre mineração*, 23 June 2025, https://revistaminerios.com.br/brasil-producao-niquel-investidores/.

examination by the European Commission[404][405][406]. Washington, then, is not only asking to enter Brazil's subsoil; it is asking to remove Beijing from it. And China is already there: in 2025 it invested a record $1.76 billion in Brazilian mining, 29% of all it invested in the country and more than triple the previous year[407], and Chinese mining companies already accounted for about 30% of niobium and tin extraction in Brazil[408]. Meanwhile Chinese retaliation against US goods made Brazilian soy more competitive in the Chinese market, and Brazilian soybean exports set records with the United States out of that market.[409][410]

The Brazilian response and what the law reaches

The Brazilian response came in September 2026, after the acquisition had closed[411]. President Lula signed into law the national policy for critical and strategic minerals, with R$5 billion in tax credits and a council empowered to decide on foreign participation in the sector[412]. It is

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404 Letícia Arcoverde, 'Venda de mina de níquel no Brasil para chineses entra na mira da UE', *Reset*, 14 September 2026, https://capitalreset.uol.com.br/empresas/venda-de-mina-de-niquel-no-brasil-para-chineses-entra-na-mira-da-ue/.

405 Survey, 'Mineral Commodity Summaries 2026', https://pubs.usgs.gov/periodicals/mcs2026/mcs2026.pdf.

406 Clickr 力嘉, 'Mineradoras chinesas já respondem por 30% da extracção de nióbio e de estanho no Brasil', *Fórum de Macau*, 27 October 2025, https://www.forumchinaplp.org.mo/pt/economic_trade/view/9258.

407 Gabriel Chiappini, 'Investimentos chineses em mineração no Brasil mais que triplicam em 2025', *eixos*, 20 May 2026, https://eixos.com.br/transicao-energetica/investimentos-chineses-em-mineracao-no-brasil-mais-que-triplicam-em-2025/.

408 力嘉, 'Mineradoras chinesas já respondem por 30%', https://www.forumchinaplp.org.mo/pt/economic_trade/view/9258.

409 Alessandra Mello, 'Com tarifa chinesa, soja brasileira fica (ainda mais) competitiva e pode ganhar mercado', *AgFeed*, 4 April 2025, https://agfeed.com.br/economia/com-tarifa-chinesa-soja-brasileira-fica-ainda-mais-competitiva-e-pode-ganhar-mercado/.

410 Roberto Samora, 'Brazil's soybean exports to hit record as US out of market, Chinese demand strong', *Reuters*, 8 October 2025, https://www.reuters.com/sustainability/climate-energy/brazils-soybean-exports-hit-record-us-out-market-chinese-demand-strong-2025-10-08/.

411 Spechoto, 'Lula sanciona lei dos minerais críticos', https://c-level.folha.uol.com.br/infraestrutura/2026/09/lula-sanciona-lei-dos-minerais-criticos-com-r-5-bi-em-subsidios-e-poder-de-decidir-sobre-estrangeiros.shtml.

412 Spechoto, 'Lula sanciona lei dos minerais críticos', https://c-level.folha.uol.com.br/infraestrutura/2026/09/lula-sanciona-lei-dos-minerais-criticos-com-r-5-bi-em-subsidios-e-poder-de-decidir-sobre-estrangeiros.shtml.

Law 15,506 of September 16, 2026, regulated the same day by Decree 13,118[413]. The council, together with the mining agency, ratifies (that is, approves, approves with conditions or vetoes) four types of operation: changes of control of companies holding rights over critical minerals; significant foreign stakes or foreign access to strategic geological data; international supply contracts, the offtakes; and the sale or encumbrance of mining titles[414]. The law has no retroactive clause. Because the Serra Verde purchase closed before the law was signed, it did not pass through the council; what falls under the filter are the next changes of control, the next forward-sale contracts and every concession still to be granted, which converts each future contract from a market transaction into an administrative decision. The counterweight to a forward-contracted rent is a veto power.

One fact contradicts the idea that the right resisted this veto. In the Chamber of Deputies the bill passed by a symbolic (voice) vote on May 6, 2026, with the support of the government and part of the opposition; only the PSOL/Rede Federation, which found the text weak, and the Novo party spoke against it[415][416]. In the Senate, on September 2, 2026, Senator Wilder Morais (PL-GO; PL is Bolsonaro's Liberal Party) was rapporteur on the text in one of the committees, Marcos Pontes (PL-SP) praised the bill, Carlos Portinho (PL-RJ) tabled and then withdrew an amendment, and Izalci Lucas (PL-DF) recorded concern about the council's role[417]. The PL did not vote against.

The campaign speaks differently to each audience

The campaign's side of this story consists of documents and addresses. A document prepared for a future government proposed aligning Brazil with the United States in building a parallel supply system for critical minerals[418]. In the programme registered with the TSE (the Superior Electoral Court), however, Flávio promises a "regulatory State, not an entrepreneurial one", foreign capital and faster environmental licensing, mentioning the United States and China,

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413 Liliam Fernanda Yoshikawa; Pedro Henrique Jardim; Yves Crivelini, 'Sancionada a lei que institui a Política Nacional de Minerais Críticos e Estratégicos', *Machado Meyer*, 18 September 2026, https://www.machadomeyer.com.br/pt/inteligencia-juridica/publicacoes-ij/infraestrutura-e-energia-ij/sancionada-a-lei-que-institui-a-politica-nacional-de-minerais-criticos-e-estrategicos.

414 Juarez, *Ministério de Minas e Energia*, *gov.br*, 17 September 2026, https://www.gov.br/mme/pt-br/acesso-a-informacao/legislacao/leis/lei-n-15-506-2026.pdf.

415 Célia Mello, 'Câmara aprova texto-base da política de minerais críticos e estratégicos', *ClimaInfo*, 6 May 2026, https://climainfo.org.br/2026/05/06/camara-aprova-texto-base-da-politica-de-minerais-criticos-e-estrategicos/.

416 Larissa Fafá; Autor no JOTA, 'Câmara aprova PL de minerais críticos e mantém mecanismos de soberania', *JOTA Jornalismo*, 6 May 2026, https://www.jota.info/legislativo/camara-aprova-pl-de-minerais-criticos-e-mantem-mecanismos-de-soberania.

417 'Senado aprova política nacional para minerais críticos e estratégicos', *Senado Federal*, 2 September 2026, https://www12.senado.leg.br/noticias/materias/2026/09/02/senado-aprova-politica-nacional-para-minerais-criticos-e-estrategicos.

but not the new council[419][420]. To Americans, the tone was different. At CPAC Texas, on March 28, 2026, he said that “Brazil is America’s solution to break the dependence on China for critical minerals, especially rare earths”[421]. After the Oval Office meeting with Trump on May 26, 2026, he himself said they had discussed rare earths and critical minerals[422]. And in the annex of the document submitted to the USTR, Lula’s refusal of an alliance with the United States on rare earths is listed as an act of hostility towards Americans (p. 36 and 38)[423].

After the law was signed, the direction became clearer. According to CNN Brasil, which spoke to campaign figures on condition of anonymity, Flávio’s inner circle is discussing a review of the council’s powers “or its very existence”, on the view that the model opens the door to discretionary decisions[424]. Because the council was created by law, abolishing it would require Congress[425]. The 21 American demands had asked for a different filter: advance notice to Washington of asset transfers in the sector, openings for US investors and limits on investment by foreign entities “of concern”[426].

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418 Campos, ‘Documento traz plano de Flávio Bolsonaro’, https://amadomundo.com/documento-eua-terras-raras-governo-flavio-bolsonaro/.

419 *Diretrizes_Plano_de_Governo_Flavio_Bolsonaro_2027-2030_versaofinal*, *static.poder360.com.br*, 13 August 2026, https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/08/plano-governo-flavio.pdf.

420 João Alfredo Nyegray, ‘O programa de Flávio Bolsonaro não menciona BRICS nem Mercosul. O que o candidato do PL propõe para o Brasil no mundo’, *ND Mais*, 29 September 2026, https://ndmais.com.br/mundo/o-programa-de-flavio-bolsonaro-nao-menciona-brics-nem-mercosul-o-que-o-candidato-do-pl-propoe-para-o-brasil-no-mundo/.

421 Campos, ‘Documento traz plano de Flávio Bolsonaro’, https://amadomundo.com/documento-eua-terras-raras-governo-flavio-bolsonaro/.

422 Reuters, ‘Brazil senator and presidential contender Flavio Bolsonaro meets Trump at White House’, *Reuters*, 26 May 2026, https://www.reuters.com/world/americas/brazilian-senator-bolsonaro-touts-trump-meeting-white-house-2026-05-26/.

423 Senator Flávio Bolsonaro, ‘Written Comment on the Proposed Action’, docket USTR-2026-0331, 1 July 2026, copy published by *Poder360*, https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/07/Flavio-pede-aos-EUA-adiamento-de-tarifaco-2jul2026.pdf.

424 Daniel Rittner; Gabriel Garcia, ‘Equipe de Flávio quer rever papel de novo conselho dos minerais críticos’, *CNN Brasil*, 16 October 2026, https://www.cnnbrasil.com.br/infra/equipe-de-flavio-quer-rever-papel-de-novo-conselho-dos-minerais-criticos/.

425 Garcia, ‘Equipe de Flávio quer rever papel’, https://www.cnnbrasil.com.br/infra/equipe-de-flavio-quer-rever-papel-de-novo-conselho-dos-minerais-criticos/.

426 Carlos Augusto, ‘Governo Trump incluiu eleição de 2026, ’dissidentes políticos’ e minerais em 21 exigências ao Brasil sobre tarifaço’, *Jornal Grande Bahia*, 17 September 2026, https://jornalgrandebahia.com.br/2026/09/governo-trump-incluiu-eleicao-de-2026-dissidentes-politicos-e-minerais-em-21-exigencias-ao-brasil-sobre-tarifaco/.

What the Rockbridge Network is

The Rockbridge Network is a closed network of major donors on the American right, created in 2019 by JD Vance, now Vice President of the United States, and the investor Chris Buskirk[427]. Its members pay annual dues to fund the infrastructure of the Trump movement: media outlets, voter mobilisation organisations and polling[428]. Buskirk also co-founded 1789 Capital, the Palm Beach investment fund, with Omeed Malik in 2022, and Donald Trump Jr. joined it as a partner; the fund invests in right-aligned companies, from Polymarket to Pentagon suppliers, and the reporting on its portfolio records that it invests in companies which have received federal money.[429][430]

Rockbridge Brazil LLC was registered in the state of Wyoming on May 12, 2026[431]. An LLC is a type of American company that is simple to register, and Wyoming is one of the states that do not require disclosure of owners[432]. The company was formed by Chris Applegate, a Republican fundraiser who worked directly with Vance and whom the formation document identifies as the *organizer*, the person responsible for the formal incorporation, which does not necessarily mean owner or manager[433]. The Lula coalition's petition to the TSE records that the opening of that company confirms Rockbridge was evaluating, until May 2026, the creation of a Brazilian arm[434].

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427 static.congressoemfoco.com.br, 'PROCESSO', https://static.congressoemfoco.com.br/2026/09/24/attachment/2026/09/24/ff691f_lula_aciona_tse_contra_possivel_financiamento_dos_eua_por_flavio_13_set__2026.pdf.

428 Cecília Olliveira; Gisele Lobato; Nick Cleveland-Stout, 'Rede trumpista Rockbridge tentou esconder início de operação no Brasil', *Intercept Brasil*, 29 September 2026, https://www.intercept.com.br/2026/09/29/rede-rockbridge-operacao-brasil/.

429 Polymarket, 'Polymarket Receives Strategic Investment from 1789 Capital and Welcomes Donald Trump Jr. to Advisory Board', *Cision PR Newswire*, 26 August 2025, https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/polymarket-receives-strategic-investment-from-1789-capital-and-welcomes-donald-trump-jr-to-advisory-board-302538997.html.

430 Tolan, 'Trump Jr.'s 1789 fund invests in', https://www.cnn.com/2026/07/20/politics/trump-jr-investments-federal-funding-invs.

431 'Rockbridge Brazil LLC - WY Company Records & Officers', *Business Entity Search*, 12 May 2026, https://businessregistry.com/wyoming/rockbridge-brazil-llc/.

432 Cecília Olliveira; Gisele Lobato; Nick Cleveland-Stout, 'Rede trumpista Rockbridge tentou esconder início de operação no Brasil', *Intercept Brasil*, 29 September 2026, https://www.intercept.com.br/2026/09/29/rede-rockbridge-operacao-brasil/.

433 Cecília Olliveira; Gisele Lobato; Nick Cleveland-Stout, 'Rede trumpista Rockbridge tentou esconder início de operação no Brasil', *Intercept Brasil*, 29 September 2026, https://www.intercept.com.br/2026/09/29/rede-rockbridge-operacao-brasil/.

434 static.congressoemfoco.com.br, 'PROCESSO', https://static.congressoemfoco.com.br/2026/09/24/attachment/2026/09/24/

The organiser of that arm has a name. The Rio de Janeiro businessman Pedro Sang introduced himself at Flávio's campaign headquarters in São Paulo, on República do Líbano avenue, as "Pedro from Rockbridge" and worked from a room on the building's second floor, according to campaign figures who spoke anonymously to Amado Mundo[435]. In March 2026 André Marinho, a candidate for the Rio de Janeiro governorship, wrote an English-language memorandum carrying the cover line "Flávio Bolsonaro | 2026 Campaign" which proposed a "parallel supply system" for critical minerals and rare earths, the gains claimed for Brazil being advancement up the value chain, long-term Western capital, high-skill industrial employment and geopolitical influence; Marinho confirms he wrote it.[436] Renan Santos, a candidate in the 2026 presidential race, has said he holds documents showing that Rockbridge financed the campaign; he has not presented them, and the Lula coalition's petition to the electoral court separately alleges foreign financing of the campaign, an allegation made by a party to a case, and recorded here as one.[437] On October 1, 2026, Folha de S.Paulo, drawing on six people close to the campaign, including members of the electoral team, reported that Sang, presented as CEO of Rockbridge Brasil, produced monitoring reports, took part in meetings and helped find the building that houses the campaign; he and the businessman Tallis Gomes deny any interest in exploiting Brazilian rare earths, and the campaign states that it received no foreign money or structure[438]. The network's own account is that the Brazilian project was abandoned before any money moved[439].

The territory

Those who pay where the mine sets up are other people. Minaçu, the Serra Verde town, has about 27,000 inhabitants[440]. Between 2010 and 2021, mining royalties (the CFEM) averaged the equivalent of 5% of the municipal budget, and between 2014 and 2020 that money did not reduce the number of families registered in the CadÚnico, the federal register of low-income

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ff691f_lula_aciona_tse_contra_possivel_financiamento_dos_eua_por_flavio_13_set__2026.pdf.

435 Guilherme Amado; João Pedroso de Campos, 'Pedro Sang, da Rockbridge, atua no QG de Flávio Bolsonaro', *Amado Mundo*, 13 September 2026, https://amadomundo.com/pedro-sang-da-rockbridge-atua-no-qg-de-flavio-bolsonaro/.

436 Campos, 'Documento traz plano de Flávio Bolsonaro', https://amadomundo.com/documento-eua-terras-raras-governo-flavio-bolsonaro/.

437 static.congressoemfoco.com.br, 'PROCESSO', https://static.congressoemfoco.com.br/2026/09/24/attachment/2026/09/24/ff691f_lula_aciona_tse_contra_possivel_financiamento_dos_eua_por_flavio_13_set__2026.pdf.

438 Carolina Linhares, 'Empresários ligados ao grupo Rockbridge ajudaram Flávio Bolsonaro com relatórios e consultoria, dizem aliados', *Folha de S.Paulo*, 1 October 2026, https://www1.folha.uol.com.br/poder/2026/10/empresarios-ligados-ao-grupo-rockbridge-ajudaram-flavio-bolsonaro-com-relatorios-e-consultoria-dizem-aliados.shtml.

439 Cleveland-Stout, 'Rede trumpista Rockbridge tentou esconder início', https://www.intercept.com.br/2026/09/29/rede-rockbridge-operacao-brasil/.

people, according to research by the geographer Agnes Serrano[441]. Two families told Agência Pública that two streams rising in the mine area had taken on a reddish appearance, and a smallholder reported a series of miscarriages among his cows, which drink that water; the company collected samples and gave the residents no answer[442]. The mine's environmental impact report, published by the DFC, includes a Minaçu land reform settlement among the communities in the study area[443].

In southern Bahia, 10 of Energy Fuels' 19 processes overlap the buffer zone (the protective strip around it) of the Cassurubá Marine Extractive Reserve, over an area of 1,500 hectares, and a local environmental organisation points to impacts on the Pataxó people of the Comexatibá Indigenous Territory, who, it says, were not consulted[444]. The new law gives affected communities no seat on the council.

The state-level enclave

Sabesp was sold in July 2024 for R$14.8 billion, the largest sanitation offering in Brazilian history[445]. The state government retained a stake in the company it had just sold. VEJA magazine reported that the operation delivered both economic and political dividends to the governor who executed it[446].

Water and sewerage are a natural monopoly: in a city, it makes no sense to have two competing networks. The sale therefore introduces no competition; it transfers a captive

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440 Isabel Seta, 'Do amianto às terras raras, cidade de Goiás vive entre passado e futuro da mineração', *Agência Pública*, 1 July 2025, https://apublica.org/2025/07/do-amianto-as-terras-raras-cidade-de-goias-vive-entre-passado-e-futuro-da-mineracao/.

441 Seta, 'Do amianto às terras raras, cidade', https://apublica.org/2025/07/do-amianto-as-terras-raras-cidade-de-goias-vive-entre-passado-e-futuro-da-mineracao/.

442 Seta, 'Do amianto às terras raras, cidade', https://apublica.org/2025/07/do-amianto-as-terras-raras-cidade-de-goias-vive-entre-passado-e-futuro-da-mineracao/.

443 *Mineração de Terras Raras em Minaçu Goiás RELATÓRIO DE IMPACTO AMBIENTAL*, *dfc.gov*, 27 January 2016, https://www.dfc.gov/sites/default/files/esia/2025/serraverde/Project/05_Local%20Language%20Summary%20of%20ESIA%20(RIMA)_508.pdf.

444 'Multinacional mira terras-raras e urânio no santuário ecológico do sul da Bahia', *O Globo*, 10 October 2026, https://oglobo.globo.com/brasil/noticia/2026/10/10/multinacional-mira-terras-raras-e-uranio-no-santuario-ecologico-do-sul-da-bahia.ghtml.

445 Do R7, 'Sabesp é privatizada por R$ 14,8 bilhões, a maior oferta de saneamento da história', *Noticias R7*, 19 July 2024, https://noticias.r7.com/economia/sabesp-e-privatizada-por-r-148-bilhoes-a-maior-oferta-de-saneamento-da-historia-19072024/.

446 Sergio Ruiz Luz; Isabella Alonso Panho, 'Privatização da Sabesp rende dividendos econômicos e políticos a Tarcísio de Freitas', *VEJA*, 26 July 2024, https://veja.abril.com.br/brasil/privatizacao-da-sabesp-rende-dividendos-economicos-e-politicos-a-tarcisio/.

revenue stream, and the state keeps enough shares to claim credit for investment while regulation stays with the government that did the selling. No federal screening applies to it: the 2026 minerals law reaches mining rights, foreign stakes in mining companies and purchases of mineral output, not the sale of a water utility.

The political return is visible in the same state's results. Guilherme Derrite was a lieutenant in the Rota, the elite unit of the São Paulo Military Police, between 2010 and 2013, and became the most voted senator for São Paulo in October 2026[447]. On September 7, 2026, the governor of São Paulo and candidate for re-election, Tarcísio de Freitas, took the stage at the rally on Paulista avenue and said the latest revelations about the relationship between Supreme Court Justice Alexandre de Moraes and the banker Daniel Vorcaro "need answers"[448][449]. The state level combines three things the national programme cannot supply on its own: the proceeds of a sold public asset, the security apparatus that manufactures the campaign's central issue, and the electoral machine that delivers the seat.

The rent that complicates the picture

The agrarian fraction that endorsed the ticket does not share in any of these three rents, and its rent is of a different kind. In Mato Grosso the state treasury collects, alongside the Fethab (a per-tonne contribution created to fund roads and housing, which the state finance secretariat does not classify as a tax), a second per-tonne contribution on soybeans and transfers it, under a 2019 state law and an agreement signed with that secretariat, to an institute linked to the soybean producers' association; the transfers reached R$138 million[450][451]. In September 2021 the Federal Police executed searches against the association, and a court froze its accounts in an inquiry into the financing of anti-democratic acts[452].

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447 Aiuri Rebello, 'Da Rota ao Senado, Derrite se torna o mais votado de São Paulo', *Gazeta do Povo*, 11 October 2026, https://www.gazetadopovo.com.br/eleicoes/2026/sao-paulo-2026/perfil-guilherme-derrite-senador-mais-votado/.

448 'As últimas revelações sobre Moraes precisam de respostas', diz Tarcísio em ato na Paulista', *O Globo*, 7 September 2026, https://oglobo.globo.com/politica/eleicoes-2026/noticia/2026/09/07/as-ultimas-revelacoes-sobre-moraes-precisam-de-respostas-diz-tarcisio-em-ato-na-paulista.ghtml.

449 O Globo, 'As últimas revelações sobre Moraes precisam', https://oglobo.globo.com/politica/eleicoes-2026/noticia/2026/09/07/as-ultimas-revelacoes-sobre-moraes-precisam-de-respostas-diz-tarcisio-em-ato-na-paulista.ghtml.

450 'Fethab repassou R$ 138 milhões para a Aprosoja por meio de convênio com a Sefaz', *Fethab repassou R$ 138 milhões para a Aprosoja por meio de convênio com a Sefaz | Gazeta Digital*, 6 September 2021, https://www.gazetadigital.com.br/editorias/politica-de-mt/fethab-repassou-r-138-milhes-para-a-aprosoja-por-meio-de-convnio-com-a-sefaz/666718.

451 Vasconcelo Quadros, 'Investigado por atos antidemocráticos, Galvan obteve vantagens do governo para produtores', *Agência Pública*, 7 September 2022, https://apublica.org/2022/09/investigado-por-atos-antidemocraticos-galvan-obteve-vantagens-do-governo-para-produtores/.

A study identified 142 agribusiness operators among those involved in the attempted coup[453]. Of the sixteen financiers named by the CPMI (the joint congressional inquiry) into January 8, thirteen are farmers[454]. The CPMI's final report requested the indictment of Lucas Costa Beber, then vice-president of Aprosoja Mato Grosso[455], who in June 2026 became interim president of Aprosoja Brasil[456].

This is a rent captured through the state's collection apparatus, secured against land and converted into money through a single main foreign buyer. It explains the otherwise incoherent position the sector occupies. A fraction whose revenue depends on a state contribution passed to a private institute linked to it, and on the Chinese order book, can endorse a candidate whose diplomatic programme turns against Chinese systems without needing either the payment rail or the mineral concession, because it is not competing for either. Under a hypothetical Flávio Bolsonaro government, a senator from the sector said, balance would be needed in agribusiness negotiations with China and the United States[457]. The coalition holds because these interests run on separate tracks.

Conclusion

Three rents, three fractions: the card networks and the acquirers operating in Brazil; the defence-minerals vehicle and the venture fund that rode on it; and the state-level bloc that sells public companies and promotes police careers at the same time. The agrarian fraction sits outside all three, its rent held in a state contribution passed to a private institute and in a foreign order book. The record supports reading the 2026 realignment as a transnational

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452 Luciana Lima, 'PF cumpre mandados de busca e apreensão na Aprosoja, que tem contas bloqueadas', *Metrópoles*, 6 September 2021, https://www.metropoles.com/brasil/politica-brasil/pf-cumpre-mandados-de-busca-e-apreensao-na-aprosoja-que-tem-contas-bloqueadas.

453 De Olho nos Ruralistas, 'Estudo identifica 142 empresários do agronegócio envolvidos em tentativa de golpe', *De Olho nos Ruralistas*, 25 June 2025, https://deolhonosruralistas.com.br/2025/06/25/relatorio-agrogolpistas/.

454 De Olho nos Ruralistas, 'Entre 16 financiadores do golpe denunciados por CPMI,13 são fazendeiros', *De Olho nos Ruralistas*, 17 October 2023, https://deolhonosruralistas.com.br/2023/10/17/entre-16-financiadores-do-golpe-denunciados-por-cpmi13-sao-fazendeiros/.

455 Midianews, 'MidiaNews | Relatório da CPMI do 8 de Janeiro pede indiciamento de 3 de MT', *MidiaNews*, 17 October 2023, https://www.midianews.com.br/politica/relatorio-da-cpmi-do-8-de-janeiro-pede-indiciamento-de-3-de-mt/455333.

456 Aprosoja Brasil e Aprosoja MT, 'Presidente da Aprosoja MT, Lucas Costa Beber assume presidência interina da Aprosoja Brasil', *Aprosoja MT*, 16 June 2026, https://aprosoja.com.br/comunicacao/release/presidente-da-aprosoja-mt-lucas-costa-beber-assume-presidencia-interina-da-aprosoja-brasil.

457 Rural, 'Flávio Bolsonaro precisará de equilíbrio em', https://www.novacana.com/noticias/flavio-bolsonaro-precisara-de-equilibrio-em-negociacoes-do-agro-com-eua-e-china-diz-senadora.

capital alignment along the minerals chain only in part, because that alignment coexists with a fraction whose interests it does not serve; the transnational partisan dimension of Brazilian foreign policy is documented, but it does not supply the missing cohesion[458]. What remains unexplained is not who gains but through what political form four incompatible rents are held inside a single candidacy. That is the next question.

Chapter 05: The China contradiction: agribusiness funds Bolsonarism while depending on Beijing

The bloc that finances Bolsonarism and the bloc that pays Brazil's bills are not the same bloc, and the distance between them is measured in one commodity. Agribusiness supplies the money, the parliamentary caucus and the machinery of mobilisation; China supplies the buyer. Roughly four fifths of Brazil's soy exports go to a single destination, and the candidate the farm caucus endorsed took to Washington a programme built against that destination's payment systems. The dependency does not merely constrain the anti-China programme. It sets the price at which the farm bloc will accept that programme, and it fixes the point at which the acceptance stops. Three things make that visible: the conversion of a state finance secretariat into the treasury of the growers' own association, the electoral channel built on top of it, and the endorsement that came with a condition attached.

What Aprosoja is

Aprosoja of Mato Grosso is the association of soy and maize growers in the state that produces the most soy in Brazil[459]. There is also Aprosoja Brasil, which brings the state associations together[460]. The Mato Grosso body receives part of the public contributions to a state transport and housing fund, Fethab, through an institute linked to it[461]. In recent years it has become one of the voices within agribusiness most closely aligned with Bolsonarism, and

458 Guilherme Casarões, 'Foreign policy and transnational partisanship in', https://revistas.ucm.es/index.php/POSO/article/download/99351/4564456573289/4564456753168.

459 'Mato Grosso consolida safra 25/26 com produção recorde e mantém liderança na soja há 26 safras - SEDEC', *SEDEC*, https://www.sedec.mt.gov.br/-/mato-grosso-consolida-safra-25/26-com-produ%C3%A7%C3%A3o-recorde-e-mant%C3%A9m-lideran%C3%A7a-na-soja-h%C3%A1-26-safras.

460 'Sobre nós', *Aprosoja Brasil*, 8 December 2018, https://aprosojabrasil.com.br/sobre-nos/.

461 Fethab repassou R$ 138 milhões para a Aprosoja por meio de convênio com a Sefaz | Gazeta Digital, 'Fethab repassou R$ 138 milhões para', https://www.gazetadigital.com.br/editorias/politica-de-mt/fethab-repassou-r-138-milhes-para-a-aprosoja-por-meio-de-convnio-com-a-sefaz/666718.

it is a long-standing partner of Eduardo Bolsonaro's institute[462]. Since June 2026 the two associations have had the same president, Lucas Costa Beber[463].

From state treasury to political war chest

The transfer that anchored Aprosoja-MT's political autonomy is a R$ 138 million arrangement routed through a state finance secretariat[464]. A reconstruction drawn from monthly Diário Oficial (official gazette) publications between February 2019 and July 2021 records the Mato Grosso treasury passing to the Instituto Mato-Grossense do Agronegócio (Iagro), an entity linked to the association, a per-tonne contribution on soybeans collected alongside the Fethab, which the state finance secretariat does not classify as a tax: R$138 million in all, with a record R$51.3 million in the first seven months of 2021[465][466]. The contribution was created by a state law of January 2019, which made it a condition of the deferral of ICMS (the state sales tax) and allowed its collection through an agreement with the finance secretariat[467]. The instrument was a convênio, that is, a formal agreement between the government and an entity, signed on August 9, 2019 by Antônio Galvan, then president of Aprosoja-MT and of the institute, and by the state finance secretary, Rogério Luiz Gallo, which also released the sums collected since the law took effect[468][469]. Under it the public collection apparatus, inspectors and electronic invoicing included, gathered alongside

462 Alice Maciel, 'Eduardo Bolsonaro: CPAC tem apoio de empresas ligadas a ato golpista', *Agência Pública*, 12 June 2024, https://apublica.org/nota/cpac-evento-do-instituto-de-eduardo-bolsonaro-tem-patrocinio-de-apoiadora-de-ato-golpista/.

463 Aprosoja Brasil e Aprosoja MT, 'Presidente da Aprosoja MT, Lucas Costa Beber assume presidência interina da Aprosoja Brasil', *Aprosoja MT*, 16 June 2026, https://aprosoja.com.br/comunicacao/release/presidente-da-aprosoja-mt-lucas-costa-beber-assume-presidencia-interina-da-aprosoja-brasil.

464 Fethab repassou R$ 138 milhões para a Aprosoja por meio de convênio com a Sefaz | Gazeta Digital, 'Fethab repassou R$ 138 milhões para', https://www.gazetadigital.com.br/editorias/politica-de-mt/fethab-repassou-r-138-milhes-para-a-aprosoja-por-meio-de-convnio-com-a-sefaz/666718.

465 Fethab repassou R$ 138 milhões para a Aprosoja por meio de convênio com a Sefaz | Gazeta Digital, 'Fethab repassou R$ 138 milhões para', https://www.gazetadigital.com.br/editorias/politica-de-mt/fethab-repassou-r-138-milhes-para-a-aprosoja-por-meio-de-convnio-com-a-sefaz/666718.

466 Fethab repassou R$ 138 milhões para a Aprosoja por meio de convênio com a Sefaz | Gazeta Digital, 'Fethab repassou R$ 138 milhões para', https://www.gazetadigital.com.br/editorias/politica-de-mt/fethab-repassou-r-138-milhes-para-a-aprosoja-por-meio-de-convnio-com-a-sefaz/666718.

467 'Lei nº 10.818, de 28 de janeiro de 2019', *Secretaria de Estado de Fazenda de Mato Grosso*, 28 January 2019, http://app1.sefaz.mt.gov.br/sistema/legislacao/legislacaotribut.nsf/2b2e6c5ed548697884256713004802l4/53097340696ef195842583910043bf66?OpenDocument.

ordinary taxes a contribution of 1.15 per cent of the state fiscal unit (UPF/MT) per tonne of soy transported, and the proceeds went to the private institute[470].

Mato Grosso's Prosecutor General, José Antônio Borges Pereira, took the convênio to the state court as unconstitutional, on the argument that a public finance machine had been converted into a collection agency for a business association[471]. The argument is this chapter's premise in legal form: what the state collected was not a tax, and what it financed was not a public function.

The judicial response followed. In September 2021 the Federal Police (PF) executed search and seizure warrants at Aprosoja's headquarters in Mato Grosso, and the Supreme Federal Court (STF) justice conducting the inquiry into the financing of anti-democratic acts ordered the association's accounts blocked in order to trace whether that money had paid for political mobilisation[472]. The order was issued to freeze the accounts, which is to say that the association's capacity to finance anything had become a judicial question[473]. That operation against the association was distinct from an earlier one against its leader. On August 20, 2021, according to court records seen by Reuters, Antônio Galvan, then head of the soybean growers' association Aprosoja, was one of ten people under investigation for a suspected conspiracy against institutions including the Supreme Court; that day the Federal Police searched his home in Sinop, and Reuters reported that Justice Alexandre de Moraes had barred those investigated from coming within one kilometre of the court building, on the Three Powers Square.[474][475] Twenty days after the search the Ministry of Agriculture extended the soybean planting window, a measure that benefited Galvan and dozens of growers who

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468 Vasconcelo Quadros, 'Investigado por atos antidemocráticos, Galvan obteve vantagens do governo para produtores', *Agência Pública*, 7 September 2022, https://apublica.org/2022/09/investigado-por-atos-antidemocraticos-galvan-obteve-vantagens-do-governo-para-produtores/.

469 'Convênio de Arrecadação nº 002/2019 - SEFAZ/IAGRO', *Secretaria de Estado de Fazenda de Mato Grosso*, 13 August 2019, https://app1.sefaz.mt.gov.br/Sistema/legislacao/legislacaotribut.nsf/7c7b6a9347c50f55032569140065ebbf/69826419f8dc75a48425845500555df3?OpenDocument.

470 Quadros, 'Investigado por atos antidemocráticos, Galvan obteve', https://apublica.org/2022/09/investigado-por-atos-antidemocraticos-galvan-obteve-vantagens-do-governo-para-produtores/.

471 Quadros, 'Investigado por atos antidemocráticos, Galvan obteve', https://apublica.org/2022/09/investigado-por-atos-antidemocraticos-galvan-obteve-vantagens-do-governo-para-produtores/.

472 Lima, 'PF cumpre mandados de busca e', https://www.metropoles.com/brasil/politica-brasil/pf-cumpre-mandados-de-busca-e-apreensao-na-aprosoja-que-tem-contas-bloqueadas.

473 Lucas Mendes, 'Moraes determina bloqueio de contas da Aprosoja para rastrear apoio a atos', *Poder360*, 6 September 2021, https://www.poder360.com.br/brasil/moraes-determina-bloqueio-de-contas-da-aprosoja-para-rastrear-apoio-a-atos/.

had been pressing against a calendar defended by the state prosecutor's office and thirteen other institutions, among them Embrapa.[476] In September 2022 Agência Pública reported that the restriction still kept Galvan a kilometre away from the Three Powers Square.[477]

The electoral channel

The line from that treasury to the electoral circuit is not metaphorical. In 2022 agribusiness entrepreneurs led donations to Jair Bolsonaro's campaign[478]. Mauro Cid, Jair Bolsonaro's former aide-de-camp, said under his plea agreement that General Walter Braga Netto handed him cash in a sealed wine bag, to be passed on to Major Rafael de Oliveira, and that the money had been raised from 'the agribusiness people'. Cid said he did not know the amount; the R$100,000 in the case is the sum Oliveira had asked for to cover hotels, transport and air

474 Reuters, 'Brazil soy group chief a target in political conspiracy probe -documents', *Reuters*, 20 August 2021, https://www.reuters.com/world/americas/brazil-soy-group-chief-target-political-conspiracy-probe-documents-2021-08-20/.

475 'Ministro Alexandre de Moraes determina busca e apreensão em endereços de deputado federal e do cantor Sérgio Reis', *noticias.stf.jus.br*, 20 August 2021, https://noticias.stf.jus.br/postsnoticias/ministro-alexandre-de-moraes-determina-busca-e-apreensao-em-enderecos-de-deputado-federal-e-do-cantor-sergio-reis/.

476 Quadros, 'Investigado por atos antidemocráticos, Galvan obteve', https://apublica.org/2022/09/investigado-por-atos-antidemocraticos-galvan-obteve-vantagens-do-governo-para-produtores/.

477 Quadros, 'Investigado por atos antidemocráticos, Galvan obteve', https://apublica.org/2022/09/investigado-por-atos-antidemocraticos-galvan-obteve-vantagens-do-governo-para-produtores/.

478 Estadão Conteúdo, 'Empresários do agronegócio lideram doações para a campanha de Jair Bolsonaro', *O Dia*, 13 September 2022, https://odia.ig.com.br/eleicoes/2022/09/6484820-empresarios-do-agronegocio-lideram-doacoes-para-a-campanha-de-jair-bolsonaro.html.

fares for protesters brought to Brasília. Braga Netto denies handing over any money.[479][480][481][482] Eight of the ten largest individual donors to the then president's campaign came from the farm sector, with the former racing driver Nelson Piquet among the names in that group[483][484]. In the second round, transfers driven by the sector pushed the campaign's second-round donations to roughly R$ 24 million[485]. Of the 83 people who had donated to Bolsonaro by late August 2022, 16, or 19.6 per cent, carried an active fine from Ibama, the federal environmental agency, for deforestation, land clearing or fire use[486][487].

Nothing in 2026 narrowed the channel. Flávio Bolsonaro raised R$ 20 million in private donations in the second round, 29 times Lula's total[488]. Among the hundred largest donors of the cycle, 42 gave directly to candidates of the PL (Bolsonaro's Liberal Party) rather than to a

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479 Alceu Luís Castilho e Bruno Stankevicius Bassi, 'Estudo identifica 142 empresários do agronegócio envolvidos em tentativa de golpe', *Biodiversidad en América Latina*, 2 July 2025, https://www.biodiversidadla.org/Documentos/Estudo-identifica-142-empresarios-do-agronegocio-envolvidos-em-tentativa-de-golpe.

480 'Cid afirma no STF que calculou dinheiro recebido de Braga Netto na trama golpista a partir do 'peso da sacola' de vinho', *O Globo*, 24 June 2025, https://oglobo.globo.com/politica/noticia/2025/06/24/cid-afirma-que-calculou-dinheiro-entregue-a-braga-netto-a-partir-do-peso-da-sacola-de-vinho.ghtml.

481 Cézar Feitoza, 'Braga Netto entregou dinheiro em sacola de vinho para plano de matar autoridades, diz Moraes', *Folha de S.Paulo*, 14 December 2024, https://www1.folha.uol.com.br/poder/2024/12/braga-netto-entregou-dinheiro-em-sacola-de-vinho-para-plano-de-matar-autoridades-diz-moraes.shtml.

482 'Cid diz que recebeu dinheiro de Braga Netto em sacola de vinho', *Poder360*, 20 February 2025, https://www.poder360.com.br/poder-justica/cid-confirma-que-recebeu-dinheiro-de-braga-netto-em-sacola-de-vinho/.

483 'Com Piquet entre intrusos, agro tem 8 dos 10 grandes doadores de Bolsonaro', *BOL - Brasil Online*, 4 September 2022, https://www.bol.uol.com.br/noticias/2022/09/04/doacoes-de-campanha-bolsonaro-agro.htm.

484 BOL - Brasil Online, 'Com Piquet entre intrusos, agro tem', https://www.bol.uol.com.br/noticias/2022/09/04/doacoes-de-campanha-bolsonaro-agro.htm.

485 Carta Capital, 'Impulsionadas pelo agronegócio, doações para campanha de Bolsonaro somam R$ 24 milhões no 2º turno', *CartaCapital*, 15 October 2022, https://www.cartacapital.com.br/politica/impulsionadas-pelo-agronegocio-doacoes-para-campanha-de-bolsonaro-somam-r-24-milhoes-no-2o-turno/.

486 Rafael Oliveira, 'A cada cinco doadores da campanha de Bolsonaro, um tem multa no Ibama', *Agência Pública*, 26 August 2022, https://apublica.org/2022/08/a-cada-cinco-doadores-da-campanha-de-bolsonaro-um-tem-multa-no-ibama/.

487 Alice Maciel; Caio de Freitas, 'Conheça quem bancou a ida de tratores no 7 de setembro em Brasília', *Agência Pública*, 8 September 2022, https://apublica.org/2022/09/conheca-quem-bancou-a-ida-de-tratores-no-7-de-setembro-em-brasilia/.

central committee[489]. Not every donation signalled commitment: Erasmo Carlos Battistella, founder of the biodiesel producer Be8, split R$ 1 million between the two presidential campaigns, R$ 500,000 to Flávio and the same amount to Lula, which is what a business group does when it is buying access to either outcome[490][491]. Among Flávio's other large donors, members of the Verdi family, shareholders of the Rodobens group, sent him R$ 300,000 in total,[492] and Hugo de Carvalho Ribeiro, linked to the Amaggi group, gave R$ 650,000 to PL candidates.[493]

The association's money went past donations. Aprosoja-MT sponsored CPAC Brasil when the conference met in Balneário Camboriú in July 2024 and stated publicly that it saw no partisan character in the event[494]. The gathering was reported as consolidating Bolsonarism's alliance with the international right, in the same season that the PL's foundation paid R$ 250,000 to sponsor the conference[495][496][497].

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488 'Turbinado por empresários, Flávio recebe R$ 20 milhões em doações privadas no 2º turno, 29 vezes o arrecadado por Lula', *O Globo*, 20 October 2026, https://oglobo.globo.com/politica/eleicoes-2026/noticia/2026/10/20/turbinado-por-empresarios-flavio-recebe-r-20-milhoes-em-doacoes-privadas-no-2o-turno-29-vezes-o-arrecadado-por-lula.ghtml.

489 Geovani Bucci, 'PL lidera doações entre os 100 maiores financiadores de campanha de 2026', *Estadão*, 14 October 2026, https://www.estadao.com.br/politica/eleicoes/pl-lidera-doacoes-entre-os-100-maiores-financiadores-de-campanha-de-2026/.

490 Felipe Salgado, 'Empresário doa R$ 1 milhão às campanhas de Lula e Flávio', *Metrópoles*, 7 September 2026, https://www.metropoles.com/colunas/grande-angular/rei-do-biodiesel-doa-r-500-mil-a-campanha-de-lula.

491 Salgado, 'Empresário doa R$ 1 milhão às', https://www.metropoles.com/colunas/grande-angular/rei-do-biodiesel-doa-r-500-mil-a-campanha-de-lula.

492 'Quem são os maiores doadores das campanhas presidenciais', *G1*, 23 September 2026, https://g1.globo.com/politica/eleicoes/2026/noticia/2026/09/23/doadores-campanhas-presidenciais.ghtml.

493 Bucci, 'PL lidera doações entre os 100', https://www.estadao.com.br/politica/eleicoes/pl-lidera-doacoes-entre-os-100-maiores-financiadores-de-campanha-de-2026/.

494 Guilherme Naldis, 'Associação de produtores de soja financia evento da direita, mas diz não ver caráter partidário no evento', *Estadão*, 15 July 2024, https://www.estadao.com.br/politica/associacao-produtores-soja-aprosoja-mt-financia-cpac-nao-ver-vies-partidario-evento-direita-nprp/.

495 Zanini, 'Evento em SC consolida aliança de', https://www1.folha.uol.com.br/poder/2024/07/evento-em-sc-consolida-alianca-de-bolsonarismo-com-direita-global.shtml.

496 Campos, 'Instituto do PL pagou R$ 250', https://platobr.com.br/instituto-do-pl-pagou-r-250-mil-em-patrocinio-a-evento-de-eduardo-bolsonaro-em-sc.

Stages in the interior: Brasil Profundo

Before the Balneário Camboriú CPAC, Aprosoja-MT had already helped pay for another stage. Between December 2021 and April 2022, the Instituto Conservador-Liberal, run by Eduardo Bolsonaro and the lawyer Sérgio Sant'Ana, took a series of congresses called Brasil Profundo ("Deep Brazil") to the interior[498]. There were three editions: Várzea Grande (Mato Grosso), in the Cuiabá metropolitan area, on December 10, 2021[499]; Londrina (Paraná), on March 12, 2022; and Camaquã (Rio Grande do Sul), in April 2022[500].

The first edition was organised with the state deputy Gilberto Cattani[501]. Besides Eduardo, Ricardo Salles, Magno Malta and Nikolas Ferreira, the stage featured two foreigners, both from the Spanish far-right party Vox: its president, Santiago Abascal, and the MEP Hermann Tertsch, who spoke in a debate with Eduardo before Abascal's speech[502][503][504]. The Londrina edition drew about a thousand people under the theme "The rediscovery of who we are" and served as a showcase for right-wing pre-candidates in Paraná[505]. Its speakers included the

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497 Campos, 'Instituto do PL pagou R$ 250', https://platobr.com.br/instituto-do-pl-pagou-r-250-mil-em-patrocinio-a-evento-de-eduardo-bolsonaro-em-sc.

498 Maciel, 'Rede social trumpista patrocina eventos que', https://apublica.org/2022/06/rede-social-trumpista-patrocina-eventos-que-fazem-pre-campanha-para-bolsonaro/.

499 Redação, 'Congresso de direita em Várzea Grande', https://www.rdnews.com.br/legislativo/congresso-de-direita-em-varzea-grande-tera-presenca-de-eurodeputado-espanhol/152771.

500 Maciel, 'Rede social trumpista patrocina eventos que', https://apublica.org/2022/06/rede-social-trumpista-patrocina-eventos-que-fazem-pre-campanha-para-bolsonaro/.

501 Da Redação, 'Em parceria com Instituto Conservador, Cattani organiza evento com Salles, Magno Malta e Eduardo Bolsonaro em VG', *A Bronca Popular*, 25 November 2021, https://www.abroncapopular.com.br/politica/em-parceria-com-instituto-conservador-cattani-organiza-evento-com-salles-magno-malta-e-eduardo-bolsonaro-em-vg/20681.

502 Redação, 'Congresso de direita em Várzea Grande', https://www.rdnews.com.br/legislativo/congresso-de-direita-em-varzea-grande-tera-presenca-de-eurodeputado-espanhol/152771.

503 Única News, 'Evento conservador reúne lideranças nacionais em Várzea Grande | Única News', *Única News - Notícias e Fatos com Credibilidade*, 10 December 2021, https://www.unicanews.com.br/politica/evento-conservador-reune-liderancas-nacionais-em-varzea-grande/75065.

504 EFE, 'Ultraderechista español Abascal impulsa en Brasil su alianza de «patriotas»', *Swissinfo*, 10 December 2021, https://www.swissinfo.ch/spa/ultraderechista-espa%C3%B1ol-abascal-impulsa-en-brasil-su-alianza-de-patriotas/47183588.

505 Redação, 'Em Londrina, Congresso Brasil Profundo reforça pautas políticas em defesa da vida e da família', *Jornal de Beltrão*, 16 March 2022, https://jornaldebeltrao.com.br/geral/politica/em-londrina-congresso-brasil-profundo-reforca-

federal deputies Eduardo Bolsonaro, Carla Zambelli and Daniel Silveira, the Belo Horizonte councillor Nikolas Ferreira and Sérgio Sant'Ana himself, and Jair Bolsonaro took part online.[506]

The congresses had two known sponsors. One was Gettr, the social network created by a former Trump adviser: in an interview with Rádio Brado on April 5, 2022, Eduardo greeted listeners "especially through Gettr, which is also a sponsor of Brasil Profundo"[507]. The other was Aprosoja-MT[508]. Neither of them, nor the institute, disclosed how much it paid[509]. Six days before the first edition, a report by Paulo Figueiredo's consultancy for Gettr, later attached to a lawsuit in the United States, already listed Brasil Profundo among the Bolsonarist events to sponsor[510]. Two electoral law specialists interviewed by Agência Pública, Isabela Damasceno, of the Minas Gerais bar association (OAB), and Marcelo Weick, of the Brazilian Academy of Electoral and Political Law, saw in a foreign company's sponsorship of pre-campaign events an irregularity that may amount to abuse of economic power[511].

Agribusiness is not a single bloc

Speaking of "agribusiness" as if it were a single actor hides the main point. The sector's fractions (the groups with interests of their own within it) position themselves differently towards Washington and Beijing, and what separates them is where they sell and who taxes them.

The grain growers of Mato Grosso are the base of Aprosoja and of the farm caucus, and Brazilian soy goes overwhelmingly to China: in 2025, 79 per cent of Brazil's soy exports went there[512]. But the grower does not sell to China; he sells to the trading houses, the large

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pautas-politicas-em-defesa-da-vida-e-da-familia/.

506 Redação, 'Em Londrina, Congresso Brasil Profundo reforça', https://jornaldebeltrao.com.br/geral/politica/em-londrina-congresso-brasil-profundo-reforca-pautas-politicas-em-defesa-da-vida-e-da-familia/.

507 Maciel, 'Rede social trumpista patrocina eventos que', https://apublica.org/2022/06/rede-social-trumpista-patrocina-eventos-que-fazem-pre-campanha-para-bolsonaro/.

508 Maciel, 'Rede social trumpista patrocina eventos que', https://apublica.org/2022/06/rede-social-trumpista-patrocina-eventos-que-fazem-pre-campanha-para-bolsonaro/.

509 Maciel, 'Rede social trumpista patrocina eventos que', https://apublica.org/2022/06/rede-social-trumpista-patrocina-eventos-que-fazem-pre-campanha-para-bolsonaro/.

510 Alves, 'Paulo Figueiredo informa à Justiça dos', https://iclnoticias.com.br/paulo-figueiredo-eua-trabalhou-bolsonaro-gettr/.

511 Maciel, 'Rede social trumpista patrocina eventos que', https://apublica.org/2022/06/rede-social-trumpista-patrocina-eventos-que-fazem-pre-campanha-para-bolsonaro/.

512 Amanda Souza, 'Reaproximação EUA-China acende alerta para soja e carne brasileiras', *Times Brasil* | *CNBC*, 16 May 2026, https://timesbrasil.com.br/brasil/reaproximacao-eua-china-acende-alerta-para-soja-e-carne-brasileiras/.

companies that buy, store and export grain. That is why the US tariff does not reach him, and his alignment with Washington comes from ideology and the land agenda. The trading houses are pragmatic, and among them is a Chinese state company, COFCO[513]. When Mato Grosso began denying tax incentives to companies that adhered to the soy moratorium (the pact under which companies undertake not to buy soy from areas of the Amazon deforested after 2008), Abiove, which groups ADM, Bunge, Cargill, COFCO and Louis Dreyfus, announced that it would leave the pact[514][515]. COFCO alone had received R$ 661 million of those incentives between 2019 and 2024[516]. Chinese capital, on this point, yielded to Aprosoja-MT's agenda.

Beef shows the other side. In 2025 China took 48.3 per cent of export volume, and for 2026 it imposed a safeguard (a temporary barrier protecting its market): a quota for Brazil, with a 12 per cent tariff within it and 67 per cent outside[517]. With the quota exhausted, the 67 per cent tariff took effect in October[518]. The safeguard had already cut deep before then: shipments of Brazilian beef to China fell by 88.2 per cent in volume in August 2026 against August 2025,[519] and by 93.2 per cent in September, while shipments to the United States rose by 389 per cent that month.[520] The meatpackers went after the US market through another door: on August 20, 2026, Joesley Batista, of JBS, met Trump in the Oval Office to discuss how more

513 Agência Safras, 'Trading chinesa diz que, com a maior produção de soja no Brasil, ampliará compras', *Canal Rural*, 29 September 2019, https://www.canalrural.com.br/agricultura/trading-chinesa-diz-que-com-a-maior-producao-de-soja-no-brasil-ampliara-compras/.

514 'Major grain companies to exit Brazil soya pact', *Oils & Fats International*, 9 January 2026, https://www.ofimagazine.com/news/major-grain-companies-to-exit-brazil-soya-pact.

515 Machado da Costa, 'STF julga regra que tirou tradings com R$ 4,7 bilhões da Moratória da Soja', *VEJA*, 6 August 2026, https://veja.abril.com.br/coluna/radar-economico/stf-julga-regra-que-tirou-tradings-com-r-47-bilhoes-da-moratoria-da-soja/.

516 Costa, 'STF julga regra que tirou tradings', https://veja.abril.com.br/coluna/radar-economico/stf-julga-regra-que-tirou-tradings-com-r-47-bilhoes-da-moratoria-da-soja/.

517 Estadão Conteúdo, 'Salvaguarda pela China impõe reorganização dos fluxos de produção e exportação', *IstoÉ Dinheiro*, 31 December 2025, https://istoedinheiro.com.br/salvaguarda-pela-china-impoe-reorganizacao-dos-fluxos-de-producao-e-exportacao.

518 'Carne brasileira vai pagar tarifa de 67% para entrar na China', *Agência Brasil*, 1 October 2026, https://agenciabrasil.ebc.com.br/economia/noticia/2026-10/carne-brasileira-vai-pagar-tarifa-de-67-para-entrar-na-china.

519 Hildeberto Jr, 'Exportações de carne bovina para a China despencam 88% e EUA assumem liderança', *Canal Rural*, 8 September 2026, https://www.canalrural.com.br/pecuaria/exportacoes-de-carne-bovina-para-a-china-despencam-88-e-eua-assumem-lideranca/.

520 'Exportações brasileiras de carne bovina chegam a 2,43 milhões de toneladas até setembro', *abiec.com.br*, 7 October 2026, https://abiec.com.br/exportacoes-brasileiras-de-carne-bovina-chegam-a-243-milhoes-de-toneladas-ate-setembro/.

Brazilian beef could bring down prices in the United States[521]. That is corporate lobbying, not electoral allegiance.

Coffee, orange juice and pulp depend more on the United States: in 2025 Americans bought $1.91 billion of green coffee and $1.32 billion of pulp from Brazil[522], and the United States takes about 37 per cent of juice exports[523]. These fractions acted technically, through the exemptions, with no visible electoral position. Sugar and ethanol are the fraction that loses from Flávio's agenda in Washington, as shown below. The mill owners of the Centre-South, however, give to both sides: Rubens Ometto, of Cosan, donated R$ 6.1 million, mostly to the MDB's national directorate[524], and Carlos Ubiratan Garms, chairman of the board of Unica, the sugar and ethanol producers' association, donated to the PL and to the PT[525]. The CNA, the national confederation representing the sector as a whole, confined itself to calculating the damage: about 36.5 per cent of agribusiness exports to the United States would be hit by the 2026 tariff[526]. The farm caucus, the FPA, stayed with Flávio[527].

Fraction	Where it sells	2026 US tariff	Position
Mato Grosso grain (Aprosoja)	Brazil's soy: about 79% to China, via trading houses	Not hit	Aligned with Washington through ideology and the land agenda
Trading houses	Buy from growers	Not hit	Pragmatic; left the soy

521 Bruno Andrade, 'A conversa amistosa entre Joesley Batista e Donald Trump para reduzir tarifas contra o Brasil', *VEJA*, 1 September 2026, https://veja.abril.com.br/economia/a-conversa-amistosa-entre-joesley-batista-e-donald-trump-para-reduzir-tarifas-contra-o-brasil/.

522 Maria Eduarda Botelho, 'China, EUA e exportações do agronegócio brasileiro', *Elevagro*, 13 July 2026, https://elevagro.com/exportacoes-agronegocio-brasileiro-china-eua/.

523 Fonte Reuters, 'Taxa dos EUA não impede exportação de suco de laranja do Brasil, mas custo sobe US$100 mi', *Notícias Agrícolas*, 7 April 2025, https://www.noticiasagricolas.com.br/noticias/laranja-citrus/398080-taxa-dos-eua-nao-impede-exportacao-de-suco-de-laranja-do-brasil-mas-custo-sobe-us100-mi.html.

524 Rute Pina, 'Os grandes doadores que apostam nos dois lados da eleição', *BBC News Brasil*, 4 October 2026, https://www.bbc.com/portuguese/articles/cm62449jp7j4o.

525 Pedro Santos Teixeira, 'Após Flávio liderar 1º turno, PL recebe R$ 2,3 mi de empresários, contra R$ 85 mil do PT', *C-Level*, 14 October 2026, https://c-level.folha.uol.com.br/negocios/2026/10/apos-flavio-liderar-1o-turno-pl-recebe-r-23-mi-de-empresarios-contra-r-85-mil-do-pt.shtml.

526 'Tarifaço deve atingir 36% das exportações do agro brasileiro, diz CNA', *G1*, 17 July 2026, https://g1.globo.com/economia/agronegocios/noticia/2026/07/17/tarifaco-deve-atingir-365percent-das-exportacoes-do-agro-brasileiro-diz-cna.ghtml.

527 Guilherme Grandi, 'Maior bancada do Congresso, bancada da agropecuária oficializa apoio a Flávio', *Gazeta do Povo*, 2 October 2026, https://www.gazetadopovo.com.br/eleicoes/2026/maior-bancada-congresso-bancada-agropecuaria-oficializa-apoio-flavio/.

Fraction (ADM, Bunge, Cargill, COFCO, Amaggi)	Where it sells and resell, mainly to China	2026 US tariff	Position moratorium
Beef (JBS, ABIEC)	China, which imposed 67% outside the quota; US rising	Exempt	Lobbying on both sides
Coffee, juice, pulp	US carries decisive weight	Coffee and juice exempt; part of pulp and paper taxed	Technical, no electoral voice
Centre-South sugar and ethanol (Unica)	Exports and domestic market	Taxed	Give to both sides
Northeast sugar and ethanol	Domestic market; compete with US ethanol	Taxed	Against Flávio's "zero for zero"
CNA and FPA	The whole sector	About 36.5% of farm exports to the US hit	CNA technical; FPA with Flávio

The order book

The other half of the arrangement is harder to argue with. When Beijing placed a 34 per cent tariff on US agricultural goods in April 2025, Brazilian soy gained a price advantage in the market that absorbs the great majority of it[528][529]. In 2025 Brazil exported 108.6 million tonnes of soy, of which 87.1 million, "about 80%" in the exporters' association's count, went to China[530]. Valor's own tally puts the Chinese share at 78.7 per cent of shipments[531]. Across agribusiness as a whole, China bought US$ 55.3 billion of Brazilian products in 2025, 32.7 per cent of the sector's export revenue, against US$ 11.4 billion, or 6.7 per cent, for the United States.[532]

528 Mello, 'Com tarifa chinesa, soja brasileira fica', https://agfeed.com.br/economia/com-tarifa-chinesa-soja-brasileira-fica-ainda-mais-competitiva-e-pode-ganhar-mercado/.

529 *THIS REPORT CONTAINS ASSESSMENTS OF COMMODITY AND TRADE ISSUES MADE BY USDA STAFF AND NOT NECESSARILY*, *fas.usda.gov*, 18 March 2026, https://www.fas.usda.gov/data/gain-report/2026/03/Oilseeds%20and%20Products%20Annual_Brasilia_Brazil_BR2026-0014.pdf.

530 Lustosa, 'Brasil fecha 2025 com recorde na', https://agfeed.com.br/economia/brasil-fecha-2025-com-recorde-na-exportacao-de-soja-mas-anec-ja-projeta-desafios-para-2026/.

531 Valor Econômico, 'Graças às tarifas de Trump, o', https://valor.globo.com/publicacoes/especiais/revista-brasil-china/noticia/2026/04/30/gracas-as-tarifas-de-trump-o-brasil-deve-continuar-como-grande-fornecedor-de-soja-para-a-china.ghtml.

Within days, Aprosoja's communications office saw a strategic opportunity in the market the tariff war could open for Brazilian soy[533]. The Financial Times' assessment, relayed by the BBC's Brazilian service, called the tariff war "a blessing" for Brazilian agriculture[534]. A sector whose revenue rises when Washington and Beijing fight is endorsing a candidate whose diplomatic programme is built on Washington's side of that fight.

The sector's most senior figure said so in terms. On September 10, 2026, during a panel at the Bradesco BBI Agro Summit, Blairo Maggi, former governor of Mato Grosso, former agriculture minister and owner of the Amaggi group, put it plainly: "Bolsonaro got it wrong", and Brazil's foreign ministry also got it wrong "in staging that confrontation with China to please the United States"[535].

The tariff that did not bite, and the one that did

Washington's July 2025 escalation met the same structure from the other direction[536]. When the 50 per cent tariff was announced, the president of Aprosoja-MT said it would not affect agriculture while warning that further sanctions could[537]. That is a statement about the instrument: a duty aimed at Brazilian politics was being absorbed by a trade relationship routed through a different port. Where it did bite, on beef, coffee, cocoa and tropical fruit, it bit American buyers, and on November 20, 2025 those products were exempted, with duties already paid made refundable[538]. Folha's reading of the sequence was that the Bolsonaro

532 Botelho, 'China, EUA e exportações do agronegócio', https://elevagro.com/exportacoes-agronegocio-brasileiro-china-eua/.

533 Vitória Kehl Araujo, 'Tarifaço de Trump sobre a China pode abrir mercado para a soja brasileira', *Aprosoja MT*, 14 April 2025, https://aprosoja.com.br/comunicacao/release/tarifaco-de-trump-sobre-a-china-pode-abrir-mercado-para-a-soja-brasileira.

534 BBC News Brasil, 'Guerra tarifária entre Trump e China é 'uma benção' para Brasil, diz Financial Times', *BBC News Brasil*, 14 April 2025, https://www.bbc.com/portuguese/articles/cpwzy22r11eo.

535 Augusto, 'Rei da Soja' diz que Bolsonaro', https://www.moneytimes.com.br/para-o-rei-da-soja-bolsonaro-errou-ao-enfrentar-china-cita-grande-perigo-para-o-agronegocio-brasileiro-e-chama-trump-de-doidao-pads/.

536 Teixeira, 'Trump signs order to remove tariffs', https://www.reuters.com/world/us/trump-signs-order-remove-tariffs-some-brazilian-agricultural-imports-2025-11-20/.

537 Camila Ribeiro, 'Presidente da Aprosoja MT diz que tarifaço não afeta agro, mas novas sanções podem trazer prejuízos', *HiperNotícias - Você bem informado*, 6 August 2025, https://www.hnt.com.br/politica/presidente-da-aprosoja-mt-diz-que-tarifaco-nao-afeta-agro-mas-novas-sancoes-podem-trazer-prejuizos/501316.

538 Teixeira, 'Trump signs order to remove tariffs', https://www.reuters.com/world/us/trump-signs-order-remove-tariffs-some-brazilian-agricultural-imports-2025-11-20/.

factor had brought agribusiness to a crossroads in the negotiations, which is a polite way of saying the sector discovered its leverage pointed at Washington rather than at Brasília[539][540].

The reflex has precedent. In August 2019, with Amazon fires dominating the international press, Maggi warned publicly of the risk of a boycott of Brazilian agricultural products[541]. Then as now, the answer proposed was reputational repair, not geopolitical realignment.

In 2026 the tariff came back by another route and bit another fraction[542]. The 50 per cent tariff had rested on emergency economic powers that the US Supreme Court struck down in February; the new one, decided in the Section 301 proceeding, was 25 per cent from July 22, 2026, hit about 18 per cent of Brazilian exports to the United States and included sugar and ethanol[543]. The USTR's final determination records that US ethanol producers supported the 25 per cent as appropriate and able to "recoup the market value" they said they had lost to the Brazilian tariff on ethanol.[544].

There is a deeper irony. To justify the new tariff, the USTR cited Mato Grosso's decision to end incentives for the soy moratorium companies as a sign that Brazil fails at environmental protection[545]. Ending the moratorium was Aprosoja-MT's cause[546]. This report reads that as

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539 AndrÃ© Borges, 'Bolsonaro Factor Puts Agribusiness at Crossroads in Trump Tariff Talks', *Folha de S.Paulo*, 21 July 2025, https://www1.folha.uol.com.br/internacional/en/business/2025/07/bolsonaro-factor-puts-agribusiness-at-crossroads-in-trump-tariff-talks.shtml.

540 André Borges, 'Fator Bolsonaro deixa agronegócio em encruzilhada na negociação de tarifaço de Trump', *Folha de S.Paulo*, 19 July 2025, https://www1.folha.uol.com.br/mercado/2025/07/fator-bolsonaro-deixa-agronegocio-em-encruzilhada-na-negociacao-de-tarifaco-de-trump.shtml.

541 'Blairo Maggi teme boicote a produtos agrícolas brasileiros devido a queimadas na Amazônia', *G1*, 22 August 2019, https://g1.globo.com/economia/blog/joao-borges/post/2019/08/22/blairo-maggi-teme-boicote-a-produtos-agricolas-brasileiros-por-conta-de-queimadas-na-amazonia.ghtml.

542 Nair, 'US imposes new 25% tariffs on', https://www.reuters.com/world/americas/us-imposes-25-tariff-some-goods-brazil-2026-07-16/.

543 Nair, 'US imposes new 25% tariffs on', https://www.reuters.com/world/americas/us-imposes-25-tariff-some-goods-brazil-2026-07-16/.

544 *Billing Code 3390-F4*, *ustr.gov*, https://ustr.gov/sites/default/files/files/Issue_Areas/Enforcement/Section%20301/Brazil%20301%20Final%20Action%20FRN%207-15-2026%20final.pdf.

545 Nayara Machado, 'Fim da Moratória da Soja serviu de argumento para nova tarifa dos EUA', *eixos*, 2 June 2026, https://eixos.com.br/newsletters/dialogos-da-transicao/fim-da-moratoria-da-soja-serviu-de-argumento-para-nova-tarifa-dos-eua/.

546 'Aprosoja-MT pede fim da Moratória da Soja', *brasilagro.com.br*, 12 December 2024, https://www.brasilagro.com.br/conteudo/aprosojamt-pede-fim-da-moratoria-da-soja.html.

the central contradiction of the bloc: the fraction that most financed the Bolsonarist stages saw its own victory used by Washington as an argument against Brazil.

Who pays with ethanol

The document Flávio delivered to the USTR asks for a “zero for zero” deal on ethanol and sugar, comparing Brazil’s 18 per cent tariff on imported ethanol with the US rate of 2.5 per cent[547]. The minister Márcio Elias Rosa answered “never”, saying it would harm the Northeast, and Unica pointed out that the 18 per cent is Mercosur’s Common External Tariff, which applies to every country outside the bloc, and that the United States limits Brazilian sugar to about 1 per cent of what the country exports[548].

The cost of opening that market falls on one region and one class. US corn ethanol enters Brazil mainly through the Northeast: according to Feplana, the federation of sugarcane planters, 60 to 70 per cent of imports arrived through Maranhão, because of tax benefits, and from there it presses on the price of Northeastern ethanol[549]. The same federation estimates that the sector employs 280,000 workers in the Northeast during the crushing season, and it called the opening a “death blow”[550]. Pernambuco alone has 13 mills in operation, and about 65,000 people work in the cane harvest, with effects on commerce in the Zona da Mata[551]. It is a small sector in the national total, but one that still harvests mostly by hand, unlike the largely mechanised Centre-South[552].

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547 Marcos Hermanson, ‘Redução da tarifa sobre etanol americano não está em negociação, diz ministro’, *Folha de S.Paulo*, 7 July 2026, https://www1.folha.uol.com.br/mercado/2026/07/reducao-da-tarifa-sobre-etanol-americano-nao-esta-em-negociacao-diz-ministro.shtml.

548 Hermanson, ‘Redução da tarifa sobre etanol americano’, https://www1.folha.uol.com.br/mercado/2026/07/reducao-da-tarifa-sobre-etanol-americano-nao-esta-em-negociacao-diz-ministro.shtml.

549 Ângela Fernanda Belfort, ‘Tiro de morte”: Feplana critica possível fim da tarifa sobre etanol americano’, *Movimento Econômico*, 6 June 2026, https://movimentoeconomico.com.br/agronegocio/2026/06/06/tiro-de-morte-feplana-critica-possivel-fim-da-tarifa-sobre-etanol-americano/.

550 Belfort, ‘Tiro de morte”’, https://movimentoeconomico.com.br/agronegocio/2026/06/06/tiro-de-morte-feplana-critica-possivel-fim-da-tarifa-sobre-etanol-americano/.

551 Ângela Fernanda Belfort, ‘Safra de cana-de-açúcar em PE deve chegar a 13 milhões de toneladas’, *Movimento Econômico*, 21 August 2026, https://movimentoeconomico.com.br/agronegocio/2026/08/21/safra-de-cana-de-acucar-em-pe-deve-chegar-a-13-milhoes-de-toneladas/.

552 ‘Cana-de-açúcar: mercado de trabalho, mão de obra é desafio para o setor no longo prazo (Custos de produção do Projeto Campo Futuro 2024)’, *Confederação da Agricultura e Pecuária do Brasil (CNA)*, 2024, https://cnabrasil.org.br/storage/arquivos/Cana-de-Acucar-Campo-Futuro-2024.pdf.

The threat has materialised before. Between 2017 and 2020 Brazil kept a tariff-free quota for imported ethanol: 600 million litres a year from 2017, raised to 750 million in August 2019; according to Sindaçúcar of Pernambuco, the enlarged quota was equivalent to more than 30 per cent of the ethanol produced in the Northeast[553]. In September 2020 it was extended for another three months[554].

The risk does not come from one side only. In June 2026 Feplana itself aimed its criticism at the Lula government, which was considering easing the tariff in its negotiations with Washington[555]. The documented difference is that the government publicly rejected the proposal and that Flávio put it in writing before the USTR[556].

The cost of mobilisation

None of this makes the association a mere lobbying shop, and the record of what its political investment cost shows why. The final report of the CPMI (joint congressional inquiry) into the January 8 attacks requested indictments in Mato Grosso, among them Lucas Costa Beber, then vice-president of Aprosoja-MT[557]. Thirteen of the sixteen coup financiers the CPMI named were farmers[558]. A study by De Olho nos Ruralistas identified 142 landowners, executives and company partners from agribusiness who had financed blockades, logistics, food and transport for the coup encampments: 74 of them in Mato Grosso, 17 in Goiás and 13 in Bahia[559]. The observatory reached that list by cross-checking more than 1,400 names of camp funders, defendants of January 8 and people indicted by the Federal Police against rural

553 Luis Barrucho, ‘Produtores do Nordeste temem medida de Bolsonaro que amplia importação de etanol sem tarifa’, *BBC News Brasil*, 4 September 2019, https://www.bbc.com/portuguese/brasil-49583625.

554 Lisandra Paraguassu e Rodrigo Viga Gaier, ‘Brasil estende por 3 meses cota de importação de etanol dos EUA sem tarifa’, *Terra*, 11 September 2020, https://www.terra.com.br/economia/brasil-estende-por-3-meses-cota-de-importacao-de-etanol-dos-eua-sem-tarifa,80e378858cae6bb7174f3296f769aa1btpygs8g2.html.

555 Redação Visão Agro, ‘Feplana prevê fim do setor canavieiro no Nordeste se governo Lula ceder aos EUA - Visão Agro’, *Visão Agro - A melhor Visão do Agronégócio*, 8 June 2026, https://visaoagro.com.br/feplana-preve-fim-do-setor-canavieiro-no-nordeste-se-governo-lula-ceder-aos-eua/.

556 Hermanson, ‘Redução da tarifa sobre etanol americano’, https://www1.folha.uol.com.br/mercado/2026/07/reducao-da-tarifa-sobre-etanol-americano-nao-esta-em-negociacao-diz-ministro.shtml.

557 Midianews, ‘MidiaNews’, https://www.midianews.com.br/politica/relatorio-da-cpmi-do-8-de-janeiro-pede-indiciamento-de-3-de-mt/455333.

558 Ruralistas, ‘Entre 16 financiadores do golpe denunciados’, https://deolhonosruralistas.com.br/2023/10/17/entre-16-financiadores-do-golpe-denunciados-por-cpmi13-sao-fazendeiros/.

559 Ruralistas, ‘Estudo identifica 142 empresários do agronegócio’, https://deolhonosruralistas.com.br/2025/06/25/relatorio-agrogolpistas/.

land registries, and found that 56 of the 234 trucks inspected at the encampment in front of Army headquarters in Brasília came from Sorriso (Mato Grosso), the world's largest soybean-producing region, 28 of them belonging to two intermarried families[560][561]. The tractors that entered the Bicentenário parade in Brasília on September 7, 2022 were paid for by named producers and associations[562]. The funding is documented by the same outlets that named the payers[563].

The association's answer to the CPMI's recommendation is also on the record. In June 2026 Aprosoja made Lucas Costa Beber interim president of Aprosoja Brasil[564]. The sector did not distance itself from the accused. It promoted him.

The conditional endorsement

The Frente Parlamentar da Agropecuária (the farm caucus) formalised its support for Flávio Bolsonaro before the first round[565]. Its president, Deputy Pedro Lupion, explained the decision by "a very clear reason, one that is demonstrated in all of the country's economic questions"[566]. Lupion's later formulation was less guarded: "I see no other way than for everyone to throw themselves headlong into this campaign"[567]. After the first round the farm

560 Ruralistas, 'Estudo identifica 142 empresários do agronegócio', https://deolhonosruralistas.com.br/2025/06/25/relatorio-agrogolpistas/.

561 De Olho nos Ruralistas, 'Meet the 142 farmers and agribusiness entrepreneurs who funded the coup attempt in Brazil', *De Olho nos Ruralistas*, 25 June 2025, https://deolhonosruralistas.com.br/2025/06/25/agrocoupists-report/.

562 Freitas, 'Conheça quem bancou a ida de', https://apublica.org/2022/09/conheca-quem-bancou-a-ida-de-tratores-no-7-de-setembro-em-brasilia/.

563 Alice Maciel e Caio de Freitas Paes, 'Quem custeou a ida dos tratores no 7 de Setembro em Brasília', *Nexo Jornal*, 10 September 2022, https://www.nexojornal.com.br/externo/2022/09/10/quem-custeou-a-ida-dos-tratores-no-7-de-setembro-em-brasilia.

564 'Lucas Costa Beber assume presidência interina da Aprosoja Brasil', *UOL*, 16 June 2026, https://noticias.uol.com.br/ultimas-noticias/agencia-estado/2026/06/16/lucas-costa-beber-assume-presidencia-interina-da-aprosoja-brasil.htm.

565 Grandi, 'Maior bancada do Congresso, bancada da', https://www.gazetadopovo.com.br/eleicoes/2026/maior-bancada-congresso-bancada-agropecuaria-oficializa-apoio-flavio/.

566 'Bancada ruralista anuncia apoio a Flávio Bolsonaro no segundo turno', *G1*, 6 October 2026, https://g1.globo.com/politica/eleicoes/2026/noticia/2026/10/06/bancada-ruralista-anuncia-apoio-a-flavio-bolsonaro-no-segundo-turno.ghtml.

567 Duarte, 'Presidente da FPA diz que não', https://www.estadao.com.br/politica/eleicoes/presidente-da-fpa-diz-que-nao-ha-outro-caminho-senao-agro-entrar-na-campanha-de-flavio-bolsonaro/.

caucus announced its backing for the second[568]. The courtship had run through the farm fairs. At Agrishow, in Ribeirão Preto, between late April and early May 2026, Flávio appeared alongside the São Paulo governor, Tarcísio de Freitas, with direct criticism of Lula; on June 23, at the opening of Feicorte, the beef-chain fair in Presidente Prudente, again with Tarcísio, he promised to go to the United States on July 6 “to defend Brazilian companies” against a new 25 per cent tariff on Brazilian exports.[569]

The condition arrived alongside the endorsement. A senator from the same caucus said a Flávio Bolsonaro administration would have to strike a balance in its agribusiness negotiations between the United States and China[570]. The bet was paid at the ballot box: Flávio led the first round with 47.03 per cent of valid votes[571]. The condition is not rhetorical modesty. It is the minimum term on which a rent held in a foreign order book can coexist with a programme that asks Washington to close the payment system and open the subsoil.

What the network is actually for

The contradiction is bearable for the sector because the programme is not aimed at it. The rent streams the campaign is assembled around, as the preceding chapter set out, run through the toll on retail payments, the forward-sold heavy rare earths of Minaçu and a sanitation company privatised at the state level: finance, defence minerals and the sale of state assets. Agribusiness’s own rent sits in a state contribution passed to a private institute and in a foreign order book, and a coalition can carry a programme that damages neither.

What the network brings is not built for the agribusiness rent either. When paid promotional posts for Flávio appeared on X in September 2026, they were placed through the betting platform Polymarket and Javier Negre’s UHN Plus[572]. Polymarket’s political commitment was not a farm-lobby product: 1789 Capital, the fund co-founded by Chris Buskirk, made a

568 G1, ‘Bancada ruralista anuncia apoio a Flávio’, https://g1.globo.com/politica/eleicoes/2026/noticia/2026/10/06/bancada-ruralista-anuncia-apoio-a-flavio-bolsonaro-no-segundo-turno.ghtml.

569 Marcelo Toledo, ‘Flávio acena ao agro em agenda com Tarcísio e fala em atuar nos EUA contra tarifas’, *Folha de S.Paulo*, 23 June 2026, https://www1.folha.uol.com.br/poder/2026/06/flavio-acena-ao-agro-em-agenda-com-tarcisio-e-fala-em-atuar-nos-eua-contra-tarifas.shtml.

570 Valor Econômico, ‘Flávio Bolsonaro precisará de equilíbrio em’, https://valor.globo.com/agronegocios/noticia/2026/10/12/flavio-bolsonaro-precisara-de-equilibrio-em-negociacoes-do-agro-com-eua-e-china-se-for-eleito-diz-senadora.ghtml.

571 ‘Flávio Bolsonaro (PL) e Lula (PT) vão disputar o 2º turno para a Presidência da República’, *Tribunal Superior Eleitoral*, 5 October 2026, https://www.tse.jus.br/comunicacao/noticias/2026/Outubro/flavio-bolsonaro-e-lula-vao-disputar-o-2o-turno-para-a-presidencia-da-republica.

572 ‘Posts pró-Flávio no X expõem elo entre Polymarket e rede transnacional de desinformação’, *Aosfatos*, 31 August 2026, https://www.aosfatos.org/noticias/posts-pro-flavio-elo-polymarket-rede-transnacional-desinformacao/.

strategic investment in the company in August 2025, and Donald Trump Jr. joined Polymarket's advisory board at the same time[573].

The geography is not Brasília's. It runs through the Madrid and Buenos Aires foundations that host the same speakers, and through the Spanish-language outlets that promote the same candidates: Fundación Disenso announced Ernesto Araújo as its international adviser in October 2023, and the Polish account Visegrád 24 has had its staff, money and political connections traced in detail[574][575][576]. The fraud narrative that treated the 2022 election as illegitimate was launched on Steve Bannon's podcast after the first round of October 2, 2022, with Matthew Tyrmand of Project Veritas and Darren Beattie, a former Trump speechwriter[577]. Eduardo Bolsonaro, then a federal deputy, met the network's continental figures repeatedly; Agência Pública counted 125 meetings with members of the region's far right[578][579]. The Argentine strategist Fernando Cerimedo received Latino Wall Street's consultant-of-the-year award from Eduardo Bolsonaro on stage at Mar-a-Lago in February

573 Polymarket, 'Polymarket Receives Strategic Investment from 1789', https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/polymarket-receives-strategic-investment-from-1789-capital-and-welcomes-donald-trump-jr-to-advisory-board-302538997.html.

574 Disenso, 'Ernesto Araújo, ex ministro de Relaciones', https://fundaciondisenso.org/ernesto-araujo-ex-ministro-de-relaciones-exteriores-de-brasil-se-incorpora-a-la-fundacion-disenso-como-asesor-internacional/.

575 Wojciech Cieśla, 'Unmasking Visegrád24: Tracing the People, Money, and Political Connections', *vsquare.org*, 2 October 2025, https://vsquare.org/unmasking-visegrad24-tracing-the-people-money-and-political-ties/.

576 Wojciech Cieśla, 'Unmasking Visegrád24: Tracing the People, Money, and Political Connections', *vsquare.org*, 2 October 2025, https://vsquare.org/unmasking-visegrad24-tracing-the-people-money-and-political-ties/.

577 Silverstein, 'How the US far-Right is acting', https://apublica.org/2022/09/how-the-us-far-right-is-acting-to-get-bolsonaro-re-elected-in-brazil/.

578 Viana, 'Eduardo Bolsonaro teve 125 reuniões com', https://apublica.org/2023/08/eduardo-bolsonaro-teve-125-reunioes-com-membros-da-extrema-direita-do-continente/.

579 Pública, 'Como Eduardo Bolsonaro e comitiva articulam', https://www.cartacapital.com.br/politica/como-eduardo-bolsonaro-e-comitiva-articulam-com-parlamentares-dos-eua-punicoes-ao-brasil/.

2026[580][581][582]. In August 2026 he was arrested in Santa Cruz de la Sierra, Bolivia, accused by Bolivian investigators of planning an attack on his former partner, an accusation his defence contests[583].

The same circuit ran into the Brazilian state. When Polymarket kept offering bets on the Brazilian election despite the prohibition, the electoral court's ban remained the operative fact[584]. The Supreme Court had already blocked Aprosoja's accounts in 2021[585]. Eduardo Bolsonaro was convicted of coercion in June 2026[586]. The network could penetrate the campaign and its financing. It could not switch off the court.

The ideological mask

What holds four incompatible things inside one candidacy is an ideological construction, not an economic one. The regional congress announced for Várzea Grande in December 2021, the first edition of Brasil Profundo, with Eduardo Bolsonaro, Magno Malta and Ricardo Salles on stage and tickets at up to R$ 1,000, is one instance of an apparatus that does work the material coalition cannot do on its own[587]. It presents a financialised export enclave as a family-farm frontier, and a diplomatic programme aligned with a foreign power as national sovereignty.

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580 Mauricio Caminos, 'Gaby WallStreet y Tony Delgado: la pareja trumpista con vida de ricos que premió a Cerimedo y lleva a Milei otra vez a EE.UU.', *elDiarioAR*, 4 October 2026, https://www.eldiarioar.com/politica/gaby-wallstreet-tony-delgado-pareja-trumpista-vida-ricos-premio-cerimedo-lleva-milei-vez-ee-uu_1_13557463.html.

581 Seguir, 'Javier Negre aseguró que Cerimedo vendió sus acciones en La Derecha Diario días antes de ser detenido en Bolivia', *infobae*, 24 August 2026, https://www.infobae.com/politica/2026/08/24/javier-negre-aseguro-que-cerimedo-vendio-sus-acciones-en-la-derecha-diario-dias-antes-de-ser-detenido-en-bolivia/.

582 Plínio Teodoro, 'Eduardo Bolsonaro confirmou que Cerimedo ajudou tentativa de golpe de Jair e sinalizou ação com Flávio; veja vídeo', *Revista Fórum*, 24 August 2026, https://revistaforum.com.br/politica/eduardo-bolsonaro-cerimedo-ajudou-golpe-video/.

583 Tiago Rogero, 'Adviser to far-right Latin American leaders arrested for allegedly plotting to kill girlfriend', *the Guardian*, 19 August 2026, https://www.theguardian.com/world/2026/aug/19/fernando-cerimedo-adviser-far-right-latin-american-leaders-arrested-allegedly-plotting-kill-girlfriend.

584 Jeniffer Mendonça, 'Apesar de proibição, Polymarket promove apostas sobre eleições brasileiras', *Núcleo Jornalismo*, 3 September 2026, https://nucleo.jor.br/reportagem/2026/09/03/apesar-de-proibicao-polymarket-divulga-apostas-sobre-eleicoes-brasileiras/.

585 Lima, 'PF cumpre mandados de busca e', https://www.metropoles.com/brasil/politica-brasil/pf-cumpre-mandados-de-busca-e-apreensao-na-aprosoja-que-tem-contas-bloqueadas.

586 Agência Brasil, 'STF condena Eduardo Bolsonaro a inelegibilidade', https://agenciabrasil.ebc.com.br/justica/noticia/2026-06/stf-condena-eduardo-bolsonaro-inelegibilidade-e-4-anos-de-prisao.

Those two images cannot be stated plainly in the same room, and the concealment documented earlier in this report is what keeps them from being put side by side.

The apparatus is not decorative. Agribusiness supplies the treasury, the caucus, the mobilisation and the electoral money; the network supplies the brand, the paid media and the transnational political cover. Neither delivers without the other. But the brand and the media run on programme commitments (payment systems, minerals, the subsoil) that serve other rent streams. The farm bloc's position inside the coalition is therefore real and second-order: it supplies the mass base, receives the rhetoric, and exercises its veto only when a commitment threatens the Chinese order book.

Conclusion

The dependency produces a coalition holding four incompatible things at once: a base whose income depends on Beijing, a candidate whose programme turns against Chinese systems, a caucus that endorses him only with a caveat about balance, and a donor circuit whose returns lie in payment systems and rare earths rather than in soy. Each can be defended separately, in its own idiom. Held together, they require that the question of what the candidacy is actually for never be put in the same form twice. That is a political form rather than an economic content, and it is that political form that the following chapters take up.

Chapter 06: Coercion as lawfare in reverse: tariffs, Magnitsky and the 2025 bargain

The offer Flávio Bolsonaro's campaign carried to Washington was met with an instrument built to secure its acceptance. Between July 30, 2025 and October 2, 2026, the United States assembled three mechanisms aimed at a single outcome: the suspension of the Brazilian proceedings against Jair Bolsonaro, and the election of a government that would not contest the terms of dependent integration. The mechanisms were a tariff declared under emergency economic powers, a sanctions designation against the Supreme Federal Court (STF) justice conducting the prosecutions, and a grant-and-visa apparatus aimed at the courts that sustained them[588]. *Lawfare* is the use of judicial proceedings and legal instruments as a political weapon, to wear down or neutralise an opponent. This chapter argues that the American instrument was lawfare in reverse, coercion applied to a foreign judiciary rather than through it, and that its own cost structure forced a partial dismantling. The withdrawals came where the coercion reached American prices, not where it reached Brazilian sovereignty. That asymmetry is the evidence.

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587 Da Redação, 'Congresso em VG traz Eduardo Bolsonaro, Magno Malta e Ricardo Salles com ingressos que chegam a R$ 1 mil', *Olhar Direto*, 25 November 2021, https://www.olhardireto.com.br/noticias/congresso-em-vg-traz-eduardo-bolsonaro-magno-malta-e-ricardo-salles-com-ingressos-que-chegam-a-r-1-mil.

588 The White House, 'Fact Sheet', https://www.whitehouse.gov/fact-sheets/2025/07/fact-sheet-president-donald-j-trump-addresses-threats-to-the-united-states-from-the-government-of-brazil/.

Before the tariff: from the fraud thesis to the call for sanctions

The 2025 instrument has a prehistory, and it runs through Eduardo Bolsonaro. He was in Washington at the time of the storming of the Capitol in January 2021, and was described as the glue between Bolsonarism and Trump's circle[589]. In August 2021 he spoke about Brazil's electronic voting machines at the "cyber symposium" held in South Dakota by Mike Lindell, a pro-Trump businessman who spread the claim that the election had been stolen from Trump; Steve Bannon later said Eduardo had given "one of the best presentations" of the event[590][591]. After the first round of 2022, suspicion about the voting machines was carried onto *War Room*, Bannon's programme, by Matthew Tyrmand and Darren Beattie[592]. On November 10, 2022, shortly after Lula's victory, Eduardo travelled to the United States, met Trump at Mar-a-Lago and had lunch in South Florida with Jason Miller, then chief executive of Gettr[593]. After the attack on the buildings of the three powers in Brasília on January 8, 2023, Bannon wrote repeatedly on Gettr that Lula had stolen the election and called the people who stormed the buildings "Freedom Fighters".[594]

The idea of punishing Brazilian officials from Washington was taken to the American Congress two years before it became government policy[595]. In early March 2024 a delegation of Bolsonarist federal deputies led by Eduardo spent about a week in Washington urging the United States to pass a law penalising Brazilian officials and to impose sanctions on the country[596]. The group visited the Heritage Foundation, the leading American conservative think tank, and on March 12, 2024 held a press conference in front of the Capitol alongside

589 Jon Queally Jan, 'Horrid': Steve Bannon Rebuked for Celebrating Brazilian Fascists as 'Freedom Fighters', *Common Dreams*, 9 January 2023, https://www.commondreams.org/news/steve-bannon-brazil-freedom-fighters.

590 Mariana Sanches, 'Steve Bannon: Estrategista de Trump e aliado de Bolsonaro se diz 'fascinado' por Lula', *BBC News Brasil*, 18 September 2022, https://www.bbc.com/portuguese/brasil-62944023.

591 Pagliarini, 'Steve Bannon Wants to Turn Brazil', https://newrepublic.com/article/163301/steve-bannon-brazil-maga-battleground-bolsonaro.

592 Silverstein, 'How the US far-Right is acting', https://apublica.org/2022/09/how-the-us-far-right-is-acting-to-get-bolsonaro-re-elected-in-brazil/.

593 Viana, 'Eduardo Bolsonaro é um projeto de', https://apublica.org/2025/08/eduardo-bolsonaro-e-um-projeto-de-steve-bannon/.

594 Mike Wendling, 'How Trump's allies stoked Brazil Congress attack', *BBC News*, 9 January 2023, https://www.bbc.com/news/world-us-canada-64206484.

595 Laura Scofield, 'EUA: Bolsonaristas articulam com republicanos punição ao Brasil', *Agência Pública*, 11 April 2024, https://apublica.org/2024/04/como-eduardo-bolsonaro-e-comitiva-articulam-com-parlamentares-dos-eua-punicoes-ao-brasil/.

596 Laura Scofield, 'EUA: Bolsonaristas articulam com republicanos punição ao Brasil', *Agência Pública*, 11 April 2024, https://apublica.org/2024/04/como-eduardo-bolsonaro-e-comitiva-articulam-com-parlamentares-dos-eua-punicoes-ao-brasil/.

Republican congressman Chris Smith, who promised to introduce a bill on “democracy, freedom and human rights” in Brazil[597]. Paulo Figueiredo, who accompanied the delegation, showed on his YouTube channel a text he presented as “what we are drafting as a resolution for Brazil”; it was H.R. 6954, a bill by Smith himself that concerns Nicaragua, which the video did not mention[598].

The design

On July 30, 2025, the White House issued an executive order implementing an additional 40 per cent tariff on Brazil, bringing the total to 50 per cent, on the stated ground that the Brazilian government’s policies constituted “an unusual and extraordinary threat to the national security, foreign policy, and economy of the United States”[599]. The same day the Treasury’s Office of Foreign Assets Control (OFAC), which administers sanctions, designated Justice Alexandre de Moraes under the Global Magnitsky programme, which allows the United States to freeze the assets of foreigners accused of corruption or human rights abuses; the designation froze assets subject to United States jurisdiction and warned financial institutions that processing payments for him exposed them to penalties[600].

Scheduling the two on a single day was a choice about the message, and the stated grounds confirm the addressee. The Treasury accused Moraes of leading an “oppressive campaign of censorship” and “politicized prosecutions”, including against former President Jair Bolsonaro[601]. The Associated Press, reporting the designations, called them politically motivated and described the strain they placed on relations among old allies[602]. Nothing in the record anchors the measures in a commercial grievance independent of the prosecutions. Nor was the sanction a matter of consensus within the American government itself: according to the Washington Post, the proposed order against Moraes initially met resistance in the Treasury Department, and the sanctions office hesitated over it in the preceding weeks[603].

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597 Pública, ‘Como Eduardo Bolsonaro e comitiva articulam’, https://www.cartacapital.com.br/politica/como-eduardo-bolsonaro-e-comitiva-articulam-com-parlamentares-dos-eua-punicoes-ao-brasil/.

598 Scofield, ‘EUA’, https://apublica.org/2024/04/como-eduardo-bolsonaro-e-comitiva-articulam-com-parlamentares-dos-eua-punicoes-ao-brasil/.

599 The White House, ‘Fact Sheet’, https://www.whitehouse.gov/fact-sheets/2025/07/fact-sheet-president-donald-j-trump-addresses-threats-to-the-united-states-from-the-government-of-brazil/.

600 U.S. Department of the Treasury, ‘Treasury Sanctions Alexandre de Moraes’, https://home.treasury.gov/news/press-releases/sb0211.

601 U.S. Department of the Treasury, ‘Treasury Sanctions Alexandre de Moraes’, https://home.treasury.gov/news/press-releases/sb0211.

602 Vessaud, ‘Trump’s politically motivated sanctions against Brazil’, https://www.ap.org/news-highlights/spotlights/2025/trumps-politically-motivated-sanctions-against-brazil-strain-relations-among-old-allies/.

The authorship is documented from both ends. In July 2025 Eduardo Bolsonaro posted a video on his own YouTube channel taking credit for the tariffs, and the reporting around it carried his claim in its headline: “Bolsonaro’s son: I convinced Trump to slap tariffs on Brazil”[604]. The New York Times’ reconstruction of the decision, which also reported Eduardo’s own account of his lobbying in Washington, reached the same conclusion: “Behind Trump’s Decision to Tax Brazil to Save Bolsonaro”[605].

What was demanded

The demand set ran wider than one defendant. Reporting on the negotiations identified 21 requirements transmitted to Brasília, among them the 2026 election, the treatment of “political dissidents”, and minerals[606]. A list that names an election, a category of prisoners and a subsoil is not a trade agenda with political ornamentation attached; it is a political programme with a tariff bolted to it.

Not every item was tradeable in both directions. When the negotiation opened, the reduction of Brazil’s duty on American ethanol was presented as not under discussion at all[607]. The asymmetry is instructive. Chapter 1 showed a Brazilian senator offering to close a payment system in exchange for relief on Brazilian exports[608]. The American side, by contrast, recorded in its own final determination that US ethanol producers backed the 25 per cent tariff as a way to “recoup the market value” they said they had lost.[609]

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603 Terrence McCoy, ‘Spurred by Bolsonaro’s son, Trump mulls sanctions on Brazilian judge’, *The Washington Post*, 17 July 2025, https://www.washingtonpost.com/world/2025/07/17/brazil-trump-lula-moraes-tariffs/.

604 Nick Cleveland-Stout, ‘Bolsonaro’s son: I convinced Trump to slap tariffs on Brazil’, *Responsible Statecraft*, 8 August 2025, https://responsiblestatecraft.org/bolsonaro-trump-tarriffs/.

605 Jack Nicas; Ana Ionova, *Behind Trump’s Decision to Tax Brazil to Save Bolsonaro*, *New York Times*, 11 July 2025, https://www.nytimes.com/2025/07/11/world/americas/brazil-trump-tariffs.html.

606 Bahia, ‘Governo Trump incluiu eleição de 2026,’, https://jornalgrandebahia.com.br/2026/09/governo-trump-incluiu-eleicao-de-2026-dissidentes-politicos-e-minerais-em-21-exigencias-ao-brasil-sobre-tarifaco/.

607 Hermanson, ‘Redução da tarifa sobre etanol americano’, https://www1.folha.uol.com.br/mercado/2026/07/reducao-da-tarifa-sobre-etanol-americano-nao-esta-em-negociacao-diz-ministro.shtml.

608 Senator Flávio Bolsonaro, ‘Written Comment on the Proposed Action’, docket USTR-2026-0331, 1 July 2026, copy published by *Poder360*, https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/07/Flavio-pede-aos-EUA-adiamento-de-tarifaco-2jul2026.pdf.

609 ustr.gov, ‘Billing Code 3390-F4’, https://ustr.gov/sites/default/files/files/Issue_Areas/Enforcement/Section%20301/Brazil%20301%20Final%20Action%20FRN%207-15-2026%20final.pdf.

The bargain's terms

The exchange was put in writing on both sides. In his letter of June 2, 2026 to Secretary of State Marco Rubio, Flávio wrote that he was prepared to "immediately place my transition team at the disposal of your government" and said he was "especially grateful" for the American decision to designate the Comando Vermelho and the Primeiro Comando da Capital as terrorist organisations[610]. In his reply of June 23, 2026, Rubio did not thank him for the offer; he took note of it, acknowledging his "optimism" and his "generous offer" of a transition team[611][612][613]. The thanks in the letter were for something else: according to Times Brasil, Rubio thanked Flávio for supporting the designation of the PCC and the CV, Brazil's largest criminal organisations, as terrorist organisations[614][615][616]. A Secretary of State who answers a foreign presidential hopeful by taking note of the offer of a transition team keeps a channel of government open with someone who does not yet govern.

The chronology around it is public. Flávio Bolsonaro was received by President Trump in the Oval Office on May 26, 2026, in a year in which he travelled to the United States six times[617]. The Lula coalition's petition to the Superior Electoral Court (TSE) states that the terrorist designation came on May 28, the day after Flávio met the Secretary of State; the date is a

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610 Amaral, 'Em carta, Flávio pede a Rubio', https://www.cnnbrasil.com.br/politica/em-carta-flavio-pede-a-rubio-que-poupe-brasil-de-nova-proposta-de-tarifaco/.

611 G1, 'Rubio responde a carta de Flávio', https://g1.globo.com/politica/noticia/2026/06/26/rubio-responde-a-carta-de-flavio-bolsonaro-e-reforca-defesa-de-tarifas-contra-o-brasil.ghtml.

612 Souza, 'Em carta, Rubio agradece a Flávio', https://timesbrasil.com.br/brasil/em-carta-rubio-agradece-a-flavio-bolsonaro-por-oferta-de-equipe-de-transicao-aos-eua-caso-seja-eleito/.

613 static.congressoemfoco.com.br, 'PROCESSO', https://static.congressoemfoco.com.br/2026/09/24/attachment/2026/09/24/ff691f_lula_aciona_tse_contra_possivel_financiamento_dos_eua_por_flavio_13_set__2026.pdf.

614 Foco, 'Carta de Marco Rubio a Flávio', https://www.congressoemfoco.com.br/noticia/120024/carta-de-marco-rubio-a-flavio-reafirma-defesa-do-tarifaco-e-ataca-pix.

615 Souza, 'Em carta, Rubio agradece a Flávio', https://timesbrasil.com.br/brasil/em-carta-rubio-agradece-a-flavio-bolsonaro-por-oferta-de-equipe-de-transicao-aos-eua-caso-seja-eleito/.

616 'Rubio responde carta de Flávio Bolsonaro e reafirma posição dos EUA sobre tarifaço', *O Globo*, 26 June 2026, https://oglobo.globo.com/blogs/malu-gaspar/post/2026/06/rubio-responde-carta-de-flavio-bolsonaro-e-reafirma-posicao-dos-eua-sobre-tarifaco.ghtml.

617 Chagas, 'Em meio a denúncias de interferência', https://www.brasildefato.com.br/2026/10/02/em-meio-a-denuncias-de-interferencia-de-trump-flavio-foi-seis-vezes-aos-eua-neste-ano-eleitoral/.

claim by a party to the case, whereas the designation itself and the thanks it drew in Rubio's letter are on the record independently of the petition[618][619]. On May 27, the day before the designation, he met Vice-President JD Vance and, at the Department of State, Deputy Secretary Christopher Landau and Beattie (the secretary of state was not present at that meeting), accompanied by Eduardo Bolsonaro and Paulo Figueiredo.[620]

The instrument's own bill

On November 20, 2025, the American President signed an order removing the additional duty from Brazilian beef, coffee, cocoa and fruits, retroactive to November 13 and which may require a refund of duties collected[621][622]. Chapter 1 recorded the exemption as a fact; what it shows is where the duty was landing. By the time of the final action, eight months later, the logic had stopped being implicit.

The 50 per cent tariff had rested on emergency economic powers, and the US Supreme Court struck down tariffs of that kind in February 2026[623]. Its replacement came through the Section 301 process[624]. The Trade Representative's formal notice imposed 25 per cent "on all imports of Brazil, with certain exemptions", and specified the criteria for those exemptions: raw materials whose taxation could make domestic supply unavailable, products that could cause economy-wide disruption, goods not produced in sufficient quantities in the United States, and articles where a tariff would not help remove the practices at issue[625]. The Trade Representative's own release described the action as a 25 per cent tariff "on certain goods of

618 static.congressoemfoco.com.br, 'PROCESSO', https://static.congressoemfoco.com.br/2026/09/24/attachment/2026/09/24/ff691f_lula_aciona_tse_contra_possivel_financiamento_dos_eua_por_flavio_13_set__2026.pdf.

619 O Globo, 'Rubio responde carta de Flávio Bolsonaro', https://oglobo.globo.com/blogs/malu-gaspar/post/2026/06/rubio-responde-carta-de-flavio-bolsonaro-e-reafirma-posicao-dos-eua-sobre-tarifaco.ghtml.

620 Isabella Menon, 'Flávio Bolsonaro volta à Casa Branca e fala com Rubio e JD Vance um dia após encontro com Trump', *Bahia Notícias*, 27 May 2026, https://www.bahianoticias.com.br/folha/noticia/394375-flavio-bolsonaro-volta-a-casa-branca-e-fala-com-rubio-e-jd-vance-um-dia-apos-encontro-com-trump.

621 Teixeira, 'Trump signs order to remove tariffs', https://www.reuters.com/world/us/trump-signs-order-remove-tariffs-some-brazilian-agricultural-imports-2025-11-20/.

622 'Modifying the Scope of Tariffs on the Government of Brazil', *The White House*, 20 November 2025, https://www.whitehouse.gov/presidential-actions/2025/11/modifying-the-scope-of-tariffs-on-the-government-of-brazil/.

623 Nair, 'US imposes new 25% tariffs on', https://www.reuters.com/world/americas/us-imposes-25-tariff-some-goods-brazil-2026-07-16/.

624 Nair, 'US imposes new 25% tariffs on', https://www.reuters.com/world/americas/us-imposes-25-tariff-some-goods-brazil-2026-07-16/.

Brazil"[626]. In practice, according to Brazil's minister Márcio Elias Rosa, the 25 per cent reached about 18 per cent of Brazilian exports to the United States, about $7.4 billion: beef, coffee and orange juice were left out, while sugar, ethanol, agricultural machinery, footwear and paper were taxed[627][628][629]. An instrument aimed at a foreign judiciary had been rewritten around American input costs. The coercion was bounded not by Brazilian resistance but by the domestic price of the goods it taxed.

The sanctions followed the same curve. On December 12, 2025, the Treasury removed from the list the entry naming Moraes, a second entry for Viviane Barci de Moraes, and the Lex institute[630]. Reuters reported the removal the same day[631]. The designation had lasted four and a half months.

Where the pressure went instead

The tariffs retreated; the apparatus did not.

Early in the election year the State Department appointed Darren Beattie as senior adviser for policy on Brazil, a fact recorded in the Lula coalition's petition, which describes him as a declared supporter of the cause of the defendants, an attribution that belongs to the petition[632].

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625 Federal Register, 'Notice of Action', https://www.federalregister.gov/documents/2026/07/20/2026-14542/notice-of-action-brazils-acts-policies-and-practices-related-to-digital-trade-and-electronic-payment.

626 'USTR Section 301 Action on Brazil's Unreasonable Acts, Policies, and Practices', *United States Trade Representative*, 15 July 2026, https://ustr.gov/about/policy-offices/press-office/press-releases/2026/july/ustr-section-301-action-brazils-unreasonable-acts-policies-and-practices.

627 Nair, 'US imposes new 25% tariffs on', https://www.reuters.com/world/americas/us-imposes-25-tariff-some-goods-brazil-2026-07-16/.

628 Ryan Last; Daniel N Anziska, 'Brazil in the Crosshairs: What Brazil's New Section 301 Tariff Means, Coming July 22', *Troutman Pepper Locke*, 20 July 2026, https://www.troutman.com/insights/brazil-in-the-crosshairs-what-brazils-new-section-301-tariff-means-coming-july-22/.

629 Estadão Conteúdo, 'Nova tarifa dos EUA afetará até 18% das exportações do Brasil, diz ministro', *InfoMoney*, 16 July 2026, https://www.infomoney.com.br/economia/nova-tarifa-dos-eua-afetara-ate-18-das-exportacoes-do-brasil-diz-ministro/.

630 Office of Foreign Assets Control | U.S. Department of the Treasury, 'Global Magnitsky Designations Removals', https://ofac.treasury.gov/recent-actions/20251212.

631 Fernando Cardoso; Lisandra Paraguassu; Daphne Psaledakis, 'US lifts sanctions on Brazil judge targeted by Trump', *Reuters*, 12 December 2025, https://www.reuters.com/world/americas/us-removes-sanctions-brazilian-top-court-justice-moraes-2025-12-12/.

632 static.congressoemfoco.com.br, 'PROCESSO', https://static.congressoemfoco.com.br/2026/09/24/attachment/2026/09/24/

This was the same Beattie who in 2022 had raised suspicions about Brazil's voting machines on Bannon's *War Room*[633]. In March 2026 Justice Moraes denied Beattie's request to visit Jair Bolsonaro in prison, and the Brazilian government revoked the American diplomat's visa[634]. In August Washington answered in kind: it revoked the visa of Brazil's ambassador to the United States, Maria Luiza Viotti, in response to Brazil's delay in approving the new American ambassador and its refusal of entry to other American diplomats; the State Department described the move as reciprocal[635]. On October 2, 2026, Washington suspended consular services in Brazil citing security, and the Federal Police (PF) said it had found no risk[636].

The grant machinery matters more, because no price statistic registers it. Senators Jeanne Shaheen, Tim Kaine and Peter Welch had written to Rubio on September 28, 2026 asking the administration to stop meddling in Brazil's elections and to recognise the certified outcome[637]. Two days later, in the final hours of the fiscal year, the State Department obligated a $1 million award titled "Countering Lawfare and Censorship in Brazil", intended to fund groups opposing what it called judicial overreach and censorship by the Supreme Court; a Democratic congressional aide said Shaheen had maintained ten holds on $22 million of awards covering Brazil among other countries, and that Rubio had personally signed a memo

ff691f_lula_aciona_tse_contra_possivel_financiamento_dos_eua_por_flavio_13_set__2026.pdf.

633 Silverstein, 'How the US far-Right is acting', https://apublica.org/2022/09/how-the-us-far-right-is-acting-to-get-bolsonaro-re-elected-in-brazil/.

634 Mauricio Savarese, 'Brazil revokes visa of US diplomat who sought to visit Bolsonaro in prison', *AP News*, 13 March 2026, https://apnews.com/article/brazil-revokes-visa-trump-adviser-bolsonaro-50a1a83aef3b38f433609abf64a24321.

635 Ana Ionova; Adam B Ellick, 'U.S. Revokes Visa of Top Brazilian Diplomat, Dialing Up Tensions', *The New York Times*, 5 August 2026, https://www.nytimes.com/2026/08/04/world/americas/brazil-ambassador-us-visa.html.

636 'EUA suspendem serviços consulares no Brasil por temor com segurança; PF descarta risco', *UOL*, 2 October 2026, https://noticias.uol.com.br/ultimas-noticias/reuters/2026/10/02/eua-suspendem-servicos-consulares-do-brasil-por-temor-com-seguranca-embaixada-em-brasilia-e-alvo-de-ameaca.htm.

637 'Kaine, Welch, Shaheen Urge Trump Admin to Stop Meddling in Brazil's Elections, Recognize Certified Outcome and Support Brazil's Democracy | U.S. Senator Tim Kaine of Virginia', *Timkaine*, 29 September 2026, https://www.kaine.senate.gov/press-releases/kaine-welch-shaheen-urge-trump-admin-to-stop-meddling-in-brazils-elections-recognize-certified-outcome-and-support-brazils-democracy.

ordering them disregarded[638]. The grants under hold included one against alleged judicial overreach and censorship in Brazil[639].

The courts that did not fold

The instrument also ran into a judiciary that did not treat a foreign sanctions list as a reason to stop. Jair Bolsonaro was sentenced to 27 years and 3 months in prison in September 2025[640]. Eduardo Bolsonaro was convicted of coercion in June 2026[641]. The award of September 2026 was therefore aimed at a court that had already convicted both men, which shows what the grant machinery was for: not to change a verdict but to strip the legitimacy of the institution that had rendered it.

The filter inside Brazil

None of this entered Brazilian politics unmediated, and the mediation is where the class logic shows.

Ciro Nogueira, president of the Progressistas party and senator for Piauí, attacked the Washington lobbying head-on, saying in October 2025 that Eduardo Bolsonaro's conduct in the United States had caused "very great damage" to the right's chances in 2026[642]. His objection was to cost rather than to alignment. He had himself run Bolsonaro's Casa Civil, the presidential chief of staff's office, so the criticism came from inside the governing apparatus rather than from its opponents[643]. The tariff threatened a coalition financed by export capital whose accumulation runs through Beijing, and the visible author of the tariff was a family member living in Texas.

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638 Gedeon, 'Trump administration diverts human rights funds', https://www.theguardian.com/us-news/2026/sep/30/trump-state-department-human-rights-fund.

639 CNN Newsource, 'Trump administration shifts funds from human rights to supporting far-right causes', *KTVZ*, 2 October 2026, https://ktvz.com/politics/cnn-us-politics/2026/10/02/trump-administration-shifts-funds-from-human-rights-to-supporting-far-right-causes/.

640 Wells, 'Jair Bolsonaro sentenced to 27 years', https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/c8xrqxk9p4xo.

641 Agência Brasil, 'STF condena Eduardo Bolsonaro a inelegibilidade', https://agenciabrasil.ebc.com.br/justica/noticia/2026-06/stf-condena-eduardo-bolsonaro-inelegibilidade-e-4-anos-de-prisao.

642 Por Andréia Sadi, 'Ciro Nogueira diz que Eduardo Bolsonaro causou 'prejuízo muito grande' para 2026', *G1*, 13 October 2025, https://g1.globo.com/politica/blog/andreia-sadi/post/2025/10/13/ciro-nogueira-eduardo-bolsonaro-eleicao-2026.ghtml.

643 Gabriela Piva, 'Quem é Ciro Nogueira, senador e ex-ministro de Bolsonaro que foi alvo da PF', *CNN Brasil*, 7 May 2026, https://www.cnnbrasil.com.br/politica/quem-e-ciro-nogueira-senador-e-ex-ministro-de-bolsonaro-que-foi-alvo-da-pf/.

On the coercion itself his posture was pragmatic in three registers. On July 9, 2025, the day the 50 per cent tariff was announced, he criticised Lula for choosing, in his words, infantile attacks over diplomacy with a country more powerful than Brazil[644]. On July 28 he urged the President to telephone Trump, arguing that "it is no humiliation to call the president of the United States"[645]. In January 2025 he had already rejected Trump's claim that the United States did not need Brazil: "Brazil is not a country with nothing to its name"[646].

No humiliation in negotiating, no servility in the answer, no patience for the family's Washington strategy: that is the posture of a broker whose coalition needs the American market open and the American electorate kept out of the conversation. The coercion did not unify the Brazilian right. It split it over who would pay the bill.

Conclusion

The coercion of 2025 and 2026 was real, and its target was named in the documents that imposed it. It bought a filing, a hearing appearance, an Oval Office photograph and the offer of a transition team. It did not buy the suspension of the proceedings, and it was withdrawn at the two points where it had begun to cost those applying it: the beef and coffee exemption of November 2025 and the delisting of the justice in December[647]. What remains is the machinery no price statistic records: the visas, the consular suspension and the grant obligated hours before the fiscal year closed. The question that machinery answers is not what Washington wanted, which is already documented, but what it was buying: an election result, and the apparatus inside Brazil built to produce it. Chapter 8 turns to the domestic machinery that was to deliver it.

644 'Ciro Nogueira critica Lula após anúncio de taxa de Trump', *Poder360*, 9 July 2025, https://www.poder360.com.br/poder-congresso/ciro-nogueira-critica-lula-apos-anuncio-de-taxa-de-trump/.

645 'Não é humilhação ligar para Trump, diz Ciro Nogueira a Lula', *Poder360*, 28 July 2025, https://www.poder360.com.br/poder-congresso/nao-e-humilhacao-ligar-para-trump-diz-ciro-nogueira-a-lula/.

646 Gabriel Buss, 'Ciro Nogueira reage a Trump: "Brasil não é um país sem eira nem beira', *Metrópoles*, 22 January 2025, https://www.metropoles.com/brasil/ciro-nogueira-reage-a-trump-brasil-nao-e-um-pais-sem-eira-nem-beira.

647 Gustavo Soares; Julia Chaib; Ricardo Della Coletta; Alex Sabino; Pedro S Teixeira; Felipe Gutierrez e Júlia Moura, 'Trump reduz tarifas sobre café e carne bovina; adicional de 40% sobre Brasil permanece', *Folha de S.Paulo*, 14 November 2025, https://www1.folha.uol.com.br/mercado/2025/11/trump-assina-medida-para-reduzir-tarifas-sobre-cafe-e-carne-bovina.shtml.

Chapter 07: Israel, the Gulf and the Iberosphere: the secondary nodes of the transnational bloc

The network behind the 2026 candidacy has a US core (the franchise, the money circuit and the coercive instrument followed in the preceding chapters) and three secondary nodes. A "secondary node" here means a point in the network that contributes something specific, which the US core cannot supply, without giving orders to the core or taking orders from it. Israel supplies a legislative channel and a messaging apparatus paid for by a foreign ministry. The Gulf supplies sovereign capital, that is, state money, whose ownership is opaque through the very way the receiving jurisdiction was built. The Iberosphere, the name the Spanish party Vox gives to the Spanish- and Portuguese-speaking countries as a whole, supplies an ideological apparatus with a funding base that never passes through a US donor. Each contribution is real, and each node's material interest diverges from the core at a point that can be identified. A coalition assembled from three non-substitutable suppliers is a weaker instrument than either its defenders or its opponents assume, and the divergences are where that weakness shows.

The Israeli node: a channel and a contract

The messaging side is contracted, and the contract is on file in the United States' own foreign-agent register[648]. In September 2025 Clock Tower X LLC, the firm of Donald Trump's former campaign manager Brad Parscale, registered under the Foreign Agents Registration Act (FARA), registration number 7649, as an agent of Havas Media Network, a global media agency contracted by the government of Israel: the filing declares Havas "supervised" by the State of Israel and describes the work as support for "Havas' engagement by the State of Israel" to run a nationwide campaign in the United States, under a contract with Havas Media Germany GmbH.[649] The Quincy Institute estimates that Clock Tower X was paid $28.5 million between September 2025 and June 2026, under a contract projected at $46.5 million.[650] The reported deliverables include content built to shape how generative artificial-intelligence models frame Israel, and placement inside a US Christian conservative radio network.[651] What the money buys is a rail: a state pays to be present inside another country's conservative media ecosystem, and the people who run Latin American campaigns are the people who run the US ones. Fernando Cerimedo was announced as the Latin American

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648 *2. Registration Number*, *efile.fara.gov*, 26 September 2025, https://efile.fara.gov/docs/7649-Exhibit-AB-20250918-1.pdf.

649 efile.fara.gov, '2. Registration Number', https://efile.fara.gov/docs/7649-Exhibit-AB-20250918-1.pdf.

650 *THE EIGHTH FRONT*, *quincyinst-2.s3.amazonaws.com*, July 2026, https://quincyinst-2.s3.amazonaws.com/wp-content/uploads/2026/07/24164818/QI-PAPER-NO.-19-CLEVELAND-STOUT-4.pdf.

651 Nick Cleveland-Stout, 'The Eighth Front: Inside Israel's $1 Billion Influence Campaign', *Quincy Institute for Responsible Statecraft*, 24 July 2026, https://quincyinst.org/research/the-eighth-front-inside-israels-1-billion-influence-campaign/.

representative of two firms tied to the Trump campaign's infrastructure,[652] and the Bolsonaro family has itself acknowledged his role in the 2022 campaign.[653] The firm's declared address is the same Medina Road address in Ohio used by Campaign Nucleus, the campaign-technology company Parscale founded and whose Latin American representative became Fernando Cerimedo.[654]

The good Israel supplies is jurisdictional: it concerns who has the power to judge. When the Hind Rajab Foundation filed a war-crimes complaint in Brazil against an Israeli soldier who had filmed himself taking part in the demolition of homes in Gaza, the filing put his holiday at risk,[655] and in January 2025 the Israeli minister for Diaspora affairs, Amichai Chikli, wrote directly to the federal deputy Eduardo Bolsonaro asking him to speak out on behalf of the soldier and for support in relation to the inquiry of the Federal Police (PF), while attacking the Brazilian government in the same letter.[656][657] The institutional channels do not depend on the family: R$134 million in contracts with an Israeli firm for aircraft and drone support,[658] R$21.7 million for an anti-drone system bought by the Federal Police,[659] trips to Israel paid

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652 'Fernando Cerimedo representará en América Latina a dos empresas vinculadas a la campaña de Donald Trump', *C5N*, 19 March 2025, https://www.c5n.com/politica/fernando-cerimedo-representara-america-latina-dos-empresas-vinculadas-la-campana-donald-trump-n194620.

653 Teodoro, 'Eduardo Bolsonaro confirmou que Cerimedo ajudou', https://revistaforum.com.br/politica/eduardo-bolsonaro-cerimedo-ajudou-golpe-video/.

654 Diego Feijó de Abreu, 'Como atua a rede estrangeira ligada à Donald Trump em favor de Flávio Bolsonaro na eleição brasileira de 2026', *Revista Fórum*, 24 September 2026, https://revistaforum.com.br/politica/rede-trump-campanha-flavio-bolsonaro/.

655 'How Filming Home Demolitions in Gaza Forced Vagdani to Flee His Holiday Destination Brazil', *THE HIND RAJAB FOUNDATION*, 11 February 2025, https://www.hindrajabfoundation.org.

656 'Israel solicita apoio de Eduardo Bolsonaro em caso de militar acusado de crimes de guerra', *Tv Brasil usa*, 6 January 2025, https://tvbrazilusa.com/2025/01/06/israel-solicita-apoio-de-eduardo-bolsonaro-em-caso-de-militar-acusado-de-crimes-de-guerra/.

657 Tv Brasil usa, 'Israel solicita apoio de Eduardo Bolsonaro', https://tvbrazilusa.com/2025/01/06/israel-solicita-apoio-de-eduardo-bolsonaro-em-caso-de-militar-acusado-de-crimes-de-guerra/.

658 Mateus Santana, 'FAB fecha contratos de R$ 134 milhões com empresa israelense para suporte a aviões e drones', *AEROIN - Notícias de Aviação*, 24 September 2025, https://aeroin.net/fab-fecha-contratos-de-r-134-milhoes-com-empresa-israelense-para-suporte-a-avioes-e-drones/.

659 Lucas Gayoso, 'PF fecha contrato de R$ 21,7 milhões para adquirir sistema antidrones de empresa israelense', *Jornal Correio da Manhã*, 30 June 2026, https://www.correiodamanha.com.br/colunistas/paulo-cappelli/2026/06/297965-pf-fecha-contrato-de-rs-217-milhoes-para-adquirir-sistema-antidrones-de-empresa-israelense.html.

for Brazilian mayors,[660] and a Brazil-Israel parliamentary front created in Congress in April 2026.[661] The Israeli account of the episode is organised around the official who extracted the soldier from the country and around his indifference to the warnings he had received.[662] Flávio's own recorded commitment was narrower than the architecture: he told representatives of the Jewish community in São Paulo that he intended to visit Israel at the start of any government,[663] and in an interview with an Israeli newspaper he paired the embassy move with an attack on the São Paulo Forum.[664] A minister writing to a legislator about a live police inquiry enters through the legislature, bypassing the foreign ministry (Itamaraty) and the armed forces. That route is the good, and maintaining it is what the node is for.

The price is paid in pledges. Flávio Bolsonaro attended the International Conference on Combating Antisemitism in Jerusalem in January 2026, convened by Chikli's Diaspora Affairs Ministry, alongside European far-right legislators including Geert Wilders and the Sweden Democrats' Jimmie Åkesson.[665][666] When he opened his presidential campaign in São Paulo in July 2026, a recorded message from Benjamin Netanyahu played above the stage.[667] The commitments he brought back from his January 2026 visit with his brother include

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660 Laís Martins; Thalys Alcântara; Tatiana Dias, 'Por que Israel pagou viagem de prefeitos brasileiros', *Intercept Brasil*, 17 June 2025, https://www.intercept.com.br/2025/06/17/israel-viagem-prefeitos-brasileiros-guerra/.

661 Jornalismo, 'Frente Parlamentar Brasil-Israel é criada no Congresso com apoio de deputados e senadores', *exibirgospel.com.br*, 16 April 2026, https://exibirgospel.com.br/frente-parlamentar-brasil-israel-e-criada-no-congresso-com-apoio-de-deputados-e-senadores/.

662 'הבכיר שחילץ את הלוחם מברזיל: "לא נרתעתי מהאזהרות, זה רק שכנע אותי', *MaarivOnline*, 10 January 2025, https://www.maariv.co.il/news/israel/article-1163130.

663 Otávio Rosso, 'Flávio Bolsonaro promete visitar Israel no início de eventual governo', *Brasil 247*, 1 October 2026, https://www.brasil247.com/mundo/flavio-bolsonaro-promete-visitar-israel-no-inicio-de-eventual-governo/.

664 Adin, 'Bolsonaro's Son Vows Jerusalem Embassy Move', *Israel Hayom*, 31 January 2026, https://www.israelhayom.com/2026/01/31/brazil-bolsonaro-son-israel-embassy-jerusalem-election/.

665 Zev Stub, 'Israel's antisemitism confab welcomes far-right pols, but draws less fire than last year', *The Times of Israel*, 27 January 2026, https://www.timesofisrael.com/israels-antisemitism-confab-welcomes-far-right-pols-but-draws-less-fire-than-last-year/.

666 Stub, 'Israel's antisemitism confab welcomes far-right pols,', https://www.timesofisrael.com/israels-antisemitism-confab-welcomes-far-right-pols-but-draws-less-fire-than-last-year/.

667 Elis Gjevori, 'Netanyahu's man: How Israel is betting on a Bolsonaro comeback in Brazil', *Middle East Eye*, 2 October 2026, https://www.middleeasteye.net/news/netanyahus-candidate-how-israel-betting-bolsonaro-comeback-brazil.

moving the embassy from Tel Aviv to Jerusalem, accession to the Isaac Accords and a return to the International Holocaust Remembrance Alliance,[668] and that is what the visit was for.[669] The framework those commitments attach to was signed by Javier Milei and Netanyahu in April 2026,[670] received $1 million from the Genesis Prize Foundation for a New York non-profit vehicle,[671] and was carried to Buenos Aires in June 2026 by legislators from 14 countries.[672] On that trip the Bolsonaro brothers met Netanyahu, the Knesset speaker Amir Ohana and Chikli, and toured Samaria with the settler leader Yossi Dagan; they did not meet opposition figures.[673]

The divergence sits in what the node can be paid with. Its interest is diplomatic: a vote, an embassy, a definition written into statute. None of that costs the Brazilian treasury foreign currency or touches the payment system or the subsoil. The embassy pledge does collide with the halal export market (meat slaughtered according to Islamic rite) on which the agrarian fraction depends, but that is the agrarian fraction's problem rather than Israel's[674]. After Lula compared Gaza to the Holocaust in February 2024, Israel declared him persona non grata and the relationship was downgraded,[675][676] which fixes the stake as electoral: the outlay pays only if the government changes.

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668 Dror Feuer, 'Brazil's Bolsonaro sons visit Israel, vow embassy move to Jerusalem', *ynetglobal*, 11 February 2026, https://www.ynetnews.com/article/sjwe0ykdbl.

669 Gjevori, 'Netanyahu's man', https://www.middleeasteye.net/news/netanyahus-candidate-how-israel-betting-bolsonaro-comeback-brazil.

670 'Netanyahu and Milei Sign Historic Isaac Accords', *genesisprize.org*, 20 April 2026, https://www.genesisprize.org/press-center/2026-04-20-signing-of-the-isaac-accords.

671 genesisprize.org, 'President Milei's Initiative to Advance Latin', https://www.genesisprize.org/press-center/2025-08-11-president-milei-initiative-to-advance-latin-america-israel-ties-receives-financial-boost-from-the-genesis-prize.

672 genesisprize.org, 'Legislators from 14 Latin American countries', https://www.genesisprize.org/press-center/2026-06-30-legislators-from-14-latin-american-countries-commit-to-pro-israel-agenda-at-the-buenos-aires-summit.

673 Feuer, 'Brazil's Bolsonaro sons visit Israel, vow', https://www.ynetnews.com/article/sjwe0ykdbl.

674 Júlia Dias Carneiro, 'Governo Bolsonaro: A aproximação entre presidente brasileiro e Israel pode afetar o mercado bilionário de carne halal no Brasil?', *BBC News Brasil*, 30 March 2019, https://www.bbc.com/portuguese/brasil-47748317.

675 Lazar Berman, 'Israel declares Brazil's Lula persona non grata for comparing Gaza war to Holocaust', *The Times of Israel*, 19 February 2024, https://www.timesofisrael.com/israel-declares-brazils-lula-persona-non-grata-for-comparing-gaza-war-to-holocaust/.

676 Gjevori, 'Netanyahu's man', https://www.middleeasteye.net/news/netanyahus-candidate-how-israel-betting-bolsonaro-comeback-brazil.

The Iberian node: an apparatus with its own base

The Iberian node is the oldest in the network and the thinnest in money, and its thinness is what makes it a node rather than a branch. Fundación Disenso, the Vox think tank presided by Santiago Abascal, hired Ernesto Araújo as its international adviser in October 2023, presenting the appointment as part of a plan to widen its international presence and to keep building a working network among the countries of the Iberosphere, Brazil and Portugal included; its international area, and the Foro Madrid with it, is directed by Eduardo Cader.[677][678] Araújo's account of the foundation's first three years states the node's function in his own words: in barely three years, he said, the foundation had become "la principal oposición al Foro de São Paulo, el Grupo de Puebla y sus satélites criminales en Iberoamérica", the principal opposition to the Foro de São Paulo, the Grupo de Puebla and their criminal satellites in Ibero-America.[679][680]

What the Foro Madrid is

The Foro Madrid is a network of the radical right in Spain and Latin America created by Fundación Disenso, the think tank of the Spanish party Vox, led by Santiago Abascal[681]. Its founding document, the Madrid Charter of October 26, 2020, presents itself as a response to the Foro de São Paulo, which brings together the region's left-wing parties[682]. Vox calls the Spanish- and Portuguese-speaking countries as a whole the "Iberosphere"[683]. The forum holds

677 Disenso, 'Ernesto Araújo, ex ministro de Relaciones', https://fundaciondisenso.org/ernesto-araujo-ex-ministro-de-relaciones-exteriores-de-brasil-se-incorpora-a-la-fundacion-disenso-como-asesor-internacional/.

678 Sepúlveda, '(PDF) El Think Tank Fundación Disenso', https://www.researchgate.net/publication/393475238_El_Think_Tank_Fundacion_Disenso_y_la_Iberosfera_ideas_discursos_y_narrativas_de_las_nuevas_derechas_sobre_Iberoamerica.

679 Disenso, 'Ernesto Araújo, ex ministro de Relaciones', https://fundaciondisenso.org/ernesto-araujo-ex-ministro-de-relaciones-exteriores-de-brasil-se-incorpora-a-la-fundacion-disenso-como-asesor-internacional/.

680 Disenso, 'Ernesto Araújo, ex ministro de Relaciones', https://fundaciondisenso.org/ernesto-araujo-ex-ministro-de-relaciones-exteriores-de-brasil-se-incorpora-a-la-fundacion-disenso-como-asesor-internacional/.

681 Sepúlveda, '(PDF) El Think Tank Fundación Disenso', https://www.researchgate.net/publication/393475238_El_Think_Tank_Fundacion_Disenso_y_la_Iberosfera_ideas_discursos_y_narrativas_de_las_nuevas_derechas_sobre_Iberoamerica.

682 Fernando Fuentes, *LaGacetaMediaKit*, *fundaciondisenso.org*, 9 September 2021, https://fundaciondisenso.org/wp-content/uploads/2021/09/FD-Carta-Madrid-AAFF-V30_2.pdf.

683 Autor Guillermo Fernández-Vázquez y David Lerín Ibarra, 'Hispanismo étnico e iberosfera: la peculiar mirada de Vox hacia la región latinoamericana', *CIDOB*, 1 November 2022, https://www.cidob.org/publicaciones/hispanismo-etnico-iberosfera-peculiar-mirada-vox-hacia-region-latinoamericana.

regional meetings (Bogotá in 2022, Lima in 2023, Buenos Aires in 2024, Asunción in 2025) and publishes statements on the politics of the region's countries[684].

The Brazilian link to the forum is in its founding document. The official list of signatories of the Madrid Charter includes two Brazilians, Eduardo Bolsonaro and the federal deputy Bia Kicis, alongside Javier Milei, the Chilean José Antonio Kast, the Venezuelan María Corina Machado and the Italian Giorgia Meloni.[685] On the day of publication, Eduardo presented the forum as a "counterweight to the Foro de São Paulo".[686] In April 2024, Disenso took Eduardo, Bia Kicis and Gustavo Gayer to meetings with the conservative group in the European Parliament to denounce Lula's "authoritarian drift".[687][688] Between 2023 and 2025 the forum published a series of statements against the Brazilian government: against Lula's visit to Spain (April 2023), against a supposed "authoritarian state" of Moraes and Lula (February 2024), against the blocking of X (September 2024) and against the "political witch-hunt" of Jair Bolsonaro (July and August 2025).[689] In March 2025, when Eduardo took leave from his seat and moved to the United States, the forum released a letter of support saying that the "regime of Lula and Moraes" threatened him.[690] Milei congratulated Flávio on leading the first round,[691] and the leader of Portugal's Chega declared his support and said that Lula's place was in prison.[692] It is the same language of "persecution" that reappears in 2026.

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684 Edmaly Maucó, 'Noticias', *Foro Madrid*, 1 September 2017, https://foromadrid.org/noticias/.

685 Fuentes, 'LaGacetaMediaKit', https://fundaciondisenso.org/wp-content/uploads/2021/09/FD-Carta-Madrid-AAFF-V30_2.pdf.

686 Redacción; Agencias, 'El hijo de Bolsonaro firma la 'Carta de Madrid' junto a Abascal "contra el avance del comunismo', *El Español*, 27 October 2020, https://www.elespanol.com/mundo/america/20201027/bolsonaro-firma-carta-madrid-abascal-avance-comunismo/531447029_0.html.

687 Fundación Disenso, 'La Fundación Disenso denuncia la deriva autoritaria de Lula da Silva ante el Parlamento Europeo', *Fundación Disenso*, 11 April 2024, https://fundaciondisenso.org/la-fundacion-disenso-denuncia-la-deriva-autoritaria-de-lula-da-silva-ante-el-parlamento-europeo/.

688 Maucó, 'Noticias', https://foromadrid.org/noticias/.

689 Maucó, 'Noticias', https://foromadrid.org/noticias/.

690 Tatiana Farah, 'Foro de extrema-direita diz que 'regime de Lula e Moraes' ameaça Eduardo Bolsonaro', *PlatôBR*, 22 March 2025, https://platobr.com.br/de-extrema-direita-foro-madrid-diz-que-regime-de-lula-e-moraes-ameaca-eduardo.

691 Redacción, 'Javier Milei felicitó a Flávio Bolsonaro por salir primero en las elecciones generales en Brasil: «Querido amigo»', *Diario Río Negro | Periodismo en la Patagonia*, 4 October 2026, https://www.rionegro.com.ar/politica/javier-milei-felicito-a-flavio-bolsonaro-por-salir-primero-en-las-elecciones-generales-en-brasil-querido-amigo-4747959/.

The apparatus runs on stages and personnel rather than grants. The Foro Madrid's first regional meeting took place in Bogotá in February 2022 under the slogan "For democracy and freedoms".[693] In December 2021 the Instituto Conservador-Liberal, working with a state deputy, convened a congress in Várzea Grande at which Abascal and the Vox member of the European Parliament Hermann Tertsch spoke alongside Eduardo Bolsonaro, Ricardo Salles and Magno Malta.[694][695] Abascal's stated purpose at the time was an alliance with Bolsonaro to defend democracy against what he called the globalist and communist threat.[696]

The stages are operational. The first Argentine edition of the Conservative Political Action Conference (CPAC) met in Buenos Aires, at a hotel in Puerto Madero, in December 2024 with speakers from the United States, Brazil, Mexico, Spain and Hungary, among them Lara Trump, Ben Shapiro, Santiago Abascal, a member of the Hungarian National Assembly and Eduardo Bolsonaro.[697][698] Eduardo Bolsonaro travelled for it and, according to the Argentine press, also to inform himself about the situation of the refugees imprisoned at the request of

692 João Pedro Farah, 'Presidente do Chega declara apoio a Flávio: "Lugar de Lula é na prisão', *O Antagonista*, 4 October 2026, https://oantagonista.com.br/mundo/presidente-do-chega-declara-apoio-a-flavio-lugar-de-lula-e-na-prisao/.

693 'I ENCUENTRO REGIONAL DE FORO MADRID - BOGOTÁ 2022 - POR LA DEMOCRACIA Y LAS LIBERTADES', *Foro Madrid*, 26 January 2022, https://foromadrid.org/encuentros-reg/i-encuentro-regional-de-foro-madrid-bogota-2022-por-la-democracia-y-las-libertades/.

694 Redação, 'Congresso de direita em Várzea Grande', https://www.rdnews.com.br/legislativo/congresso-de-direita-em-varzea-grande-tera-presenca-de-eurodeputado-espanhol/152771.

695 EFE, 'Ultraderechista español Abascal impulsa en Brasil su alianza de «patriotas»', *Swissinfo*, 10 December 2021, https://www.swissinfo.ch/spa/ultraderechista-espa%C3%B1ol-abascal-impulsa-en-brasil-su-alianza-de-patriotas/47183588.

696 Agencias, 'Abascal busca formar con Bolsonaro una alianza que defienda la democracia y contra "la amenaza globalista y comunista', *Confidencial Digital*, 13 December 2021, https://www.elconfidencialdigital.com/articulo/actualidad/abascal-busca-formar-bolsonaro-alianza-que-defienda-democracia-amenaza-globalista-comunista/20211213145247319699.html.

697 Chaves, 'CPAC Argentina confirmó oradores y horarios', https://www.infobae.com/politica/2024/12/03/cpac-argentina-confirmo-oradores-y-horarios-de-lara-trump-y-ben-shapiro-a-bolsonaro-y-el-cierre-de-milei/.

698 Chaves, 'CPAC Argentina confirmó oradores y horarios', https://www.infobae.com/politica/2024/12/03/cpac-argentina-confirmo-oradores-y-horarios-de-lara-trump-y-ben-shapiro-a-bolsonaro-y-el-cierre-de-milei/.

the Brazilian courts.[699] A conference that doubles as a channel to the government hosting those fugitives does work no communiqué can do.

Budapest, Berlin, Lisbon and Rome

Europe supplied goods of the same order, and the oldest relationship is with Viktor Orbán, then prime minister of Hungary[700]. Orbán attended Jair Bolsonaro's inauguration in January 2019, and in April of that year received Eduardo in Budapest.[701] In the 2022 election he recorded a video addressed to Brazilians asking for Bolsonaro's re-election.[702] At Milei's inauguration in December 2023 he met Jair again and called him a "hero", and in April 2024 he again received Eduardo in Budapest, during CPAC Hungary.[703] Miklós Szanthó opened CPAC Hungary in 2026, after which Orbán spoke, and the speakers included Milei, who travelled for it, alongside Abascal, André Ventura, Alice Weidel, Geert Wilders and Tom Van Grieken; Donald Trump addressed it remotely.[704] Hungary supplied the most concrete good in the network: after the Federal Police operation of February 2024, Jair Bolsonaro spent two nights inside the Hungarian embassy in Brasília,[705][706] under another state's diplomatic roof while his own country's judiciary moved against him. According to reported documents, in

699 Chaves, 'CPAC Argentina confirmó oradores y horarios', https://www.infobae.com/politica/2024/12/03/cpac-argentina-confirmo-oradores-y-horarios-de-lara-trump-y-ben-shapiro-a-bolsonaro-y-el-cierre-de-milei/.

700 'Bolsonaro na embaixada da Hungria: entenda a ligação do ex-presidente com Viktor Orbán, o primeiro-ministro húngaro', *G1*, 25 March 2024, https://g1.globo.com/mundo/noticia/2024/03/25/bolsonaro-na-embaixada-da-hungria-entenda-a-ligacao-do-ex-presidente-com-viktor-orban-o-primeiro-ministro-hungaro.ghtml.

701 Julia Braun, 'As ligações da família Bolsonaro com Viktor Orbán, que perdeu eleição na Hungria após 16 anos', *BBC News Brasil*, 13 April 2026, https://www.bbc.com/portuguese/articles/c5y94vx22ppo.

702 'Bolsonaro já esteve três vezes com primeiro-ministro da Hungria', *Agência Brasil*, 26 March 2024, https://agenciabrasil.ebc.com.br/politica/noticia/2024-03/bolsonaro-ja-esteve-tres-vezes-com-primeiro-ministro-da-hungria.

703 Braun, 'As ligações da família Bolsonaro com', https://www.bbc.com/portuguese/articles/c5y94vx22ppo.

704 'Warning Against the Global Left's "Militant Democracy" at CPAC Hungary 2026', *ordoiuris.pl*, 23 March 2026, https://ordoiuris.pl/en/press-newsdesk/warning-against-the-global-lefts-militant-democracy-at-cpac-hungary-2026/.

705 G1, 'Bolsonaro na embaixada da Hungria', https://g1.globo.com/mundo/noticia/2024/03/25/bolsonaro-na-embaixada-da-hungria-entenda-a-ligacao-do-ex-presidente-com-viktor-orban-o-primeiro-ministro-hungaro.ghtml.

706 G1, 'Bolsonaro na embaixada da Hungria', https://g1.globo.com/mundo/noticia/2024/03/25/bolsonaro-na-embaixada-da-hungria-entenda-a-ligacao-do-ex-presidente-com-viktor-orban-o-primeiro-ministro-hungaro.ghtml.

July 2022, in the middle of the campaign, Hungary's foreign minister, Péter Szijjártó, asked Brazil's then minister for women, family and human rights, Cristiane Britto, in London whether there was anything the Hungarian government could do to help re-elect President Bolsonaro.[707][708]

With the Alternative for Germany (AfD), the German far-right party, the link runs through the deputy Beatrix von Storch[709]. She came to Brasília in July 2021 to build an international conservative alliance, visited Eduardo Bolsonaro there,[710] and published her own description of Jair Bolsonaro as humble, kind and good-humoured in contrast to what the press said.[711] She returned to Brazil in 2023 and called Justice Alexandre de Moraes "Brazil's biggest criminal"; the Brazilian government summoned the German ambassador to express its displeasure, and she ended up stepping away from the German-Brazilian parliamentary group.[712] In April 2024 Eduardo went to the Bundestag, the German parliament, posed beside her and wrote that the "current strange times in Brazil" recalled the Reichstag fire of 1933, the episode Hitler used as a pretext to persecute his opponents.[713] Beatrix von Storch, a member of the Bundestag and of the Alternative für Deutschland, and the granddaughter of Hitler's finance minister, came to Brasília in July 2021 saying she was there "para conquistar aliados para o AfD".[714]

On the Iberian peninsula, the thread also runs through Chega, the Portuguese far-right party[715]. In September 2021 Eduardo had a meeting scheduled in Lisbon with André Ventura, Chega's

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707 Braun, 'As ligações da família Bolsonaro com', https://www.bbc.com/portuguese/articles/c5y94vx22ppo.

708 Braun, 'As ligações da família Bolsonaro com', https://www.bbc.com/portuguese/articles/c5y94vx22ppo.

709 Deutsche Welle, 'Deputada da AfD se afasta de grupo Brasil-Alemanha', *Deutsche Welle*, 16 June 2023, https://www.dw.com/pt-br/deputada-da-afd-se-afasta-de-grupo-brasil-alemanha/a-65941176.

710 Mariana Sanches, 'Beatrix von Storch: quem é a líder da extrema-direita alemã que se reuniu com Bolsonaro', *BBC News Brasil*, 26 July 2021, https://www.bbc.com/portuguese/internacional-57978671.

711 Sanches, 'Beatrix von Storch', https://www.bbc.com/portuguese/internacional-57978671.

712 Welle, 'Deputada da AfD se afasta de', https://www.dw.com/pt-br/deputada-da-afd-se-afasta-de-grupo-brasil-alemanha/a-65941176.

713 Rafaela Ferreira, 'Eduardo Bolsonaro posta foto ao lado de deputada neta de ministro nazista', *Estadão*, 30 April 2024, https://www.estadao.com.br/politica/eduardo-bolsonaro-posta-foto-lado-deputada-neta-ministro-nazista-nprp/.

714 Sanches, 'Beatrix von Storch', https://www.bbc.com/portuguese/internacional-57978671.

715 Carlos Hortmann, 'Quando o bolsonarismo encontra a extrema direita de Portugal', *Jacobin Brasil*, 8 October 2021, https://jacobin.com.br/2021/10/quando-o-bolsonarismo-encontra-a-extrema-direita-de-portugal/.

leader, and with Abascal, at the close of Chega's municipal campaign; he tested positive for Covid-19 and did not attend, while Abascal did.[716][717] In April 2023 Ventura announced Jair Bolsonaro and Matteo Salvini as guests at a party event in Lisbon.[718] In Italy, the relationship is with Salvini, leader of the League, who had already met Eduardo in Rome and who received Jair in Pistoia in November 2021.[719] Flávio barely appears in this circuit before 2025. He had been one of the first Brazilian politicians to open an account on Gettr, in July 2021, welcomed on the platform by its founder, Jason Miller,[720] and his one documented appeal to Rome came in July 2025, when he publicly asked Giorgia Meloni and Matteo Salvini to support the deputy Carla Zambelli, who had fled to Italy after being sentenced by the Supreme Federal Court to ten years in prison.[721] No meeting of the Bolsonaro brothers with Meloni, Marine Le Pen or the Patriots for Europe before 2025 appears in the sources gathered for this report. When Vox brought Le Pen and Milei to Madrid for Europa Viva 24 in May 2024, with Orbán and Meloni appearing by video, the other guests reported included Amichai Chikli, André Ventura and José Antonio Kast, but no Bolsonaro;[722] the Patriots for Europe rally in Madrid in February 2025 hosted Kevin Roberts, of the Heritage Foundation, and aired video messages from María Corina Machado and Javier Milei, again with no Bolsonaro among them.[723]

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716 José Carlos Duarte, 'Filho de Bolsonaro encontra-se com André Ventura e líder do VOX em Lisboa', *Observador*, 10 September 2021, https://observador.pt/2021/09/10/filho-de-bolsonaro-encontra-se-com-andre-ventura-e-lider-do-vox-em-lisboa/.

717 Carlos Hortmann, 'Quando o bolsonarismo encontra a extrema direita de Portugal', *Jacobin Brasil*, 8 October 2021, https://jacobin.com.br/2021/10/quando-o-bolsonarismo-encontra-a-extrema-direita-de-portugal/.

718 Lusa, 'Ventura anuncia que Bolsonaro e Salvini vão estar em evento do Chega', *PÚBLICO*, 7 April 2023, https://www.publico.pt/2023/04/07/politica/noticia/ventura-anuncia-bolsonaro-salvini-vao-estar-evento-chega-2045366.

719 Lucas Ferraz; Especial Para O Globo, 'Bolsonaro vai se encontrar com Salvini, líder da ultradireita na Itália', *O Globo*, 30 October 2021, https://oglobo.globo.com/economia/bolsonaro-vai-se-encontrar-com-salvini-lider-da-ultradireita-na-italia-25258606.

720 Scofield, 'Bolsonaro já tem perfil verificado e', https://apublica.org/2021/07/bolsonaro-ja-tem-perfil-verificado-e-quase-100-mil-seguidores-na-rede-social-de-trump/.

721 Agenzia ANSA; Redazione ANSA, 'Flávio Bolsonaro a Meloni e Salvini, 'sostenete Carla Zambelli' - America Latina - Ansa.it', *Agenzia ANSA*, 25 July 2025, https://www.ansa.it/sito/notizie/mondo/americalatina/2025/07/25/flavio-bolsonaro-a-meloni-e-salvini-sostenete-carla-zambelli_b0a63bf8-0f2a-4916-bd84-a96f1c56d2c1.html.

722 Sam Jones, 'European far-right leaders gather ahead of EU elections', *the Guardian*, 19 May 2024, https://www.theguardian.com/world/article/2024/may/19/european-far-right-leaders-gather-ahead-of-eu-elections.

723 Paula Soler, 'Your time is over' - far-right leaders start fight with EU mainstream', *euronews*, 8 February 2025, https://www.euronews.com/2025/02/08/your-time-is-over-far-

The divergence here is that the currency is symbolic and the budget is a party foundation's. Vox and Fidesz, Orbán's party, have no stake in the US tariff schedule and none in Brazilian rare earths; they trade in definitions, commemorations and parliamentary resolutions, and none of those is damaged by a programme that closes a payment system or forward-sells a mine's output. What the node takes in return is presence, the cheapest good in the network. Its institutional capacity amounts to a foundation's budget and an embassy's floor.

The Gulf node: capital that cannot be commanded

The Gulf node cannot be directed at all, because its capital is sovereign. The chain that carried more than $12 million from a liquidated bank to a Dallas fund through a payment conglomerate was followed in chapter 3; what matters here is its structural property. Funds of that construction can conceal who their quotaholders are,[724] and the United States never joined the international standard for the automatic exchange of tax information, so Brazilian investigators depend on treaty requests for cooperation.[725] No US vendor supplies that at any price.

What the International Holding Company is

The International Holding Company, known as IHC, is one of the largest conglomerates in Abu Dhabi, the capital of the United Arab Emirates, with companies in several sectors, technology included[726]. It is chaired by Sheikh Tahnoon bin Zayed, brother of the Emirati president, deputy ruler of Abu Dhabi and the country's national security adviser[727]. Tahnoon is a direct link to Trump: he was in the Oval Office in March 2025, when the Emirates announced a $1.4 trillion investment plan in the United States, and investors tied to him bought 49 per cent of World Liberty Financial, the Trump family's cryptocurrency company[728].

The originating end runs through Abu Dhabi, and the Bolsonaro family's bridge to the Emirates has a name. In December 2019 Eduardo visited, on an official mission of the Chamber of Deputies, the then crown prince Mohammed bin Zayed, now the country's

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right-leaders-take-on-the-eus-mainstream-parties.

724 Carrança, 'Havengate', https://www.bbc.com/portuguese/articles/cp8pwzl3y45o.

725 Carrança, 'Havengate', https://www.bbc.com/portuguese/articles/cp8pwzl3y45o.

726 'International Holding Company', *AGBI*, 13 February 2025, https://www.agbi.com/companies/international-holding-company-ihc/.

727 Luke Fountain, 'UAE 'spy sheikh' backs 49% stake in Trump family's crypto bank venture, WSJ reports', *CNBC*, 27 August 2026, https://www.cnbc.com/2026/08/27/uae-spy-sheikh-trump-family-crypto-bank.html.

728 Fountain, 'UAE 'spy sheikh' backs 49% stake', https://www.cnbc.com/2026/08/27/uae-spy-sheikh-trump-family-crypto-bank.html.

president.[729][730] In May 2022 he returned, on a tour of the Gulf with the fighter Renzo Gracie, Sheikh Tahnoon's jiu-jitsu teacher, had a three-hour meeting with Mohammed bin Zayed that included a video call with Jair, met hosts who also included Bahrain's Nasser bin Hamad al-Khalifa, and publicly thanked Gracie for opening the doors of the palaces; Brazilian reporting treated the resulting meetings as a scandal in their own right.[731][732] In November 2021, in the wake of Jair's trip to the Gulf, Eduardo's institute, the Instituto Conservador-Liberal, sealed a cooperation memorandum with the Emirates Policy Center, an Abu Dhabi think tank that is formally independent but closely tied politically to the country's rulers; Eduardo and the institute's director, Sergio Sant'Ana, took part in a seminar of the centre and signed the agreement, which provides for information exchange and joint events.[733] A second Gracie made the American introduction: Royce Gracie, the first UFC champion turned lobbyist for the American gun industry, introduced Eduardo in Las Vegas in 2017 to two leading names in the National Rifle Association.[734]

The same Gracie reappears in business[735]. Lerco Consulting is registered in Abu Dhabi and owned in similar stakes of approximately 33% each by Renzo Gracie, the Frenchman Eric Leandri and Ludgero de Sousa; Lerco brokered the bid by Fictor and Royal Capital for Banco Master, and because a Brazilian contract must be signed with an individual taxpayer number

729 Administrador, *Relatório de Viagem referente à missão oficial para os Emirados Árabes*, *camara.leg.br*, 16 December 2019, https://www.camara.leg.br/missao-oficial/missao_oficial_Relatorio?codViagem=105640&ponto=811863.

730 Frazão, 'Renzo Gracie leva Eduardo Bolsonaro a', https://www.estadao.com.br/politica/renzo-gracie-abre-portas-para-eduardo-bolsonaro-no-oriente-medio/.

731 Frazão, 'Renzo Gracie leva Eduardo Bolsonaro a', https://www.estadao.com.br/politica/renzo-gracie-abre-portas-para-eduardo-bolsonaro-no-oriente-medio/.

732 Frazão, 'Renzo Gracie leva Eduardo Bolsonaro a', https://www.estadao.com.br/politica/renzo-gracie-abre-portas-para-eduardo-bolsonaro-no-oriente-medio/.

733 Fábio Zanini; Folhapress, 'Tour de Bolsonaro pelo Oriente Médio rende frutos ao instituto de seu filho Eduardo', *Folha PE - Noticias de politica, economia, esportes, cultura*, 24 November 2021, https://www.folhape.com.br/politica/tour-de-bolsonaro-pelo-oriente-medio-rende-frutos-ao-instituto-de-seu/206937/.

734 Frazão, 'Renzo Gracie leva Eduardo Bolsonaro a', https://www.estadao.com.br/politica/renzo-gracie-abre-portas-para-eduardo-bolsonaro-no-oriente-medio/.

735 Vassallo, 'Lutador Renzo Gracie diz ter orientado', https://www.estadao.com.br/economia/lutador-renzo-gracie-diz-ter-orientado-arabes-a-nao-comprarem-banco-master/.

(CPF), Leandri signed it with Gracie's.[736] Gracie's later account is that he advised the Abu Dhabi investors to walk away; it was given after the bank's liquidation and places him inside the transaction he was distancing himself from[737].

The corporate layer is visible in its own registers, and it leads to the top of the chain. Leandri runs Aleria, an artificial-intelligence company that the Abu Dhabi newspaper The National describes as "an affiliate of the International Holding Company chaired by Sheikh Tahnoon bin Zayed".[738] Aleria announced a partnership with IFZA, a company-formation group, which also presents it as an affiliate of the IHC group,[739] and an integration with e&, the Emirati telecommunications operator.[740] In a memorandum with Nexumous and REACH Group, a company acquired by the IHC group, Aleria committed to serving "IHC Group companies" with artificial intelligence and robotics.[741] IHC is chaired by Tahnoon,[742] and Ludgero de Sousa, Leandri's and Gracie's partner in Lerco, presented himself as Elytron's executive for Europe, the Middle East and Africa; Elytron now describes him as a commissioned partner.[743] Elytron Cybersecurity, a Brazilian firm whose branch in the Algarve had two employees in 2022, according to its chief executive, João Lucas Brasio,[744] to which Flávio Bolsonaro's

736 Vassallo, 'Lutador Renzo Gracie diz ter orientado', https://www.estadao.com.br/economia/lutador-renzo-gracie-diz-ter-orientado-arabes-a-nao-comprarem-banco-master/.

737 Vassallo, 'Lutador Renzo Gracie diz ter orientado', https://www.estadao.com.br/economia/lutador-renzo-gracie-diz-ter-orientado-arabes-a-nao-comprarem-banco-master/.

738 Salim A Essaid, 'UAE doubles down on US tech and AI ambitions amid Iran war', *The National*, 11 May 2026, https://www.thenationalnews.com/future/technology/2026/05/11/uae-doubles-down-on-us-tech-and-ai-ambitions-amid-iran-war/.

739 Mahvish Hameed, 'IFZA & Aleria Forge AI Partnership to Advance Digital Services', *IFZA*, 4 February 2026, https://ifza.com/en/ifza-aleria-ai-digital-services-partnership/.

740 'e& UAE Unleashes AI Power for SMBs with Aleria Integration', *TechAfrica News*, 11 February 2025, https://techafricanews.com/2025/02/11/e-uae-unleashes-ai-power-for-smbs-with-aleria-integration/.

741 Jorge Muñoz, 'Nexumous, Aleria and REACH Group Forge Strategic Partnership to Deliver Next-Generation AI-Robotics Solutions Across UAE', *Nexumous*, 13 November 2025, https://www.nexumous.ai/post/nexumous-aleria-and-reach-group-forge-strategic-partnership-to-deliver-next-generation-ai-robotics.

742 Goulart, 'EXCLUSIVO', https://www.intercept.com.br/2026/10/16/flavio-pagou-empresa-eua-sistema-manipular-eleicoes/.

743 Goulart, 'EXCLUSIVO', https://www.intercept.com.br/2026/10/16/flavio-pagou-empresa-eua-sistema-manipular-eleicoes/.

744 Inês Capucho, '"É inegável que vivemos diariamente uma guerra cibernética", diz especialista de segurança digital, João Lucas Brasio', *Observador*, 2 April 2022, https://observador.pt/especiais/e-inegavel-que-vivemos-diariamente-uma-guerra-cibernetica-

campaign declared R$600,000 in payments, booked as information-technology consultancy,[745] has a Portuguese entity 25 per cent owned by Jorge Remígio, who also presented himself as responsible for Europe, the Middle East and Africa and whom the company likewise now describes as a commissioned partner; Sousa is also a business director at Aleria, founded and presided over by Eric Leandri.[746]

The full chain, in public registers, runs as follows: Tahnoon chairs IHC; IHC counts Aleria as an affiliate; Leandri runs Aleria and is a partner in Lerco; Sousa is a partner in the same Lerco and was an Elytron executive; and Elytron is a declared supplier to Flávio's campaign. That the company sought to sell an artificial-intelligence influence system abroad rests on the account of a single US consultant, is denied by the company and by the campaign, and the element of that account that could be checked against a public register did not hold. The corporate chain does not depend on that account.

The top of the chain is also a direct link to Trump. In March 2025 Trump received Tahnoon, as the Emirates' national security adviser, in the Oval Office, and the Emirates then announced a $1.4 trillion, ten-year investment plan in the United States.[747] In January 2025 Tahnoon and other investors put $500 million into World Liberty Financial, the cryptocurrency company backed by the Trump family, in exchange for 49 per cent of it, and in 2026 sovereign capital tied to him came to stand behind 49 per cent of the same family's crypto bank.[748]

The Gulf's divergence is positional. Its interest is in being the point through which both sides route: it holds technology partnerships with the United States and trade with China at once, and it is not subordinate to the US core in the way a comprador fraction is (the part of the local bourgeoisie that profits from intermediating foreign capital). Participation is priced and revocable, and a contribution that can be withdrawn is a different instrument from one embedded in a fraction's accumulation.

Where the alliance does not hold

The material core of the 2026 realignment runs through none of the three nodes. It runs through US defence capital and Brazilian subsoil: the Pentagon's $750 million commitment to the vehicle holding a 15-year offtake contract for the whole of Serra Verde's first-phase

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diz-especialista-de-seguranca-digital-joao-lucas-brasio/.

745 Goulart, 'EXCLUSIVO', https://www.intercept.com.br/2026/10/16/flavio-pagou-empresa-eua-sistema-manipular-eleicoes/.

746 Goulart, 'EXCLUSIVO', https://www.intercept.com.br/2026/10/16/flavio-pagou-empresa-eua-sistema-manipular-eleicoes/.

747 U S Mission UAE, 'Thanks to President Trump, UAE Announces Significant Investments in U.S. Economy', *U.S. Embassy & Consulate in the United Arab Emirates*, 21 March 2025, https://ae.usembassy.gov/thanks-to-president-trump-uae-announces-significant-investments-in-u-s-economy/.

748 Fountain, 'UAE 'spy sheikh' backs 49% stake', https://www.cnbc.com/2026/08/27/uae-spy-sheikh-trump-family-crypto-bank.html.

magnetic rare earths;[749] the US development finance agency appearing in the resale prospectus as a selling stockholder with 15,221,917 shares;[750] Energy Fuels' 19 active processes at the national mining agency over the monazite sands of Prado, Caravelas and Alcobaça, on the coast of Bahia;[751][752] and the $620 million Pentagon loan to a magnet manufacturer, which a White House aide intervened to advance, in which a venture fund counting Donald Trump Jr. among its partners holds a stake, and to which Energy Fuels has agreed to supply separated oxides.[753][754] The Brazilian counter-move of September 2026, giving the executive the power to approve foreign participation, was aimed at that chain and at nothing the three nodes do.[755]

The bloc also divides over the instrument that assembled it. The sharpest attack on the tariff increase came from inside the coalition: Ciro Nogueira, president of the Progressistas party and a senator, said Eduardo Bolsonaro's conduct in the United States had caused very great damage to the right's 2026 prospects.[756][757] The objection concerned cost, not alignment. A biodiesel businessman split R$1 million between the two presidential campaigns,[758] which is

749 sec.gov, https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1970622/000121390026092810/ea030292401ex99-1.htm.

750 sec.gov, https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1970622/000121390026100977/ea0305798-424b3_usarare.htm.

751 Neri, 'Grupo ligado à campanha de Flávio', https://conjur.com.br/2026-set-22/grupo-dos-eua-ligado-a-campanha-de-flavio-bolsonaro-explora-terras-raras-na-bahia/.

752 Paulo Motoryn, 'Grupo dos EUA ligado a Flávio explora terras raras na Bahia', *Noites Húngaras*, 21 September 2026, https://paulomotoryn.substack.com/p/grupo-dos-eua-ligado-a-campanha-de.

753 Faturechi, 'The White House Intervened to Get', https://www.propublica.org/article/donald-trump-jr-vulcan-deal-white-house.

754 Vulcan Elements, 'Energy Fuels and Vulcan Elements Join', https://vulcanelements.com/company/updates/energy-fuels-and-vulcan-elements-join-forces-to-advance-u-s-rare-earth-magnet-security.

755 Spechoto, 'Lula sanciona lei dos minerais críticos', https://c-level.folha.uol.com.br/infraestrutura/2026/09/lula-sanciona-lei-dos-minerais-criticos-com-r-5-bi-em-subsidios-e-poder-de-decidir-sobre-estrangeiros.shtml.

756 Sadi, 'Ciro Nogueira diz que Eduardo Bolsonaro', https://g1.globo.com/politica/blog/andreia-sadi/post/2025/10/13/ciro-nogueira-eduardo-bolsonaro-eleicao-2026.ghtml.

757 Correio do Povo; Estadão Conteúdo, 'Eduardo Bolsonaro nos EUA foi prejuízo gigantesco para nosso projeto, diz Ciro Nogueira', *Correio do Povo*, 13 October 2025, https://www.correiodopovo.com.br/not%C3%ADcias/pol%C3%ADtica/eduardo-bolsonaro-nos-eua-foi-prejuizo-gigantesco-para-nosso-projeto-diz-ciro-nogueira-1.1658385.

758 Salgado, 'Empresário doa R$ 1 milhão às', https://www.metropoles.com/colunas/grande-angular/rei-do-biodiesel-doa-r-500-mil-a-campanha-de-lula.

what a capital group does when it is buying access to either outcome rather than to a government.

The asymmetry of legal exposure completes the picture. The Brazilian operators carry the convictions (Eduardo Bolsonaro was sentenced in June 2026 to four years and two months in prison and to ineligibility[759]), while no node and no node's principal faces a proceeding anywhere.

The reading that treats these gatherings as affinity networks rather than as a class project is not refuted by the gatherings themselves. It is refuted, where it is refuted, by the appointments, the embassy nights and the offtake contract. What the record also shows is that participation is priced: seats at the Hispanic Prosperity Gala at Mar-a-Lago ran from $10,000 to more than $100,000,[760] and the same circuit gave Cerimedo Latino Wall Street's consultant-of-the-year award in February 2026, handed to him on stage by Eduardo Bolsonaro.[761][762] Cerimedo was arrested in Santa Cruz, Bolivia, in August 2026 on suspicion of ordering the shooting of his former partner, an accusation his defence contests.[763] Entrance is bought and reputations circulate. That is the behaviour of an alliance with divergent material interests, and it is why the network is better described as an alliance than as a single class project with a Latin American agent.

Chapter conclusion

Three secondary nodes, three specific goods, three divergences. Israel takes payment in an embassy and a definition written into statute. The Iberosphere spends its own political capital and takes presence. The Gulf prices its participation as a transaction, reaches Trump through the top of the same chain that leads to Flávio's supplier, and can withdraw what it offers. None of the three takes orders from Washington, and none of the three is injured by the programme the campaign carried to the US trade authority; that absence of injury is the only coherence the bloc requires. What remains to be explained is not who gains but through what

759 Agência Brasil, 'STF condena Eduardo Bolsonaro a inelegibilidade', https://agenciabrasil.ebc.com.br/justica/noticia/2026-06/stf-condena-eduardo-bolsonaro-inelegibilidade-e-4-anos-de-prisao.

760 Caminos, 'Gaby WallStreet y Tony Delgado', https://www.eldiarioar.com/politica/gaby-wallstreet-tony-delgado-pareja-trumpista-vida-ricos-premio-cerimedo-lleva-milei-vez-ee-uu_1_13557463.html.

761 Mauricio Caminos, 'Gaby WallStreet y Tony Delgado: la pareja trumpista con vida de ricos que premió a Cerimedo y lleva a Milei otra vez a EE.UU.', *elDiarioAR*, 4 October 2026, https://www.eldiarioar.com/politica/gaby-wallstreet-tony-delgado-pareja-trumpista-vida-ricos-premio-cerimedo-lleva-milei-vez-ee-uu_1_13557463.html.

762 Plínio Teodoro, 'Eduardo Bolsonaro confirmou que Cerimedo ajudou tentativa de golpe de Jair e sinalizou ação com Flávio; veja vídeo', *Revista Fórum*, 24 August 2026, https://revistaforum.com.br/politica/eduardo-bolsonaro-cerimedo-ajudou-golpe-video/.

763 Rogero, 'Adviser to far-right Latin American leaders', https://www.theguardian.com/world/2026/aug/19/fernando-cerimedo-adviser-far-right-latin-american-leaders-arrested-allegedly-plotting-kill-girlfriend.

political form four incompatible rent streams fit inside one candidacy. That is the next chapter's question.

Chapter 08: The information machine: export, re-import and the manufacture of electoral inevitability

The preceding chapters traced money, rents, coercion and the secondary nodes of a transnational bloc. None of that explains how a programme that cannot be campaigned on becomes a candidacy that can be voted for. This chapter argues that the domestic hate apparatus and its foreign amplifiers form a single circuit rather than two separate spheres. Material produced inside Brazil is exported to platforms and broadcasters the Brazilian courts cannot reach, processed there into the idiom of independent verification, and returns to the country as proof. In 2022 the export commodity was the claim of fraud in the electronic voting machines, carried out of the country and returned as foreign analysis[764]. In 2026 it is a percentage: the odds of a betting site, carried in paid posts on X, that arrive in Brazilian feeds stripped of who paid for them[765]. What the circuit manufactures is not consent but inevitability (the sense that the outcome is already settled), and the first-round count is the only measurement in the sequence with a denominator, that is, a known universe of who was counted.

The playbook is declared

The templates are not hidden. The campaign's economic coordinator, Daniella Marques, said the government plan is inspired by the reforms Javier Milei carried out in Argentina, and the reporting on the plan describes it as a programme of spending cuts.[766] The plan's main banner is "a great tesouraço", a big cut that the reporting reads as a reference to Milei's chainsaw;[767] in Flávio's own words, "If Argentina had the chainsaw, Brazil will have a big pair of scissors for taxes, bureaucracy and corruption".[768] The launch opened with a recorded message from

764 Renata Galf, 'Argumentos de relatório golpista do PL apareceram antes em live de argentino', *Folha de S.Paulo*, 27 November 2022, https://www1.folha.uol.com.br/poder/2022/11/argumentos-de-relatorio-golpista-do-pl-apareceram-antes-em-live-de-argentino.shtml.

765 Ana Luiza Albuquerque, 'Influenciadores trumpistas divulgam propaganda paga a favor de Flávio Bolsonaro e de empresa de apostas', *Folha de S.Paulo*, 22 September 2026, https://www1.folha.uol.com.br/poder/2026/09/influenciadores-trumpistas-divulgam-propaganda-paga-a-favor-de-flavio-bolsonaro-e-de-empresa-de-apostas.shtml.

766 Economia Jb, 'Plano de Flávio Bolsonaro se inspira em Milei e prevê corte de gastos', *Jornal do Brasil*, 16 September 2026, https://www.jb.com.br/economia/2026/09/1060913-plano-de-flavio-bolsonaro-se-inspira-em-javier-milei-e-preve-corte-de-gastos.html.

767 Marcelo Montanini, 'O plano de Flávio para a economia é um cheque em branco?', *Nexo Jornal*, 24 September 2026, https://www.nexojornal.com.br/expresso/2026/09/24/flavio-bolsonaro-proposta-economica-ministra-economia-flavio.

Benjamin Netanyahu, and Milei flew to Brazil the night before the event and spoke in person.[769] The Salvadoran model was cultivated separately, when Flávio and Eduardo Bolsonaro met a minister of Nayib Bukele's government in San Salvador in November 2025.[770] The security plan, *Brasil sem Medo* ("Brazil without Fear"), provides for five maximum-security prisons on the El Salvador model,[771] and after meeting Bukele's justice minister, Gustavo Villatoro, in São Paulo on August 30, 2026, Flávio said it had been "a meeting that inspired us a great deal".[772] The Trump template is on the record in the form of the stage itself: in March 2026 Flávio spoke from the main platform of the American conservative conference, with seventeen sitting Brazilian parliamentarians in the audience.[773] A voter reading the platform and watching the launch is being told, in the open, which governments the candidate intends to imitate. What is not disclosed is the payment system, the customs union and the subsoil.

Those who studied the electorate, however, were Brazilians. Marcos Aurélio Carvalho, of the AM4 agency, which ran Jair Bolsonaro's digital campaign in 2018, coordinated a national qualitative study with 68 voter focus groups, built the campaign's data and digital monitoring structure, and positioned Flávio as a "more moderate and family-friendly" version of his father, before leaving the pre-campaign in May 2026 once, in his words, the diagnosis and positioning phase was complete.[774] The campaign strategist Duda Lima worked with three messages: the "anti-system" heir, the "transition president" for a centre tired of the Workers' Party (PT), and a moral tie with Lula built on the INSS case, the fraud scandal at the national

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768 Martha Beck; Bloomberg; James Grainger, 'Milei's chainsaw inspires Bolsonaro to wield scissors in Brazil election', *Buenos Aires Times*, 21 September 2026, https://www.batimes.com.ar/news/latin-america/mileis-chainsaw-inspires-bolsonaro-to-wield-scissors-in-brazil-election.phtml.

769 AFP; AP; Reuters, 'Bolsonaro's son begins Brazil presidential bid with Netanyahu, Milei kudos', *Al Jazeera*, 26 July 2026, https://www.aljazeera.com/news/2026/7/26/bolsonaros-son-begins-brazil-presidential-bid-with-netanyahu-milei-kudos.

770 Pedro Grigori, 'Flávio e Eduardo Bolsonaro encontram ministro de Bukele em El Salvador', *Metrópoles*, 19 November 2025, https://www.metropoles.com/brasil/flavio-e-eduardo-bolsonaro-encontram-ministro-de-bukele-em-el-salvador.

771 Da redação, 'Maioridade penal, castração e mais: entenda plano de Flávio para segurança', *Band*, 18 June 2026, https://www.band.com.br/politica/eleicoes/maioridade-castracao-quimica-e-mais-entenda-o-plano-brasil-sem-medo-de-flavio-bolsonaro.

772 'Flávio se reúne com ministro da Justiça de Bukele e se diz inspirado', *Poder360*, 30 August 2026, https://www.poder360.com.br/poder-eleicoes-2026/flavio-se-reune-com-ministro-da-justica-de-bukele-e-se-diz-inspirado/.

773 SGBR, 'Brasil é destaque em evento da', https://sleepinggiantsbrasil.com/saiba-como-foi-a-participacao-brasileira-no-maior-evento-da-extrema-direita-global/.

774 Jussara Soares, 'Estrategista digital é nova baixa na campanha de Flávio', *CNN Brasil*, 26 May 2026, https://www.cnnbrasil.com.br/blogs/jussara-soares/eleicoes/estrategista-digital-e-nova-baixa-na-campanha-de-flavio/.

social security institute.[775] It was also Duda Lima who conceived “TV Celular” (“Mobile TV”), Flávio’s YouTube channel with a schedule of live broadcasts 24 hours a day.[776] The method resembles the package American consultants sell, but the suppliers are Brazilian; what is visible is a similarity of method, not an imported service.

The organisational form is older than the candidacy. In February 2019 Eduardo Bolsonaro announced in a statement that he was “very proud” to join Steve Bannon as leader in South America of The Movement, Bannon’s international network.[777][778] It was a licence granted to a person, and therefore transferable in a way that an office is not. Eduardo had met Bannon personally in early August 2018, on the eve of that year’s election campaign, and the association became a public one from there.[779] The meeting took place in New York,[780] and the bridge to Bannon was Gerald Brant, a financial-market executive in New York whom Veja described as responsible for the Bolsonaro family’s link with Bannon.[781] The channel the licence ran on was a platform: Gettr financed the CPAC Brasil and *Brasil Profundo* events that functioned as pre-campaign.[782]

The enforcement problem is structural rather than incidental. When a justice of the Supreme Federal Court (STF) suspended Telegram in March 2022, the order reached an application the press described as a key Bolsonaro platform; whether a Brazilian court’s order binds a

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775 Beto Bombig; Autor no JOTA, ‘Sob Duda Lima, Flávio Bolsonaro afina discurso e encontra rumo para sua campanha’, *JOTA Jornalismo*, 21 August 2026, https://www.jota.info/eleicoes/eleicoes-2026/sob-duda-lima-flavio-bolsonaro-afina-discurso-e-encontra-rumo-para-sua-campanha.

776 Vinicius Passarelli, ‘O que tinha que fazer, foi feito”, diz marqueteiro de Flávio Bolsonaro’, *Metrópoles*, 4 October 2026, https://www.metropoles.com/colunas/vinicius-passarelli/o-que-tinha-que-fazer-foi-feito-diz-marqueteiro-de-flavio-bolsonaro.

777 Movement, ‘Steve Bannon Welcomes Eduardo Bolsonaro as’, https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/steve-bannon-welcomes-eduardo-bolsonaro-as-head-of-the-movement-in-south-america-300788579.html.

778 Bilenky, ‘Bannon anuncia Eduardo Bolsonaro como líder’, https://www1.folha.uol.com.br/mundo/2019/02/bannon-anuncia-eduardo-bolsonaro-como-lider-sul-americano-de-movimento-de-ultradireita.shtml.

779 Breiller Pires, ‘Os laços do clã Bolsonaro com Steve Bannon’, *El País Brasil*, 20 August 2020, https://brasil.elpais.com/brasil/2020-08-20/os-lacos-do-cla-bolsonaro-com-steve-bannon.html.

780 Pires, ‘Os laços do clã Bolsonaro com’, https://brasil.elpais.com/brasil/2020-08-20/os-lacos-do-cla-bolsonaro-com-steve-bannon.html.

781 Braun, ‘Eduardo Bolsonaro se reúne com Steve’, https://veja.abril.com.br/politica/eduardo-bolsonaro-se-reune-com-steve-bannon-em-washington/.

782 Maciel, ‘Rede social trumpista patrocina eventos que’, https://apublica.org/2022/06/rede-social-trumpista-patrocina-eventos-que-fazem-pre-campanha-para-bolsonaro/.

channel operated from outside the country is precisely the question on which the whole circuit depends.[783] The instrument's value lies less in what it says than in where it says it.

What the domestic machine produces

The production side is documented at the level of named officials and named programmes. The Federal Police (PF) final report on the "parallel Abin", an unofficial intelligence operation run inside the Brazilian Intelligence Agency, identified Carlos Bolsonaro as the idealiser of both the "hate office" and the parallel intelligence scheme,[784] and concluded that father and son defined the targets and the strategies of the scheme.[785] In February 2022 the Federal Police delegate Denisse Ribeiro had already informed the Supreme Federal Court that the digital militia under investigation acted through the self-styled "hate office", which produced content to attack targets chosen in advance by the group.[786] The Planalto always officially denied that a "hate office" existed.[787] The Israeli geolocation system at its centre, a tool supplied by the firm Cognyte and run through signalling-network vulnerabilities, was used for more than 60,000 location searches against targets who included Supreme Court justices, the president of the Chamber of Deputies and investigative journalists, as the reporting that reconstructed the chain end to end sets out.[788][789] In July 2020, Facebook had

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783 News Wires, 'Brazil Supreme Court judge suspends Telegram messaging app, a key Bolsonaro platform', *France 24*, 19 March 2022, https://www.france24.com/en/americas/20220319-brazil-supreme-court-judge-suspends-messaging-app-telegram-a-key-bolsonaro-platform.

784 'Relatório da PF aponta Carlos Bolsonaro como idealizador da 'Abin paralela' e do 'gabinete do ódio', *Valor Econômico*, 18 June 2025, https://valor.globo.com/politica/noticia/2025/06/18/relatorio-da-pf-aponta-carlos-bolsonaro-como-idealizador-da-abin-paralela-e-do-gabinete-do-odio.ghtml.

785 BBC News Brasil, 'Bolsonaro e Carlos definiam alvos e estratégias da 'Abin paralela', diz PF', *BBC News Brasil*, 17 June 2025, https://www.bbc.com/portuguese/articles/c7vr50q6999o.

786 Fabio Serapião, 'PF cita atuação de Bolsonaro e afirma ao STF que milícia digital usa gabinete do ódio', *Folha de S.Paulo*, 10 February 2022, https://www1.folha.uol.com.br/poder/2022/02/pf-diz-ao-stf-que-milicia-digital-usa-gabinete-do-odio-e-delegada-se-licencia.shtml.

787 Por Lisandra Paraguassu E Jack Stubbs, 'Facebook liga assessor de Bolsonaro a fake news; PT pedirá que TSE use relatório em ação', *Reuters Japan*, 9 July 2020, https://www.reuters.com/article/facebook-liga-assessor-de-bolsonaro-a-fake-news-pt-pedir-que-tse-use-relatrio-idUSKBN24A35K/.

788 Thiago Domenici, 'Abin Paralela, como tudo se conecta: espionagem, FirstMile, Bolsonaros e Ramagem', *Agência Pública*, 17 June 2025, https://apublica.org/2025/06/abin-paralela-como-tudo-se-conecta-espionagem-firstmile-bolsonaros-e-ramagem/.

789 Domenici, 'Abin Paralela, como tudo se conecta', https://apublica.org/2025/06/abin-paralela-como-tudo-se-conecta-espionagem-firstmile-bolsonaros-e-ramagem/.

removed a network linked to employees of the offices of Jair, Eduardo and Flávio Bolsonaro, and the forensic analysis of that network described coordinated inauthentic behaviour.[790] According to Facebook, the network comprised 35 Facebook accounts, 14 pages, one group and 38 Instagram accounts.[791] Tércio Arnaud Tomaz came out of the Bolsonaro family's circle to become the operator known in the Brazilian press as the "rapaz das redes", the social-media boy, working directly in the Planalto palace inside the group that became known as the *gabinete do ódio*, the hate office.[792] Arnaud later told the Federal Police that no structure of that kind had existed and that he had worked only on the president's social accounts.[793] Cognyte's Brazilian footprint was not confined to the agency: reporting has documented the same family of tools across nine states.[794]

The 2026 edition is more industrial. The party's own platform, *Direita Já*, supplies thirty to fifty new attack pieces a week to a declared network of influencers, was built by the developer who made *LulaFlix* in 2022 and was fined for irregular campaign propaganda, and routes WhatsApp sign-ups through a company in which Pablo Marçal's holding became a partner.[795] That developer is a Brazilian agency, Magic Beans, whose owner had been fined by the electoral court in 2023 over the earlier *LulaFlix* site.[796] The numbers give the scale. In September the site held more than 600 pieces divided into 27 categories.[797] More than 200

790 @DFRLab, 'Facebook removes inauthentic network linked to Bolsonaro allies', *Medium*, 8 July 2020, https://medium.com/dfrlab/facebook-removes-inauthentic-network-linked-to-bolsonaro-allies-5927b0ae750d.

791 Chandler Thornton; Rodrigo Pedroso, 'Facebook shuts down fake accounts tied to Bolsonaro staffers', *CNN*, 9 July 2020, https://www.cnn.com/2020/07/09/americas/brazil-bolsonaro-facebook-fake-accounts-intl.

792 Afonso Benites, 'Tércio Arnaud, o "rapaz das redes" de Bolsonaro no centro da trama desbaratada pelo Facebook', *El País Brasil*, 9 July 2020, https://brasil.elpais.com/brasil/2020-07-10/tercio-arnaud-o-rapaz-das-redes-de-bolsonaro-no-centro-da-trama-desbaratada-pelo-facebook.html.

793 Pablo Giovanni, 'À PF, ex-assessor de Bolsonaro nega existência de "gabinete do ódio', *Metrópoles*, 4 July 2025, https://www.metropoles.com/brasil/a-pf-ex-assessor-de-bolsonato-nega-existencia-de-gabinete-do-odio.

794 Laura Scofield; Rubens Valente; Caio de Freitas, 'Cognyte: Além da Abin, empresa de espionagem atua em 9 estados', *Agência Pública*, 20 October 2023, https://apublica.org/2023/10/como-empresa-de-espionagem-israelense-alvo-da-pf-se-espalhou-pelo-poder-publico-no-brasil/.

795 Abreu, 'Site do PL, que propaga ataques', https://revistaforum.com.br/politica/direita-ja-pablo-marcal-pl-lula/.

796 Abreu, 'Site do PL, que propaga ataques', https://revistaforum.com.br/politica/direita-ja-pablo-marcal-pl-lula/.

797 Carol Macário; Ethel Rudnitzki, 'PL distribui conteúdos de campanha com alegações falsas e ataques a adversários • Lupa', *Lupa*, 3 September 2026, https://www.agencialupa.org/jornalismo/2026/09/03/pl-distribui-conteudos-de-campanha-

partners were already receiving weekly guidance and exclusive content before public release.[798] The platform created at least 900 WhatsApp groups to distribute the material and sent them at least ten pieces of disinformation against Lula.[799] Of the more than 350 images available on the site, about four in ten were made with artificial intelligence.[800] That is a supply chain: production, packaging, distribution, and a messaging layer that carries the product past platform moderation.

The export

What leaves the country is not the material but the argument. The route was opened before 2022. According to Bannon himself, in an interview with the BBC, Eduardo attended the "cyber symposium" that Mike Lindell, a businessman who spread the fraud claim against Trump's defeat, held in South Dakota in August 2021, and presented there Bolsonarism's concerns about the electronic voting machines.[801][802] On October 3, 2022, hours after the first round, Bannon's *War Room* put the electronic-voting fraud claim into circulation, joined by Matthew Tyrmand and Darren Beattie, with Bannon claiming a Bolsonaro defeat was "mathematically impossible" because his party had won eight seats in the simultaneous Senate election and become the largest bloc.[803] The choice of venue is the mechanism. A claim made on a Brazilian channel is subject to the electoral courts; a claim made on an American podcast is not, and it can be clipped, translated and re-posted into Brazilian Telegram groups as though it had arrived from outside the contest. The slogans that came out of that circuit, "Brazil Was Stolen", "Brazilian Spring", were coined by a transnational initiative, and the material moved on Telegram channels, in part as a way around the electoral court's restrictions on the Brazilians who were promoting it at home.[804]

The figure who performs that translation is the operator who built the original audience for it. Allan dos Santos, described in the American press as the fake-news kingpin of the Bolsonarist

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com-alegacoes-falsas-e-ataques-a-adversarios/.

798 Vinicios Souza, 'Campanha de Flávio cria plataforma para mobilizar influenciadores e distribuir conteúdos contra Lula', *ND Mais*, 23 July 2026, https://ndmais.com.br/politica/campanha-flavio-cria-plataforma-influenciadores-pl/.

799 Diario do Centro do Mundo, 'Plataforma ligada à campanha de Flávio Bolsonaro enviou desinformação em grupos de WhatsApp', *Diário do Centro do Mundo*, 3 October 2026, https://www.diariodocentrodomundo.com.br/plataforma-ligada-a-campanha-de-flavio-enviou-fake-news-contra-lula-no-whatsapp/.

800 Ethel Rudnitzki, 'Site ligado a Flávio Bolsonaro disponibilizou 140 imagens geradas por IA a eleitores; 15% sem aviso • Lupa', *Lupa*, 15 September 2026, https://www.agencialupa.org/eleicoes/2026/09/15/pl-inteligencia-artificial/.

801 Sanches, 'Steve Bannon', https://www.bbc.com/portuguese/brasil-62944023.

802 Pública, 'Quem são os aliados do clã', https://www.cartacapital.com.br/politica/quem-sao-os-aliados-do-cla-bolsonaro-na-extrema-direita-dos-eua/.

803 Silverstein, 'How the US far-Right is acting', https://apublica.org/2022/09/how-the-us-far-right-is-acting-to-get-bolsonaro-re-elected-in-brazil/.

ecosystem, who has written and broadcast from the United States since the Brazilian courts moved against him, is the node through which the exported claim returns as a domestic product.[805] The loop is not a metaphor: the same person who supplies the domestic audience supplies the re-import, and the passport between the two ends is a jurisdiction the court order does not reach.

The circuit has a documented precedent outside Brazil. The media network Bannon built with the Chinese billionaire Guo Wengui, the financier of Gettr (chapter 3), spread disinformation about electoral fraud in the United States, about Covid and about the QAnon conspiracy theory, with content translated into Portuguese among other languages, according to the reference study on the network, published by the research firm Graphika in 2021.[806] In July 2024 the government of Singapore ordered platforms to block 95 accounts linked to Guo and his organisations, after a coordinated campaign about the succession in the country's government, citing the same study.[807] On Gettr's activity in Brazil there is no published study, only press reporting and court records.

The Telegram network

On Telegram the Bolsonaro family has a large and uneven presence. On October 19, 2026, Jair's channel had 1.04 million subscribers but had published nothing since July 17, 2025.[808] The largest active Bolsonarist channel is that of Nikolas Ferreira, with about 245,000 subscribers, followed by those of Carlos, with 108,000, Flávio, with 90,000, and Eduardo, with 61,000.[809][810][811][812] The family's content is distributed by Carlos: between October 6 and 18, 2026, eleven of his channel's posts pointed to Flávio's channel, six of them asking readers

804 Marcelo Zanotti, 'Como uma rede internacional de desinformadores ajudou a tentativa de golpe no Brasil', *ihu.unisinos.br*, 12 August 2023, https://www.ihu.unisinos.br/categorias/631363-como-uma-rede-internacional-de-desinformadores-ajudou-a-tentativa-de-golpe-no-brasil.

805 Paula Ramón, 'The fake-news kingpin of Brazil', *Columbia Journalism Review*, 13 April 2022, https://www.cjr.org/analysis/brazil-bolsonaro-lula-allan-dos-santos.php.

806 public-assets.graphika.com, 'Ants in a Web', https://public-assets.graphika.com/reports/graphika_report_ants_in_a_web.pdf.

807 Ministry of Home Affairs, 'Issuance of Account Restriction Directions Under', https://www.mha.gov.sg/media-room/newsroom/issuance-of-account-restriction-directions-under-the-foreign-interference-countermeasures-act-2021-against-95-social-media-accounts-linked-to-a-foreign-network/.

808 Jair M. Bolsonaro, 'Jair M. Bolsonaro 1 (@jairbolsonarobrasil), public channel preview', *Telegram*, 19 October 2026, https://t.me/s/jairbolsonarobrasil.

809 Nikolas Ferreira, 'Nikolas Ferreira (@nikolasferreira), public channel preview', *Telegram*, 19 October 2026, https://t.me/s/nikolasferreira.

810 Carlos Bolsonaro, 'CARLOS BOLSONARO (@BolsonaroCarlos), public channel preview, posts of 1 August to 18 October 2026', *Telegram*, 19 October 2026, https://t.me/s/BolsonaroCarlos.

outright to follow it, usually together with Eduardo's and, in three posts from October 15 to 17, Jair's as well; and between August and October the channel asked its subscribers four times to follow Carlos on Gettr.[813] The channels of Flávio and Eduardo, by contrast, forwarded no posts from other channels in the periods captured.

The most visible bridge abroad runs through the channel of Bannon's *War Room*, with about 51,000 subscribers, in English[814]. Between October 3 and 18, 2026, it published at least thirteen posts about Brazil, most of them hostile to Lula. Among them were clips of Allan dos Santos calling Lula a "CCP puppet" and saying, without presenting evidence, that Lula and his "regime" interfered in the election "to stop Bolsonaro from winning outright in the first round" and that "vote counts were stopped"; two clips of Paulo Figueiredo; and a post headed "Lula Works to Steal Brazil's Election" that linked to a Polymarket post on X.[815] These are Brazilians living in the United States speaking to an American audience, and the fraud claim returns to Brazil after passing through Bannon's channel.

The movement repeats that of 2022. In the hours after Bolsonaro's defeat, Bannon coined the slogan #BrazilianSpring, which became one of the most used rallying cries among the supporters who openly planned the January 8 attack online.[816] The Atlantic Council's DFRLab found Telegram channels with "BrazilWasStolen" and "Brazilianspring" in their names, and copies of a broadcast by Fernando Cerimedo against the voting machines, made private on YouTube, circulated on the platform.[817] The Brazilian courts acted on the platform: besides the suspension of March 2022,[818] the Superior Electoral Court (TSE) ordered Telegram, on the eve of the second round, to remove groups carrying attacks on the voting

811 Flávio Bolsonaro, 'FLÁVIO BOLSONARO (@senadorflaviobolsonaro), public channel preview, posts of 1 September to 19 October 2026', *Telegram*, 19 October 2026, https://t.me/s/senadorflaviobolsonaro.

812 Eduardo Bolsonaro, 'Eduardo Bolsonaro (@depeduardobolsonaro), public channel preview, posts of 2 June to 17 October 2026', *Telegram*, 19 October 2026, https://t.me/s/depeduardobolsonaro.

813 Carlos Bolsonaro, 'CARLOS BOLSONARO (@BolsonaroCarlos), public channel preview, posts of 1 August to 18 October 2026', *Telegram*, 19 October 2026, https://t.me/s/BolsonaroCarlos.

814 Friedman, 'Scoop', https://www.motherjones.com/politics/2024/02/gettr-guo-layoffs/.

815 War Room, 'WarRoom: Official Telegram Channel (@BannonWarRoom), public channel preview, posts of 1 to 19 October 2026', *Telegram*, 19 October 2026, https://t.me/s/BannonWarRoom.

816 Joshua Goodman; David Klepper, 'Pro-Bolsonaro rioters in Brazil plotted openly online, promising a huge 'party', *Los Angeles Times*, 12 January 2023, https://www.latimes.com/world-nation/story/2023-01-12/brazil-bolsonaro-capital-rioters-plotted-openly-online.

817 DFRLab, 'Election fraud narratives surge on Brazilian Twitter following Bolsonaro defeat', *DFRLab*, 18 November 2022, https://dfrlab.org/2022/11/18/election-fraud-narratives-surge-on-brazilian-twitter-following-bolsonaro-defeat/.

machines and messages about political violence.[819] A study by NetLab, a laboratory at the Federal University of Rio de Janeiro (UFRJ), for the Mozilla Foundation followed 864 Telegram groups linked to Brazilian politics and concluded that the most connected channel in the sample was a conservative religious channel, the “Foro Conservador Cristão do Brasil”, and that most of the channels with the greatest influence on the network were openly pro-Bolsonaro.[820]

The re-import

In 2026 the same loop runs on numbers. Polymarket took a strategic investment from 1789 Capital and put Donald Trump Jr. on its advisory board,[821] and the federal investigations that US prosecutors and the Commodity Futures Trading Commission had been running against the platform were dropped in July 2025.[822][823] Foreign accounts carrying X’s “paid partnership” label then published the site’s odds on the Brazilian election as evidence of a Flávio Bolsonaro lead,[824] and the posts were traced to the same transnational network that carries the rest of the operation.[825] Brazil’s Finance Ministry and the telecommunications regulator, Anatel, moved against unauthorised betting sites in April 2026, and the promotional

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818 Wires, ‘Brazil Supreme Court judge suspends Telegram’, https://www.france24.com/en/americas/20220319-brazil-supreme-court-judge-suspends-messaging-app-telegram-a-key-bolsonaro-platform.

819 ‘TSE manda Telegram remover grupos com mensagens sobre violência política’, *G1*, 28 October 2022, https://g1.globo.com/politica/eleicoes/2022/noticia/2022/10/28/tse-manda-telegram-remover-grupos-com-mensagens-sobre-violencia-politica.ghtml.

820 ‘Election Manipulation in Brazil’s 2022 General Elections’, *Mozilla Foundation*, 27 February 2024, https://www.mozillafoundation.org/en/research/library/global-elections-casebook/brazil-case-study/.

821 Polymarket, ‘Polymarket Receives Strategic Investment from 1789’, https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/polymarket-receives-strategic-investment-from-1789-capital-and-welcomes-donald-trump-jr-to-advisory-board-302538997.html.

822 Nikhilesh De; Nikhilesh-De, ‘U.S. Prosecutors, CFTC Drop Polymarket Investigations’, *CoinDesk*, 15 July 2025, https://www.coindesk.com/policy/2025/07/15/us-prosecutors-cftc-drop-polymarket-investigations.

823 Nikhilesh-De, ‘U.S. Prosecutors, CFTC Drop Polymarket Investigations’, https://www.coindesk.com/policy/2025/07/15/us-prosecutors-cftc-drop-polymarket-investigations.

824 José Augusto Limão; Álvaro Luiz, ‘Perfis de fora do Brasil têm posts pagos para apontar favoritismo de Flávio’, *Metrópoles*, 21 September 2026, https://www.metropoles.com/brasil/perfis-de-fora-do-brasil-tem-posts-pagos-para-apontar-favoritismo-de-flavio.

825 Aosfatos, ‘Posts pró-Flávio no X expõem elo’, https://www.aosfatos.org/noticias/posts-pro-flavio-elo-polymarket-rede-transnacional-desinformacao/.

posts, as the reporting notes, carry no direct link inviting the reader onto the platform, which is what makes the object portable and the blocking order irrelevant.[826]

What Polymarket is

Polymarket is a site for betting on real-world events, such as elections, wars and government decisions[827]. The price of each bet works as an estimate of the probability of an outcome, which is why the site is cited as though it were a poll, although it is not one: it reflects the money of those who bet, not the opinion of the electorate, and it discloses neither a sample nor a margin of error. The 1789 Capital fund, in which Donald Trump Jr. is a partner, invested in the company, and Trump Jr. joined its advisory board[828]. In Brazil the site has been banned since April 2026[829].

The ban did not take the site out of the election. Up to August 24, Polymarket's Brazilian Instagram profile made 103 posts about the election, some of them in collaboration with 15 gossip, meme and football profiles, none of which disclosed whether the post was paid, as the law requires for advertising.[830] The communications agency FSB, which began serving the company in 2026, confirmed that the profile belonged to Polymarket and said the company "has no team in Brazil, only occasional service providers"; the profile's most frequent partner, Bruno Richards, of the site Not Journal, presented himself on LinkedIn as a Polymarket employee and, at an event in Rio, as its "country manager", the person in charge of operations in the country.[831] Between September 18 and 21, at least eleven foreign accounts published posts on X with the "paid partnership" label about Flávio's lead in the betting, without

826 Mendonça, 'Apesar de proibição, Polymarket promove apostas', https://nucleo.jor.br/reportagem/2026/09/03/apesar-de-proibicao-polymarket-divulga-apostas-sobre-eleicoes-brasileiras/.

827 Chris Prentice; Jason Lange, 'EXCLUSIVE: Most Americans oppose betting on elections, government events, Reuters/Ipsos poll finds', *Reuters*, 12 October 2026, https://www.reuters.com/world/most-americans-oppose-betting-elections-government-events-reutersipsos-poll-2026-10-12/.

828 Factchequeado, 'Javier Negre y La Derecha Diario: cómo expandió su red de medios entre América Latina y Estados Unidos', *Chequeado*, 24 September 2026, https://chequeado.com/investigaciones/javier-negre-y-la-derecha-diario-como-expandio-su-red-de-medios-entre-america-latina-y-estados-unidos/.

829 Marcela Ayres; Lisandra Paraguassu, 'Brazil blocks prediction platforms, tightens rules to curb 'bet-like' products', *Reuters*, 24 April 2026, https://www.reuters.com/world/americas/brazil-blocks-prediction-platforms-tightens-rules-curb-bet-like-products-2026-04-24/.

830 Mendonça, 'Apesar de proibição, Polymarket promove apostas', https://nucleo.jor.br/reportagem/2026/09/03/apesar-de-proibicao-polymarket-divulga-apostas-sobre-eleicoes-brasileiras/.

831 Mendonça, 'Apesar de proibição, Polymarket promove apostas', https://nucleo.jor.br/reportagem/2026/09/03/apesar-de-proibicao-polymarket-divulga-apostas-sobre-eleicoes-brasileiras/.

identifying who paid; among them were the former Republican congressman Matt Gaetz, UHN Plus, which describes itself as “powered by Polymarket”, and the Visegrád 24 profile.[832][833][834] Flávio and at least nine allied candidates from the PL (Bolsonaro’s Liberal Party) and the Novo party circulated the betting charts as though they were electoral polls; Flávio himself reposted one of them in an Instagram Story on September 21.[835]

The profiles that spread the odds have owners and funders who recur. DonorsTrust, a donor-advised fund for American conservative donors that allows giving without appearing, recorded in its tax return a grant of $175,000 to the Intermarium Foundation, the US-registered tax-exempt non-profit that runs Visegrád 24, with the stated purpose “to support Visegrad24”.[836][837][838] The Spaniard Javier Negre is co-owner and vice-president of UHN Plus, co-owner of La Derecha Diario and partner of Visegrád 24 in the profile’s Spanish-language edition, and was a business partner of Fernando Cerimedo.[839]

The mechanism needs precision, because the easy version of the critique is wrong. A percentage produced by bettors is not a falsehood; it is a different kind of object from a poll. What the paid post does is make the object’s production invisible. The reader sees a number and a chart; the reader does not see the invoice, the label, or the fact that the chart was purchased. A poll discloses its sample and its margin of error; a contract price discloses nothing, and is treated as though it had.

Read against the vote

Flávio Bolsonaro led the first round with 47.03 per cent of the valid vote.[840] The odds were therefore not wrong about the direction of the result, and any argument that rests on their being wrong should be discarded. What they did was narrower and more consequential: they

832 Aosfatos, ‘Posts pró-Flávio no X expõem elo’, https://www.aosfatos.org/noticias/posts-pro-flavio-elo-polymarket-rede-transnacional-desinformacao/.

833 Abreu, ‘Como atua a rede estrangeira ligada’, https://revistaforum.com.br/politica/rede-trump-campanha-flavio-bolsonaro/.

834 Abreu, ‘Como atua a rede estrangeira ligada’, https://revistaforum.com.br/politica/rede-trump-campanha-flavio-bolsonaro/.

835 ‘Flávio Bolsonaro e aliados divulgam apostas do Polymarket como pesquisa eleitoral’, *Aosfatos*, 3 September 2026, https://www.aosfatos.org/noticias/flavio-bolsonaro-e-aliados-divulgam-apostas-do-polymarket-como-pesquisa-eleitoral/.

836 Abreu, ‘Como atua a rede estrangeira ligada’, https://revistaforum.com.br/politica/rede-trump-campanha-flavio-bolsonaro/.

837 Cieśla, ‘Unmasking Visegrád24’, https://vsquare.org/unmasking-visegrad24-tracing-the-people-money-and-political-ties/.

838 Cieśla, ‘Unmasking Visegrád24’, https://vsquare.org/unmasking-visegrad24-tracing-the-people-money-and-political-ties/.

839 Abreu, ‘Como atua a rede estrangeira ligada’, https://revistaforum.com.br/politica/rede-trump-campanha-flavio-bolsonaro/.

anticipated the outcome, in a form that could not be audited, before the only measurement in the sequence that had a denominator had taken place. The scale of the domestic operation behind that result is on the record: the campaign declared about R$65 million in first-round spending, and the overwhelming majority of its revenue came from the party's own national directorate, not from foreign donors.[841] Forty-seven per cent is a count of ballots. Fifty-eight per cent, the figure Polymarket announced for Flávio on September 20, two weeks before the first round, was a market price, read as a probability.[842][843] The order in which the two numbers reached the public is the whole of the political effect, and the gap between them measures how much of the "inevitability" was manufactured rather than observed.

The vendor

The figure who sells the machinery is the circuit's most legible node. Fernando Cerimedo announced that he would represent, across Latin America, Brad Parscale's Campaign Nucleus and EyesOver technologies,[844] received Latino Wall Street's consultant-of-the-year award on stage at Mar-a-Lago from Eduardo Bolsonaro, and was described by Eduardo in a recorded statement as having helped the coup attempt.[845] Parscale has argued that the tools from Campaign Nucleus and EyesOver helped his clients in Bolivia and Honduras, and a consultant tied to Trump's campaigns assisted a Honduran presidential candidate in 2025.[846] In August 2026 Cerimedo was arrested in Bolivia and accused of ordering the attempted

840 'Flávio Bolsonaro (PL) e Lula (PT) vão disputar o 2º turno para a Presidência da República', *Tribunal Superior Eleitoral*, 5 October 2026, https://www.tse.jus.br/comunicacao/noticias/2026/Outubro/flavio-bolsonaro-e-lula-vao-disputar-o-2o-turno-para-a-presidencia-da-republica.

841 Lambiazzi, 'Flávio Bolsonaro já gastou quase R$', https://folhadealphaville.com.br/politica/2026/09/08/flavio-bolsonaro-ja-gastou-quase-r-50-milhoes-em-campanha-veja-principais-despesas.html.

842 Jeniffer Mendonça; Núcleo Jornalismo, 'Flávio Bolsonaro e aliados podem confundir eleitores ao divulgar apostas do Polymarket como pesquisa eleitoral', *Agência Pública*, 24 September 2026, https://apublica.org/2026/09/flavio-bolsonaro-e-aliados-divulgam-apostas-do-polymarket-como-pesquisa-eleitoral/.

843 Abreu, 'Como atua a rede estrangeira ligada', https://revistaforum.com.br/politica/rede-trump-campanha-flavio-bolsonaro/.

844 Abreu, 'Como atua a rede estrangeira ligada', https://revistaforum.com.br/politica/rede-trump-campanha-flavio-bolsonaro/.

845 Teodoro, 'Eduardo Bolsonaro confirmou que Cerimedo ajudou', https://revistaforum.com.br/politica/eduardo-bolsonaro-cerimedo-ajudou-golpe-video/.

846 The San Juan Daily Star, 'Trump's former campaign manager assisted Honduran presidential candidate', *San Juan Daily Star*, 5 December 2025, https://www.sanjuandailystar.com/post/trump-s-former-campaign-manager-assisted-honduran-presidential-candidate.

killing of his former partner; the charge is contested and is not a judicial finding.[847][848] The profile published by the Brazilian investigative press at the time of the arrest sets out who he is and what his consultancy consists of.[849]

That record supports a structural reading and limits it at the same time. A vendor who is also, on the prosecutors' account, a principal in a violent crime unrelated to the campaign is not a disciplined instrument of anybody's foreign policy. He is a supplier who sells to buyers, and the buyers' leverage over him is the price of the contract.

What the circuit does not explain

Casarões and Belém Lopes have made the transnational partisan dimension of Brazilian foreign policy a subject in its own right, treating the international channel as structure rather than ornament.[850] That accounts well for the payment system, the minerals memorandum and the tariff diplomacy of the earlier chapters. What it does not account for is the vote. The comparative literature on the far-right alignment documents its consolidation and its endurance beyond its founder's electoral fortunes.[851] The 2026 first round confirms the point from the other direction: the votes were produced by a party machine financed with public party funds and by Brazilian voters, not by anything purchased abroad.

So the foreign layer did not buy the votes. It supplied something the party machine could not manufacture on its own: the appearance that the outcome had already been settled elsewhere, and therefore that resisting it was futile. That is a real effect, and a weaker one than command.

Chapter conclusion

The circuit works because each of its parts is deniable on its own terms. A sponsorship is a commercial contract; a paid post is advertising; a podcast is commentary; a betting site is a market. Only the sequence makes them an instrument, and the sequence is not visible from inside any single transaction. What that produces is not a majority but the sense that a

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847 Rogero, 'Adviser to far-right Latin American leaders', https://www.theguardian.com/world/2026/aug/19/fernando-cerimedo-adviser-far-right-latin-american-leaders-arrested-allegedly-plotting-kill-girlfriend.

848 Fraga, 'Dossiê identifica 142 empresários do agronegócio', https://www.extraclasse.org.br/politica/2025/07/dossie-identifica-142-empresarios-do-agronegocio-ligados-a-atos-golpistas/.

849 Aline Melo, 'Quem é Fernando Cerimedo, preso em investigação sobre ataque a tiros à ex-companheira', *Agência Pública*, 18 August 2026, https://apublica.org/nota/quem-e-fernando-cerimedo-preso-por-investigacao-de-ataque/.

850 Guilherme Casarões, 'Foreign policy and transnational partisanship in', https://revistas.ucm.es/index.php/POSO/article/download/99351/4564456573289/4564456753168.

851 Tamaki, 'Beyond Electoral Fortunes', https://journals.sagepub.com/doi/10.1177/1866802X261424885.

majority is inevitable, and the difference between the two is exactly the space in which an election is decided. Whether a candidacy assembled from four incompatible rent streams and an imported playbook can convert that appearance into a government is the question the next chapter takes up.

Chapter 09: What the network is: class alliance, roster and the open frontiers

The preceding chapters assembled a record that can be read two ways. On the first reading, Bolsonarism in 2026 is a domestic populism that borrows foreign symbols (a conference, a strategist, a prime minister's recorded message) for legitimacy, and the transnational traffic is ornament. On the second, it is a class alliance with a determinate material content: fractions of Brazilian capital whose accumulation runs through foreign intermediation, politically organised through a foreign franchise and a foreign donor circuit. The record supports the second reading, in a specific form. What it shows is neither a family conspiracy nor a chain of command. It is the political expression of a comprador and agro-financial bloc, held together by the fact that no member's material interest is seriously injured by the programme the campaign carried to Washington, and bounded by an enforcement record that convicted the operators while stopping short of the family members who could be placed near the money but not inside an act.

Two terms need defining before going further. "Comprador" is the fraction of the local bourgeoisie that makes money by facilitating foreign control over a domestic function, such as a payment system or a mine. "Agro-financial" designates export agribusiness capital and the financial capital that revolves around it. A "bloc" is an alliance between fractions with different interests that, for a period, act together.

What the literature settles, and what it does not

The most useful framing comes from work whose very title joins the two terms at issue: foreign policy and transnational partisanship in Brazil.[852] A second body of scholarship puts durability in the title rather than in the actors: the study of the far-right alignment is titled "beyond electoral fortunes", its claim being that the alignment consolidated as something that outlasts one candidate's results.[853] A book-length treatment carries the movement's name as its title.[854] Read together, these establish that the phenomenon is neither a personality nor an election cycle.

852 Guilherme Casarões, 'Foreign policy and transnational partisanship in', https://revistas.ucm.es/index.php/POSO/article/download/99351/4564456573289/4564456753168.

853 Tamaki, 'Beyond Electoral Fortunes', https://journals.sagepub.com/doi/10.1177/1866802X261424885.

854 'Bolsonarismo', *rutgersuniversitypress.org*, 10 November 2023, https://www.rutgersuniversitypress.org/bolsonarismo/9781978838567.

The academic literature, taken as a whole, arrives at a reading close to this report's. Casarões and Belém Lopes, in *Política y Sociedad*, the journal of the Complutense University of Madrid, treat Bolsonaro's foreign policy as partisanship beyond borders, with Eduardo at the centre, from The Movement to lobbying in the US Congress.[855][856] CEBRI-Revista places Bannon, CPAC and the Madrid Forum at the centre of the current phase of the Brazilian far right's international ties.[857] Vieira and Faria, in *Revista Tempo do Mundo*, published by Ipea (the federal government's applied economic research institute), treat Eduardo as the family's chief international organiser and count five CPACs held in Brazil between 2019 and 2024, in a period when, in Latin America, only Mexico and Argentina hosted others.[858] Both authors are at the Pontifical Catholic University of Minas Gerais (PUC Minas), and the article's own phrase for Eduardo is "principal international articulator of the clan".[859] Silverman, in the *Journal of Illiberalism Studies*, shows that CPACs outside the United States depend on local partners and become a source of revenue for the American organisation that owns the brand.[860] On the Madrid Forum, Ballester Rodríguez and Perez Oliveira, in *Maracanan*, the journal of the State University of Rio de Janeiro (UERJ),[861] and Morales Martín and Álvarez Sepúlveda, in *e-l@tina*, published by the University of Buenos Aires,[862] describe the forum as a stage for the Bolsonarist denunciation of Lula, with Ernesto Araújo inside the structure of

855 Guilherme Casarões, 'Foreign policy and transnational partisanship in', https://revistas.ucm.es/index.php/POSO/article/download/99351/4564456573289/4564456753168.

856 *REDES TRANSNACIONAIS DA DIREITA RADICAL E A*, *Instituto de Pesquisa Econômica Aplicada*, 23 June 2026, https://www.ipea.gov.br/revistas/index.php/rtm/article/download/786/542/3077.

857 David Magalhães and Odilon Caldeira Neto, 'Brazilian Far-Right Transnationalization Pathways', *CEBRI Revista*, 2024, https://cebri.org/revista/en/artigo/173/brazilian-far-right-transnationalization-pathways.

858 Instituto de Pesquisa Econômica Aplicada, 'REDES TRANSNACIONAIS DA DIREITA RADICAL E', https://www.ipea.gov.br/revistas/index.php/rtm/article/download/786/542/3077.

859 Instituto de Pesquisa Econômica Aplicada, 'REDES TRANSNACIONAIS DA DIREITA RADICAL E', https://www.ipea.gov.br/revistas/index.php/rtm/article/download/786/542/3077.

860 Silverman, 'Rallying the Troops', https://www.illiberalism.org/rallying-the-troops-cpac-and-the-international-far-right/.

861 Mateo Ballester Rodríguez; Rodrigo Perez Oliveira, 'Derechas radicales conectadas en Iberoamérica: El Foro de Madrid y la alianza entre el bolsonarismo y el partido Vox', *Revista Maracanan*, 21 November 2025, https://www.e-publicacoes.uerj.br/maracanan/article/view/87585.

862 Sepúlveda, '(PDF) El Think Tank Fundación Disenso', https://www.researchgate.net/publication/393475238_El_Think_Tank_Fundacion_Disenso_y_la_Iberosfera_ideas_discursos_y_narrativas_de_las_nuevas_derechas_sobre_Iberoamerica.

the Fundación Disenso. Fernando Brancoli's book, *Bolsonarismo: The Global Origins and Future of Brazil's Far Right*, published by Rutgers University Press, retraces the movement's international origins.[863] On the digital machine, there is the DFRLab's 2020 analysis of the network Facebook took down[864] and Chrobak's study of the Brazilian right's early adoption of Parler, among others.[865] On Guo Wengui, the American court material is extensive, but research on his disinformation network rests almost entirely on Graphika's 2021 report, which mapped the network across Facebook, Instagram, YouTube, Twitter, Gab, Telegram, Parler and Discord and remains the most detailed account of that structure in existence,[866][867] and there is no study of Gettr in Brazil. The American organisation's own statements describe an international tour that launched an edition in Poland and, in March 2025, took its chairman and senior fellow to Jerusalem to speak at the International Conference on Combatting Antisemitism.[868]

These studies cannot answer the questions this record raises. They are gathered at the end of the chapter. Each is a documented transaction with an undocumented counterparty: they are the points at which the class-alliance reading stops being an inference and becomes a finding, and at which it has not yet arrived.

The roster and the asymmetry

The roster of legal casualties is long enough to function as a dataset, and its shape is the argument. Eduardo Bolsonaro was convicted by the Supreme Federal Court (STF) in June 2026 of coercion in the coup proceedings, sentenced to four years and two months and declared ineligible;[869] an arrest warrant followed in October, after the Chamber of Deputies

863 rutgersuniversitypress.org, 'Bolsonarismo', https://www.rutgersuniversitypress.org/bolsonarismo/9781978838567.

864 @DFRLab, 'Facebook removes inauthentic network linked to', https://medium.com/dfrlab/facebook-removes-inauthentic-network-linked-to-bolsonaro-allies-5927b0ae750d.

865 John Chrobak, 'The International Embrace of Parler by Right-Wing and Populist Parties', *illiberalism.org*, 25 January 2021, https://www.illiberalism.org/the-international-embrace-of-parler-by-right-wing-and-populist-parties/.

866 public-assets.graphika.com, 'Ants in a Web', https://public-assets.graphika.com/reports/graphika_report_ants_in_a_web.pdf.

867 public-assets.graphika.com, 'Ants in a Web', https://public-assets.graphika.com/reports/graphika_report_ants_in_a_web.pdf.

868 'CPAC International Tour Expands Conservative Values to Poland and Israel', *CPAC*, 26 March 2025, https://www.cpac.org/us/statements/03-26-25/cpac-international-tour-expands-conservative-values-to-poland-and-israel.

869 Agência Brasil, 'STF condena Eduardo Bolsonaro a inelegibilidade', https://agenciabrasil.ebc.com.br/justica/noticia/2026-06/stf-condena-eduardo-bolsonaro-inelegibilidade-e-4-anos-de-prisao.

had removed him for abandoning the seat.[870] Jair Bolsonaro is serving twenty-seven years and three months.[871] Carlos Bolsonaro and Alexandre Ramagem were indicted in June 2025 over the parallel intelligence apparatus.[872]

The chain reaches beyond the family. The final report of the CPMI (joint congressional inquiry) into January 8 proposed sixty-one indictments in total, sixteen of them in the category of financiers, and thirteen of those sixteen were farmers.[873][874] Paulo Figueiredo was charged by the Prosecutor General's Office in September 2025 alongside Eduardo,[875] and in the United States an entry of default was recorded against his consultancy in a case over $140,000 it received from one of Guo Wengui's shell companies.[876]

Then the asymmetry. Michelle Bolsonaro appears in the network's most damaging files and in none of the indictments. The R$ 89,000 in cheques that Fabrício Queiroz and his wife deposited into her personal account contradicted the explanation the then president had given, as the Brazilian press documented at the time;[877] the Supreme Court later archived, by ten votes to one, the petition to investigate the deposits.[878] In the Saudi jewellery case the PF (Federal Police) indicted Jair Bolsonaro and Mauro Cid.[879] In the coup inquiry the Federal

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870 DW, 'STF decreta prisão de Eduardo Bolsonaro', https://www.dw.com/pt-br/stf-decreta-pris%C3%A3o-de-eduardo-bolsonaro-ap%C3%B3s-condena%C3%A7%C3%A3o-por-coa%C3%A7%C3%A3o/a-79605868.

871 Wells, 'Jair Bolsonaro sentenced to 27 years', https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/c8xrqxk9p4xo.

872 Constança Rezende, 'Carlos e Ramagem são indiciados por 'Abin paralela'; PF vê crime de Bolsonaro, mas o deixa de fora', *Folha de S.Paulo*, 17 June 2025, https://www1.folha.uol.com.br/poder/2025/06/pf-indicia-bolsonaro-carlos-e-ramagem-no-caso-da-abin-paralela.shtml.

873 'Relatora da CPMI pede indiciamento de Bolsonaro e de mais 60 pessoas', *Senado Federal*, 17 October 2023, https://www12.senado.leg.br/noticias/materias/2023/10/17/relatora-da-cpmi-pede-indiciamento-de-bolsonaro-e-de-mais-60-pessoas.

874 Ruralistas, 'Entre 16 financiadores do golpe denunciados', https://deolhonosruralistas.com.br/2023/10/17/entre-16-financiadores-do-golpe-denunciados-por-cpmi13-sao-fazendeiros/.

875 Agência Brasil, 'PGR denuncia Eduardo Bolsonaro e Paulo', https://agenciabrasil.ebc.com.br/justica/noticia/2025-09/pgr-denuncia-eduardo-bolsonaro-e-paulo-figueiredo-por-coacao.

876 Jones, 'Brazil's Key MAGA Ally Linked to', https://apublica.org/2025/08/records-reveal-paulo-figueiredos-alleged-connection-to-fraud/.

877 BBC News Brasil, 'As contradições de Bolsonaro sobre depósitos da família Queiroz a Michelle, que agora chegam a R$ 89 mil', *BBC News Brasil*, 8 August 2020, https://www.bbc.com/portuguese/brasil-53706559.

Police's director-general said she had not been indicted with her husband because the investigators had not seen "sufficient elements" to reach that conclusion.[880]

The correct reading of that asymmetry is not exemption. It is that the Brazilian state acted against the operators whose conduct could be proven and not against the family members who could be placed near the money but not inside an act. That is what due process produces, and it is why the enforcement record cannot be read as a family story: the Supreme Court convicted the son who lobbied; the commentator who broadcast was charged alongside him by the Prosecutor General's Office and has not been tried.[881]

The enforcement also ran in the other direction, which belongs in the roster. The United States designated Justice Alexandre de Moraes under the Global Magnitsky sanctions programme on July 30, 2025;[882] the Treasury's sanctions list was amended to remove his name on December 12, 2025.[883] An instrument aimed at a foreign judiciary was withdrawn four and a half months later, which is itself evidence: the network could reach the enforcer, but could not hold him.

The class content

A class fraction is not a label attached to a group of people; it is a description of where a group's income comes from and which policy it therefore cannot survive. On that test the 2026 coalition holds at least four distinct positions, and only some are comprador, in the sense of accumulating by facilitating external control of a domestic function.

The payments and minerals fraction is the clearest case. Its income depends on bringing foreign capital into Brazilian infrastructure and subsoil; the fifteen-year agreement with the United States government to purchase one hundred per cent of the acquired mine's first-phase production, with guaranteed price floors for the magnetic rare earths, is the purest instance.[884] That fraction's interest is served by the July 2026 submission, which offered Washington a

878 Campos, 'Por 10 a 1, STF arquiva', https://veja.abril.com.br/coluna/maquiavel/por-10-a-1-stf-arquiva-pedido-para-apurar-cheques-de-queiroz-a-michelle/.

879 'PF indicia Bolsonaro e Mauro Cid no caso das joias sauditas', *Agência Brasil*, 4 July 2024, https://agenciabrasil.ebc.com.br/justica/noticia/2024-07/pf-indicia-bolsonaro-no-caso-das-joias-sauditas.

880 O Globo, 'PF não viu 'elementos suficientes' para', https://oglobo.globo.com/politica/noticia/2025/01/28/pf-nao-viu-elementos-suficientes-para-o-indiciamento-de-michelle-bolsonaro-em-plano-de-golpe-diz-diretor-geral.ghtml.

881 'PGR denuncia Eduardo Bolsonaro e Paulo Figueiredo por coação', *Agência Brasil*, 22 September 2025, https://agenciabrasil.ebc.com.br/justica/noticia/2025-09/pgr-denuncia-eduardo-bolsonaro-e-paulo-figueiredo-por-coacao.

882 U.S. Department of the Treasury, 'Treasury Sanctions Alexandre de Moraes', https://home.treasury.gov/news/press-releases/sb0211.

883 Office of Foreign Assets Control | U.S. Department of the Treasury, 'Global Magnitsky Designations Removals', https://ofac.treasury.gov/recent-actions/20251212.

legislative commitment to keep Pix (the Central Bank's free instant payment system) closed to "non-Western" settlement systems in exchange for tariff relief.[885]

The agrarian fraction is not comprador. Its rent rests on a state contribution (in Mato Grosso, a per-tonne contribution collected by the state finance department, which does not classify it as a tax, and transferred under a 2019 state law and agreement to an institute linked to the soybean producers' association, R$ 138 million in transfers in all) and realised through a single foreign buyer.[886][887] That buyer is China, which took about eighty per cent of Brazil's soybean exports in 2025.[888] A senator from the ruralist bench said a Flávio Bolsonaro government would need balance in agribusiness negotiations with the United States and China;[889] Blairo Maggi said, at an agribusiness meeting hosted by Bradesco BBI, that Bolsonaro, and Brazilian diplomacy with him, had erred in confronting China to please the United States.[890] Neither statement is available to a fraction whose income runs through the American relationship.

The family core is a third position and the franchise a fourth. The family holds political capital that converts into contracts; the Fundo Partidário (public party fund) of the PL (Bolsonaro's Liberal Party) paid R$ 600,000 over 2024 to the operator of the institute Eduardo Bolsonaro co-founded.[891] What is documented is a chain of introductions: Eduardo

884 sec.gov, https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1970622/000121390026092810/ea030292401ex99-2.htm.

885 Jornal O Sul, 'Flávio Bolsonaro propõe aos Estados Unidos', https://www.osul.com.br/flavio-bolsonaro-propoe-aos-estados-unidos-barrar-conexao-do-pix-com-sistemas-nao-ocidentais/.

886 Fethab repassou R$ 138 milhões para a Aprosoja por meio de convênio com a Sefaz | Gazeta Digital, 'Fethab repassou R$ 138 milhões para', https://www.gazetadigital.com.br/editorias/politica-de-mt/fethab-repassou-r-138-milhes-para-a-aprosoja-por-meio-de-convnio-com-a-sefaz/666718.

887 'Novo Fethab inclui exportações e eleva arrecadação estadual em mais de R$ 540 mi - SEFAZ', *SEFAZ*, https://www5.sefaz.mt.gov.br/-/11082689-novo-fethab-inclui-exportacoes-e-eleva-arrecadacao-estadual-em-mais-de-r-540-mi.

888 Lustosa, 'Brasil fecha 2025 com recorde na', https://agfeed.com.br/economia/brasil-fecha-2025-com-recorde-na-exportacao-de-soja-mas-anec-ja-projeta-desafios-para-2026/.

889 Rural, 'Flávio Bolsonaro precisará de equilíbrio em', https://www.novacana.com/noticias/flavio-bolsonaro-precisara-de-equilibrio-em-negociacoes-do-agro-com-eua-e-china-diz-senadora.

890 Augusto, 'Rei da Soja' diz que Bolsonaro', https://www.moneytimes.com.br/para-o-rei-da-soja-bolsonaro-errou-ao-enfrentar-china-cita-grande-perigo-para-o-agronegocio-brasileiro-e-chama-trump-de-doidao-pads/.

891 Rudnitzki, 'Sócio de Eduardo Bolsonaro presta serviço', https://apublica.org/2026/10/socio-de-eduardo-bolsonaro-presta-servico-para-campanhas-eleitorais/.

Bolsonaro's 2022 Gulf tour was opened by Renzo Gracie and included a meeting with the chief executive of the Edge Group, a state military-technology conglomerate, Mansour Mohamed AlMulla.[892] What the four positions share is not a common accumulation model but a common immunity from the programme's costs. Closing the payment system or forward-selling the mine injures no member's material interest, and that absence of injury is the only coherence the bloc requires.

The name for the coalition as a whole is therefore not "the comprador bourgeoisie". It is a comprador and agro-financial bloc: an alliance in which the leading political project belongs to the comprador fraction and the decisive electoral base belongs to a fraction whose interests that project does not serve. That is an unstable description, and it should be. It holds for 2026 and for the sectors named (payments, defence minerals, state-level public utilities, export agriculture). It does not extend to Brazilian capital as a whole, and it should not be treated as permanent: the sectoral composition of the coalition is the variable that will decide what survives its founder.

Who pays the bill

The immunity of the bloc's members has a counterpart: someone pays. Three promises the campaign made to Washington carry a cost for workers, and none of them appears in the programme presented to voters. Flávio's submission to the US trade office was published in full, as an 86-page copy of the comment filed in docket USTR-2026-0331, and the quotations below come from it.[893]

The card. To the American office, Flávio asked for relief from the "regulatory and tax burden" on card networks and acquirers (the companies that run card machines) (pages 11 and 12).[894][895] Two things must be kept apart: the card networks earn fees charged on each sale, while card interest goes to the banks that issue the cards. In February 2026, interest on revolving credit stood at 435.9% a year, and on instalment credit at 200.2%.[896] A 2023 law

892 Frazão, 'Renzo Gracie leva Eduardo Bolsonaro a', https://www.estadao.com.br/politica/renzo-gracie-abre-portas-para-eduardo-bolsonaro-no-oriente-medio/.

893 Senator Flávio Bolsonaro, 'Written Comment on the Proposed Action', docket USTR-2026-0331, 1 July 2026, copy published by *Poder360*, https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/07/Flavio-pede-aos-EUA-adiamento-de-tarifaco-2jul2026.pdf.

894 Senator Flávio Bolsonaro, 'Written Comment on the Proposed Action', docket USTR-2026-0331, 1 July 2026, copy published by *Poder360*, https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/07/Flavio-pede-aos-EUA-adiamento-de-tarifaco-2jul2026.pdf.

895 Giovanna Estrela, 'Aos EUA, Flávio critica Mercosul e defende empresas de cartões de crédito', *Metrópoles*, 2 July 2026, https://www.metropoles.com/brasil/aos-eua-flavio-critica-mercosul-e-defende-empresas-de-cartoes-de-credito.

896 Agência Brasil, 'Juros do cartão de crédito pesam', https://agenciabrasil.ebc.com.br/economia/noticia/2026-03/juros-do-cartao-de-credito-pesam-

capped total interest and charges on revolving and instalment debt at the original amount owed, but did not cap the rate.[897] In July 2026, 82% of families were in debt, a record for the series, and the credit card appeared in 85.3% of those cases.[898] The weight falls on those who earn least: in August, among families earning up to three minimum wages, 38.8% had overdue bills, against 14.9% among those earning more than ten.[899] The programme registered with the TSE (Superior Electoral Court) speaks to this indebted voter ("the salary comes in and almost all of it goes out to cover the card's revolving balance").[900] The request to Washington does not touch interest rates[901].

Mercosur. In the same document, Flávio said Brazil should "free itself from Mercosur bindings", following "the path taken by Javier Milei's Argentina" (p. 12).[902] Argentina is Brazil's third-largest buyer, behind China and the United States, and buys mainly industrial goods: in June 2026, vehicles made up 16.9% of what it took from Brazil, and auto parts 7.9%.[903] In 2022 the bloc absorbed almost a fifth (19.8%) of the manufactured goods Brazil exported, and by the National Confederation of Industry's calculations each R$ 1 billion exported to Mercosur sustains 24,400 jobs, against 15,700 in the case of China, because what is sold to the neighbours is industry and not raw materials.[904] The figure measures jobs linked to those sales, not jobs that would automatically be lost on exit; but it shows where the blow

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mais-para-familias-em-fevereiro.

897 Presidência da República, 'Lei nº 14.690, de 3 de outubro de 2023', *Planalto*, 3 October 2023, https://www.planalto.gov.br/ccivil_03/_ato2023-2026/2023/lei/l14690.htm.

898 Agência Brasil, 'CNC: endividamento das famílias sobe para 82%, mas inadimplência cai', https://agenciabrasil.ebc.com.br/economia/noticia/2026-08/cnc-endividamento-das-familias-sobe-para-82-mas-inadimplencia-cai.

899 CNC, 'CNC: mais endividadas do que a média, famílias de menor renda lideram avanço na inadimplência em agosto', *Portal do Comércio*, 10 September 2026, https://portaldocomercio.org.br/acoes-institucionais/cnc-mais-endividadas-do-que-a-media-familias-de-menor-renda-lideram-avanco-na-inadimplencia-em-agosto/.

900 static.poder360.com.br, 'Diretrizes_Plano_de_Governo_Flavio_Bolsonaro_2027-2030_versaofinal', https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/08/plano-governo-flavio.pdf.

901 Senator Flávio Bolsonaro, 'Written Comment on the Proposed Action', docket USTR-2026-0331, 1 July 2026, copy published by *Poder360*, https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/07/Flavio-pede-aos-EUA-adiamento-de-tarifaco-2jul2026.pdf.

902 Senator Flávio Bolsonaro, 'Written Comment on the Proposed Action', docket USTR-2026-0331, 1 July 2026, copy published by *Poder360*, https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/07/Flavio-pede-aos-EUA-adiamento-de-tarifaco-2jul2026.pdf.

903 'Exportações brasileiras para Argentina caíram 18% nos últimos 12 meses; veja os números da balança comercial', *O Globo*, 28 July 2026, https://oglobo.globo.com/economia/noticia/2026/07/28/exportacoes-brasileiras-para-argentina-cairam-18percent-nos-ultimos-12-meses-veja-raio-x-da-balanca-comercial.ghtml.

would land: in car assembly, auto parts and machinery. Leaving the bloc would also strip workers of two rights: the Residence Agreement, which allows Brazilians to live and work in neighbouring countries,[905] and the social security agreement, which allows contribution time in more than one member country to be added together for a pension.[906][907][908] One detail weighs against the argument: "the path of Milei's Argentina" was not leaving Mercosur. Milei remains in the bloc, and the agreement between Mercosur and the European Union entered into provisional force in May 2026.[909][910]

Ethanol. The document asks for a zero-tariff agreement in both directions for ethanol and sugar (p. 15).[911] American corn ethanol enters Brazil mainly through the Northeast: according to the federation of sugarcane suppliers, Feplana, 60% to 70% arrives through the port of Itaqui, in Maranhão, and the federation called the opening a "death shot" for the sector.[912][913] When the Bolsonaro government enlarged the tariff-free import quota in 2019, it was equivalent, according to the Pernambuco producers' union, to more than 30% of the ethanol

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904 Daniel Rittner, 'Mercosul perde relevância comercial, mas vira "salvação" da indústria, mostra estudo', *CNN Brasil*, 3 July 2023, https://www.cnnbrasil.com.br/economia/macroeconomia/mercosul-perde-relevancia-comercial-mas-vira-salvacao-da-industria-mostra-estudo/.

905 'Artigo 1', *planalto.gov.br*, 8 October 2009, https://www.planalto.gov.br/ccivil_03/_ato2007-2010/2009/decreto/d6975.htm.

906 'Acordo Multilateral de Seguridade Social do Mercado Comum do Sul', *Instituto Nacional do Seguro Social - INSS*, 28 March 2025, https://www.gov.br/inss/pt-br/direitos-e-deveres/acordos-internacionais/paises/mercosul.

907 'Seguridade social', *MERCOSUL*, 10 June 2025, https://www.mercosur.int/pt-br/estatuto-de-la-ciudadania/seguridade-social.

908 *PREVIDÊNCIA*, *gov.br*, 6 June 2018, https://www.gov.br/previdencia/pt-br/assuntos/acordos-internacionais/acordos-internacionais-em-vigor/mercosul/mercosulpt.pdf.

909 'Acordo Mercosul-UE valerá provisoriamente em maio, confirma governo', *Agência Brasil*, 25 March 2026, https://agenciabrasil.ebc.com.br/economia/noticia/2026-03/acordo-mercosul-ue-valera-provisoriamente-em-maio-confirma-governo.

910 Marcos Falcone, 'Argentina Gives Mercosur an Ultimatum It Can't Ignore', *Cato Institute*, 28 August 2026, https://www.cato.org/blog/argentina-gives-mercosur-ultimatum-it-cant-ignore.

911 Senator Flávio Bolsonaro, 'Written Comment on the Proposed Action', docket USTR-2026-0331, 1 July 2026, copy published by *Poder360*, https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/07/Flavio-pede-aos-EUA-adiamento-de-tarifaco-2jul2026.pdf.

912 Belfort, 'Tiro de morte"', https://movimentoeconomico.com.br/agronegocio/2026/06/06/tiro-de-morte-feplana-critica-possivel-fim-da-tarifa-sobre-etanol-americano/.

produced in the Northeast.[914] The sector is small in the national total but labour-intensive: the association of mills in the North and Northeast cites 280,000 direct jobs in the two regions,[915] and Pernambuco alone has 13 mills and about 65,000 people working the harvest.[916] The threat does not come from Flávio alone: in June, Feplana itself criticised the Lula government, which was studying the opening.[917] The documented difference is that the Development minister, Márcio Elias Rosa, answered “never” to the proposal,[918] and the one who put it in writing before Washington was Flávio. In July, the United States imposed a 25% tariff on Brazilian goods, ethanol included.[919][920]

Where the mine sets up. There are also those who pay on the ground. In Minaçu, in Goiás, home of Serra Verde, mining royalties averaged the equivalent of 5% of the municipal budget between 2010 and 2021 and did not reduce poverty between 2014 and 2020: today 30% of the municipality’s families live in poverty, and farmers report streams rising in the mine area with

913 Ângela Fernanda Belfort, ‘Tiro de morte”: Feplana critica possível fim da tarifa sobre etanol americano’, *Movimento Econômico*, 6 June 2026, https://movimentoeconomico.com.br/agronegocio/2026/06/06/tiro-de-morte-feplana-critica-possivel-fim-da-tarifa-sobre-etanol-americano/.

914 Barrucho, ‘Produtores do Nordeste temem medida de’, https://www.bbc.com/portuguese/brasil-49583625.

915 ‘NovaBio divulga levantamento prévio de moagem das usinas do Norte e Nordeste; confira detalhes’, *Folha de Pernambuco*, 27 October 2023, https://www.folhape.com.br/economia/novabio-divulga-levantamento-previo-de-moagem-das-usinas-do-norte-e/298674/.

916 Belfort, ‘Safra de cana-de-açúcar em PE deve’, https://movimentoeconomico.com.br/agronegocio/2026/08/21/safra-de-cana-de-acucar-em-pe-deve-chegar-a-13-milhoes-de-toneladas/.

917 Folha de Pernambuco, ‘Feplana prevê fim do setor canavieiro no Nordeste se governo Lula ceder aos EUA’, *NovaCana*, 3 June 2026, https://www.novacana.com/noticias/feplana-preve-fim-setor-canavieiro-nordeste-governo-lula-ceder-eua-030626.

918 Hermanson, ‘Redução da tarifa sobre etanol americano’, https://www1.folha.uol.com.br/mercado/2026/07/reducao-da-tarifa-sobre-etanol-americano-nao-esta-em-negociacao-diz-ministro.shtml.

919 Vinicius Marques, ‘UNICA condena sobretaxa de 25% ao etanol’, *Times Brasil | CNBC*, 16 July 2026, https://timesbrasil.com.br/brasil/tarifado-setor-sucroenergetico-brasileiro-diz-que-queda-de-87-da-importacao-do-etanol-dos-eua-foi-compensada-por-producao-nacional/.

920 ‘Tarifa de Trump: setor de etanol e açúcar rebate EUA e diz que medida’, *G1*, 16 July 2026, https://g1.globo.com/economia/agronegocios/noticia/2026/07/16/as-tarifas-dos-eua-sobre-o-brasil-sao-uma-pilula-amarga-para-os-produtores-de-acucar-e-etanol.ghtml.

reddened water.[921] Residents report rising rents with the arrival of workers,[922] and the map in the project's environmental impact report includes the agrarian reform settlements of Céu Azul, Mucambão and Dom Roriz.[923] In southern Bahia, where Energy Fuels holds 19 mining applications over monazite sands,[924] 10 of them overlap the buffer zone of the Cassurubá Marine Extractive Reserve, and the Pataxó people of the Comexatibá Indigenous Land, according to a local organisation, were not consulted.[925]

The pattern is the same on all four fronts. The gains from the agenda carried to Washington go to the card networks, the buyers of ore and defence capital; the costs fall on small retailers, indebted families, the industrial workers whose factories sell to the neighbours, the sugarcane workers of the Northeast and the communities where the mine sets up. That is why these promises appear in the document sent to the US government and not in the programme presented to voters.

The complicating record

Three findings cut against the thesis and have to be stated as such. First, the United States withdrew its tariffs where they reached American prices: the 40 per cent duties on Brazilian beef, coffee, cocoa and fruits were removed in November 2025,[926] and the final action, of July 2026, imposed 25 per cent on about 18% of Brazil's exports to the United States, sparing beef, coffee and orange juice and hitting sugar, ethanol, agricultural machinery, footwear and

921 Seta, 'Do amianto às terras raras, cidade', https://apublica.org/2025/07/do-amianto-as-terras-raras-cidade-de-goias-vive-entre-passado-e-futuro-da-mineracao/.

922 G1, 'Terras raras', https://g1.globo.com/go/goias/noticia/2026/08/26/saiba-como-cidade-goiana-saiu-da-exploracao-de-amianto-para-o-centro-da-disputa-por-terras-raras.ghtml.

923 dfc.gov, 'Mineração de Terras Raras em Minaçu', https://www.dfc.gov/sites/default/files/esia/2025/serraverde/Project/05_Local%20Language%20Summary%20of%20ESIA%20(RIMA)_508.pdf.

924 Neri, 'Grupo ligado à campanha de Flávio', https://conjur.com.br/2026-set-22/grupo-dos-eua-ligado-a-campanha-de-flavio-bolsonaro-explora-terras-raras-na-bahia/.

925 O Globo, 'Multinacional mira terras-raras e urânio no', https://oglobo.globo.com/brasil/noticia/2026/10/10/multinacional-mira-terras-raras-e-uranio-no-santuario-ecologico-do-sul-da-bahia.ghtml.

926 Teixeira, 'Trump signs order to remove tariffs', https://www.reuters.com/world/us/trump-signs-order-remove-tariffs-some-brazilian-agricultural-imports-2025-11-20/.

paper.[927928929] A protector imposing costs on its own consumers is not commanding an alliance; it is negotiating with one.

Second, the Brazilian state acted autonomously and effectively. The convictions, the Federal Police operations, the electoral court's proceedings and the September 2026 minerals law giving the executive power to decide on foreign participation all proceeded without regard to Washington's preferences,[930] and the Supreme Court convicted a former president's son in June 2026, less than four months before an election in which the family was on the ballot.[931] A comprador fraction controlling the state would not have produced that record.

Third, the agrarian base's dependence on Beijing is material, not rhetorical, and it did not bend when the confrontation was sharpest. A coalition that endorses a programme built against its own export market is not coherent. It is buying time, and what it is buying time against is the moment when the programme's terms become the government's terms.

What the network is

The network is the political expression of a comprador and agro-financial bloc: a coalition in which the leading programme belongs to capital whose accumulation runs through foreign intermediation, the decisive electoral base belongs to capital whose accumulation runs through a Chinese order book, and the organisational form belongs to a foreign franchise that sells the product and keeps the liability offshore. It is not a family, although a family sits at its centre. It is not a command structure, although commands travel through it. It is an alliance held together by the fact that its programme damages none of its members enough to make them leave, and whose cost falls on those who are not in it.

What remains open is what the record cannot reach: the counterparties to documented transactions and, with them, the question of whether the comprador fraction directs the coalition or merely rides it. Those frontiers are listed below and are not close to closure. Until they are, the class-alliance reading is the best-supported account available: one whose leading fraction is identified, whose base is not yet converted, and whose outcome will be decided

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927 Federal Register, 'Notice of Action', https://www.federalregister.gov/documents/2026/07/20/2026-14542/notice-of-action-brazils-acts-policies-and-practices-related-to-digital-trade-and-electronic-payment.

928 United States Trade Representative, 'USTR Section 301 Action on Brazil's', https://ustr.gov/about/policy-offices/press-office/press-releases/2026/july/ustr-section-301-action-brazils-unreasonable-acts-policies-and-practices.

929 Nair, 'US imposes new 25% tariffs on', https://www.reuters.com/world/americas/us-imposes-25-tariff-some-goods-brazil-2026-07-16/.

930 Spechoto, 'Lula sanciona lei dos minerais críticos', https://c-level.folha.uol.com.br/infraestrutura/2026/09/lula-sanciona-lei-dos-minerais-criticos-com-r-5-bi-em-subsidios-e-poder-de-decidir-sobre-estrangeiros.shtml.

931 Mauricio Savarese, 'Brazil's top court convicts son of former President Bolsonaro for coercion', *AP News*, 16 June 2026, https://apnews.com/article/brazil-supreme-court-eduardo-bolsonaro-coercion-ff7f2fd0c16a46308aa3b1ee161548f0.

less by anything Washington does than by whether the export bloc's trade with Beijing continues, and whether that trade continues to outweigh its preference for the politics of the man it endorsed.

What remains to be learned

Some things did not appear in the public documents, which does not mean they do not exist: a foreign consultancy formally hired by the campaign, a voter study carried out by a foreign firm (the suppliers declared to the electoral court are Brazilian), Rockbridge money reaching the campaign, or a Cerimedo or Parscale contract in Brazil. The same holds for US government agencies: the documents on their activity remain classified, and those agencies' history in Brazil does not allow their involvement to be ruled out. The new form of interference, carried out in the open by government, foundations, donors and vendors, adds to the old one, that of the agencies; it has not replaced it.

These are the questions worth the next round of reporting:

- Who drafted the 86-page document Flávio submitted to the US trade office on July 1, 2026, the last day of the comment period, and on whose instruction?[932] The filed text still carried an internal drafting instruction, in English, according to which the tariff codes "should be confirmed against the current HTSUS and cross-checked against the exclusions already in the Notice's Annex before filing" (p. 84).[933]
- Who are the owners of Rockbridge Brazil LLC, registered in Wyoming on May 12, 2026, and who funds it?[934]
- Who will receive the $1 million the State Department obligated hours before the fiscal year closed?[935]
- Who paid for the foreign posts labelled "paid partnership" published between September 18 and 21?[936]

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932 Junior, 'Carta de Flávio aos EUA inclui', https://www.jornalfolhadoestado.com/politica/carta-de-flavio-aos-eua-inclui-proposta-para-restringir-integracao-do-pix/.

933 Senator Flávio Bolsonaro, 'Written Comment on the Proposed Action', docket USTR-2026-0331, 1 July 2026, copy published by *Poder360*, https://static.poder360.com.br/uploads/2026/07/Flavio-pede-aos-EUA-adiamento-de-tarifaco-2jul2026.pdf.

934 Business Entity Search, 'Rockbridge Brazil LLC', https://businessregistry.com/wyoming/rockbridge-brazil-llc/.

935 Gedeon, 'Trump administration diverts human rights funds', https://www.theguardian.com/us-news/2026/sep/30/trump-state-department-human-rights-fund.

936 Aosfatos, 'Posts pró-Flávio no X expõem elo', https://www.aosfatos.org/noticias/posts-pro-flavio-elo-polymarket-rede-transnacional-desinformacao/.

- What exactly did Elytron supply for the R$ 600,000 the campaign declared, and why did the partial financial report record R$ 1 million?[937]
- Is there Emirati money or interest behind that contract, as suggested by the corporate chain running from Tahnoon bin Zayed, through IHC, Aleria and Lerco, to a former Elytron executive (chapter 7)?
- Did the Texas fund controlled by Eduardo Bolsonaro's allies receive the money the Federal Police traced from Daniel Vorcaro, and did any of it cover Eduardo's expenses in the United States?[938]
- How much did Gettr, supplied with Guo Wengui's money, and Aprosoja of Mato Grosso pay for the conferences that functioned as pre-campaign events?[939][940]
- Who holds the CPAC brand in Brazil, and what does the American organisation that owns the brand charge or receive for the licence?
- What role did US government agencies play, whose documents remain classified?

Each of these questions points to a documented transaction with a counterparty the documents do not yet show.

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937 Goulart, 'EXCLUSIVO', https://www.intercept.com.br/2026/10/16/flavio-pagou-empresa-eua-sistema-manipular-eleicoes/.

938 Marques, 'PF suspeita que dinheiro de Vorcaro', https://www1.folha.uol.com.br/poder/2026/05/pf-suspeita-que-dinheiro-de-vorcaro-tenha-custeado-despesas-de-eduardo-bolsonaro-nos-eua.shtml.

939 Maciel, 'Rede social trumpista patrocina eventos que', https://apublica.org/2022/06/rede-social-trumpista-patrocina-eventos-que-fazem-pre-campanha-para-bolsonaro/.

940 Naldis, 'Associação de produtores de soja financia', https://www.estadao.com.br/politica/associacao-produtores-soja-aprosoja-mt-financia-cpac-nao-ver-vies-partidario-evento-direita-nprp/.

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